



ADLM STUDIO · EVERY PRODUCT

The complete ADLM user guide

Every ADLM product in one book: getting started, the Installer Hub, QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen, SERVIQ for Revit MEP, Time Pro, the ADLM Cloud, the sample projects and the QS handbook.

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adlmstudio.net/guides

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Good habits

Getting started with ADLM Studio

Create your account, buy a licence, install your software and find your way around your account, billing, seats and support.

This guide is for everyone who uses ADLM Studio software, whether you have just heard of us or you are renewing for the third year. It walks you through creating your account, paying for a product, installing it, and looking after your licence, devices, invoices and support requests on adlmstudio.net. It describes the website as it is on 4 October 2026, after the new design went live on 1 October. At the end there is a table of every ADLM product with a link to its own guide.

What's new in October 2026

- **A new website design.** The public pages, sign-in and sign-up have a new look. Once you sign in you land on your **Overview** ([/manage](#)), with one menu down the left side of every signed-in page. The old [/dashboard](#) address opens the Overview too.
- **Sign in and sign up in one place.** **Sign in** and **Sign up** sit at the top right of every public page, with **Continue with Google**, **Continue with Microsoft** or **Continue with Autodesk** under each form.
- **Software comes from the Installer Hub only.** The only file you download from the website is the ADLM Installer Hub. The Hub installs every product your licence covers.
- **WhatsApp verification.** Confirm your WhatsApp number with a six-digit code sent on WhatsApp, from **Account settings**.
- **Sign-up checks your email can receive our code.** An address that can never receive mail is refused at sign-up, so you are not left waiting for a code that cannot arrive.
- **Ada, on every page.** **Ask Ada** is at the top of the signed-in menu as well as the round button in the corner. Signed in, she can answer about your own licences and projects.
- **Choose how the site looks.** **Appearance** in **Account settings** offers **Light**, **Dark blue**, **Black** or **Match my device**.

Before you start

You need:

- An email address you can open now. We send a six-digit code to it before your account can be used.
- A WhatsApp number, with the country code (for example +2348012345678). It is required when you sign up.
- A web browser on a phone, tablet or computer. Everything in this guide works in any modern browser.
- For the desktop products (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen, Revit MEP, CIVIQ and Time Pro), a Windows 64-bit computer. These are installed with the [ADLM Installer Hub](#).

One ADLM account signs you in to every product, on every machine. The same email and password work on the website, in the Installer Hub and inside Revit, PlanSwift and the other host programs.

Create your account

Sign up with your email

1. Open adlmstudio.net and click **Sign up** at the top right. On a phone, open the menu first.
2. On **Create your ADLM account**, enter your **First name** and **Last name**.
3. Enter your **Email**.
4. Enter your **WhatsApp number**, with the country code.
5. Enter a **Password**. It must be at least 8 characters and contain at least one letter and one number.
6. Click **Create account**. It reads **Creating your account...** while it works.

You are taken straight to the **Confirm your email** screen. By creating an account you agree to the **Terms** and **Privacy Policy** linked under the button.

NOTE

If the site says the user already exists, an account with that email is already registered. Click **Sign in** instead and use **Forgot your password?** if you need to. If it says your email cannot receive our code, check the spelling or use another address.

Confirm your email address

Your account cannot be used, and you cannot buy anything, until your email address is confirmed.

1. Open the email from ADLM Studio. It contains a six-digit code. It can take a minute to arrive, so check your spam or promotions folder too.
2. Type the six digits into the box on the **Confirm your email** screen.
3. Click **Confirm**.

The code works for 30 minutes. On the same screen you can:

- Click **Send a new code** if it has expired or never arrived.
- Click **Wrong address? Change it** if you mistyped your email, enter **The right email address**, then click **Send the code there**.
- Click **Sign out** to leave and come back later.

Once confirmed, you arrive on your **Overview**. Until you confirm, a bar across the top of every page reads "Confirm your email address to use your account." Click **Enter the code** in that bar to come back to this screen.

IMPORTANT

The desktop products also refuse to sign in until your email is confirmed. They tell you to sign in at adlmstudio.net, enter the code, and then try again.

Sign up with Google, Microsoft or Autodesk

Under the sign-up form you may see **Continue with Google**, **Continue with Microsoft** or **Continue with Autodesk**. Only the ones we have switched on are shown. Clicking one creates your ADLM account from that provider's account, already confirmed, or signs you in if you already have one with the same email.

IMPORTANT

Google, Microsoft and Autodesk sign-in work on the website only. The Windows software always asks for an email and a password. After a social sign-in, open your **Profile** and use **Set a password for the desktop software**. Do it straight away, otherwise you cannot open QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen, the Revit MEP plugin, Time Pro or CIVIQ.

Sign in

ADLM Studio

One account.
Every product,
every machine.

Your licences, your rate library and every project measured against it — reachable from Revit, from the Installer Hub, from a browser and from your phone.

- ✓ Sign in on a new laptop and your seats follow you
- ✓ The rate library belongs to the practice, not to a machine
- ✓ Work extracted from a model stays reachable without the model

Sign in

New here? [Create an ADLM account](#)

Email or username

you@practice.ng

Password

☒ Keep me signed in [Forgot your password?](#)

Sign in

or

Continue with Google

Continue with Microsoft

Trouble signing in? [Contact support](#)

Ask Ada

The sign-in page, with email and password or Google and Microsoft sign-in.

1. Click **Sign in** at the top right of any public page.
2. Enter your **Email or username** and your **Password**.
3. Leave **Keep me signed in** ticked on your own computer. Untick it on a shared one.
4. Click **Sign in**.

If you connected Google, Microsoft or Autodesk, you can click the matching **Continue with** button instead. New to ADLM? Click **Create an ADLM account** on the same page.

Some accounts are asked for a second step. If you see **Enter your code**, type the **6-digit code** we emailed you and click **Sign in**.

Forgot your password

1. On the sign-in page, click **Forgot your password?**. The **Reset your password** form opens.
2. Enter your **Email** and click **Send the code**.
3. Check your email for a six-digit code. It works for 10 minutes.

4. Type the code into **6-digit code**.
5. Type a **New password** (at least 8 characters, with a letter and a number).
6. Click **Set the password**. The page says "Password updated. You can now sign in."
7. Sign in with the new password.

Click **Back to sign in** to leave the form. If you are still stuck, click **Contact support** under **Trouble signing in?**

The codes we send you

Code	When you get it	Valid for
Email confirmation	After you sign up, or when you change the address	30 minutes
Password reset	After you click Forgot your password?	10 minutes
WhatsApp verification	When you click Verify on WhatsApp	A few minutes
Destructive-action code	Before deleting a project or locking a contract, if you turned this on	About 10 minutes

TIP

Never share a code with anyone. ADLM support does not need your codes or your password to help you.

Extra protection for deleting projects

On your **Profile**, under **Security & Admin**, tick **Require an email code for destructive actions**. When it is on, we email you a six-digit code before you can delete a project or lock or unlock a contract. Untick it to turn it off.

Your account area

The menu

Every signed-in page has a menu down the left side. On a phone, open it with the menu button at the top left.

- **Ask Ada (Your library, answered)** at the top opens Ada.
- **Work: Overview, My tools** (QUIV, HERON, RateGen, Constants, SERVIQ, CIVIQ) and **Projects**. These are your project workspaces, covered in the [ADLM Cloud guide](#). A tool you have no licence for is marked **Add**.
- **Learn: My learning, Assignments, Certificates, Lessons & events** and **Guides & docs**.
- **Manage** (marked **Installer Hub**): **Overview, Products & seats, Team, Billing & invoices, Downloads** and **Support**.
- **Account settings** and **Sign out** at the bottom.

The bar at the top has a search box that jumps to a page by its name, and a bell for reminders.

NOTE

A few menu items still open the older page that does the same job. **Billing & invoices** and **Account settings** open your **Profile**, **Support** opens **Request technical help**, **Guides & docs** opens **What's New**, and **Products & seats, Team** and **Downloads** open your **Overview**. To reach those three pages, use the links on the Overview described below, or type their address.

Overview

Your **Overview** ([/manage](#)) is where you land after signing in. It greets you by name ("Good morning", "Good afternoon" or "Good evening") and shows **Products active**, **Seats in use**, **Next charge** and **Courses running**.

The screenshot shows the ADLM Studio Overview page for user Tunde. The page is titled "Overview" and features a search bar for rates, materials, and projects. The user's name "Tunde" is displayed in the top right corner. The main content area is divided into several sections:

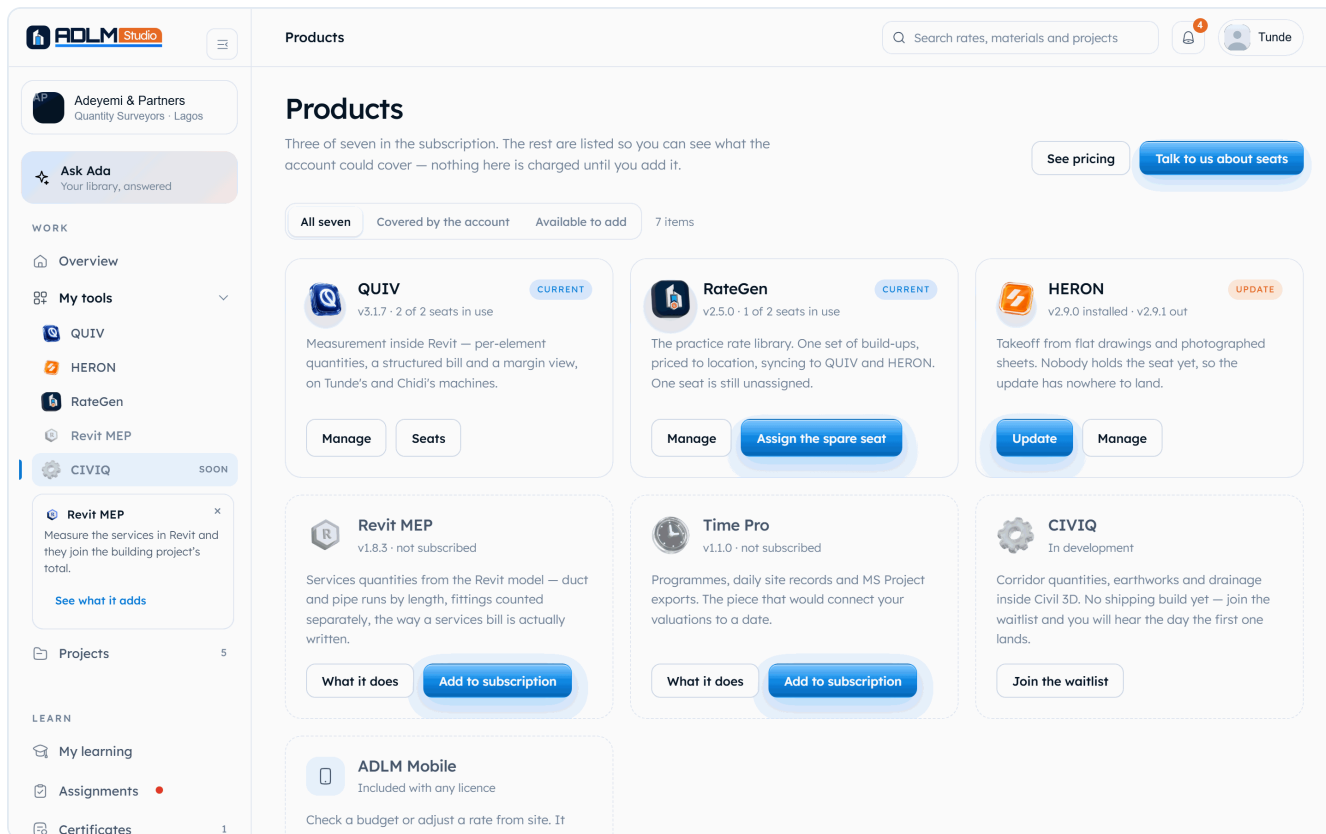
- Greeting:** "Good evening, Tunde" with a sub-header "Adeyemi & Partners — everything the practice is licensed for, and the three things worth your attention this week." and the date "Sunday, 4 October 2026".
- Summary Cards:** Four cards showing key metrics: "Products active" (3), "Seats in use" (3 of 5), "Next charge" (₦137,600), and "Courses running" (1 of 2).
- Your products:** A table listing installed products: QIV (v3.1.7, 2 of 2 seats), RateGen (v2.5.0, 1 of 2 seats), and HERON (v2.9.0 installed, v2.9.1 available, 0 of 1 seat). Each product has a "Manage" or "Update" button.
- Needs your attention:** A section with 4 items, including "HERON v2.9.1 is waiting to install" and "A RateGen seat has been unassigned since 28 July".
- Installer Hub v1.0:** A section for downloading the desktop app, with a "Download for Windows" button.
- Recent activity:** A list of recent events, including "Certificate issued", "QIV v3.1.7 installed", "Seat assigned", and "Invoice paid".

Your Overview: your products, what needs your attention, the Installer Hub and recent activity.

- **Your products** lists each licence and how many machines it is installed on. Click **All products** for the **Products** page.
- **Needs your attention** lists anything to act on, such as an expiring licence or a seat not yet installed, each with a link to fix it. When all is well it says "Nothing needs you. Everything is active and installed."
- **ADLM Installer Hub** has **Download for Windows** and **Watch the walkthrough**.
- **Recent activity** shows what has happened lately. Its link opens your **Profile**.
- **Your learning** shows your courses. Its link opens **My learning**.

Products and seats

The **Products** page ([/manage/products](#)) lists every ADLM product, split into **Covered by the account** and **Available to add**. Open it with **All products** on your Overview.



The Products page: what your account covers and what you can add.

- For products you own: click **Download** to go to **Downloads**, or **Seats** to see who holds them on the **Team** page.
- For products you do not own: click **What it does** to read about it, **Add to subscription** to buy it, or **Join the waitlist** for one not yet on sale.
- **See pricing** opens the price list. **Talk to us about seats** opens a support ticket.

Team

Team (/manage/team , titled **Team & seats**) shows your seats and the machines they are on. See [Licences, seats and devices](#).

Downloads

Downloads (/manage/downloads) has the **ADLM Installer Hub** with **Download the Installer Hub**, **Your products**, **Not in the subscription**, **User guides** and **Before you install**, short answers to the most common installation problems. Open it from **Download** on the Products page.

The Installer Hub is the only software you download from the website. It signs in with your account and installs only what your licences cover.

Billing and invoices

Your orders, invoices, receipts and saved card are on your **Profile** (/profile), which is where **Billing & invoices** in the menu takes you. See [Invoices and receipts](#) and [Saved card and auto-renewal](#).

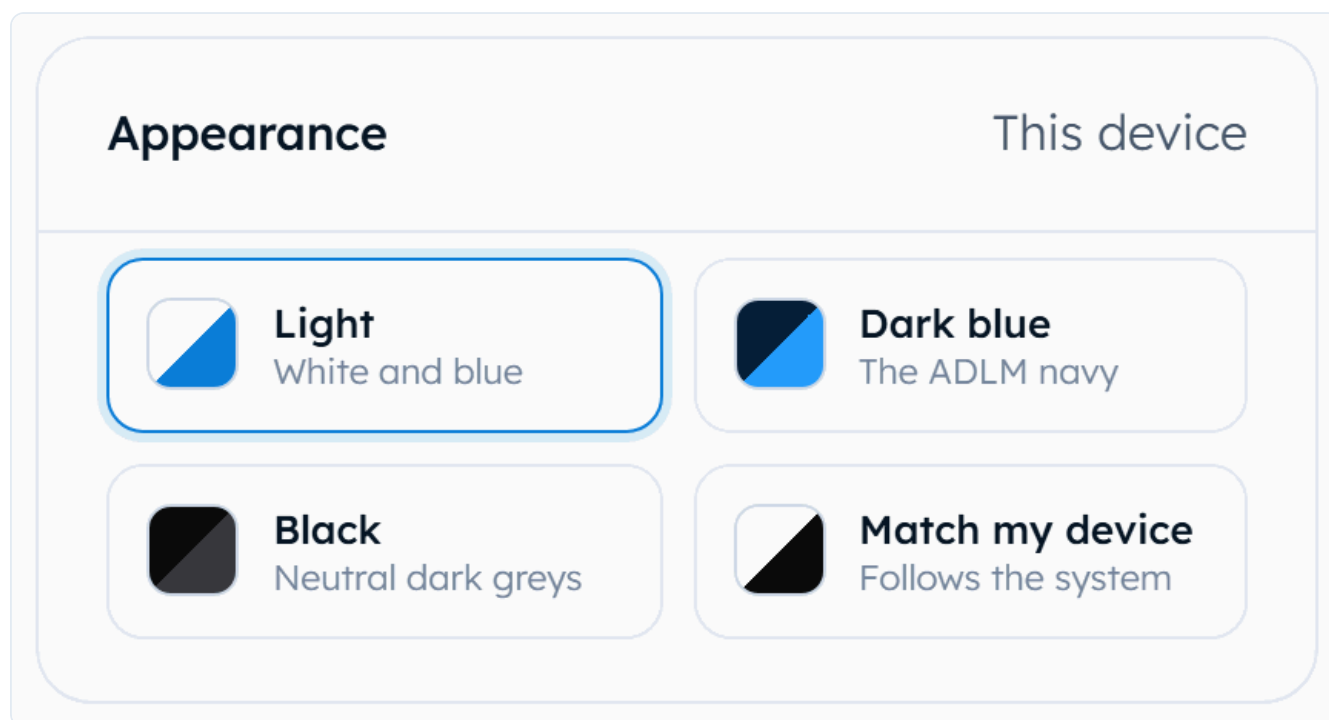
There is also a **Billing & invoices** page at /manage/billing , which the button in a renewal email opens. **Next charge** shows what your next renewal comes to; change the seats with the minus and plus buttons and click **Buy the change** to go to checkout. **Switch to yearly** appears when yearly would cost less. **Invoices** lists every

invoice with **PDF** and **Receipt** links, **Billing details** has **Edit details**, and **Talk to us first** opens a ticket if you are thinking of cancelling. A licence runs to the end of the period you paid for, and your rate library and projects stay in your account either way.

Account settings

Account settings (</manage/settings>) has these panels:

- **Your profile:** **First name**, **Last name**, **Phone** (your WhatsApp number) and an optional display name. **Work email** cannot be changed here. Click **Save profile**.
- **Rates and currency:** **Where you work** (your state). The **Geopolitical zone** fills itself in. **Currency** switches how prices are shown between NGN and USD. Click **Save location**.
- **The firm:** **Practice name** and **Address**, printed on invoices raised from now on. Click **Save firm details**.
- **Password:** see [Changing your password](#).
- **Machines signed in:** every computer that has activated a licence, with **Sign out** beside each.
- **Connected accounts:** connect or **Disconnect** Google, Microsoft or Autodesk sign-in.
- **Appearance:** **Light**, **Dark blue**, **Black** or **Match my device**, for this device. It saves straight away.
- **Notifications:** the emails you get. See [Emails we send](#).
- **Your data:** **Activity log** and **Ask for an export**.



Appearance in Account settings: Light, Dark blue, Black or Match my device.

Your Profile

Your **Profile** (</profile>) is also reachable from **Profile** at the top right of the public pages. It has:

- **Account details:** **Upload new photo**, **Username**, **First Name**, **Last Name**, firm name and **Location (Geopolitical Zone)**, and **Pricing location (State)**. Your Rate Gen prices, and projects you price afterwards, use the zone your state belongs to. Click **View Prices** to see them, and **Save** to keep your changes.
- **Change your password** (or **Set a password for the desktop software** after a social sign-in).
- **Connected accounts**.

- **Billing & auto-renewal:** your saved card and auto-renew for each product.
- **Orders, Invoices & Installations:** tabs for **Orders**, **Invoices**, **Installations** and **Project Activity**.
- **Security & Admin:** the destructive-action code setting.

NOTE

If your name has been printed on a course certificate, it is locked. The page says so. Contact support if it needs correcting.

My learning

My learning (/dash-learning) shows your courses and progress, with **Free lessons** and **Enrol someone else**. **Assignments** and **Certificates** sit beside it under **Learn**.

The screenshot displays the ADLM Studio 'My learning' dashboard. On the left, a sidebar contains the ADLM Studio logo and a list of navigation items: 'Ask Ada', 'WORK' (with sub-items: Overview, My tools, QUIV, HERON, RateGen, Revit MEP, CIVIQ), and 'LEARN' (with sub-items: My learning, Assignments, Certificates). The main content area is titled 'My learning' and features a search bar, a 'Free lessons' button, and an 'Enrol someone else' button. Below these, there's a video player for 'Reading a sequence for buildability' with a play button and a 13:15 duration. To the right of the video, text reads 'BIM FOR BUILDING WORKS - WEEK 4' and 'Overlaps, float and the trades that quietly decide a completion date.' Below the video, a section titled 'Assignments due' lists three tasks: 'Elemental cost plan from the Block A model' (Due tomorrow), 'Capstone — a full building, measured and priced' (Due in 8 days), and 'Measure the ground floor slab from drawings' (Overdue by 2 days). At the bottom, a section titled 'Your courses' shows two courses: 'BIM for Building Works' (Six weeks - Revit, coordination and model-based measurement) and 'Rates & 2D Takeoff' (Four weeks - Build-ups, measurement from flat drawings, and).

My learning: your courses and progress.

Your WhatsApp number

Your WhatsApp number is how support reaches you quickly. You give it when you sign up, and you can change it under **Phone** in **Account settings**.

Verifying your WhatsApp number

1. Open **Account settings** (/manage/settings).
2. Check the number in **Phone**, with the country code, for example +234 803 000 0000. If you changed it, click **Save profile** first: "Save the new number, then verify it on WhatsApp."
3. Click **Verify on WhatsApp**. The page says **Code sent on WhatsApp**.
4. Open WhatsApp on your phone. A six-digit code arrives from ADLM Studio.

5. Type it into the **6-digit code** box and click **Confirm**.

When it works, the field reads **Verified on WhatsApp**. Click **Send again** if the code does not arrive. Changing your number later removes the verified mark until you verify the new one.

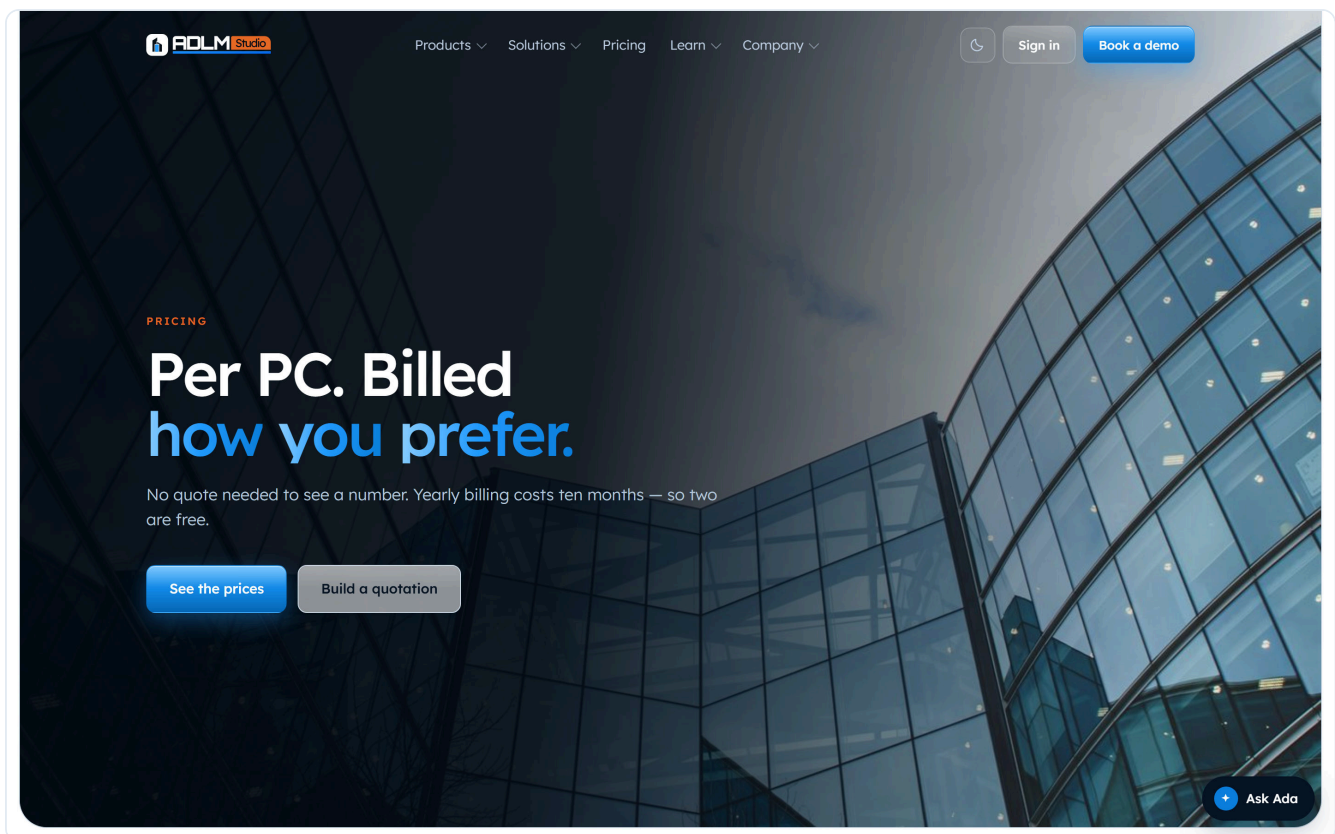
NOTE

If you do not see **Verify on WhatsApp**, verification is not switched on for your account yet, and there is nothing you need to do.

Buying a product or subscription

See the prices

Pricing at the top of the public pages (/pricing) shows every product's price. Prices are per PC: one ADLM account can hold several seats, and you assign them to machines yourself.



The Pricing page, with See the prices and Build a quotation.

- Click **See the prices** to jump to the price list.
- Click **Explore QUIV** (or the matching button for another product) to open that product's page.
- Click **Build a quotation** for a printable quotation (see [Quotations](#)).

From a product page

1. Click **Products** at the top of the public pages and open a product.
2. Under **Choose your term**, pick how long you want. Longer terms show the percentage you save.
3. Click **Get started now**. You are taken to checkout with the product already chosen.

If a product shows **Notify me when available** instead, it is not on sale yet. Click it to be told when it is.

At checkout

The checkout page is called **Subscribe** (/purchase). You must be signed in, with your email confirmed.

1. At the top, choose your **Currency: NGN (₦)** or **USD (\$)**.
2. Choose **Purchase for: Personal** (one seat, one computer) or **Organization** (several seats for a firm).
3. In the products list, click a product.
4. Set the **Duration**. "Tip: 6 and 12 months unlock better pricing."
5. If you chose **Organization**, set **Seats / users**. Some products have a minimum number of users for organisation licences; the page tells you.
6. If the product offers it, tick **First-time install** to add our one-time installation fee.
7. If you pay in NGN, you can add extra project storage in blocks of 10 project slots.
8. Check the total and click **Add to order**.
9. Repeat for any other products. To change one, click it, adjust it and click **Update order**.

Your order builds up in the **Summary**.

Buying for an organisation

When **Purchase for** is set to **Organization**, an **Organization details** box appears:

1. Enter the **Organization name**. It is required.
2. Optionally add an organisation email and phone.
3. Prices are shown per seat. The seats you choose on each product are the number of users or computers your organisation needs.

In the same box you can ask for physical training at your office: choose a training location, and the **Location**;, duration and **Training cost**: are shown. You can also add **BIM Software Installation** on your **Office computers setup**. The training date is agreed with you after your purchase is approved.

Coupons

1. In the **Summary**, find **Discount coupon**.
2. Type your code in **Enter coupon code**.
3. Click **Apply**.

When the code is accepted, the **Discount** line is taken off your **Subtotal**, any VAT is added and the final **Total** shown. Add products to your order before applying a coupon.

Auto-renewal

If you are paying in NGN, the **Summary** shows **Auto-renew my subscription**. Tick it before you pay. It only applies when you pay by card: we save the card and charge it at the price at that time shortly before your licence expires. If a renewal is declined, you get an email and it is tried again before your access ends.

Paying

Click **Pay**. The **Complete your payment** box opens.

Paying by card (NGN orders)

1. Click **Pay with Card (Paystack)**.
2. Enter your card details in the Paystack window. Your bank may ask for an OTP.
3. When the payment succeeds your access is activated and you are taken to your account area.

Your licence is active as soon as the card payment is confirmed. If you were debited but the page could not confirm it, wait a few minutes: the payment is confirmed automatically.

NOTE

Card payments are charged in Naira, and **Nigerian-issued cards** clear reliably. On a USD order, click **Switch to NGN & pay by card** to pay by card. If you hold a Nigerian card and the page suggests a transfer, click **I have a Nigerian card. Switch to NGN & pay by card**.

Paying by bank transfer

1. In the **Complete your payment** box, note the **Account number**, **Account name** and **Bank**.
2. Make the transfer from your bank app.
3. Click **I have paid**.

A bank transfer is checked by our team before your licence is switched on. Your order shows **Awaiting admin approval** until then. If we sent you an order link by email, open it and click **Upload your receipt** to attach a photo or PDF of your transfer slip. That speeds up approval.

Quotations

If you need a figure for your firm's approval before you buy, build a quotation at [/quote](#). You do not need to be signed in.

1. Open [/quote](#), or click **Build a quotation** on the Pricing page.
2. Choose the currency and billing (yearly or monthly).
3. Choose each product you need and the number of PCs or users.
4. Add training at your office if you want it.
5. Print or save the quotation, or have it emailed to you.

NOTE

A quotation is an estimate. The final price is the one shown at checkout.

Invoices and receipts

- **Orders.** Every purchase is on your **Profile** under **Orders, Invoices & Installations**, in the **Orders** tab, with its status: **Paid**, **Approved**, **Rejected** or **Awaiting admin approval**. Once an order is approved, click **Print / Download Receipt**.
- **Invoices.** Invoices raised for you by ADLM Studio are in the **Invoices** tab. Click **View Invoice** to open one, or **Download PDF** to save it. When an invoice is paid, **Download Receipt** appears beside it.
- **On the Billing & invoices page** ([/manage/billing](#)), **Invoices** lists the same invoices with **PDF** and **Receipt** links.

TIP

If ADLM sent an invoice to your email before you had an account, sign up with that same email. The invoice is linked to your new account automatically.

Saved card and auto-renewal

When you pay by card with auto-renew ticked, the card is saved for renewals. Manage it on your **Profile** under **Billing & auto-renewal**.

- The card shows as its type and last four digits, with the expiry date.
- Each subscription has its own **Auto-renew** tick box. Untick it to stop that product renewing.
- If a renewal failed, the line says so with the reason.
- To stop all renewals, click **Remove card**, then **Yes, remove**. The page says "Saved card removed. Auto-renew is off for all products."

If you have no saved card, pay any order by card and it is saved for renewals.

Installing your software

Once you have an active licence, install everything with the ADLM Installer Hub.

1. On your **Overview**, click **Download for Windows** under **ADLM Installer Hub**. (Or open **Downloads** and click **Download the Installer Hub**.)
2. Run the downloaded file on your Windows computer.
3. Sign in to the Hub with your ADLM email and password.
4. Install the products your licence covers.

The full walkthrough is in the [ADLM Installer Hub guide](#), and **Watch the walkthrough** on the Overview plays the video.

IMPORTANT

Close Revit and PlanSwift before installing a plugin. If the host program is open during the install, the ADLM panel does not appear until you close it and start it again.

NOTE

The website only offers the Installer Hub. Individual product packages are installed by the Hub, which keeps your licence, version and updates in step. An account with no active licence sees no Hub download; buy a product first.

If you bought a **First-time install**, the **Installations** tab on your Profile shows its status and next steps. You can install it yourself with the Hub, or send your AnyDesk address to support so we can install it for you remotely.

Licences, seats and devices

How seats work

- A **seat** is one licence for one computer. A seat activates against a machine, not a person.
- A **Personal** licence has one seat.
- An **Organization** licence has as many seats as you bought for each product.

To see your seats, open **Team** (</manage/team>), titled **Team & seats**), or click **Seats** on the Products page. It shows:

- **Seats per product:** how many seats each product has and how many are in use.
- **Machines:** each computer holding a seat, the products on it and when it was last used, with a **Free the seat** button.
- **Free activations:** seats owned, in use and free right now.

To add seats, click **Buy more seats**. Installing on a new machine costs nothing extra while you have a free seat.

When all your seats are in use

Each seat can be active on one computer at a time. If you sign in to a product on a computer when all your seats are in use, the product refuses and tells you which computer holds the seat, for example "This QUIV licence is already in use on another computer..." or "All 3 seats on this QUIV licence are in use...", with the computer's name and when it was last used.

Moving a licence to a new computer

You can do this yourself, without a ticket:

1. Sign in at adlmstudio.net and open **Team** (</manage/team>), or **Machines signed in** in **Account settings**.
2. Find the old computer in the list.
3. Click **Free the seat** (on the Team page) or **Sign out** (in Account settings).
4. Confirm. The seat is freed at once. Nothing on the old computer is deleted; it simply stops being licensed at its next check-in.
5. Sign in to the product on the new computer.

You can also release a seat from the Installer Hub on the computer itself. See the [Installer Hub guide](#).

IMPORTANT

Free the seat first, then install on the new machine. Reinstalling without freeing the seat uses up an activation that support then has to release for you.

Things that count, and things that do not

- A rebuilt, reformatted or reimaged computer counts as a new device. Free the old entry first.
- Switching between Wi-Fi, ethernet or a VPN does **not** use up a seat.
- Changing your password signs your other machines out at their next check-in, so they will ask for the new password.

Each person signs in with their own ADLM account; to work on one project together, share it (see [Sharing, team and Ada](#)).

Changing your password

On your Profile

1. Open your **Profile** and scroll to **Change your password**.

2. Enter your **Current password**.
3. Enter a **New password** (at least 8 characters, with a letter and a number), and again in **Confirm password**.
4. Click **Change password**.

In Account settings

1. Open **Account settings** (</manage/settings>).
2. In the **Password** panel, enter your **Current password** and **New password**.
3. Click **Change password**.

The new password is the one the Windows products sign in with. If you signed up with Google or Microsoft and have never set a password, the Profile card is called **Set a password for the desktop software** and asks only for the new password twice. If you have forgotten your current password, sign out and use **Forgot your password?**.

What's New and the emails we send

What's New

</whats-new> shows what has changed in every ADLM product, and the user guides. Each product's guide on this site also has a "What's new" section.

Emails we send

- **Account email:** receipts, licence activations, renewal notices and support replies. These always arrive.
- **Product update emails:** when a new version ships for a product you are licensed for.
- **New video emails:** when ADLM Studio publishes a video on YouTube.
- **Marketing email:** news and offers.

Choose what you get under **Notifications** in **Account settings: Product updates, Billing, Seats and machines, Courses and events** and **New videos**.

Every marketing, product-update and new-video email has an unsubscribe link at the bottom. You do not need to sign in. Unsubscribing does not stop receipts, licence activations, renewal notices or support replies.

Getting support

Ask Ada first

Click **Ask Ada** at the top of the menu or the round button in the corner of any page. Ada answers questions about products, prices and training from ADLM's own information, and once you are signed in she can also answer about your own licences and projects. She can hand you to a person on WhatsApp whenever you prefer.

Open a support ticket

From Request technical help (where **Support** in the menu takes you, </support/request>)

1. Enter a **Title**, for example "Can't open RateGen after update".

2. Describe the problem in **What's happening?**, including any error message.
3. Choose a **Category: Technical issue, Account / login, Billing / subscription, Feature request, General question or Other / not sure.**
4. Choose the product under **Select a product....**
5. Optionally click **Add images** to attach screenshots.
6. If you would like us to fix it on your computer, paste your AnyDesk address (for remote support).
7. Click **Submit request.**

Your tickets and their status are listed under **Your requests.** We reply by email.

From the Support page (/manage/support , linked from **Needs your attention** on your Overview and from the Team and Guides pages)

Support

A ticket opened here already carries your licences, versions and machines, so nobody has to ask you for them first. Replies come from a real address, usually the same working day.

Open a ticket

Which product: **QUIV v3.1.7** | Which machine: **TUNDE-WS02**

Summary

The Revit panel does not appear after installing

What happens, and what you expected

Steps, the exact message if there is one, and when it started.

Send to support

Your account, licence and version details are attached automatically.

Answers first

- **Moving a licence to a new laptop** — do it from Team & seats, no ticket needed
- **Activation says the machine changed** — a rebuilt PC counts as a new device
- **The Hub cannot sign in** — update to v3.1.7, which fixed the fallback address
- **Adding a product mid-month** — it is pro-rated onto the next invoice

Reach a human

Email: **admin@adlmstudio.net**

WhatsApp: **+234 810 650 3524**

Hours: **Mon-Fri, 9-6 WAT**

Where: **Lagos, Nigeria**

Your tickets 3 raised

The Support page: open a ticket, your tickets, answers and how to reach a person.

1. Under **Open a ticket**, choose **Which product** and, if it is about one computer, **Which machine.**
2. Enter a **Summary** and describe what happens and what you expected.
3. Optionally add your AnyDesk address.
4. Click **Send to support.**

A ticket opened here already carries your licences and machines. Your tickets appear under **Your tickets**, with any reply. **Answers first** has short answers to common questions, and **Reach a human** has WhatsApp.

TIP

The two things that shorten a ticket most are the exact wording of any message you saw, and what you had just done when it appeared. A screenshot helps.

WhatsApp

For anything that stops you working, WhatsApp is the quickest way to reach us: **+234 810 650 3524**.

Contact	Details
Email	admin@adlmstudio.net
WhatsApp	+234 810 650 3524
Hours	Mon to Fri, 9 to 6 WAT
Where	Lagos, Nigeria

Network check

If the website keeps saying "Failed to fetch", sign in and open [/network-check](#). It sends a few tiny test requests and shows which got through; nothing on your account changes. Click **Copy results** or **Send to ADLM on WhatsApp**, and quote the **Reference code** shown at the top.

Learning, courses and trainings

- **Lessons & events** ([/learn](#)) has free lessons from the ADLM Studio YouTube channel and paid courses with certificates.
- Courses you are enrolled in appear under **My learning**, with your progress and **Assignments**. Finished courses give a certificate under **Certificates**.
- **Trainings** ([/trainings](#)) lists online sessions, office trainings and conferences. Firms can add physical training at their office when buying an organisation licence.

NOTE

Your name is locked once it has been printed on a certificate, so check your first and last name before you finish a course.

AI in your ADLM account

Feature	Where	What it does	Availability
Ada, product questions	Ask Ada , any page	What a product does, what it costs, which one you need, trainings	On for everyone; visitors share a monthly limit
Ada on your account	Ask Ada , signed in	Your subscriptions, expiry dates, project slots and your projects' figures	On for everyone, signed in
Ada as estimator and project manager	Ask Ada , signed in	Proposes rates for your unpriced lines and reports on a period, for you to confirm	On for everyone, signed in

Ada never asks for a password or card details, and she cannot change your account. Any active ADLM licence opens the AI tools in the products; there is no separate AI add-on. Full details are in [ADLM AI services](#).

ADLM products and their guides

Product	What it does	Where it runs	Guide
ADLM Installer Hub	Installs, updates and licenses every ADLM desktop product from one app	Windows 10 and 11	Installer Hub guide
QUIV for Revit	Quantity takeoff and estimating inside Autodesk Revit	Revit add-in (Windows)	QUIV guide
HERON	Takeoff-to-budget estimating for PlanSwift	PlanSwift add-in (Windows)	HERON guide
ADLM Rate Gen	Builds and edits your rates, with market prices and carbon	Windows; your library is viewable on the website	Rate Gen guide
SERVIQ (Revit MEP)	MEP quantity takeoff for Autodesk Revit	Revit add-in (Windows)	Revit MEP guide
ADLM Time Pro	Site productivity tracking and programme durations	Windows 10 and 11	Time Pro guide
ADLM Cloud	Your projects, budgets, valuations, reports and sharing on the web	Any browser	ADLM Cloud guide

Troubleshooting

I never received my confirmation code

Wait a minute and check your spam or promotions folder. On the **Confirm your email** screen, click **Send a new code**. If the address is wrong, click **Wrong address? Change it**. Each code works for 30 minutes.

Sign-up says my email cannot receive the code

The address has a typing mistake, or its domain cannot receive email. Check the spelling, or sign up with another address.

The desktop software says my email is not confirmed

Sign in at adlmstudio.net, enter the six-digit code on the **Confirm your email** screen (click **Send a new code** if needed), then sign in to the product again.

I signed up with Google and the software will not accept my sign-in

The Windows products need an email and a password. Open your **Profile** and use **Set a password for the desktop software**, then sign in to the product with your email and that password.

A menu item opened a page I did not expect

Some menu items still open the older page that does the same job. See the note under [The menu](#) for where each one goes and how to reach the other pages.

My card was debited but my licence is not active

Card payments are usually confirmed within moments. If the page could not confirm it, the payment is confirmed automatically shortly afterwards. Refresh your Overview after a few minutes. If it is still not active, open a ticket with the **Billing / subscription** category or message us on WhatsApp.

My card was declined

Cards issued outside Nigeria are often declined because the charge is in Naira. Pay by bank transfer instead, then click **I have paid** and upload your receipt.

My order says Awaiting admin approval

Bank transfers are checked by our team before the licence is switched on. Make sure you clicked **I have paid**, and upload your transfer receipt on the order page if you have the link. Contact support on WhatsApp if it has been more than a working day.

A product says the licence is in use on another computer

All your seats are taken. Free the old computer's seat from **Team** or **Machines signed in**, then sign in again. If you need more computers at once, buy more seats.

The ADLM panel is missing in Revit or PlanSwift after installing

Revit or PlanSwift was open during the install. Close it and start it again.

The website says "Failed to fetch"

Run the network check at `/network-check` and send us the results with the reference code. It is usually something on your office network blocking part of the website.

I cannot change my email address

The email is your account. Contact support to change it.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need a separate account for each product?

No. One ADLM account signs in to every product, on every machine.

Can I use one licence on two computers?

Not at the same time. A personal licence has one seat, which is one computer. To use two computers at once, buy an organisation licence with two seats. To move between computers, free the seat on the old one first.

What happens when my subscription ends?

The licence stops working at the end of the period you paid for. Your rate library, projects and takeoffs stay in your account, and are there again when you renew.

How do I renew?

Turn on auto-renew and pay by card, and it renews itself. Otherwise, buy the product again at checkout, or follow the link in **Needs your attention** on your Overview.

Where are my receipts?

On your **Profile** under **Orders, Invoices & Installations**, and on the **Billing & invoices** page at `/manage/billing`.

Where did the old Dashboard go?

It has been replaced by your **Overview** at `/manage`. The `/dashboard` address still works and opens the Overview.

Will unsubscribing stop my renewal notices?

No. Receipts, licence activations, renewal notices and support replies always arrive.

Who do I contact if I am stuck?

Ask Ada, open a ticket from **Support** in the menu, or message us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, Monday to Friday, 9 to 6 WAT.

ADLM Installer Hub

Sign in once, then install, update, open and repair every ADLM product your licence covers.

The ADLM Installer Hub is the Windows app that puts your ADLM software on your computer. You sign in with your ADLM account. The Hub then shows the products your subscription covers and installs each one where its host program looks for it. It tells you when an update is ready, opens your products and repairs a broken install. You never copy files or hunt for folders yourself.

This guide covers the redesigned Installer Hub, **from Hub 2.0 (rolling out)**. ADLM is moving customers onto it in stages. Until then, the website download is the earlier 2.0 build, with a dark sidebar and a **Secure Sign In** screen. Products, licences and seats work the same way in both; only the screens differ. When the new design reaches you, download the setup again and run it over the old Hub.

What's new in Hub 2.0 (rolling out)

- **A new look, built on Richard Enoch's design**, in light, dark or **Match Windows**. The sidebar has **Dashboard**, **Installation Center**, **Free software**, **Subscriptions**, **Install history**, and an **ACCOUNT** group with **Profile**, **Settings** and **Help and contact**.
- **A splash screen that turns into the sign-in**, with **Forgot password?**, **Work offline** and **Remember my email on this PC**.
- **Releases read as names: QUIV 4.0, HERON 3.0**, and buttons such as **Update to HERON 3.0**.
- **A Dashboard that says what needs you**, with **Update all**, and the host programs found on this PC.
- **Filters and search** in the Installation Center: **All**, **Installed**, **Updates** and **Available**.
- **Open** on every installed product and free tool.
- **A network signal** in the header for your connection to ADLM Cloud.
- **Work offline**, a local **Install history** you can export, **keyboard shortcuts** (**F1**), and messages shown inside the Hub instead of Windows pop-ups.
- **Settings** for **Relink this PC**, **Clear the download cache** and **Export a diagnostic report**, and a **Help and contact** page that sends your account, machine and Hub version with your message.

Before you start

What you need

You need	Why
A Windows 10 or Windows 11 PC, 64-bit	The Hub does not run on Mac, older Windows or 32-bit Windows.
Administrator rights on that PC	The Hub writes plugins into shared program folders, so Windows asks for administrator approval.
Your ADLM account	The same email (or username) and password you use on adlmstudio.net. There is no separate Hub account.

You need	Why
An active licence for at least one ADLM desktop product	The Hub download comes with a paid licence. It installs only what your account covers.
An internet connection	You need it to sign in, load your products and download them. Without it you can still work offline (see Working offline).
The host program, for plugins	Revit for QUIV for Revit and SERVIQ (Revit MEP), PlanSwift for HERON, Civil 3D for CIVIQ, Archicad for QUIV for ArchiCAD. Install the host program first.

NOTE

If your company bought the licences, sign in with the account that holds them. Licences belong to the account, not to whoever uses the computer.

Where to download the Hub

1. On the computer you want to install on, sign in at adlmstudio.net.
2. Open **Downloads** in your account (</manage/downloads>).
3. Click **Download the Installer Hub**.
4. Save the setup file. It is a normal Windows installer, saved as ADLM-Installer-Hub-Setup.exe.

NOTE

The download button only appears when your account has an active licence for a desktop product. Without one, the page says the Hub comes with a licence and links to the products. If you think that is wrong, [contact support](#).

How many computers

Each licence seat is tied to one computer. You can install, update and repair as often as you like on that computer. To use a seat on a different computer, free it from the old one first. See [Your devices and moving a licence](#).

Install the Hub on your PC

You do this once per computer.

1. Double-click the setup file you downloaded.
2. If Windows shows a blue **Windows protected your PC** screen, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Do this only for a file you downloaded from adlmstudio.net.
3. Windows asks "Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?". Click **Yes**.
4. If you want a desktop icon, tick the desktop shortcut box. It is off by default.
5. Click **Install**. Setup chooses the folder for you.
6. On the last page, leave the launch box ticked and click **Finish** to open the Hub.

The Hub appears in the Start menu as **ADLM Installer Hub**. Only one copy of the Hub runs at a time. If you open it again while it is running, the window that is already open comes to the front.

IMPORTANT

If the **Yes** button on the Windows prompt is greyed out, or Windows asks for an administrator password, your Windows account is a standard user. Ask whoever manages the PC to approve it, or to install the Hub for you.

Updating from an older Hub

Download the setup from the website again and run it. It installs over the old version. If the Hub is open, setup offers to close it first. The record of what you installed on this PC is kept.

The Hub does not update itself. **Check for updates** inside the Hub checks your products, not the Hub. When ADLM releases a new Hub, download it from the website the same way.

First run and sign-in

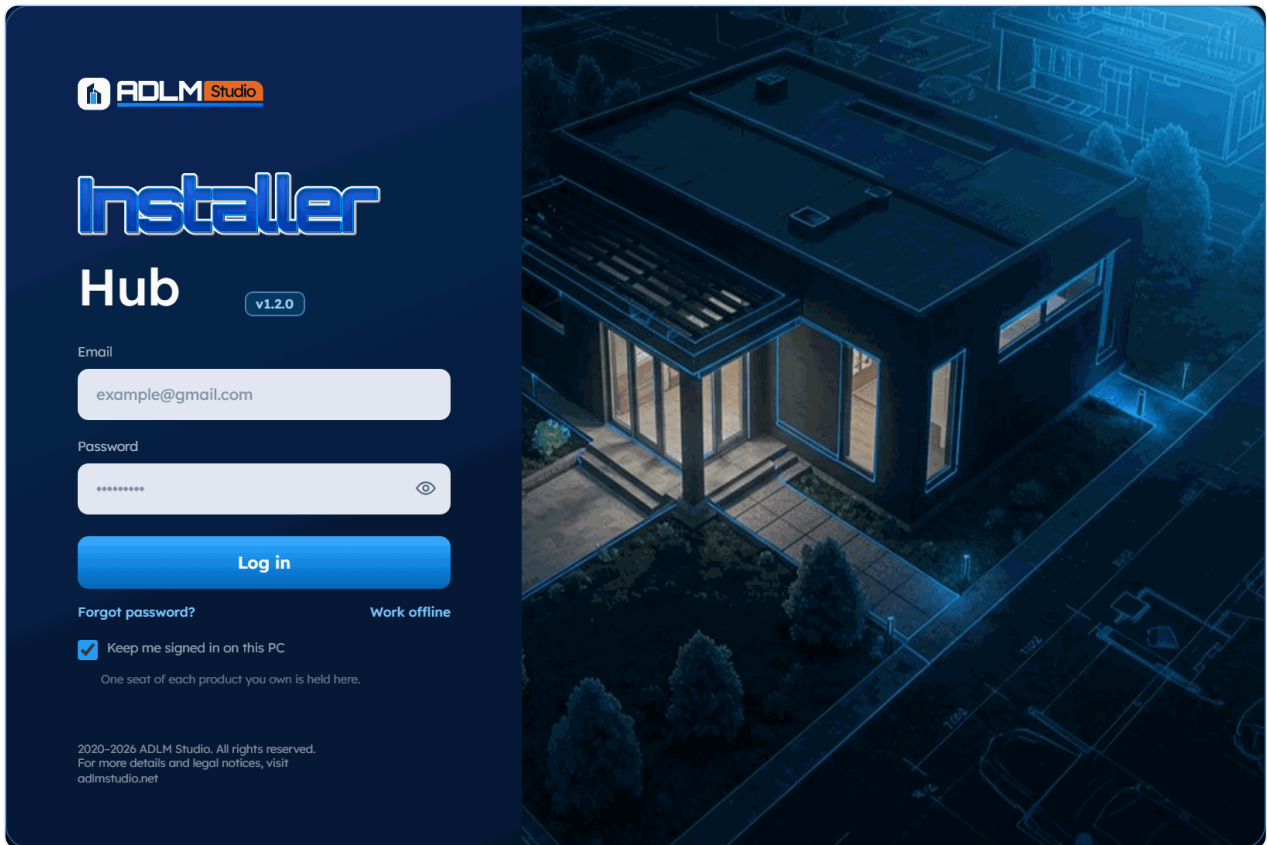
The splash screen

When the Hub starts, a card shows the ADLM Installer Hub mark and its version. The line under it tells you what the Hub is doing:

1. **Starting the Hub**
2. **Reading what is installed on this PC**
3. **Looking for Revit, PlanSwift and Excel**
4. **Ready**

After a couple of seconds the same card turns into the sign-in form.

Sign in



The Installer Hub sign-in window with Email, Password, Log in, Forgot password and Work offline.

1. In **Email or username**, type your ADLM email or username.
2. In **Password**, type your ADLM website password. Click the eye icon to show what you typed.
3. To have the Hub fill in your email next time, tick **Remember my email on this PC**. It never saves your password.
4. Click **Log in**, or press **Enter**. The button reads **Signing in...** while it works.

The Hub loads your products, compares them with what is on this PC and opens the **Dashboard**. A note in the corner says **Signed in**, and tells you how many products have an update waiting.

NOTE

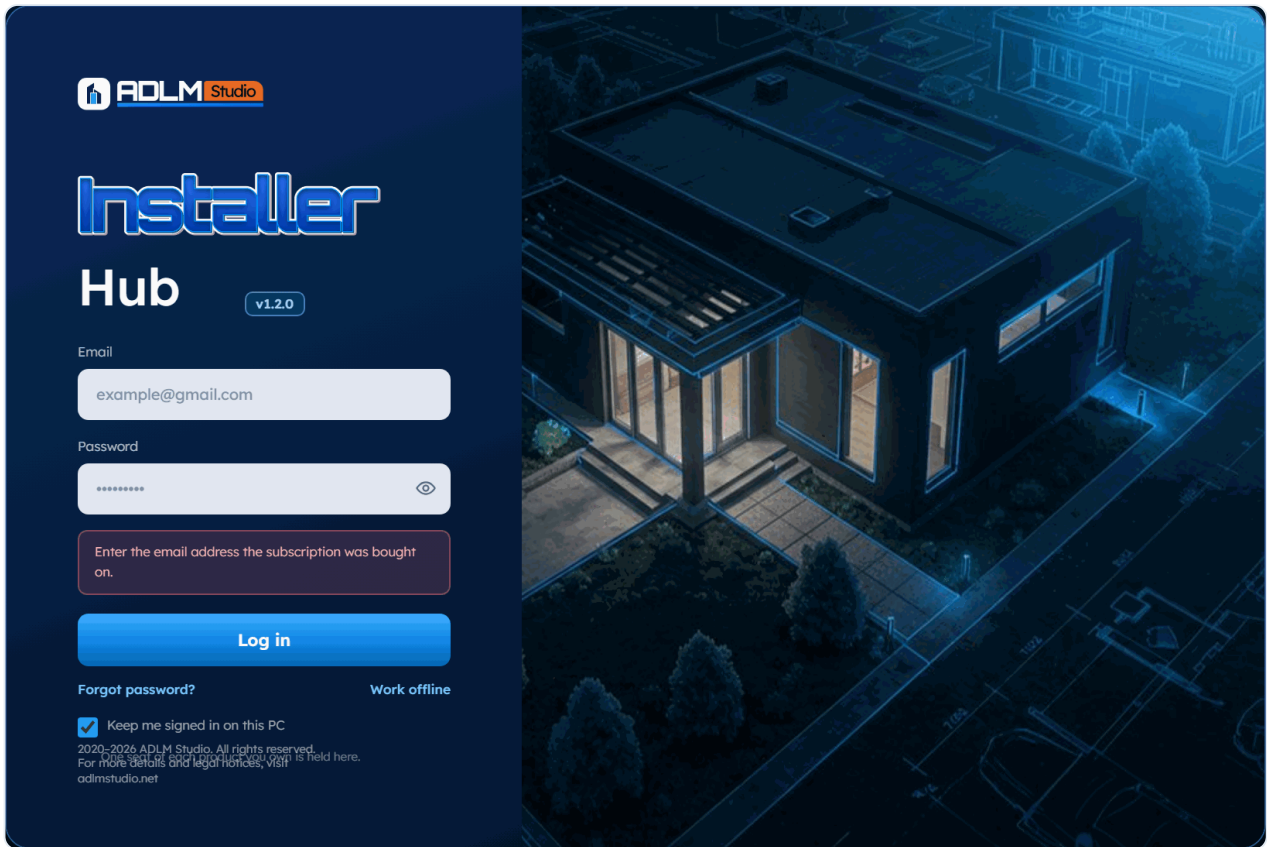
The Hub does not keep you signed in. You sign in each time you open it. Closing the window signs you out. Your installed products keep working.

Forgot password? opens the ADLM sign-in page in your browser, where you can reset your password. The Hub uses the new password the next time you sign in.

Work offline opens the Hub without signing in. See [Working offline](#).

If sign-in does not work

The Hub shows the problem in red above the **Log in** button.



The sign-in window showing the message when no email is entered.

What you see	What it means and what to do
Enter the email address or username your subscription is on.	The email box is empty. Type your ADLM email or username.
Enter your password.	The password box is empty.
Invalid email, username, or password.	The details do not match. Passwords are case-sensitive. Reset your password on the website, then try again.
We couldn't reach the server. Please check your internet connection and try again.	The Hub could not reach ADLM. Check your internet. On an office network, ask IT to allow the Hub to reach adlmstudio.net.
The request timed out. Please check your connection and try again.	The connection is too slow or dropped. Try again on a steadier connection.
Your ADLM account is not allowed to sign in right now.	The account is on hold. Contact support .
The ADLM server is temporarily unavailable. Please try again.	A short outage on our side. Wait a few minutes.
Your session has expired. Please sign in again.	You left the Hub open for a long time. Sign in again.

TIP

If sign-in fails three times, stop retrying. Message support on WhatsApp with the exact red message.

Sign out or switch accounts

1. Click **Sign out** at the bottom of the sidebar.
2. The Hub asks **Sign out of the Hub?**. Click **Sign out**, or **Stay** to cancel.

Installed products keep working, and your seats stay held on this PC.

Find your way around

The window

A Windows-style title bar has **Minimise**, **Maximise** and **Close**. The sidebar on the left switches pages, and the **Installation Center** shows a count of your products. The header across the top shows the page title, your name and email, the connection status and **Check for updates**.

The sidebar pages

Page	Use it to
Dashboard	See what needs you, what this PC has, and what is installed.
Installation Center	Install, update, open and repair your products. You will spend most of your time here.
Free software	Install free ADLM tools.
Subscriptions	Check your plan, your products, seats and expiry dates.
Install history	See every install, update and repair on this PC.
Profile	See your account, the seats this PC holds and your machines.
Settings	Change the look, relink this PC, and run the maintenance tools.
Help and contact	Reach ADLM support.

At the foot of the sidebar are the **Need help?** card, with **Chat on WhatsApp** and **More ways to reach us**, then **Keyboard shortcuts** and **Sign out**.

Check for updates

Click **Check for updates** in the header, or press **F5**. The button reads **Checking...** while the Hub asks ADLM Cloud for your subscriptions and the latest releases. Then a note says **Checked ADLM Cloud**, with either the number of updates available or **Everything is on its latest version**.

Use it after you buy or renew something, when a product you expect is missing, or when you hear an update is out.

Small screens

On a narrow window, such as a laptop at 125% scaling, the sidebar folds to icons only and the **Need help?** card is hidden. Hover over an icon to see its name. Pages drop to one column.

The Dashboard

ADLM Installer Hub 1.2.0

Dashboard
ADLM-QS-04 · tunde@adlmstudio.net

Online · checked just now [Check for updates](#)

Needs you
5 of your 8 products want something.

- HERON**
v2.9.0 → v2.9.5 [Update](#)
- RateGen**
v2.9.0 → v2.9.2 [Update](#)
- ADLM Time Pro**
v1.1.0 → v1.1.1 [Update](#)
- BIM MEP**
Package not built yet [Waiting](#)
- ADLM Time Pro for teams**
Licence expired 02 Sep 2026 [Renew](#)

[Update all 3](#)

This PC
The Hub installs against what is actually on the machine, so a plugin never lands where its host is missing.

MACHINE
ADLM-QS-04

WINDOWS
Windows 11 Pro · 26200

SIGNED IN
Tunde Adeyemi · ADLM Studio

DISK
412 GB free of 1 TB

HOST APPLICATIONS FOUND

Autodesk Revit	2024, 2025
PlanSwift Pro Metric	11.0
Microsoft Excel	365
AutoCAD	not found

Installed on this PC

PRODUCT	INSTALLED	LATEST	LICENCE	EXPIRES	
QUIV Autodesk Revit 2021–2026	v3.1.7	v3.1.7	Personal	11 Aug 2027	Installed
HERON PlanSwift 10 and 11	v2.9.0	v2.9.5	Personal	11 Oct 2026	Update available
RateGen Windows 64-bit	v2.9.0	v2.9.2	Personal	11 Aug 2027	Update available

[Sign out](#)

The Hub dashboard: what needs you, this PC and the host applications found, and what is installed.

The Dashboard has three parts.

Needs you. Products that want your attention. Each row has a button:

- **Update:** a newer release is out. The row shows the version you have and the release you will get, for example "v3.1.11 → QUIV 4.0".
- **Renew:** the licence has expired. This opens billing on ADLM Cloud.
- **Waiting:** your purchase is recorded but the package is not released yet.

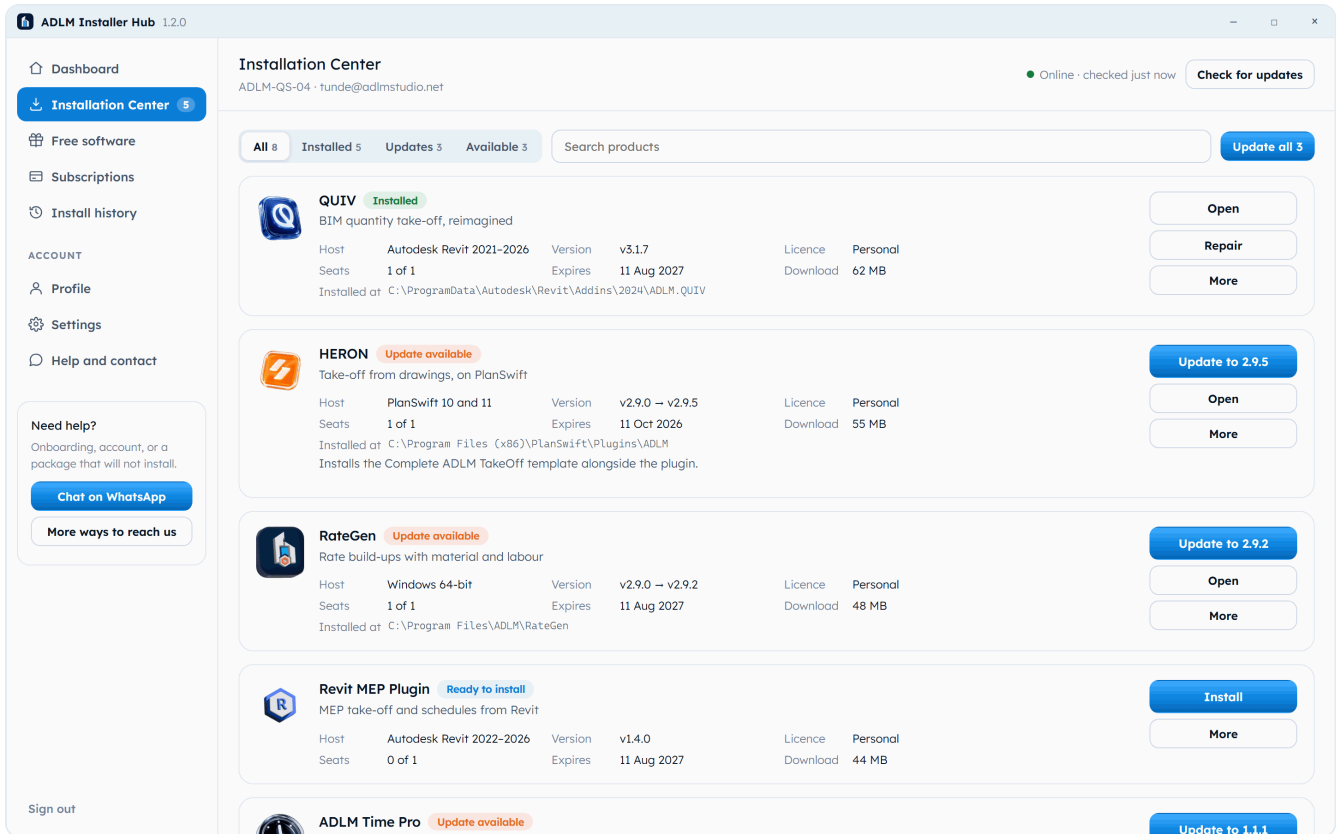
When two or more updates are waiting, **Update all** installs them one after another. The button shows the number, for example **Update all 3**. When nothing needs you, the heading reads **Everything is up to date**.

This PC. The facts the Hub uses to install correctly: **MACHINE**, **WINDOWS**, **SIGNED IN** and **DISK**. Under **HOST APPLICATIONS FOUND** it lists each host program and the years or versions it found, or "not found". The Hub checks these so a plugin never lands where its host is missing.

Installed on this PC. A table of **PRODUCT**, **INSTALLED**, **LATEST**, **LICENCE** and **EXPIRES** for everything the Hub has installed here.

The Installation Center: your product gallery

Click **Installation Center** in the sidebar. Each product appears as a card with its own icon. The gallery shows the products on your plan, and other ADLM products you can add.



The Installation Center listing every product with its state and the action it needs.

Release names

Cards name releases the way people say them: **QUIV 4.0** rather than 4.0.0, and **HERON 3.0**. A release such as 3.1.11 keeps its full number. When an update is waiting, **Version** shows both, for example "v2.9.6 → HERON 3.0".

Reading a card

Each card shows the product name, a coloured state label and a short description. Then come **Host** (the program it runs in, such as Autodesk Revit or Windows 64-bit), **Version**, **Licence** (your organisation or licence type), **Seats** (for example "1 of 2") and **Expires**. The buttons for what you can do next sit on the right.

What the state labels mean

Label	Buttons	Meaning
Ready to install	Install	On your plan, licence active, package released.
Installed	Open, More	Installed here and up to date.
Update available	Update to (the release), Open, More	A newer release is out.
Licence expired	Renew licence	The subscription has run out. This opens billing on ADLM Cloud.
Not on your plan	Add to plan	An ADLM product you do not have. This opens its page on the website.
Package pending	Tell me when it is out	Your licence is fine, but the package is Not released yet .

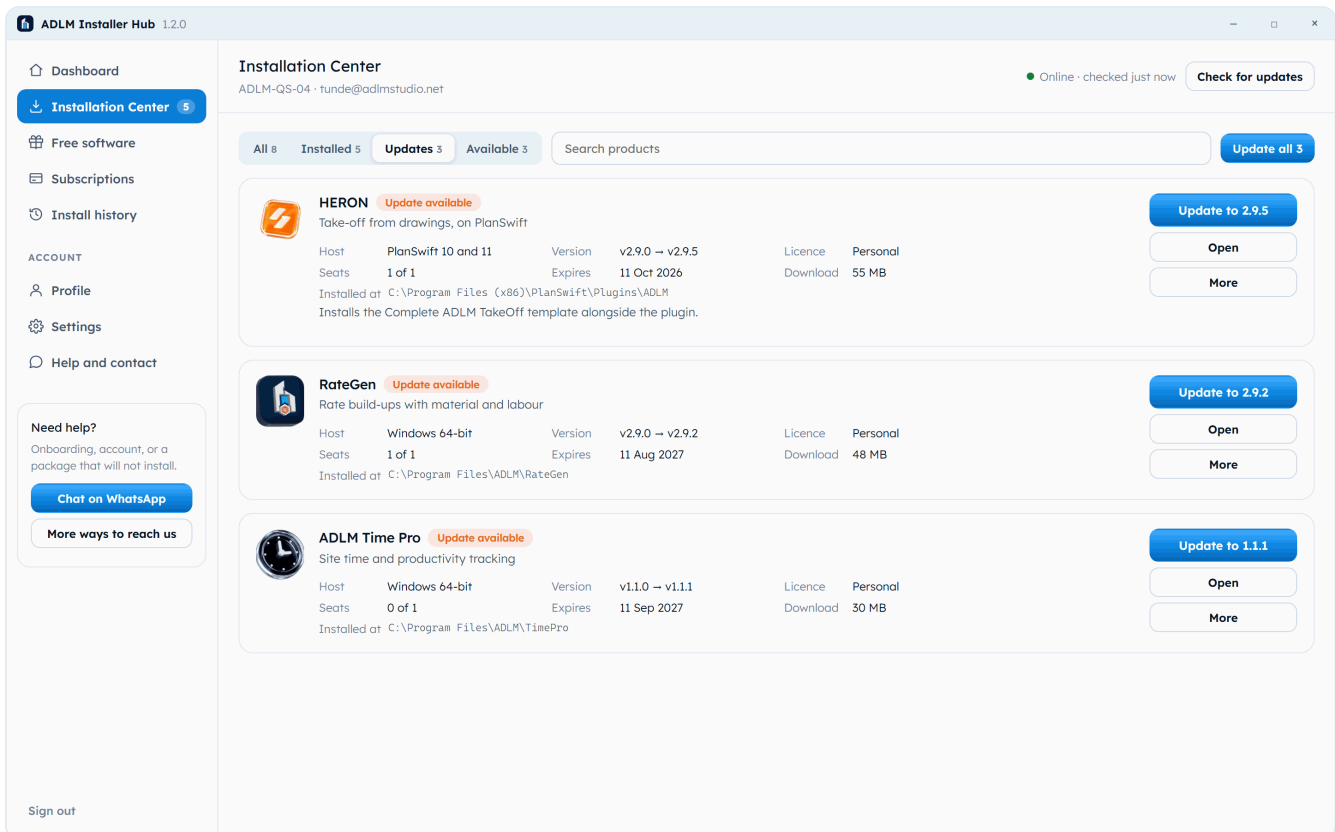
NOTE

Open arrives with the Hub 2.0 rollout. On a build without it, a **Repair** button sits on installed cards instead, and you open the product from the Start menu or its host program as usual.

Filter and search

Along the top of the gallery:

- **All**, **Installed**, **Updates** and **Available**, each with a count. Click one to show only those cards.
- A search box. Type part of a product name to filter. Press **Ctrl** + **F** from anywhere to jump to it. If nothing matches, the page says **Nothing matches that**.
- **Update all**, when updates are waiting.

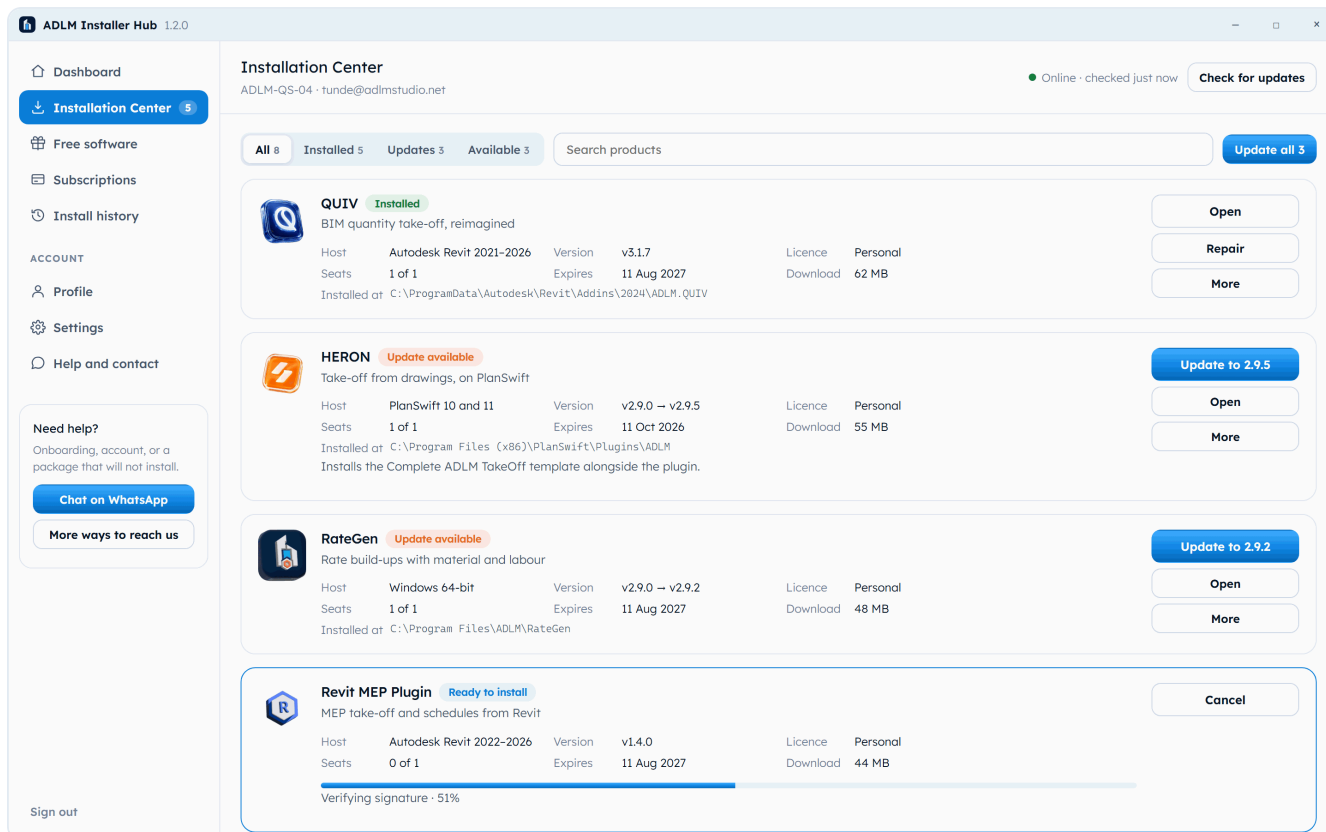


The Installation Center filtered to products with an update.

Install a product

Most installs finish in a couple of minutes.

1. If you are installing a plugin, close the host program: Revit, PlanSwift, Civil 3D or Archicad. Check the Windows system tray as well.
2. Click **Installation Center** in the sidebar.
3. On the product's card, click **Install**.
4. If the Hub asks for your Revit year, choose it (see below).
5. Watch the progress bar on the card. When it finishes, a note says the product is installed and the label changes to **Installed**.



A product installing, with the step it is on and the progress bar.

Picking your Revit year

QUIV for Revit and SERVIQ (Revit MEP) need to know which year of Revit you use, because each year loads add-ins from its own folder.

- If the Hub finds only one Revit year on your PC, it uses it without asking.
- If it finds more than one, the **Choose Your Revit Version** window opens. Pick the year from **Revit Version** and click **Continue Install**.
- If your year is not in the list, type the four-digit year (for example 2026) into the box.
- Click **Cancel** to stop. Nothing is changed.

TIP

To put the plugin into a second Revit year, click **More**, then **Repair**, and choose the other year. Do this after each update too, so every Revit year gets the new release.

When the host program is missing

If a card's host program was not found on this PC, the card warns you before you install. For example: "Revit was not found on this PC. Install it first, or install here anyway and the plugin is picked up once Revit is installed."

HERON is the exception. It needs PlanSwift's own folders, so without PlanSwift the install stops with "PlanSwift is not installed on this machine. Please install PlanSwift before installing the ADLM Plugin." Install PlanSwift, then click **Install** again.

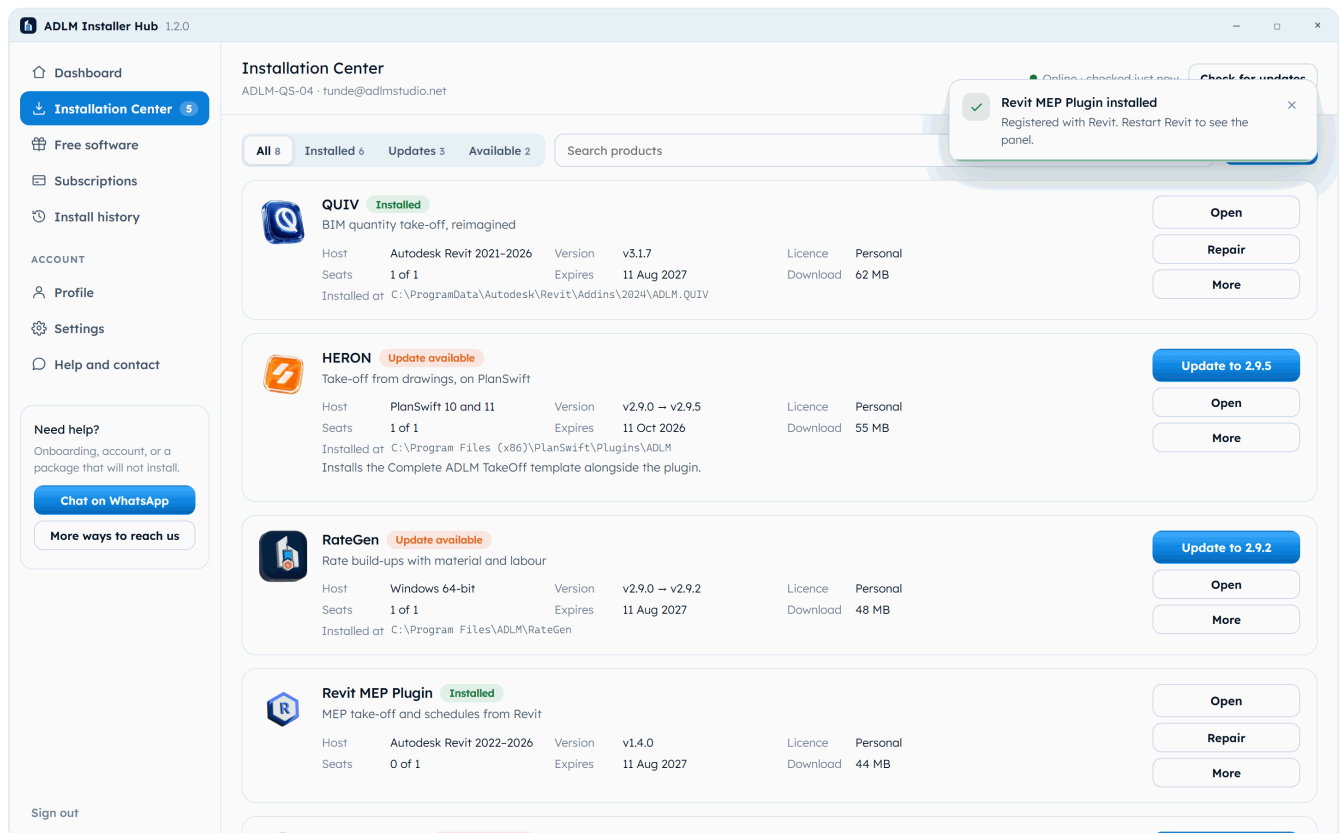
Watching the progress

The line under the progress bar shows the step and the percentage. The steps you may see:

Step	What is happening
Preparing	Checking your licence and where the files should go.
Downloading / Downloaded	Fetching the package from ADLM.
Cached	The package was downloaded before and is being reused, so reinstalls are quick.
Retrying	The download dropped. The Hub tries again on its own.
Verifying	Checking the download is complete and has not been tampered with.
Extracting / Extracted	Unpacking the files.
Cleaning / Cleanup	Removing the older version so it cannot clash with the new one.
Running / Launching	Running the product's own installer.
Complete	Done.

While it is safe to stop, a **Cancel** button shows. Click it and the button reads **Cancelling...** while the Hub finishes the current step safely. A note then says **Stopped**, and that nothing was changed on this PC.

After the install



The Installation Center after an install finishes, with the confirmation message.

- **Plugins (QUIV, SERVIQ, HERON, CIVIQ, QUIV for ArchiCAD):** the note reads, for example, "Registered with Revit. Restart Revit to see the panel." Plugins load when the host starts, so if it was open, close it and open

it again.

- **Standalone apps** (Rate Gen, Time Pro): the note says the version is ready to open. Click **Open** on the card, or use the Start menu.

The install is added to **Install history** and to **Installed on this PC** on the Dashboard.

Open a product

On an installed card, click **Open**. Hover over it to see what it will start, for example "Open Autodesk Revit".

- **Standalone apps** start directly. A note says **Opening** and the app name, and that it can take a few seconds to appear.
- **Plugins** start their host program. For a QUIV card, the Hub opens Revit, and the note says QUIV is on its ribbon once Revit has loaded.

If the Hub cannot find the product where it installed it, a note says the product could not be found. Click **More**, then **Repair**, to put it back.

Open is also on installed tools in **Free software**.

Update a product

Updates install over the old version. You do not need to uninstall first, and your projects, rates, templates and preferences are kept.

How you know an update is waiting

- **Needs you** on the Dashboard lists it.
- The card's label reads **Update available**, and the button reads **Update to** plus the release, for example **Update to QUIV 4.0**.
- The **Updates** filter in the Installation Center shows a count.
- After you sign in, the **Signed in** note says how many products have an update waiting.

To update one product

1. Close the program you are updating.
2. Click **Update to** on the card, or **Update** in **Needs you**.
3. Wait for the note that it is updated, then open the program again.

To update everything

1. Close the host programs.
2. Click **Update all** on the Dashboard or in the Installation Center, or press **Ctrl + Shift + U**.

The Hub installs the updates one at a time, because they share the Windows approval prompt and the host programs.

TIP

Heard an update is out but you do not see it? Click **Check for updates**.

Repair and product details

Click **More** on a card. A card opens with everything the Hub knows about the product on this PC: **State**, **Installed**, **Latest**, **Host**, **Licence**, **Seats**, **Expires** and **Installed on**.

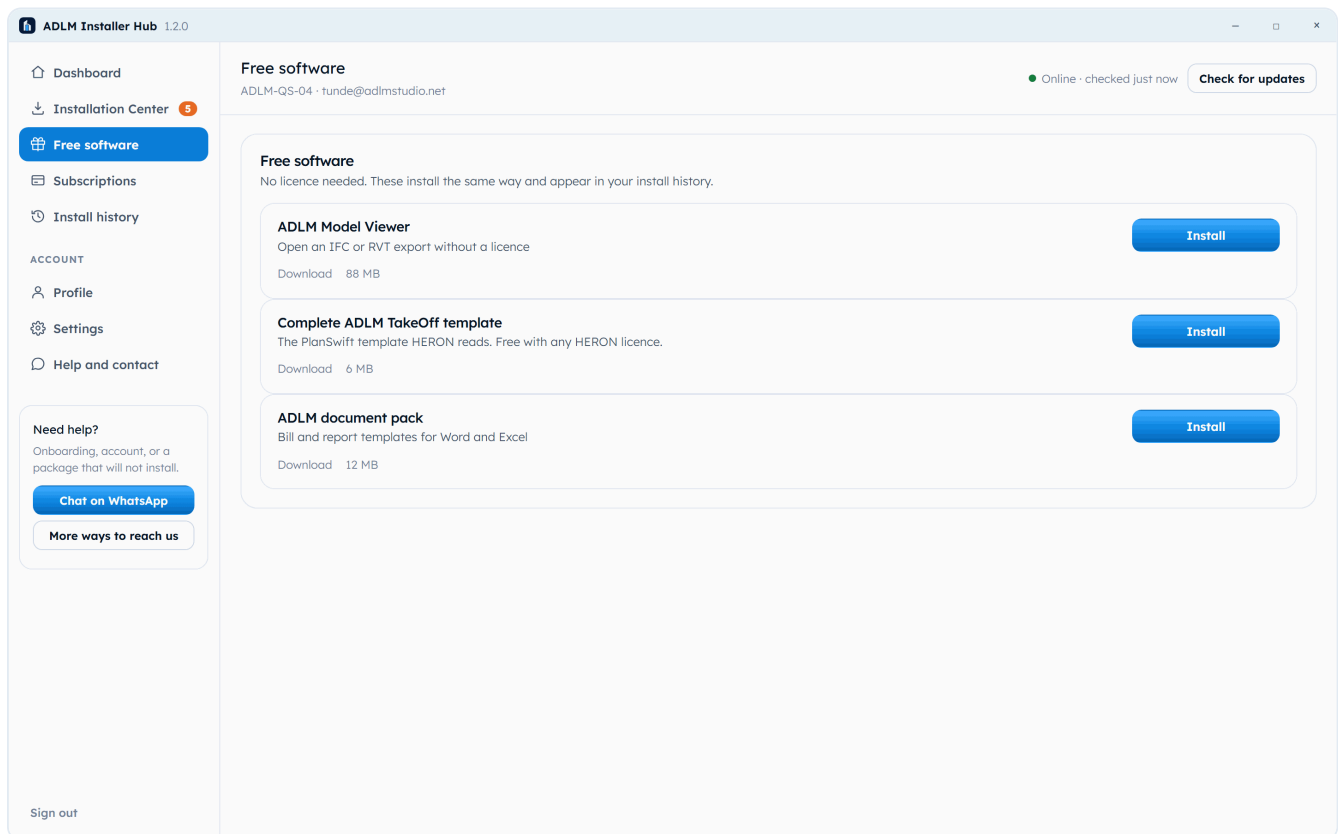
- Click **Repair** to install the same version again over the top.
- Click **Close** to leave it.

Use **Repair** when a plugin no longer appears in its host, antivirus damaged some files, **Open** cannot find the product, or you want the Revit plugin in another Revit year. Repairing does not use another seat. It is logged as **Repaired** in **Install history**.

Removing a product

The Hub does not remove products. Uninstall from Windows **Settings**, **Apps**, **Installed apps** if the product is listed there. Most plugins are not listed; for those, [contact support](#).

Free software



The Free software screen with the free ADLM tools you can install.

Click **Free software** for free ADLM tools, templates and utilities. You need no licence, only to be signed in.

- Items packaged for the Hub show **Install**. They install like a paid product and appear in your install history. Once installed, they show **Open**.
- Other items show **Download**. The file opens in your browser and saves to your Downloads folder.

If nothing is listed, the page says nothing is being given away right now.

Subscriptions

The screenshot shows the 'Subscriptions' page in the ADLM Installer Hub. The left sidebar contains navigation links: Dashboard, Installation Center (with a red 'S' badge), Free software, Subscriptions (highlighted), Install history, ACCOUNT, Profile, Settings, and Help and contact. The main content area is titled 'Subscriptions' and shows the user's account information: 'tunde@adlmstudio.net' and 'ADLM Studio'. It also displays '7 licensed' products and the next renewal date '11 Oct 2026' for 'HERON'. A 'Manage on ADLM Cloud' button is present. On the right, the 'Seats on this PC' section lists products and their seat status. A table below shows the following data:

PRODUCT	SEATS	EXPIRES	
QUIV	1 of 1	11 Aug 2027	Release
HERON	1 of 1	11 Oct 2026	Release
RateGen	1 of 1	11 Aug 2027	Release
Revit MEP Plugin	0 of 1	11 Aug 2027	Not held here
ADLM Time Pro	0 of 1	11 Sep 2027	Not held here
BIM MEP	0 of 1	11 Aug 2027	Not held here
ADLM Time Pro for teams	4 of 4	02 Sep 2026	Release

The Subscriptions screen with each product's licence, seats and expiry.

Your plan shows your **ACCOUNT**, **ORGANISATION**, how many **PRODUCTS** are licensed, and the **NEXT RENEWAL**. Plans, invoices and seats are changed on the website, never from a single PC. Click **Manage on ADLM Cloud** to open billing in your browser.

Seats on this PC lists each product with its **SEATS** and **EXPIRES** date. A product this machine holds a seat for shows **Release**. Others show **Not held here**. See [Your devices and moving a licence](#).

Install history

Click **Install history** for every install, update and repair on this PC, with **WHEN**, **WHAT**, **ACTION** and **BY**. The action reads **Installed**, **Updated from the old version**, or **Repaired**.

Support asks for this first. To send it:

1. Click **Export the log**.
2. A note says **History exported** and where the file was saved.
3. Attach that file to your support ticket.

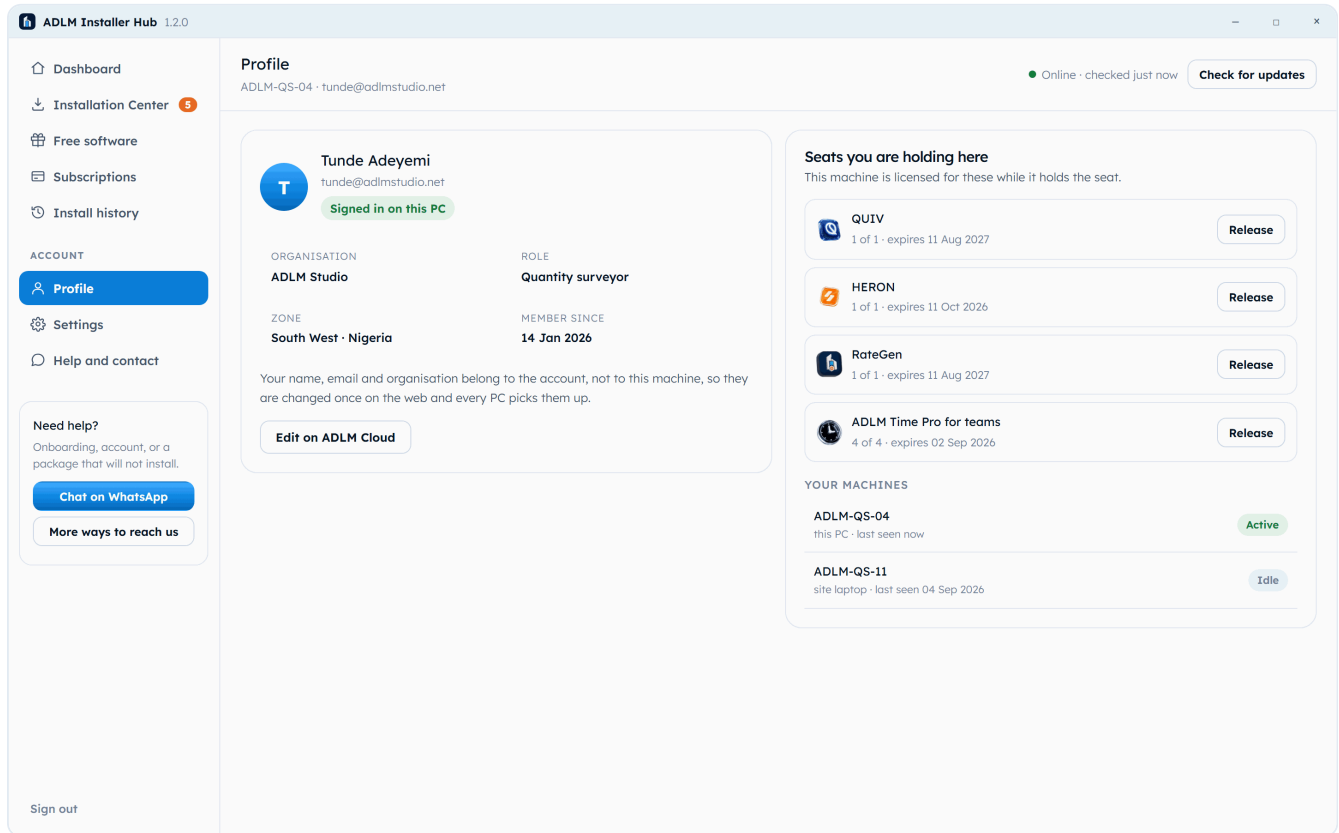
Your devices and moving a licence

Each licence seat belongs to one computer. The first time you install a product, the Hub registers the seat to that PC.

What this means day to day

Install, update and repair as often as you like on that PC; it never uses another seat. You can sign in to the Hub on any computer, but installing on a new one needs a free seat.

See your seats and machines



The Profile screen with the account, this machine and the seats held here.

Click **Profile** in the sidebar.

- The top card shows your name, **Signed in on this PC**, and your **ORGANISATION**, **ROLE**, **ZONE** and **MEMBER SINCE**. To change these, click **Edit on ADLM Cloud**.
- **Seats you are holding here** lists the products this machine is licensed for, with seats and expiry.
- **YOUR MACHINES** lists every computer registered to your account. This computer is tagged **This PC** and the rest **Other PC**, each with the products it holds.

The message you see on another computer

If a product's seats are all held by other computers, the install stops with **The seat is in use on another PC**. It tells you how many seats are held, for example "1 of 1 held". Nothing is installed and nothing is lost. Free a seat (below), click **Check for updates**, then **Install** again.

Release a seat from this PC

1. In **Profile** or **Subscriptions**, click **Release** next to the product.
2. The Hub asks **Release the (product) seat?** and shows the product, its seats and this machine.
3. Click **Ask support to release it**, or **Keep the seat** to cancel.

For now, ADLM support releases seats for you. The Hub opens WhatsApp with a message to support that already names the product and this machine.

Move a licence to a new computer

1. If you still have the old computer, close the ADLM products on it.
2. Free the old computer's seat. Either:
 - on the website, open [Account settings](#), find the old computer under **Machines signed in**, and click **Sign out**; or
 - on the old computer, click **Release** in the Hub and send the request to support.
3. On the new computer, download and install the Hub (see [Install the Hub on your PC](#)).
4. Sign in, open **Installation Center** and click **Install** on each product.

TIP

Replacing or reformatting a PC? Free its seat before you wipe it. Installing on the rebuilt PC is then straightforward.

Relink this PC

If a product says `DEVICE_MISMATCH`, or will not accept your sign-in on a PC that holds its seat, relink:

1. Open **Settings**.
2. Under **This machine**, click **Relink this PC**.

The Hub registers this PC again for every active subscription. A note says **This PC is relinked**. If some subscriptions are still registered to a different PC, a card says **A device reset is needed**. Chat to support on WhatsApp and give them your account email.

If a product installs but the Hub cannot update its registration, a card says the product is installed and explains what to do if the app reports `DEVICE_MISMATCH`. Relink first, then contact support if it persists.

The network signal

Signal bars in the header show how well this PC reaches ADLM Cloud. They sit beside the status text, for example "Online · checked just now". They arrive with the Hub 2.0 rollout. On a build without them, a dot shows instead: green when online and orange when offline.

Bars	Label	Meaning
Four, green	Excellent	A fast connection to ADLM Cloud.
Three, green	Good	Everything works normally.
Two, amber	Fair	Usable, but large downloads take a while.
One, red	Poor	Slow, or the internet is up but the ADLM server is not answering. Installs and sign-in may fail.
Crossed out	Offline	No internet connection. What is installed keeps working.

- Hover over the bars for details: the connection level and its round-trip time, your Wi-Fi signal strength when on Wi-Fi, and when it last checked.
- Click the bars to check again straight away.
- The Hub checks on its own every 20 seconds when online, and every 10 seconds when offline.

Keyboard shortcuts

The Hub uses the same shortcuts as every other ADLM product. Press **F1**, or click **Keyboard shortcuts** at the foot of the sidebar, to see the list. Press **F1** or **Esc** to close it.

Keys	What it does
F1 or Ctrl + /	Show keyboard shortcuts
Ctrl + 1	Go to Dashboard
Ctrl + 2	Go to Installation Center
Ctrl + 3	Go to Free software
Ctrl + 4	Go to Subscriptions
Ctrl + 5	Go to Install history
Ctrl + 6	Go to Profile
Ctrl + 7	Go to Settings
Ctrl + 8	Go to Help and contact
Ctrl + F	Search products
Ctrl + ,	Settings
F5	Check for updates
Ctrl + Shift + U	Update all
Ctrl + Shift + L	Switch light / dark mode
Esc	Close the message card that is open
F12 or Ctrl + Print Screen	Take a screenshot of the Hub

Screenshots are saved in your Pictures folder, under ADLMInstallerHub, and copied to the clipboard. A note says **Screenshot saved**. They are handy when you report a problem.

Notifications and messages

The Hub speaks to you in two ways, both inside its own window.

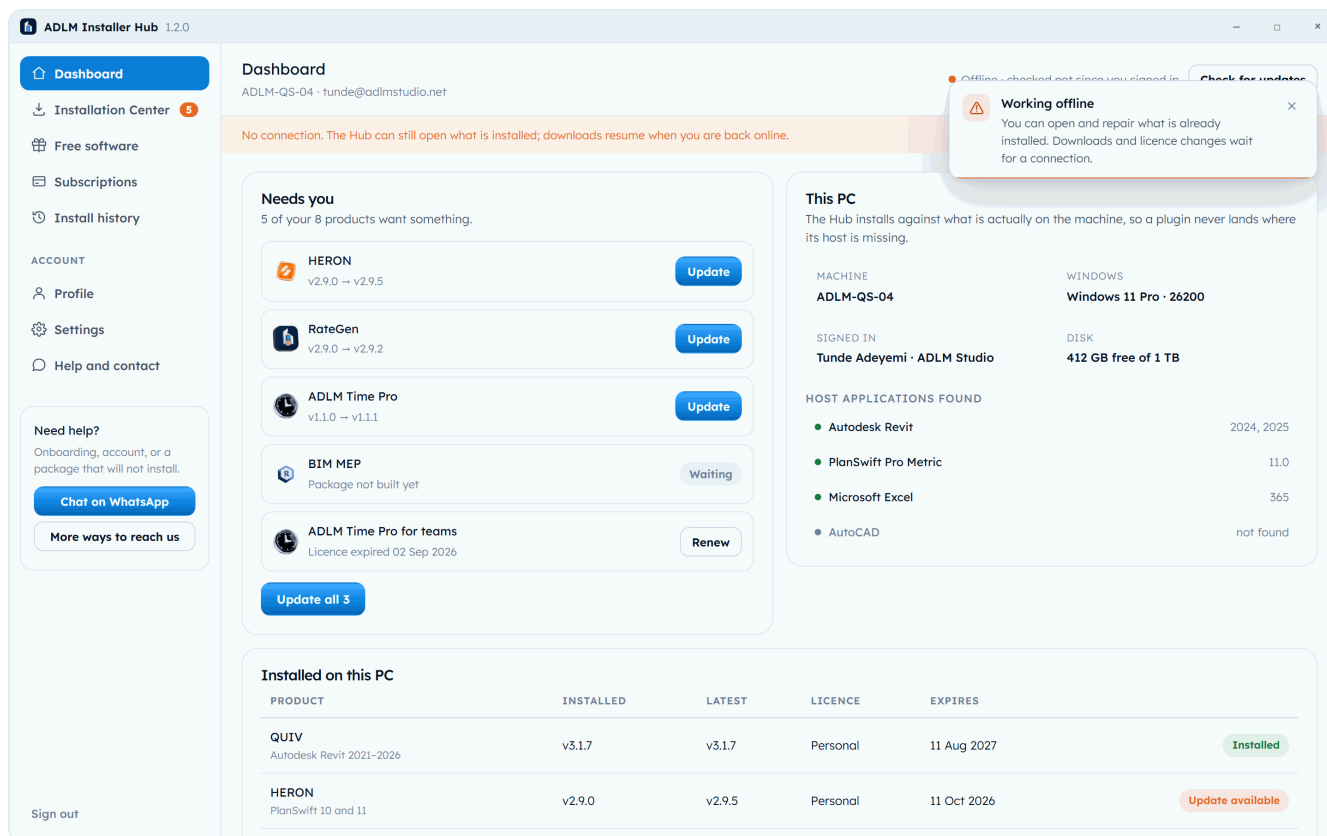
Notes in the corner. Short messages that confirm something or warn you, such as **Signed in**, **Checked ADLM Cloud**, (product) **installed**, **Stopped**, **Working offline**, **Package list unavailable** or **Report exported**. They slip away on their own after about four seconds, or about seven for an error. No more than three show at once.

Cards with buttons. For anything that needs a decision, or an error you should read, a card opens over the window. Examples are **Sign out of the Hub?**, **The seat is in use on another PC** and **(product) did not install**. Read it, then click a button. `Esc` closes it, like clicking the cancel button.

Working offline

You can open the Hub without an internet connection.

1. On the sign-in screen, click **Work offline**.
2. The Hub opens with **Working offline** in place of your name, and a banner across the top: "Working offline. The Hub shows what is installed on this PC; installs, updates and licences wait until you sign in."



The Hub dashboard when working offline.

While offline:

- the Dashboard and Installation Center show what is installed on this PC;
- installs, updates and licence changes wait; clicking **Install** shows a note that the product installs once you are signed in and online;
- the header reads "Offline · not since you signed in";
- **Sign out** becomes **Back to sign-in**. Use it to sign in when you are connected again.

If you lose connection while signed in, the banner reads "No connection to ADLM Cloud. What is installed still works; installs and updates resume when you are back online."

IMPORTANT

If the Hub cannot fetch the latest package list from ADLM, it will not install from the list it was built with. That list can point at older builds that cannot sign in. You see **Cannot install (product) right now**, and the install stops. Reconnect, click **Check for updates**, and install again.

Products you have already installed do not need the Hub to run. How each behaves without internet is covered in its own guide.

Settings

Click **Settings** in the sidebar, or press **Ctrl + ,**.

Appearance. Under **Theme**, choose **Light**, **Dark** or **Match Windows**. **Match Windows** follows your Windows setting and changes when Windows does. **Ctrl + Shift + L** switches between light and dark.

This machine.

- **Relink this PC** registers this PC with your subscriptions again (see [Relink this PC](#)).
- **Where products go** shows **Set by each host**. Each plugin installs where its host program looks for it, so there is no folder to choose. Standalone apps install to Program Files.

Maintenance. If a product will not start, work down this list before you raise a ticket: **Clear the download cache** (so the next install starts clean), **Relink this PC to my subscriptions**, **Export a diagnostic report** and **Open the user guide**. The report holds the Hub's version, this PC, the host programs, your products and recent installs. Nothing from your jobs, drawings or rates is ever included.

Help and contact

Click **Help and contact** in the sidebar, or **More ways to reach us** at the foot of the sidebar.

Under **Talk to us**:

- **WhatsApp** is the fastest. Weekdays 9:00 to 18:00 WAT. It opens WhatsApp with a message to support already started, naming the Hub version and this PC.
- **Raise a ticket** opens the support page on adlmstudio.net, with your account and Hub version filled in.
- **Email support@adlmstudio.net** starts an email with your account, machine and Hub version. Answered within one working day.
- **Read the user guide** opens this guide.

Before you write lists the three fixes that solve most problems: restart the host program if a panel is missing, relink this PC if a seat is in use, and clear the download cache if an install stops part way. See [Troubleshooting](#).

WHAT WE WOULD BE SENDING shows exactly what support receives: your **ACCOUNT**, this **MACHINE**, the **HUB** version and how many **PRODUCTS** are installed. Nothing from your jobs, drawings or rates is ever included.

AI in the Installer Hub

The Installer Hub has no AI features of its own. It does not read your projects, and nothing it sends to ADLM includes your jobs, drawings or rates.

It installs and updates the products that have AI features, so installing the latest release from the Hub is how you get them:

Product	AI features	Availability
QUIV for Revit	AI Rate Check; ♦ Run the whole takeoff and Auto take-off (uses no AI model)	On for everyone (Auto take-off in QUIV 4.0)
HERON	AI Review (AI Bill Review)	On for everyone in HERON 2.9 and 3.0
Rate Gen	Build with AI	On for everyone, from Rate Gen 3.0.1
SERVIQ (Revit MEP)	ADLM AI Review and BUILD WITH ADLM AI	Not in standard installs

AI features need a good connection to ADLM Cloud. The network signal is a quick check. On **Fair** or **Poor**, AI features and cloud saves will be slow.

For what each feature does, where to find it and the monthly allowances, see [ADLM AI services](#).

Uninstall the Hub

1. Open Windows **Settings**, then **Apps**, then **Installed apps**.
2. Find **ADLM Installer Hub** and choose **Uninstall**.
3. Windows asks whether to also remove your Installer Hub settings and data for all users on this computer. Choose **No** to keep them, or **Yes** to remove them.

Removing the Hub does not remove the products it installed.

Troubleshooting

Windows says "Windows protected your PC" when I run setup

This is Windows SmartScreen. It appears for installers that are new to Windows. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**, but only for a file you downloaded from adlmstudio.net.

My Hub looks different from this guide

You have the earlier 2.0 build. The redesigned Hub is rolling out in stages. Your products, licences and seats work the same way. When the new Hub reaches your account, download it from [Downloads](#) and run it over the old one.

My antivirus blocked or deleted the setup or a plugin

Some security products quarantine newly downloaded files. Signs: setup will not start, an install fails at **Extracting**, or a plugin disappears after working. Restore the file from quarantine, or ask IT to allow the ADLM Installer Hub. Then click **More**, then **Repair**.

The install fails with "Access denied" or "file in use"

The program you are installing into is still running. Close Revit, PlanSwift, Civil 3D, Archicad or the ADLM app completely (check the system tray), then install again.

I installed while Revit was open

Revit holds its plugin files open. The progress line may say **Cleanup skipped**, with a note that Revit is running and old version folders were left behind. Close Revit, click **More**, then **Repair**, then open Revit again.

Revit cannot see the plugin

1. Close Revit fully. Plugins load only when Revit starts.
2. Open Revit again.
3. If it is still missing, click **More**, then **Repair**, and choose the Revit year you actually use.

(Product) did not install

A card explains what went wrong and suggests the next step. Clear the download cache in **Settings** and try again. If it stops in the same place, click **Export a diagnostic report** and send it with a ticket.

I cannot sign in

Check the red message against the table in [If sign-in does not work](#). The usual causes are a mistyped password (passwords are case-sensitive), no internet, and signing in with a personal email when the licence is on the company account.

The Hub cannot reach the server even though my internet works

Look at the network signal. One red bar means the internet is up but the ADLM server is not answering. Office networks, firewalls and some security products can block it.

1. Sign out of the Hub, then sign in again.
2. On the same computer, open adlmstudio.net/network-check in your browser. It runs a set of tests and shows what is blocked.
3. If something fails, send the results or the reference code it shows to support on WhatsApp.

My product is not in the Installation Center

1. Click **Check for updates**.
2. Click **All** in the filter row and clear the search box.
3. Check that you are signed in with the account that holds the licence. Your name and email show in the header.
4. Check the subscription on the website. A new purchase may show as **Package pending** until it is released.

"The seat is in use on another PC"

Another computer holds the seat. Free it (see [Move a licence to a new computer](#)), click **Check for updates**, then **Install**.

The Hub will not start

Right-click the **ADLM Installer Hub** shortcut and choose **Run as administrator**. If Windows refuses, ask whoever manages the PC.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need a separate account for the Hub?

No. Use the same email or username and password as the ADLM website.

Why do I have to sign in every time?

The Hub does not save your session. Signing in each time keeps your account safe on shared computers. Tick **Remember my email on this PC** to save typing your email.

What happens to my products if I sign out or close the Hub?

Nothing. They stay installed and keep working. You need the Hub only to install, update, open and repair.

Does the Hub update itself?

No. **Check for updates** checks your products. When ADLM releases a new Hub, download it again from [Downloads](#) and run it over the old one.

Can my IT team install the Hub for everyone?

Yes. The Hub uses standard Windows install locations and needs outbound internet access to adlmstudio.net and the ADLM download service. Each person then signs in with the account that holds the licence.

Where are the guides for the products themselves?

See [QUIV for Revit](#), [HERON](#), [Rate Gen](#), [SERVIQ for Revit MEP](#), [Time Pro](#) and [ADLM Cloud](#). New to ADLM? Start with [Getting started](#).



QUIV for Revit

Measure your Revit model item by item, review the quantities, and send the take-off to ADLM Cloud to price, plan and value.

QUIV is ADLM's quantity take-off add-in for Autodesk Revit. It reads quantities straight from your model: foundations, frame, walls, roof, doors, windows, finishes and external works. You add only what a quantity surveyor knows that the model does not, such as bar sizes, spacing and filling thicknesses. QUIV 4.0 measures; ADLM Cloud prices. You save your take-off to ADLM Cloud, and on adlmstudio.net you price the bill with your Rate Gen rates, plan the budget and value the work.

NOTE

This guide covers **QUIV 4.0.3**. QUIV 4.0.0 is the version the Installer Hub gives customers today. Versions 4.0.1, 4.0.2 and 4.0.3 are being prepared, and each feature they add is marked "from 4.0.1", "from 4.0.2" or "from 4.0.3". Until the Hub offers them, those features are not on your PC yet.

What's new in 4.0.3

QUIV 4.0 is a new QUIV, from sign-in to save. The measuring underneath is the QUIV you know. The latest builds add:

- **From 4.0.1: search on Review.** Type any words, such as "intel 230 basement", to filter the bill lines.
- **From 4.0.1: click a line to see it in the model.** A Review line selects and zooms to the Revit elements behind it.
- **From 4.0.1: Add rates on ADLM Cloud.** One button on Review opens your project on the website, where it is priced.
- **From 4.0.1: tile skirting.** The floor finishes item now measures skirting in metres, net of door openings.
- **From 4.0.2: room finishes go to ADLM Cloud.** Each save sends the floor finish, floor area and skirting length of every Revit room.
- **From 4.0.3: aligned material constants.** POP ceiling boards, emulsion paint and pile cap soil poison now use the same figures as ADLM Cloud and HERON. See [Material constants](#).

See [Version history](#) for everything that changed since QUIV 3.1.11.

Before you start

What you need

Item	Requirement
Autodesk Revit	Revit 2024, 2025, 2026 or 2027, on a Windows PC
Your licence	An active QUIV subscription on your ADLM account
The Installer Hub	QUIV is installed and updated through the ADLM Installer Hub
Internet	Needed to sign in and to save to ADLM Cloud

Item	Requirement
Rate Gen (for pricing)	Needed to price the bill on ADLM Cloud with the ADLM rate library and your own rates

Install QUIV

Installing is covered in full in the [Installer Hub guide](#). The short version:

1. Close Revit. Windows will not let the Hub replace add-in files that Revit is holding open.
2. Open the ADLM Installer Hub and sign in with your ADLM account.
3. Find **QUIV for Revit** and click **Install**.
4. When asked, choose the year of Revit you use. If you use more than one year, install once for each.
5. Start Revit. QUIV loads when Revit starts, so a Revit that was already open will not see it until you restart it.

When the Hub offers an update, close Revit, update, then open Revit again.

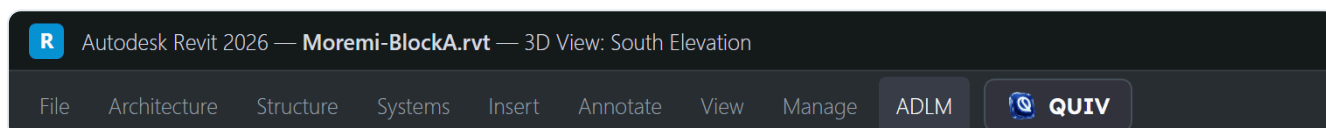
NOTE

Your licence is tied to the computer you sign in from. If you change computers, contact ADLM support from [/support](#) rather than buying again.

Open QUIV and sign in

QUIV adds a **QUIV** tab to the Revit ribbon. Its **ADLM** panel has two buttons:

Button	What it does
QUIV	Opens the QUIV panel beside your model. Asks you to sign in the first time.
Model Checker	Opens the ADLM Model Checker, which tells you whether the model is ready to measure. See The Model Checker .



The QUIV tab on the Revit ribbon, with the QUIV button that opens the panel.

1. Open the model you want to measure.
2. On the **QUIV** tab, click **QUIV**.
3. The panel opens with the sign-in card. Enter your **Email** and **Password**. These are the same details you use on [adlmstudio.net](#).
4. Click **Log in**. The button reads **Signing in...** while it works.

After a good sign-in the card shows "Preparing your projects..." while QUIV builds your panel. QUIV remembers your email and your session, so you normally sign in once on each computer.



The QUIV start card, shown while QUIV prepares your projects.

On the sign-in card, **Forgot password?** opens the website so you can reset your password, and **Create account** opens adlmstudio.net to make an account.

IMPORTANT

If QUIV says "This account has no active QUIV licence. Renew or buy one on adlmstudio.net.", your subscription has expired or does not include QUIV. Renew it on adlmstudio.net, then click **QUIV** again.

Finding your way around

QUIV 4.0 is one panel, docked inside Revit, that walks you through a take-off in order: open the model, make the take-off list, measure item by item, review, and save to ADLM Cloud.

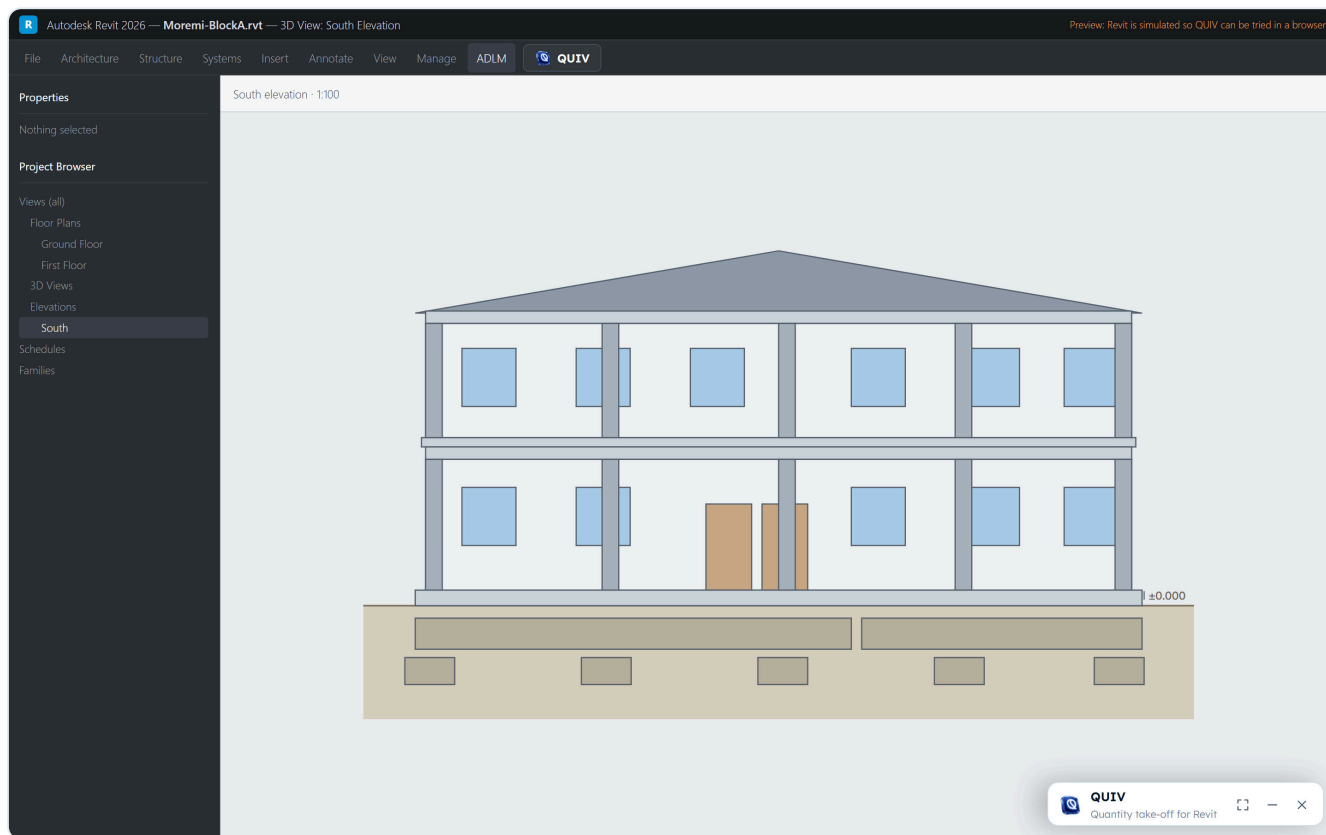
The header

The header shows where you are: the screen name and, under it, the project and progress (for example "8 of 12 items · BESMM4R"). A thin bar under the header fills as items are completed. On the right are four small buttons. Hover over one to see its name:

Button (tooltip)	What it does
Dark mode / Light mode	Switches the panel between light and dark. Not shown in Revit 2024.
Full screen / Dock as a panel	Expands QUIV to full screen, with the take-off list on the left and the open item on the right. Click again to go back to the docked panel.

Button (tooltip)	What it does
Minimise	Folds QUIV down to its title bar so you can see the whole Revit view.
Close	Closes the panel. Your work is kept.

On inner screens, a **Back** arrow at the top left takes you one step back.



QUIV minimised to its title bar, leaving the Revit view clear.

The status bar

The line along the bottom tells you whether QUIV is online:

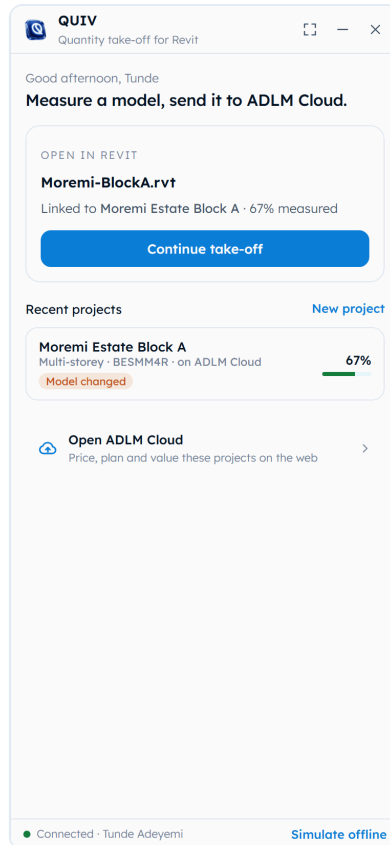
- **Connected** · **your name** means QUIV can reach ADLM Cloud.
- **Offline** · **your work stays on this PC** means the internet is down. You can keep measuring; your work is kept on this computer. Save to ADLM Cloud once you are back online.

Sign out is at the right of the status bar.

Short messages appear at the bottom of the panel and fade after a few seconds. Some carry a button, such as **Undo**.

Home

Home is where QUIV opens after sign-in. It greets you and shows three things.



The QUIV home panel: the model open in Revit, Continue take-off, recent projects and Open ADLM Cloud.

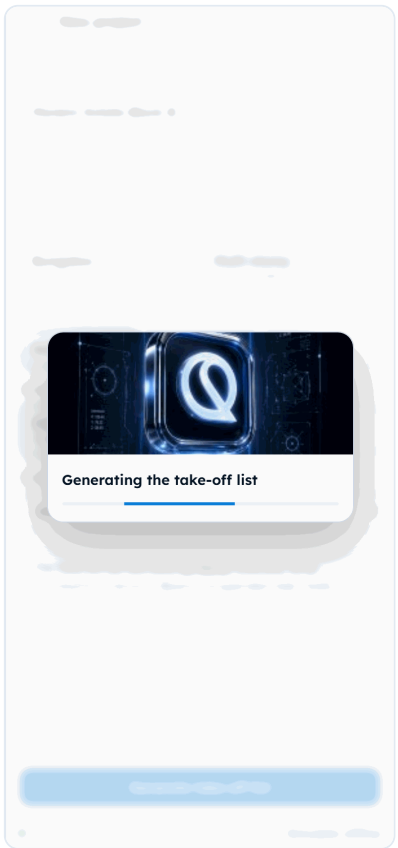
- **Open in Revit** names the model you have open. If that model already belongs to a project, it reads "Linked to" the project name and how much is measured, with **Continue take-off**. If not, it reads "Not linked to a project yet." with **Start a take-off for this model**.
- **Recent projects** lists the projects you have saved to ADLM Cloud, with the number of lines and when each was last saved. Click one to open it. **New project** starts another take-off for the open model.
- **Open ADLM Cloud** ("Price, plan and value these projects on the web") opens your QUIV projects on adlmstudio.net.

Projects open on any computer where you sign in with the same account.

Starting a new project

1. On Home, click **Start a take-off for this model** or **New project**.
2. Type a **Project name**. QUIV will not go on without one ("Give the project a name.").
3. Type the **Client** if you want to. It is optional.
4. Under **Building**, choose **Bungalow** ("One storey") or **Multi-storey** ("Frame, slabs, stairs").
5. Under **Foundation**, tick one or more of **Strip**, **Pad**, **Pile** and **Raft**, or none. A building on pads with a piled core is one take-off, so tick both. An extension with no new foundation can have none.
6. Under **How to start**, choose **Item by item** ("You select, QUIV measures") or **Auto take-off** ("AI measures, you review"). See [Auto take-off](#).
7. Choose the **Standard**: **BESMM4R**, **NRM2**, **SMM7** or **POMI**.
8. Read the line "The take-off list will have...", which names every item the list will contain.
9. Click **Generate take-off list**.

QUIV shows "Generating the take-off list", then opens your take-off list. If you chose **Auto take-off**, the run starts straight away.



QUIV generating the take-off list.

NOTE

The standard is recorded with the take-off. Bill descriptions are not yet worded differently for each standard.

The take-off list

The take-off list is your plan for the job. Items are grouped the way a bill is written:

Group	Items
Foundation	Oversite, Strip foundation, Pad foundation, Pile cap, Raft foundation
Frames	Columns, Beams, Suspended slab, Steelwork
Architectural	Walls, Roof, Ceilings, Curtain wall, Doors, Windows, Staircase, Floor finishes
External works	Railings, Landscaping, Model items

Only the items for your building and foundations appear. Each group shows how many of its items are done, for example "2 of 3". Each item has a dot: empty when not started, a blue ring when part measured, and green with a tick when complete. A measured item shows its main quantity.

- **Click an item** to measure it.

- **Remove from the list** (the cross on an item) takes off an item the job does not need, such as the frame on a substructure-only job. Click **Undo** in the message to bring it back. An item with saved lines cannot be removed.
- **Auto take-off** lets QUIV measure the items for you.
- **Review and save** opens Review.

TIP

Work down the list from top to bottom. It is the order a bill is written in, so your bill comes out in bill order.

NOTE

QUIV reads the model when you measure, not all the time. If the model changes after you measured an item, open the item again and measure it again. QUIV 4.0.3 does not warn you when the model changes.

Measuring an item

Every item screen works the same way, in three numbered steps with the results underneath.

The screenshot shows a mobile application interface for measuring a 'Suspended slab' item. The title bar at the top says 'Suspended slab' and 'Moremi Estate Block A'. Below the title bar, there are three numbered steps:

- 1 Select the suspended floors in Revit**: This step includes the instruction 'Only the suspended floors can be picked. Other elements are ignored.' and a blue button labeled 'Select in Revit'.
- 2 From the model**: This step includes the instruction 'Read from Revit — no typing'. It has two input fields: 'Area' with a unit of 'm²' and 'Edge length' with a unit of 'm'.
- 3 Your inputs**: This step includes the instruction 'What only the QS knows'. It has a single input field for 'Slab thickness' with a value of '0.15' and a unit of 'm'.

Below the steps, there is a 'Results' section with the instruction 'Select in Revit to see quantities.' and two buttons: 'Previous' and 'Mark complete'.

At the bottom of the screen, there is a status bar showing 'Connected - Tunde Adeyemi' and a link to 'Simulate offline'.

An item before measuring: step 1 asks you to select the elements in Revit.

1. **Select in Revit.** The step names what to pick, for example "Select the suspended floors in Revit". Only that kind of element can be picked; anything else is ignored. Where the item measures by level and type, choose the **Level** and **Type** here instead, and QUIV measures them.
2. Click **Select in Revit**, click the elements in the Revit view, then click **Finish** on the Revit options bar. QUIV shows "Reading the model..." and then how many elements it measured.

3. **From the model** shows what QUIV read from Revit, with no typing: areas, lengths, volumes and counts.
You cannot type over these. To change them, change the model and measure again.
4. **Your inputs** ("What only the QS knows") holds thicknesses, depths, bar sizes, numbers of bars, spacing and switches. Change a value and the results update when you leave the field. "0,15" and "0.15" both mean 0.15.
5. **Results** shows the quantities that will go into the bill.

Suspended slab
Moremi Estate Block A

1 **Select the suspended floors in Revit**
Floor - Suspended slab 150 - Level 1
[Change selection](#)

2 **From the model**
Read from Revit — no typing

Area	Edge length
540.00 m²	100.00 m

3 **Your inputs**
What only the QS knows

Slab thickness

0.15 m

Results **Material breakdown**

Concrete in slab 81.00 m³	Formwork to soffit 540.00 m²
Formwork to edges 15.00 m²	Reinforcement 7,290.00 kg

[Previous](#) [Mark complete](#)

Connected - Tunde Adeyemi [Simulate offline](#)

A measured item: the selection, the quantities read from the model, your inputs and the results.

To pick again, click **Change selection**.

Material breakdown and mix ratio

Click **Material breakdown** under the results to see the materials behind them, such as cement in bags, sharp sand and granite in tonnes, blocks and bars. Concrete items show a **Mix ratio** you can edit, for example 1:2:4. Click **Hide materials** to fold it away.

Oversite
Moremi Estate Block A - complete

0.15 m 0.15 m
Slab thickness Blinding thickness

0.15 m 0.05 m

Results [Hide materials](#)

Hardcore filling 84.00 m³	Laterite filling 84.00 m³
BRC mesh 560.00 m²	DPM 560.00 m²
Formwork to edges 15.30 m²	Oversite concrete 84.00 m³
Blinding 28.00 m³	

Mix ratio 1 : 2 : 4

Cement	710 bags
Sharp sand	78.85 tonnes
Granite	147.84 tonnes
Hardcore	159.60 tonnes
Laterite	151.20 tonnes
BRC mesh A142	13 rolls
Damp-proof membrane	7 rolls
1x12 hardwood	14 nr
Nails	2.30 kg

Completed · next item

Connected · Tunde Adeyemi [Simulate offline](#)

The material breakdown for an item, with the editable mix ratio.

Mark complete

1. Check the selection, inputs and results.
2. Click **Mark complete**. QUIV saves the item's lines to the take-off and ticks it on the list.
3. The button now reads **Completed · next item**. Click it to go to the next item, or **Previous** to go back.

When every item is done, the button reads **Review and save**.

Walls

Moremi Estate Block A - complete

1

Select the walls in Revit

Basic Wall - 225 Blockwork - Ground
Basic Wall - 225 Blockwork - Level 1

Change selection

2

From the model

Read from Revit — no typing

Gross area

820.00 m²

Openings

186.00 m²

3

Your inputs

What only the QS knows

Rendered faces

2 m²

Results

Material breakdown

Blockwork, net of openings

634.00 m²

Render

1,268.00 m²

Emulsion paint

1,268.00 m²

Previous

Completed · next item

Connected · Tunde Adeyemi

Simulate offline

A completed item, ready to move on with Completed · next item.

If you save a level and type you have already saved, QUIV asks whether to replace the previous figures or add to them. Choose replace when you are correcting a measurement, and add when you are measuring another part of the same thing.

If the save did not complete, QUIV says "Not saved yet". Check the selection and inputs, then mark it complete again.

What each item measures

Item	What it measures
Oversite	Hardcore and laterite filling (leaving out the walls standing on the slab), BRC mesh, DPM, formwork to edges, oversite concrete and blinding
Strip foundation	Excavation, earthwork support, concrete in footing, blockwork in foundation, blinding, surface treatment, levelling and compacting, damp-proof course, backfill and disposal
Pad foundation	Excavation, earthwork support, concrete in pads, formwork, blinding and bars
Pile cap	Excavation, concrete in pile caps and piles, formwork, blinding, bars and surface treatment
Raft foundation	Excavation, concrete in slab and beams, hardcore, laterite, DPM, beam formwork and reinforcement
Columns	Concrete in columns, formwork, main bars and links
Beams	Concrete in beams, formwork, top and bottom bars and links

Item	What it measures
Suspended slab	Concrete in slab, formwork to soffit and edges, and reinforcement
Steelwork	Structural steel by weight and surface area
Walls	Blockwork net of openings, rendering, lintel concrete, formwork and reinforcement
Roof	Roof members such as rafters, purlins, tie beams, king posts, struts, wall plate, fascia and ridge
Ceilings	Ceiling area, noggings and POP boards
Curtain wall	Curtain walling area with its mullions, panels and fixings
Doors / Windows	Doors and windows by type, with area and perimeter
Staircase	Concrete in stairs, formwork and reinforcement
Floor finishes	Wall paint, floor tiling, ceilings, paint in litres, tile packs and tile skirting
Railings	Railings and balustrades in metres, by level and type
Landscaping	Paving, turf, fencing and other external works
Model items	Anything modelled that does not fit an item above

Steel beams and columns are measured under **Steelwork** only, not as concrete beams or columns.

Tile skirting

From 4.0.1, the **Floor finishes** item measures tile skirting, in metres.

1. Open **Floor finishes** and select the finished floors in Revit.
2. Read **Skirting** (m) under **Results**, beside **Floor tiling** and **Tile packs**.

How it is measured:

- For each tiled floor, QUIV takes the perimeter of every Revit room standing on it, less the width of each door into that room. A door between two tiled rooms comes off both rooms.
- If no rooms are modelled, QUIV uses the floor's own edge, less the doors on it.
- Each room counts once.

Skirting goes on the bill as its own line, "Skirtings, 100mm high", in metres under M40 Skirtings in the floor finishes. It is never added to the tiling area.

TIP

Skirting is most accurate when the model has Revit rooms. Place rooms before you measure finishes.

Room finishes sent to ADLM Cloud

From 4.0.2, every save to ADLM Cloud also sends a room-by-room record of the finishes QUIV measured. For each Revit room standing on a measured floor, it records:

- the room name, number and level
- the floor finish
- the floor area, in m²
- the skirting length, in metres

A room on two floors is one record, and re-saving keeps rooms measured earlier. Wall finish areas per room are not included yet. The records let ADLM Cloud answer room questions, such as "floor area and skirting for the toilets". Your bill lines are not changed by them.

NOTE

For the room records to be useful, give your Revit rooms clear names, such as "Toilet 1" or "Master bedroom".

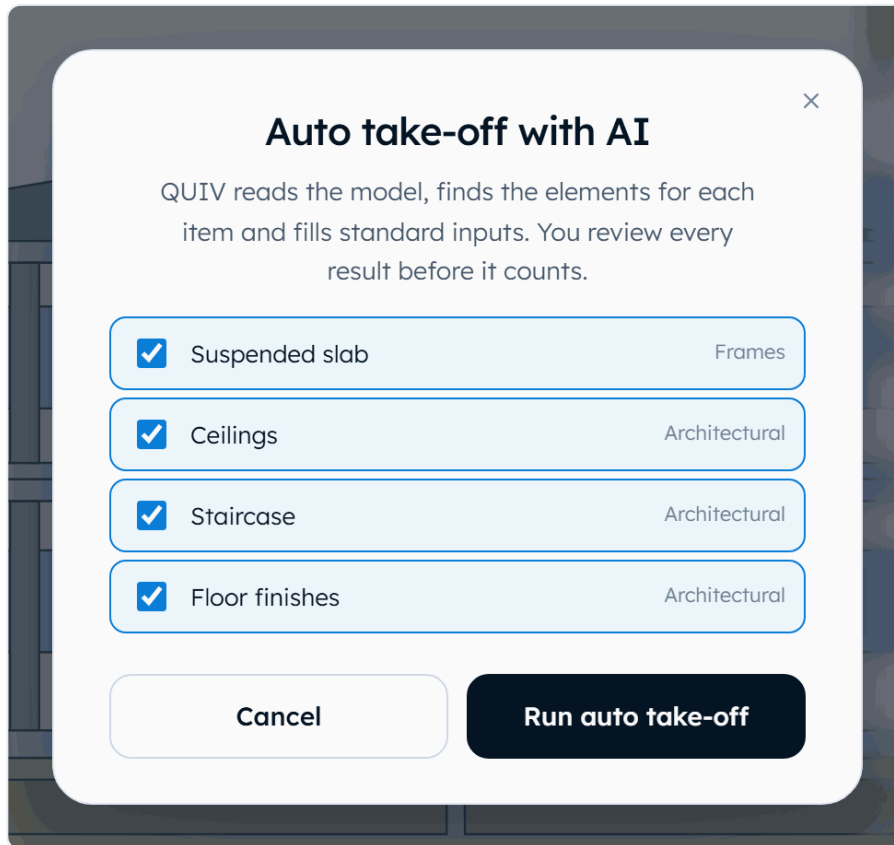
Auto take-off

Instead of measuring each item yourself, you can let QUIV measure them. In QUIV 3 this was ♦ **Run the whole takeoff**. In QUIV 4.0 it is **Auto take-off**.

QUIV goes through the model level by level and type by type with the same measuring engines you use by hand, and puts every level and every type on its own bill line. Nothing it measures counts until you accept it.

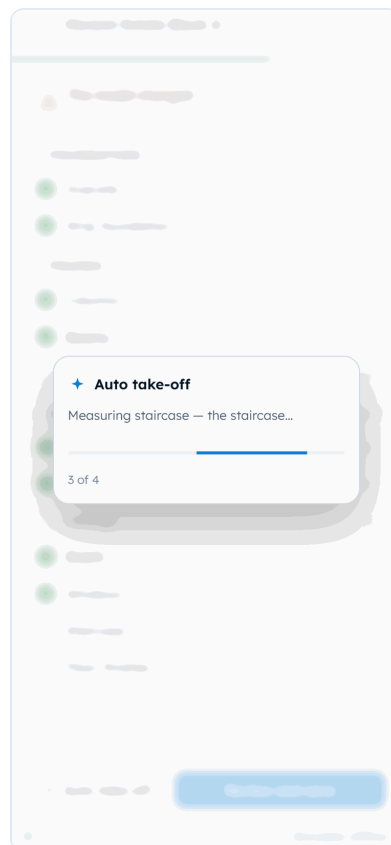
Run it

1. On the take-off list, click **Auto take-off** (in full screen, **Auto take-off with AI**). Or choose **Auto take-off** under **How to start** when you make a new project; the run then starts straight away over every item it can reach.
2. In **Auto take-off with AI**, tick the items to measure. Items that start with a pick in Revit say "You pick this in Revit" and cannot be ticked; measure those yourself.
3. Click **Run auto take-off**, or **Cancel**.



The Auto take-off with AI window, where you tick the items to measure.

While it runs, a card shows the item and level, measurements saved, a clock and a time estimate. Revit stays usable.



QUIV measuring items, showing the item it is on and how many are left.

To stop, click **Stop**. QUIV finishes the measurement in progress, then stops. What is saved is kept.

Review and accept the results

When the run ends, QUIV says how many items it measured, how many look right and how many need a closer look. Each measured item shows a confidence figure, and a bar at the top of the list reads, for example, "4 AI results to review".

- **Accept 2** (the number changes) accepts every result at 85% confidence or more in one click.
- For the others, open the item. It reads "Measured by AI" with its confidence and a note, such as which levels did not save. Check the selection and inputs, then click **Accept and complete**.

AI measured 4 items
2 look right. 2 need a closer look. Nothing is complete until you accept it.

Waist thickness is not modelled — 150mm assumed.
Check the selection and inputs below, then accept.

1 Select the staircase in Revit
Stair - Cast-in-place - 2 flights
Change selection

2 From the model
Read from Revit — no typing

Flights 2 nr Risers per flight 18 nr

3 Your inputs
What only the QS knows

Waist thickness 0.15 m Going 0.275 m

Results
Concrete in stairs 2.03 m³
Formwork to soffit and risers 20.01 m³

Material breakdown

Previous Accept and complete

Connected - Tunde Adeyemi Simulate offline

An item measured by auto take-off at lower confidence, with its note and Accept and complete.

IMPORTANT

The confidence figure is not a guess. It is the share of an item's planned measurements that saved without failing. A low figure means some levels did not save; check those levels.

You cannot save to ADLM Cloud while results are waiting. QUIV says "Accept the AI results first".

NOTE

Auto take-off runs are limited per day on each account. QUIV tells you when you are close to the limit. Measuring item by item is never limited.

Review and save to ADLM Cloud

Click **Review** and **save** on the take-off list. Review shows your take-off as bill lines before it goes to ADLM Cloud.



The Review screen: items measured, items still to do, the bill lines and Save changes to ADLM Cloud.

- Three figures at the top: **measured**, **still to do** and **bill lines**.
- If items are not measured yet, a note names them. You can save now and finish later; the project updates on ADLM Cloud each time. When all are done it says "Every item is measured."
- **Click a bill line** (from 4.0.1) to select and zoom to its elements in the Revit model. A line with nothing behind it, or from a model that is not open, says so.

Search the quantities

From 4.0.1, a search box sits above the bill lines: "Search quantities: item, level, type or size".

1. Type one or more words, for example `lintel 230 basement`.
2. Every word must appear in the line (item, level, type, size, quantity or unit), in any order.
3. QUIV shows how many lines match, for example "6 of 120 lines". If nothing matches, it says "No line matches. Try fewer words."
4. Click the cross to clear the search.

You can still click a found line to see it in the model.

Save to ADLM Cloud

1. On Review, click **Save to ADLM Cloud**. For a project already on ADLM Cloud, the button reads **Save changes to ADLM Cloud**.

2. Answer any question QUIV asks, for example whether to replace or add to lines you measured before.
3. QUIV shows "Saved to ADLM Cloud" with the project name.

Each save updates the same project. QUIV will not save when nothing is measured, while auto take-off results are waiting, or offline ("You are offline"); your measurements stay on this PC until you reconnect.

Add rates on ADLM Cloud

QUIV 4.0 measures; rates and the budget are added on ADLM Cloud. From 4.0.1, **Add rates on ADLM Cloud** on Review opens this project's page on adlmstudio.net. Save the take-off first; otherwise QUIV says "Save to ADLM Cloud first".

Pricing with Rate Gen

Prices and rates come from the ADLM rate library, which is part of Rate Gen. Rates are built only in ADLM Rate Gen. On ADLM Cloud you pick a Rate Gen rate onto a bill line, or type a price on a project bill line; you cannot build or edit a rate on the website. See the [Rate Gen guide](#) for building rates and the [ADLM Cloud guide](#) for pricing a bill.

The Rate Gen licence rule

A Rate Gen licence is what prices the bill. QUIV checks your licence once after you sign in.

- **With Rate Gen:** nothing extra appears. When you save, QUIV says your project "is on the web, ready to price in RateGen". On ADLM Cloud, prices from your Rate Gen library are added to the QUIV budget when you save, and you pick Rate Gen rates onto bill lines. A price you typed on the web is never overwritten.
- **Without Rate Gen:** your bill is quantities only. Review shows a card, **Price this bill with RateGen:** "This bill is quantities only. Prices and rates come from the ADLM rate library, which is part of RateGen. With a RateGen licence you can price it and add your own rates." The save message says pricing it needs Rate Gen.

On the card, **Get RateGen** opens Rate Gen pricing on adlmstudio.net, and **I have RateGen** checks your licence again after you buy. If it says "No RateGen licence yet", wait a minute and try again.

If QUIV cannot reach ADLM to check (for example, offline), it does not show the card and does not block anything. If a Rate Gen pricing request fails for a licensed account, QUIV says "RateGen did not answer" rather than showing a silent zero.

TIP

You can measure and save a full take-off without Rate Gen. Your quantities are safe on ADLM Cloud, ready to price when you get a licence.

Linked models

Many jobs come as an architectural model with the structural engineer's model linked into it. QUIV measures the beams, columns and slabs inside a linked structural model.

- **Levels are matched for you**, by name where the two models agree and by height where they do not. So "00 - GROUND FLOOR" in the engineer's file is recognised as your "Ground floor level". Each linked element is measured on exactly one level.

- **Load the link.** QUIV can only measure a link that is loaded in Revit. If an item comes back empty when you know it is modelled, check the link is loaded in Manage Links.

IMPORTANT

If the same linked file is placed in your model more than once (copied, mirrored, or linked again when it looked missing), its elements can be measured once for each placement, which doubles the quantities. Open Manage Links in Revit and remove the link instances you do not need before you measure.

Material constants

QUIV turns measured quantities into materials with a set of material constants: waste factors, coverages and conversions. From 4.0.3, the constants below match ADLM Cloud and HERON, so the same model gives the same materials in every ADLM product.

Constant	Value in 4.0.3	What it means
POP board factor	1.44 m ² per board	A 1.2 m x 1.2 m POP ceiling board. Boards = ceiling area x 1.3 ÷ 1.44, rounded up. Was 4.32.
Emulsion paint (20L drum)	0.026 drums per m ²	0.52 litres per m ² , so 100 m ² needs 52 litres (2.6 drums). Used by the floor finishes item, the material schedule and model items alike.
Soil poison coverage	20 m ² per unit	Also used for the pile cap surface treatment. 10 m ² now needs 1 unit, not 56 as before.
Blockwork waste factor	1.03	Added to blockwork.
Tiles per area	1.10 m ² per m ²	Tile waste on floor tiling.
Reinforcement weight	d ² ÷ 162 kg per metre	Bar weight from its diameter in mm.
Beam main bars: laps and waste	1.15	Added to beam main bars.
Staircase bars: laps and waste	1.10	Added to staircase bars.

The old "Paint coverage" setting (10 m² per litre) is retired, because it priced paint about five times lower than real bills do.

Your own values are kept

QUIV keeps your constants in a file on your PC. When you update:

- A constant still at the old default moves to the new value.
- A constant you changed yourself stays as you set it. If you had edited the old paint coverage, it is converted to drums per m².

NOTE

The QUIV 4.0 panel has no button that opens the full constants library. QUIV uses the values saved on your PC, or the defaults above. You can change an item's **Mix ratio** in its **Material breakdown**.

The Model Checker

Before you measure, the Model Checker tells you whether the model can be measured: what is there, what is missing, what overlaps, and whether reinforcement has been modelled.

Run a check

1. Sign in through the **QUIV** button first. Otherwise the checker says "Please sign in via the QUIV button first."
2. Open the model you want to check.
3. On the **QUIV** tab, click **Model Checker**. The **ADLM Model Checker** window opens.
4. Under **Select Model Type**, choose **Architectural Model** or **Structural Model**.
5. Under **Check Options**, tick the checks you want.
6. Click **Run Model Check**.

Option	What it looks for
Check for Overlapping Elements	Duplicated elements sitting on top of each other. Duplicates are the usual reason a quantity comes out double.
Check Inter-Model Clashes	Clashes between your model and the models linked into it.
Check Reinforcement (InDesign Rebar)	Structural models only. Shows which categories carry modelled rebar and which do not.

Read the results

The results screen shows four figures: **Readiness Score**, **Elements Found**, **Issues Found** and **Element Categories**. Below them:

- **Element Categories** lists what was found. A missing category has to be modelled first.
- **Reinforcement Analysis** (structural models) shows which categories have modelled rebar. Where there is none, you enter bars yourself when you measure.
- **Issues** lists each problem. Click a row to highlight that element in Revit.

Button	What it does
Export Excel	Saves the whole check to a spreadsheet.
View QS Query	Opens a QS Query Report : the questions to send the design team about missing or unclear parts of the model.
Generate QR Code	Saves the report to the ADLM website with a QR code anyone can scan to read it.
Proceed to Takeoff	Records your take-off decision in the QS query and closes the checker.
Back to Setup	Returns to the options to run another check.

IMPORTANT

A report published with **Generate QR Code** can be read by anyone who has the link or the code. Check the project name and the category list before you share it.

AI in QUIV

This section sums up the AI features you can use from QUIV 4.0. For how ADLM AI works, what it never does on its own, and the allowances, see [ADLM AI services](#).

Feature	Where	Availability
Auto take-off	Take-off list, or How to start on a new project	On for everyone signed in. Runs are limited per day.
Ada and the AI cost checks	ADLM Cloud, on the project you saved	See ADLM AI services
AI Rate Check, AI Match Labour, AI Match Materials	Not in the QUIV 4.0 panel	These lived on QUIV 3's Bill and Budget, which QUIV 4.0 replaced with pricing on ADLM Cloud.
QUIV AI Assistant , the AI prompt bar and AI Assist	Not in standard installs	Set up by ADLM only

Auto take-off

Auto take-off is labelled "AI" on screen, but a run **uses no AI model**. It drives QUIV's own measuring engines over every level and type, and every result waits for you to accept it. See [Auto take-off](#). It is rationed per day because a run walks every item over every level.

Ada on ADLM Cloud

Once your take-off is saved, Ada, the assistant on the website, can answer questions about your project, and the AI cost checks compare your rates with the market. From 4.0.2, the room finishes QUIV sends are there for room questions. Nothing changes in your bill without your confirmation.

ADLM Cloud: your project on the website

Go to [/projects/revit](#) after signing in on adlmstudio.net, or click **Open ADLM Cloud** on QUIV's Home. Every project you saved from QUIV is listed there. Open a project to price the bill, plan the budget, value the work and export it.

Learning samples

At the top of the QUIV projects page you may see **Learning samples**: fully worked projects, each measured from its own 3D model. Click **Show** and the number of samples, then open one to see every tab filled in on a realistic job. Samples are read-only.

Exports on the website

Exports are made on ADLM Cloud. On an open project, click **Export**. The groups are **Bill & Budget**, **Generic BoQ**, **Elemental BoQ** (by building element), **Trade BoQ** (by work section) and **Milestone BoQ** (one priceable

bill per construction stage).

From the ICMS 3 release on ADLM Cloud, the **Export** menu also has an **ICMS 3** group, "international cost and carbon report":

- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**: cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, with every line's code and carbon source, and the lines not yet placed.
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)**: the same report as data, conforming to the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3.

The report total equals the contract total: preliminaries go in Group 08, contingency in 09.020 and VAT in 10.020. Carbon per line comes from your Rate Gen rates, so price the bill with Rate Gen rates first. Cost and carbon per m² appear when an IPMS 1 or 2 floor area is given. It works on the learning samples too.

See the [ADLM Cloud guide](#) for the rest of the website.

Version history

4.0.3 (October 2026, being prepared)

- POP ceiling boards use 1.44 m² per board in every QUIV tool, matching ADLM Cloud.
- One paint basis everywhere: 0.026 drums per m² (0.52 L/m²). The old 10 m² per litre paint coverage is retired.
- Pile cap surface treatment uses the soil poison coverage, 20 m² per unit.
- Values you edited yourself are kept through the update.

4.0.2 (October 2026, being prepared)

- Room-by-room finishes (floor finish, floor area and skirting per Revit room) go to ADLM Cloud with each save.

4.0.1 (October 2026, being prepared)

- Search on Review.
- Click a Review line to see its elements in the model.
- **Add rates on ADLM Cloud** on Review.
- Tile skirting in metres on **Floor finishes**.
- Curtain walling reopened from ADLM Cloud keeps its mullion, panel and fixing lines.
- A fence wall modelled from ground level bills its blockwork below ground.

4.0.0 (September 2026)

A new QUIV, from sign-in to save:

- Sign-in inside the panel, Home, a one-screen new project, a take-off list you can trim, and one screen per item.
- **Auto take-off** replaces ✦ **Run the whole takeoff**, with confidence on every result.
- Review and **Save to ADLM Cloud**. Pricing, the budget and exports move to ADLM Cloud, so QUIV 3's Bill, Budget and Revit exports are gone. Pricing follows your Rate Gen licence.
- Light and dark, full screen and minimise.

- A full check of every item's quantities. For example, strip backfill is now excavation less footing concrete, blinding and blockwork; oversite filling leaves out the walls standing on the slab; and laps and waste on beam and staircase bars are material constants (1.15 and 1.10).

Since 3.1.11

QUIV 3.1.11 was the last QUIV 3 release ([Esc](#) closes pop-ups; pop-ups fit a narrow panel). 4.0.0 includes its fixes, and the 3.1.9 features (linked models, a line per level and type) carry on.

Troubleshooting

There is no QUIV tab in Revit

QUIV is not loaded. Close Revit, open the Installer Hub, and install or reinstall **QUIV for Revit**, choosing the year of Revit you use. Then start Revit again. Add-ins load only when Revit starts.

"That email and password do not match."

Check your email and password and try again. Use the same details as on adlmstudio.net. If you have forgotten your password, click **Forgot password?**.

My computer changed and now I cannot sign in

Your licence is tied to the computer you first used. Contact ADLM support from [/support](#) to move it.

Nothing appears in the Type list, or Select in Revit picks nothing

Nothing of that kind is modelled on the level you chose. Check the level first; this is nearly always the cause. Only the kind of element the step names can be picked. If the elements are in a linked model, make sure the link is loaded.

A quantity looks double

1. **Duplicated elements.** Run the Model Checker with **Check for Overlapping Elements** ticked, then click the issue rows to find the duplicates in Revit.
2. **A link placed twice.** Open Manage Links in Revit and remove link instances you do not need. See [Linked models](#).

The reinforcement comes out as zero

The rebar is not modelled, which is normal. Enter the bar sizes, numbers and spacing under **Your inputs**.

I changed the model but the quantities did not change

QUIV reads the model when you measure. Open the item, select again, and mark it complete. When asked, choose to replace the previous figures. Then save to ADLM Cloud again.

Auto take-off says "You pick this in Revit"

That item starts with a pick in Revit, so auto take-off cannot reach it. Open it and select the elements yourself.

"Accept the AI results first"

Auto take-off results are waiting. Click **Accept** for the sure ones on the list, or open each item and click **Accept and complete**. Then save.

I cannot find the Bill, the Budget or Export in QUIV

QUIV 4.0 measures, and ADLM Cloud prices. Save on Review, then click **Add rates on ADLM Cloud** to price, plan and export on the website.

My bill has no prices

Prices are added on ADLM Cloud, from Rate Gen. Without a Rate Gen licence the bill stays quantities only; see [The Rate Gen licence rule](#). If you have just bought Rate Gen, click **I have RateGen** on Review.

There is no dark mode button

You are using Revit 2024, where QUIV stays in light mode.

Support asks for my log file

QUIV writes a diagnostic log to `%APPDATA%\ADLM\adlm.log`. Paste that address into the Windows File Explorer address bar to find it, and attach the file to your support ticket.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need Rate Gen to use QUIV?

No. QUIV measures and saves without it. You need Rate Gen to price the bill with the ADLM rate library and your own rates on ADLM Cloud.

Can I still price inside Revit?

No. In QUIV 4.0, pricing, the budget and exports are on ADLM Cloud. Rates are built in ADLM Rate Gen.

Can I measure a structural model linked into my architectural model?

Yes, for beams, columns and slabs. Make sure the link is loaded. See [Linked models](#).

Why did my POP boards or paint change after the update?

From 4.0.3, QUIV uses the same constants as ADLM Cloud and HERON: 1.44 m² per POP board and 0.52 litres of paint per m². Constants you edited yourself are kept. See [Material constants](#).

Which versions of Revit does QUIV work with?

Revit 2024 to 2027. The Installer Hub asks which year you use and installs the matching version.

Where can I get help?

Raise a ticket or chat with ADLM from [/support](#). With a take-off problem, send the project name, the item, the level and type you chose, the number QUIV gave and the number you expected, and a screenshot of the item screen.



ADLM HERON

Measure PDF drawings in PlanSwift with the ADLM template, then let HERON check the take-off, price the budget and hand a clean bill to Excel and ADLM Cloud.

ADLM HERON is a Windows app for quantity surveyors and estimators who take off from 2D drawings in PlanSwift. You measure in PlanSwift with the ADLM template, so every slab, wall, finish and service already knows its unit and its formula. HERON then reads the job PlanSwift has open, tells you what is wrong with the take-off before it becomes a bill, prices a material and labour budget from your Rate Gen library, works out steel tonnage, and sends the bill to Excel and to ADLM Cloud. This guide covers HERON 3.0.1. HERON 3.0.0 is the version on the Installer Hub today; 3.0.1 is staged and adds the constants fixes listed in [What's new](#).

What's new in 3.0.1

HERON 3.0 is a complete redesign. If you used HERON 2.9, the main changes are:

- **A new shell.** A slim sidebar with **Take-offs**, then the open take-off's four screens: **Take-off**, **Budget**, **Steel tonnage** and **Excel**. **Dock** puts HERON in a narrow column beside PlanSwift.
- **Take-offs, not projects.** Each PlanSwift job becomes a take-off card. Jobs you saved to ADLM Cloud earlier appear as cards too.
- **Checks before the bill.** HERON flags items with **No quantity**, **No unit**, a **Dead form field**, **Not in a folder** or **Empty sub-items**, so silent zeros never reach the bill.
- **Re-cut without touching PlanSwift.** View the take-off **By Folder**, **By Trade** or **By Element**, and search every item and sub-item in the job.
- **Show in PlanSwift.** Jump from an item to the page it is drawn on.
- **A simpler review.** **Review & save** opens one sheet, **Review before saving**, with **AI Review** and **Save to ADLM Cloud**.
- **Fill a client's bill.** Put HERON's quantities into a client's own Excel bill, in their layout.
- **Roof timber is billed again.** The Roof Covering works out its rafters, purlins, struts and ties, wall plate, fascia and barge boards, and they reach the bill, the budget and the export.
- **Pile, beam, slab and staircase breakdowns** are calculated again.

HERON 3.0.1 (staged) aligns HERON's material constants with the other ADLM products:

- Blockwork waste is now **1.03** (was 1.05).
- Floor and wall tile waste is now **1.10** (was 1.12).
- Rebar weight uses **d²/162** everywhere (0.00617 kg/m per mm²).
- Paint is measured and labelled in **litres** (coverage 2.0 m² per litre, all coats).
- HERON keeps **1.10** waste on rebar and formwork on purpose: rebar waste carries laps and offcuts, and formwork is bought in whole sheets.

Constants you have edited yourself are kept. Only values still at the old default move to the new one.

Before you start

What you need

You need	Notes
A Windows PC	HERON is a Windows desktop app.
PlanSwift 10 or 11	HERON works alongside PlanSwift. It does not replace it.
An ADLM account with a HERON subscription	The same email and password you use on the ADLM website.
Rate Gen (optional)	Prices in the Budget come from the ADLM rate library, which is part of Rate Gen. Without it you get the budget as quantities only.
Microsoft Excel (optional)	For the workbooks, the Excel Takeoff Link and Fill a client's bill .
An internet connection	For your first sign-in, loading rates, AI Review and saving to ADLM Cloud. Reading and checking a take-off works offline.

Installing HERON

HERON is installed from the ADLM Installer Hub. See [ADLM Installer Hub](#).

1. Close PlanSwift and Excel completely.
2. Open the Installer Hub and sign in.
3. Find **ADLM Heron** and install or update it.
4. Wait for the Hub to report that the install has finished.

The Hub installs the HERON app with an **ADLM HERON** shortcut, the ADLM template inside every PlanSwift it finds, a protected copy of the template, and the Excel add-in.

IMPORTANT

If the install fails with access denied, PlanSwift or Excel was still running. Close both and install again.

One licence, one PC

Your HERON licence is tied to the PC you first sign in on. To move it to a new computer, contact ADLM support through [/support](#) and ask for the device lock to be reset.

Signing in

When HERON starts you see its splash card while it reads the ADLM template in PlanSwift.



The HERON splash window shown while the plugin starts and reads the ADLM template in PlanSwift.

1. Open **ADLM HERON** from the Start menu or the desktop.
2. Type your **Email** and **Password**. Click the eye to check what you typed.
3. Click **Log in**.

If you have forgotten your password, click **Forgot password?** to reset it on the ADLM website, then sign in with the new one.

- HERON remembers you and signs you back in next time.
- If it cannot reach the server, it signs you in from your saved licence and the top bar shows **Offline session: sign in again for cloud features**. You can still read and check take-offs. Loading rates, AI Review and saving to ADLM Cloud need a full sign-in.
- **Sign out** is at the bottom of the sidebar. Signing out hides the ADLM template from PlanSwift at its next restart, because the template belongs to your licence. Sign back in and restart PlanSwift to get it back.

TIP

The first time you sign in on a PC, restart PlanSwift afterwards. PlanSwift only reads its template library when it starts.

The HERON window

The sidebar

Item	What it does
Take-offs	All your take-offs, and the job PlanSwift has open.
Take-off	The items read from PlanSwift and their checks. The badge shows how many need attention.
Budget	Material and labour beneath every item.
Steel tonnage	Measured steel lengths turned into tonnes.
Excel	Workbooks, Fill a client's bill and the Excel Takeoff Link.
Settings	Display units, the take-off time log, material constants and the beta programme.
Send feedback	Opens WhatsApp with a message to ADLM support.
Sign out	Signs you out of HERON.

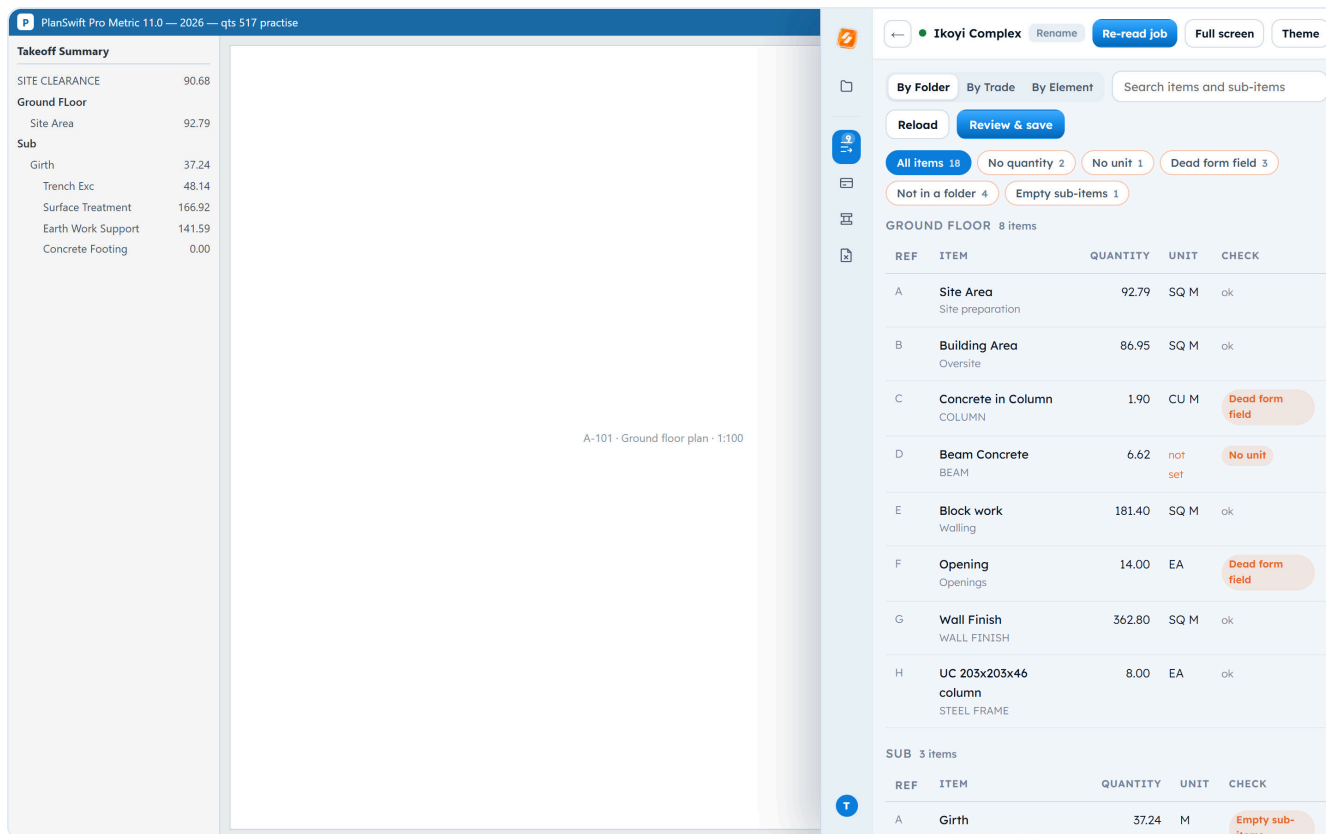
The four take-off screens appear under the name of the open take-off. Under **BETA** you will also see **Auto take-off** and **Auto-takeoff probe**, greyed out. They are switched off in this release (see [AI in HERON](#)).

The top bar

- ← goes back to all take-offs.
- The take-off name, with **Rename**, and a line saying which PlanSwift job it came from and when it was read. The dot turns green once the job has been read.
- **Read this job** (before the first read) or **Re-read job**.
- **Dock and Theme** (light or dark).

Docking beside PlanSwift

Click **Dock** to shrink HERON into a narrow column on the right of your screen, so you can see PlanSwift and HERON together. The sidebar folds to icons and the tables drop their less important columns. Click **Full screen** to go back.



HERON docked beside PlanSwift instead of full screen.

The ADLM template in PlanSwift

The template is where your measurements get their meaning. Instead of drawing a shape and deciding later what it is, you pick what you are measuring first, and the template brings its own unit, form and formula.

In PlanSwift's templates panel choose **Complete ADLM TakeOff Plugin**. It is grouped by trade: SUBSTRUCTURE, FRAME, SWIMMING POOL, STAIRCASE, BLOCKWORK AND OPENINGS, FINISHES, ROOFING, ELECTRICAL, PLUMBING, EXTERNAL WORKS, RAILING, HVAC, FIRE ALARM and ELV SYSTEMS. Expand a trade to find the tool you measure with.

HERON matches each item back to this template by its name, form and formula. That match gives the item its trade and element. Items drawn without the template are still read, but they show **Not matched to the ADLM template**.

Setting up the job

1. Create the job in PlanSwift and set metric or imperial.
2. Import your drawings and name every page properly, for example "Ground Floor Plan".
3. Scale every page. The scale is set per page, not per job. Scale off a long dimension you trust, then check another dimension on the other axis.
4. Measure with the ADLM tools, room by room or element by element.
5. On each item's properties dialog, set the **Folder**. A folder becomes a heading in the bill. Name folders by storey, block or trade.

IMPORTANT

An item with no folder is flagged **Not in a folder** and will not fall under any heading. HERON reads folders; it does not write them.

Names that carry meaning

Name it like this	Because
225 Wall Area, 150 Wall Area	The leading figure is the wall thickness in millimetres.
Concrete in Column, Concrete in slab	The element drives the concrete, formwork and reinforcement breakdown.
UKB 305x165x40, SHS 100x100x5	Steel tonnage reads the section from the name.

Take-offs

Click **Take-offs** in the sidebar. At the top, a card tells you **PlanSwift has a job open**, with the job's name. Below are your take-offs as cards.

The screenshot shows the HERON Take-offs screen. The sidebar on the left has a 'Take-offs' button. The main content area has a header 'Take-offs · PlanSwift 11.0 · Metric — PlanSwift Page (M)' and buttons for 'Dock' and 'Theme'. Below the header is a card for 'PlanSwift has a job open' with the title 'qts 517 practise' and a description. Below this is a 'Your take-offs' section with a 'Grid' button, a 'List' button, and a 'New take-off' button. The first take-off card is for 'Ikoyi Complex' with 18 items, 9 to check, and priced. The user is Tunde Adeyemi.

The HERON take-offs screen: the job PlanSwift has open and your saved take-offs as cards.

Each card shows **ITEMS**, **TO CHECK** and **PRICED**, the PlanSwift job it came from, and when it was last read. Switch to **List** for a table with **TAKE-OFF**, **PLANSWIFT JOB**, **CLIENT**, **ITEMS**, **TO CHECK** and **READ**. **Grid** switches back.

HERON
PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Take-offs

Tunde Adeyemi
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Send feedback
Sign out

Take-offs · PlanSwift 11.0 · Metric — PlanSwift Page (M)

Dock

Theme

PlanSwift has a job open

qts 517 practise
A-101 · Ground floor plan · 1:100 · Metric — PlanSwift Page (M). The ADLM template is installed in this job, so whatever has been measured against it can come straight across. The name is PlanSwift's — you can change it after.

Make a project from this job

Your take-offs 1

Grid

List

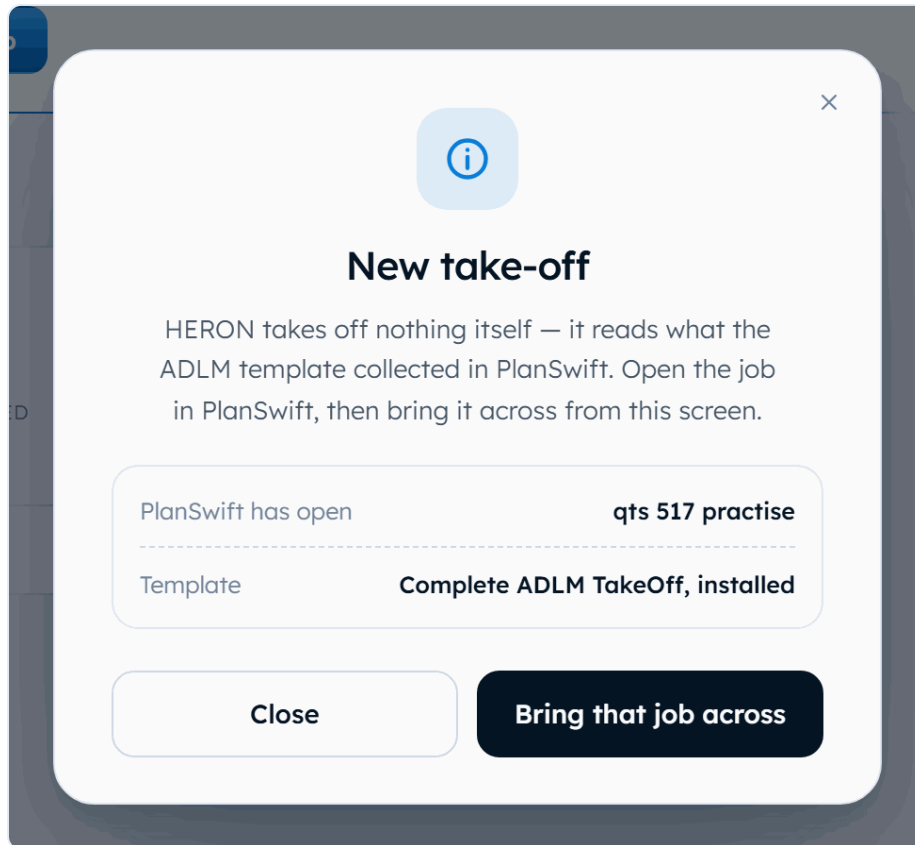
New take-off

TAKE-OFF	PLANSWIFT JOB	CLIENT	ITEMS	TO CHECK	READ	
Ikoyi Complex	ikoyi-residences	Ardova Properties	18	9	2 days ago	...

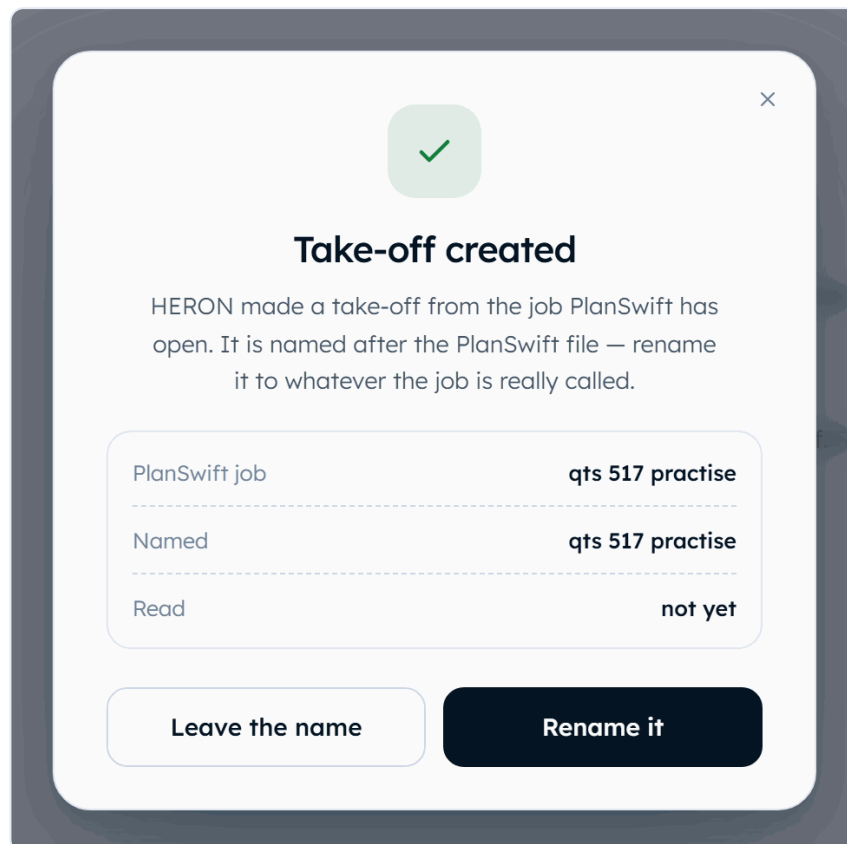
The take-offs screen switched to List view.

Making a take-off from a job

1. Open the job in PlanSwift.
2. In HERON, click **Make a project from this job** on the top card. (Or click **New take-off**, then **Bring that job across**.)
3. HERON shows **Take-off created**. It is named after the PlanSwift file. Click **Rename it** to give it the job's real name, or **Leave the name**.

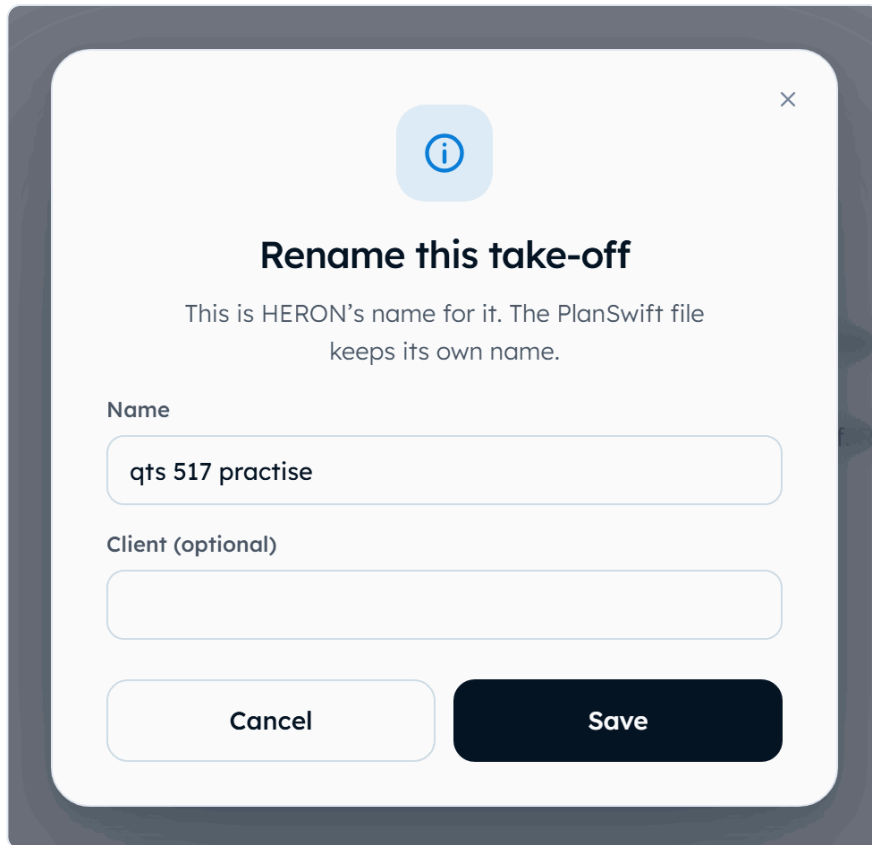


The New take-off dialog explaining that HERON brings across the job open in PlanSwift.



The confirmation after Make a project from this job, offering to rename the new take-off.

In **Rename this take-off**, type a **Name** and, if you like, a **Client (optional)**, then click **Save**. This is HERON's name for it. The PlanSwift file keeps its own name.



Rename this take-off

This is HERON's name for it. The PlanSwift file keeps its own name.

Name

qts 517 practise

Client (optional)

Cancel Save

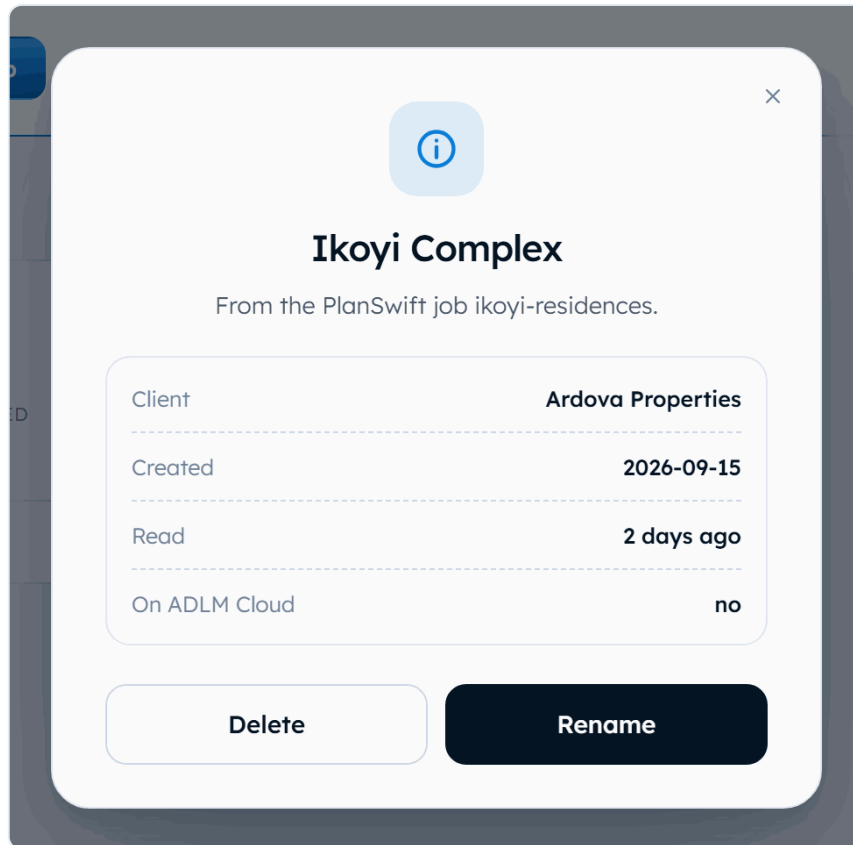
The Rename this take-off dialog with Name and optional Client.

NOTE

HERON takes off nothing itself. It reads what the ADLM template collected in PlanSwift. If the job PlanSwift has open is already a take-off, **New take-off** says so.

Renaming or deleting a take-off

Click ... (**More**) on a card. The details card shows the client, when it was created and read, and whether it is **On ADLM Cloud**. Click **Rename** or **Delete**.



The take-off details dialog opened from the card menu, with Rename and Delete.

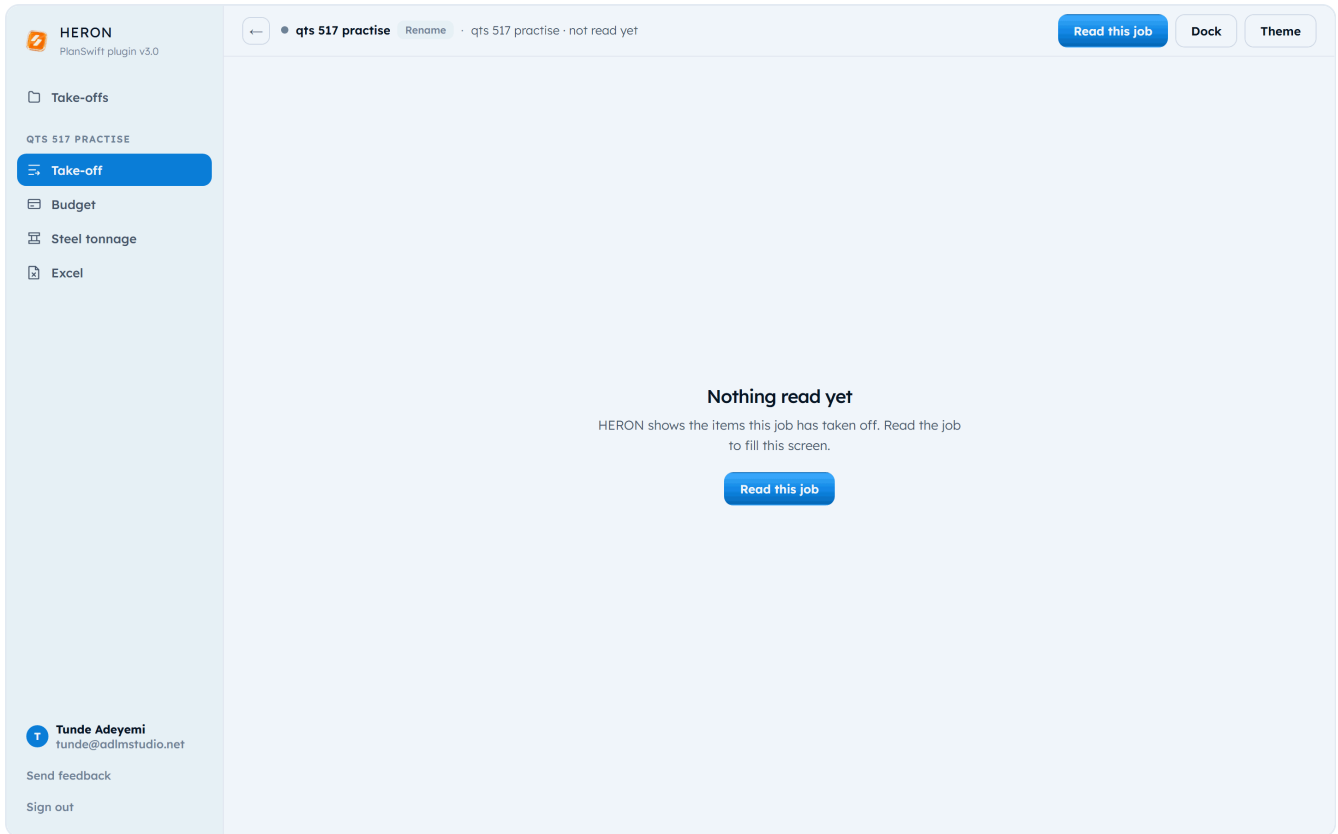
Deleting removes the take-off from HERON only. Nothing is deleted in PlanSwift, and anything already saved to ADLM Cloud stays there.

Take-offs from ADLM Cloud

Projects already saved to ADLM Cloud from HERON become take-off cards the first time HERON sees them, marked as from ADLM Cloud. Open the matching job in PlanSwift before you read one.

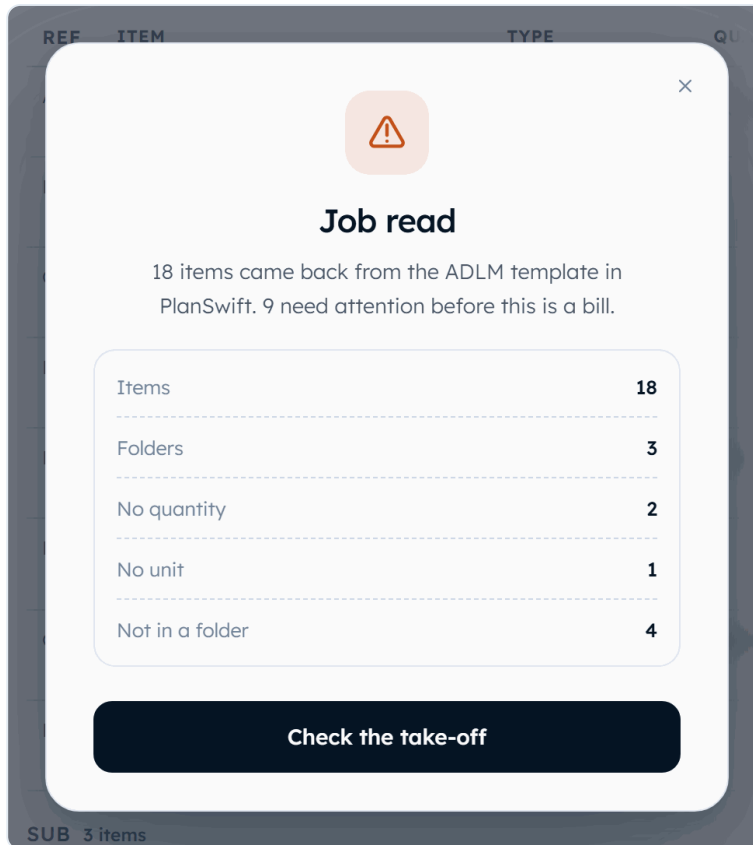
Reading the job

Open a take-off. Before its first read, HERON asks you to **Read the job PlanSwift has open**, and shows the **JOB**, **UNITS** and **PLANSWIFT** version it found. Check the units each time you start a new job.



A new take-off before the job is read, with Read this job at the top.

1. Make sure the right job is open in PlanSwift.
2. Click **Read this job**.
3. HERON reports **Job read**: items read, folders, and how many have **No quantity**, **No unit** or are **Not in a folder**.
4. Click **Check the take-off**.



The Job read summary: items read, folders, and how many have no quantity, no unit or no folder.

Nothing is imported and PlanSwift is not changed. If a different job is open in PlanSwift, HERON warns you (**A different job is open in PlanSwift**) and asks before reading it into this take-off.

After you measure more in PlanSwift, click **Re-read job** in the top bar (or **Reload** on the **Take-off** screen).

TIP

A take-off read by an older version of HERON is read again automatically when you open it with that job open in PlanSwift, so new calculations such as roof timber show up.

The take-off home

Once read, a take-off opens on its home screen. Four figures sit at the top: **Items read**, **Sub-items**, **Needs attention** and **Budget**.

HERON
PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Ikoyi Complex · Ikoyi-residences · read 2 days ago

Re-read job Dock Theme

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

Items read
18
3 folders

Sub-items
41
calculated by the template

Needs attention
9
before this becomes a bill

Budget
₦20,275,086
material and labour

What is wrong with this take-off
The ADLM template ships with items that carry no unit and fields that point at properties PlanSwift no longer has. On a job they show up as silent zeros. Fix them here and the bill states the truth.

2 No quantity
Traced but the quantity came back 0.00 — usually a form field left blank.

1 No unit
This tool has no unit set on its quantity in the template, so the bill cannot state one.

3 Dead form field
A field on this tool points at a property that no longer exists, so it shows blank.

4 Not in a folder
No folder was chosen on the properties dialog, so it will not fall under any heading.

1 Empty sub-items
The tool measured, but some of its sub-items came back 0.00.

Carry on

Check the take-off
18 items across 3 folders

Price the budget
₦20,275,086

Work out steel tonnage
3 steel items detected by section

Review and save to ADLM Cloud
hand the bill to the web product

Saved take-offs

TAKE-OFF	ITEMS	VERSION	SAVED
Ikoyi Complex	undefined	1	Open on the web

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Send feedback

Sign out

A take-off's home screen: what needs checking and the next steps, Check the take-off, Price the budget and Work out steel tonnage.

- **What is wrong with this take-off** lists each check with a count and a plain explanation.
- **Carry on** takes you to **Check the take-off**, **Price the budget**, **Work out steel tonnage** or **Review and save to ADLM Cloud**.
- **Saved take-offs** lists each version saved to ADLM Cloud with **Open on the web**.
- **Build this bill in PlanSwift** appears for a take-off that is on ADLM Cloud. See [Importing a bill from Excel](#).

Checking the take-off

Click **Take-off** in the sidebar. Folders are on the left, as you named them in PlanSwift, with **Everything** at the top. The table shows **REF**, **ITEM**, **TYPE**, **QUANTITY**, **UNIT**, **SUB-ITEMS** and **CHECK**.

HERON

PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Ikoyi Complex

Rename

Ikoyi-residences · read 2 days ago

Re-read job

Dock

Theme

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off 9

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

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Send feedback

Sign out

Folders

as you named them in PlanSwift

Everything 18

Ground Floor 8

Sub 3

First Floor 3

Not in a folder 4

A folder is whatever you typed on the properties dialog. Name it by element or by trade — HERON reads it either way, and can re-cut it below.

By Folder

By Trade

By Element

Search items and sub-items

Reload

Review & save

All items 18

No quantity 2

No unit 1

Dead form field 3

Not in a folder 4

Empty sub-items 1

GROUND FLOOR 8 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Site Area Site preparation	Area	92.79	SQ M	—	ok
B	Building Area Oversite	Area	86.95	SQ M	8	ok
C	Concrete in Column COLUMN	Count	1.90	CU M	3	Dead form field
D	Beam Concrete BEAM	Linear	6.62	not set	2	No unit
E	Block work Walling	Area	181.40	SQ M	2	ok
F	Opening Openings	Count	14.00	EA	2	Dead form field
G	Wall Finish WALL FINISH	Area	362.80	SQ M	2	ok
H	UC 203x203x46 column STEEL FRAME	Count	8.00	EA	—	ok

SUB 3 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Girth STRIP FOUNDATION	Linear	37.24	M	8	Empty sub-items
B	COLUMN BASE EXCAVATION PAD FOUNDATION	Count	34.56	CU M	3	ok

The Take-off screen: folders on the left, the items read from PlanSwift and the checks that need attention.

The five checks

Check	What it means	What to do
No quantity	Traced, but the quantity came back 0.00, usually a form field left blank.	Fill the field on the item in PlanSwift, then re-read.
No unit	The tool has no unit set in the template, so the bill cannot state one.	Set the result unit in PlanSwift, or correct the line on the web.
Dead form field	A field on the tool points at a property that no longer exists, so it shows blank.	Tell ADLM support which tool; it is a template fault.
Not in a folder	No folder was chosen on the properties dialog.	Click Put it in a folder for the steps, set the Folder in PlanSwift, then re-read.
Empty sub-items	The tool measured, but some of its sub-items came back 0.00.	Check the tool's form in PlanSwift.

Click a check chip (for example **No unit**) to list only the items with that problem. **All items** shows everything again.

HERON

PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off 9

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

Tunde Adeyemi

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Send feedback

Sign out

Ikoyi Complex

Rename

Ikoyi-residences · read 2 days ago

Re-read job

Dock

Theme

By Folder

By Trade

By Element

Search items and sub-items

Reload

Review & save

All items 18

No quantity 2

No unit 1

Dead form field 3

Not in a folder 4

Empty sub-items 1

Everything 18

Ground Floor 8

Sub 3

First Floor 3

Not in a folder 4

NOT IN A FOLDER 2 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Linear Unclassified	Linear	0.00	M	—	No quantity Not in a folder
B	BULK EXCAVATION RAFT FOUNDATION	Area	0.00	CU M	2	No quantity Not in a folder

Folders

as you named them in PlanSwift

A folder is whatever you typed on the properties dialog. Name it by element or by trade — HERON reads it either way, and can re-cut it below.

The take-off filtered to one check so only the items with that problem are listed.

NOTE

Checks are warnings, not blocks. You can save a take-off with items still needing attention. They go across as they are.

Folders, trades and elements

Click a folder to narrow the list to it. The segmented control re-cuts the whole take-off:

- **By Folder:** your PlanSwift folders.
- **By Trade:** the template trade each item came from, for example FRAME or FINISHES.
- **By Element:** the element, for example COLUMN, BEAM or PAD FOUNDATION.

Re-cutting changes nothing in PlanSwift.

HERON
PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

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Send feedback

Sign out

Ikoyi Complex

Rename

Ikoyi-residences · read 2 days ago

Re-read job

Dock

Theme

By Folder

By Trade

By Element

Search items and sub-items

Reload

Review & save

All items 18

No quantity 2

No unit 1

Dead form field 3

Not in a folder 4

Empty sub-items 1

Everything

18

Ground Floor

8

Sub

3

First Floor

3

Not in a folder

4

A folder is whatever you typed on the properties dialog. Name it by element or by trade — HERON reads it either way, and can re-cut it below.

GROUND FLOOR

8 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Site Area Site preparation	Area	92.79	SQ M	—	ok
B	Building Area Oversite	Area	86.95	SQ M	8	ok
C	Concrete in Column COLUMN	Count	1.90	CU M	3	Dead form field
D	Beam Concrete BEAM	Linear	6.62	not set	2	No unit
E	Block work Walling	Area	181.40	SQ M	2	ok
F	Opening Openings	Count	14.00	EA	2	Dead form field
G	Wall Finish WALL FINISH	Area	362.80	SQ M	2	ok
H	UC 203x203x46 column STEEL FRAME	Count	8.00	EA	—	ok

The take-off narrowed to a single PlanSwift folder.

HERON
PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

Tunde Adeyemi

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Send feedback

Sign out

Ikoyi Complex

Rename

Ikoyi-residences · read 2 days ago

Re-read job

Dock

Theme

By Folder

By Trade

By Element

Search items and sub-items

Reload

Review & save

All items 18

No quantity 2

No unit 1

Dead form field 3

Not in a folder 4

Empty sub-items 1

Everything

18

Ground Floor

8

Sub

3

First Floor

3

Not in a folder

4

A folder is whatever you typed on the properties dialog. Name it by element or by trade — HERON reads it either way, and can re-cut it below.

Re-cut by trade from the template each item came from. Nothing in PlanSwift changes.

BLOCKWORK AND OPENINGS

2 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Block work Walling	Area	181.40	SQ M	2	ok
B	Opening Openings	Count	14.00	EA	2	Dead form field

FINISHES

1 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Wall Finish WALL FINISH	Area	362.80	SQ M	2	ok

FRAME

6 items

REF	ITEM	TYPE	QUANTITY	UNIT	SUB-ITEMS	CHECK
A	Concrete in Column COLUMN	Count	1.90	CU M	3	Dead form field
B	Beam Concrete BEAM	Linear	6.62	not set	2	No unit
C	Concrete in slab SLAB	Area	13.04	CU M	3	ok
D	UB 305x165x40 roof beam STEEL FRAME	Linear	48.60	M	—	ok
E	UC 203x203x46 column STEEL FRAME	Count	8.00	EA	—	ok
F	SHS 100x100x5 bracing	Linear	62.40	M	—	Not in a folder

The take-off re-grouped by trade without changing anything in PlanSwift.

Searching

Type in **Search items and sub-items**. The search covers the whole job, not just the open folder, and also matches folder, trade, element and bill description.

An item's details

Click a row to open it beside the list. You see its **Quantity**, **Folder** and **Measured as**, the checks that apply to it, and:

- **BILL DESCRIPTION:** the wording that goes to the bill. Type to correct it; your wording is used when you save.
- **THE FORM THE QS FILLED:** the values typed on the tool in PlanSwift. A missing field shows **field missing**.
- **BREAKDOWN:** the sub-items the template (or HERON) calculated, with quantity and unit.

Showing an item in PlanSwift

- In the item's details, click **Show in PlanSwift** to open the page it is drawn on, select it and zoom to it. Where it is drawn on several pages, use < and > to step through them.
- Tick **Follow in PlanSwift** above the table, and every item (or folder) you pick also opens in PlanSwift.

Roofs and roof timber

Measure the roof plan with the Roof Covering tool and type its pitch. HERON works out the roof members from the plan area, perimeter and pitch:

- rafters, purlins, ridge board and ridge cap, and hip rafters on a hip roof;
- **Struts and Ties** (one line), wall plate, fascia and barge boards.

Each member becomes timber pieces in the stock length with cutting waste, nails and wood preservative. These lines appear in the take-off, the **Budget** and the export, and are billed once. If the roof tool was left at pitch 0, HERON uses the angle between the sloped and plan areas, or else the default pitch in **Settings** (15°). Rafter spacing, purlin spacing, eaves overhang and timber waste are material constants under **Roof**.

The Budget

Click **Budget** in the sidebar. Every item becomes a card with its materials and labour beneath it, worked out from QS recipes and your material constants. Totals for **Material**, **Labour** and **Total** sit at the top.

HERON

PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

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Send feedback

Sign out

Ikoyi Complex

Rename

Ikoyi-residences · read 2 days ago

Re-read job

Dock

Theme

Material

Labour

Total

Refresh rates

Export

A

Site Area

92.79 SQ M

N167,022

No sub-items — this tool is measured and billed on its own.

B

SITE CLEARANCE

90.68 SQ M

N163,224

MATERIAL / LABOUR	QTY	UNIT	PRICE	AMOUNT
Topsoil Exc	90.68	SQ M		N163,224
Labour	90.68	SQ M	1800	N163,224

C

Building Area

86.95 SQ M

N3,592,505

MATERIAL / LABOUR	QTY	UNIT	PRICE	AMOUNT
Topsoil Exc	86.95	SQ M		N156,510
Labour	86.95	SQ M	1800	N156,510
Hardcore Filling	13.04	CU M		N486,392
Hardcore	20.86	tonnes	18000	N375,552
Labour	13.04	CU M	8500	N110,840
Laterite filling	8.70	CU M		N256,650
Laterite	13.05	tonnes	14000	N182,700
Labour	8.70	CU M	8500	N73,950
Wire Mesh	86.95	SQ M		N232,591
A142 mesh	6.09	sheets	12500	N76,081
Labour	86.95	SQ M	1800	N156,510

The Budget screen, with material and labour priced beneath every item and the totals.

Pricing the budget

Rates never load on their own. A new budget opens with every price at 0.

1. Click **Load rates**. HERON prices the budget from the ADLM rate library for your zone.
2. The button becomes **Refresh rates**. Click it to pull the latest prices.
3. Every **PRICE** cell stays editable. Type a price, or type a material or labour name to search Rate Gen and pick a rate.

NOTE

Prices come from Rate Gen. Without a Rate Gen licence the budget shows **Price this budget with RateGen**: you still see the materials and labour each item needs, without prices. Click **Get RateGen** to buy it, or **I have RateGen** if you already do. Rates themselves are built and edited only in [ADLM Rate Gen](#).

Working with the budget

Button	What it does
× on an item or sub-item	Leaves it out of the budget. PlanSwift is not changed.
Restore hidden (n)	Appears when you have left items out. Brings them back.
Bill rates from budget	Sets each bill rate from its budget cost plus overhead and profit (from your material constants).
Export	Saves the budget as an Excel workbook.

If the project's contract is locked on ADLM Cloud, the budget says so: budget changes saved from HERON are recorded as actuals.

Steel tonnage

Steel is measured in metres but bought in tonnes. HERON reads the section designation from the item name (UB, UC, SHS, RHS, PFC and so on) and converts the measured length. A count item is multiplied by its height.

HERON
PlanSwift plugin v3.0

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

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Send feedback

Sign out

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Re-read job Dock Theme

Steel tonnage

HERON reads the section designation out of the item name — UB, UC, SHS, RHS, PFC — and converts the measured length to tonnes. A count item is multiplied by its height.

Scan job Clear Connections and fittings % 7.5 Waste % 0

Press Scan job to read steel items from what HERON has already read.

The Steel tonnage screen before scanning.

1. Click **Steel tonnage** in the sidebar.
2. Set **Connections and fittings %** (default 7.5) and **Waste %** (default 0).
3. Click **Scan job**.
4. Read the table: **ITEM, TRADE, SECTION, KG/M, QTY, LENGTH M, NET T, ALLOWANCE T** and **GROSS T**, with a **Total** row.
5. Where no section was found in the name, type in the section box to search the catalogue and pick one. Your choice is kept when you scan again.

HERON

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Re-read job

Dock

Theme

Take-offs

IKOYI COMPLEX

Take-off

Budget

Steel tonnage

Excel

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Send feedback

Sign out

Steel tonnage

HERON reads the section designation out of the item name — UB, UC, SHS, RHS, PFC — and converts the measured length to tonnes. A count item is multiplied by its height.

Scan job

Clear

Connections and fittings %

7.5

Waste %

0

ITEM	TRADE	SECTION	KG/M	QTY	LENGTH M	NET T	ALLOWANCE T	GROSS T
UB 305x165x40 roof beam	FRAME	UB 305x165x40	40.30	48.60 M	48.60	1.959	0.147	2.105
UC 203x203x46 column	FRAME	UC 203x203x46	46.10	8.00 EA	28.80	1.328	0.100	1.427
SHS 100x100x5 bracing	FRAME	SHS 100x100x5	14.40	62.40 M	62.40	0.899	0.067	0.966
Total						4.185	0.314	4.499

Steel tonnage after a scan, listing each steel item by section with net and gross tonnage.

The ADLM steel frame columns and beams, and the weights the STEEL TRUSS tools already compute, are included. Click **Clear** to start again.

TIP

Name steel with its full designation, for example UKB 305x165x40. "Steel beam" cannot be read.

Reviewing and saving to ADLM Cloud

When the take-off is right, click **Review & save** (on the **Take-off** screen) or **Review and save to ADLM Cloud** (on the home screen). HERON gathers the take-off from PlanSwift, folder by folder, and opens **Review before saving**.

Review before saving
18 items, grouped by folder

9 items still need attention. You can save anyway — they go across as they are.

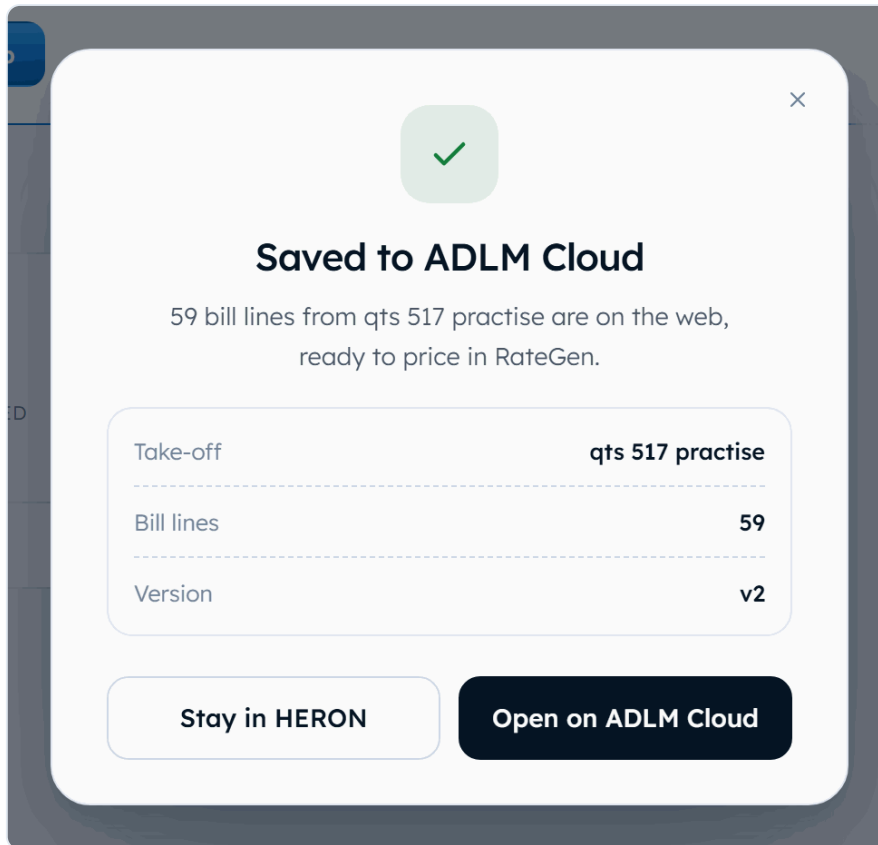
REF	DESCRIPTION	QTY	UNIT	AMOUNT
Ground Floor				
A	Site Area.	92.79	SQ M	₺167,022
B	Building Area; Filling Thickness 0.15; Concrete Thickness 0.15.	86.95	SQ M	₺3,592,505
B1	Topsoil Exc	86.95	SQ M	
B2	Hardcore Filling	13.04	CU M	
B3	Laterite filling	8.70	CU M	
B4	Wire Mesh	86.95	SQ M	
B5	DPM	86.95	SQ M	
B6	Oversite Concrete	13.04	CU M	
B7	Formwork to Edges	38.40	M	
B8	Blinding	4.35	CU M	
C	Concrete in Column; Nr 12; Width 0.23; Depth 0.23; Height 3.00; Dia 10.	1.90	CU M	₺1,010,973
C1	Formwork to Column	33.12	SQ M	
C2	10mm bar in Column Links	158.40	Kg	

Take-off name
qts 517 practise
Cancel
Save to ADLM Cloud

The Review before saving sheet, listing every item and part with the take-off name and Save to ADLM Cloud.

The sheet lists every line grouped by folder, with **REF**, **DESCRIPTION**, **QTY**, **UNIT** and **AMOUNT**. Sub-items sit under their item (B1, B2 and so on). An amount shows where the line has a bill rate, for example after **Bill rates from budget**; otherwise it shows a dash. A bar at the top tells you how many items still need attention.

1. Check the lines. To change a description, close the sheet, correct the **BILL DESCRIPTION** on the item, and review again.
2. Optionally click **AI Review** (see [AI in HERON](#)).
3. Type the **Take-off name**.
4. Click **Save to ADLM Cloud**. Click **Stop saving** if you need to cancel.
5. HERON shows **Saved to ADLM Cloud** with the bill lines and the version. Click **Open on ADLM Cloud** to open the bill on the website, or **Stay in HERON**.



The confirmation after saving a HERON take-off to ADLM Cloud.

What to know:

- The bill and its material and labour budget are saved together. A budget you never priced goes across with quantities and 0 prices.
- Each save is a new version, so re-saving never wipes out an earlier one.
- If the name is already used by another project on your account, HERON says **Project name already exists**. Choose another name, or open that take-off and save from it.
- If the contract is locked on ADLM Cloud, the sheet says so. Changed quantities are recorded as actuals and the contract stays as it was.
- If the budget did not save, or some items cost more than their rate, HERON tells you after saving.

On the website

Saved take-offs appear on the ADLM website under your HERON projects (**HERON** in the side rail, or </projects/planswift>). There you can price the bill from your Rate Gen rates, value it, share it and export it. See the [ADLM Cloud guide](#).

From the project's **Export** menu on the website, the **ICMS 3** group ("international cost and carbon report") offers **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**, with cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, and **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)**, the same report as data to the RICS Data Standard. Carbon per line comes from your Rate Gen rates, so price the HERON bill with Rate Gen rates first.

Excel

Click **Excel** in the sidebar.

Send the bill out

Button	What you get
Bill of quantities	ref, description, quantity, unit, rate, amount. The same lines HERON would save to ADLM Cloud; folders become headings and sub-items keep their reference.
Budget	Material and labour beneath every item. Open Budget once first so HERON can build it.
Steel schedule	Section, length, net and gross tonnage.

Choose where to save. The files are ordinary .xlsx workbooks.

Fill a client's bill

The client sent their own bill format? **Fill a client's bill** puts HERON's quantities into a copy of their workbook, in their layout. Their file is never changed.

1. Read the job first, so HERON has quantities.
2. On the **Excel** screen, click **Import a bill format**.
3. Click **Choose the bill** and pick their workbook (.xlsx, .xlsm, or an old .xls, which HERON converts to a working copy).
4. Under **SHEETS IN THIS WORKBOOK**, tick the sheets to fill. If HERON read the wrong column, type the letter for **Description**, **Unit** or **Quantity** and click **Apply**. Summary sheets are left out unless you tick them.
5. Click **Match with AI**. HERON's AI proposes which HERON lines make up each of their lines.
6. Check the table: **THE CLIENT'S ITEM, IN THEIR FILE, HERON QTY, MEASURED FROM** and **STATUS**. Filter with **All**, **Matched**, **To review** and **Not measured**.
7. Tick the lines that are right, or click **Tick all matched**. Type in **HERON QTY** to set a quantity yourself; the line is ticked for you.
8. Optionally keep **Note on each cell**, so each filled cell lists the HERON lines behind it, and tick **Clear ... old quantities HERON did not replace** if their file held quantities from another job.
9. Click **Write ... ticked lines to a copy** and choose where to save.
10. HERON shows **The client's bill is filled**. Click **Open the filled bill**.

Only ticked lines are written. Click ← to go back to **Excel**.

Link Excel to this take-off

The Takeoff Link pane pulls quantities, materials and rates from HERON into a workbook, and refreshes them when you re-read the job.

1. Under **PANE ON**, choose **Right** or **Left** for where the pane docks in Excel.
2. Pick where it opens: one of the workbooks open in Excel (listed by name), **A new workbook**, or **A workbook on this computer**. Click **Refresh** if a workbook you just opened is not listed.
3. HERON opens Excel with the **ADLM Takeoff Link** pane. It installs the ADLM add-in first if it is missing.

In the pane, pick a dataset: **Quantity Takeoff**, **Material Takeoff** (the budget's materials and labour) or **Rates**. Type in **Search** to filter it. Then:

1. Click the cell in your workbook.
2. Select one or more rows in the pane.

3. Click **Link Cell**. Several rows are added together.
4. **Add to Cell** adds more rows to the same cell; **Remove from Cell** takes rows out; **Unlink Cell** breaks the link.

Linked cells update when you switch back to Excel after a change in HERON. You can also click **Refresh** in the pane or on the **ADLM** ribbon tab.

TIP

If the **ADLM** tab disappears from Excel, close Excel and open the link again from HERON's **Excel** screen. You can also double-click `Register-ExcelAddin.cmd` in `C:\ProgramData\Planswift Plugin`.

Importing a bill from Excel

Sometimes the bill comes first and you need real measurements behind it. Importing a bill as a new HERON project happens on the ADLM website; you then build it in PlanSwift from HERON. (To put HERON's quantities into a client's bill instead, use [Fill a client's bill](#).)

NOTE

Excel bill import is switched on for your account by ADLM and needs a live HERON subscription. If you do not see **Import Excel BoQ · HERON** on your HERON projects page, contact [/support](#).

1. On the website, open your HERON projects and click **Import Excel BoQ · HERON**. Choose your bill (.xlsx or .xlsm) and click **Import project**.
2. In PlanSwift, open the job you will measure in.
3. In HERON, open the imported take-off from **Take-offs** (it is marked as from ADLM Cloud).
4. On its home screen, click **Build this bill in PlanSwift**.
5. In **Build Bill in PlanSwift**, check the **Template** for each line and, where needed, **Measured as**, **Depth/Height**, **Width** and **Thickness**. Choose lines with **Select all**, **Select none** or **Only lines not in the job**.
6. Click **Build in PlanSwift**. Each work section becomes a folder and each bill line a measurable item.
7. Scale the drawings, click **Measure** on a line to trace it, then read the job and save as usual.

Building again is safe: matched lines are updated, never duplicated, and an existing measurement is never overwritten.

Settings

Click **Settings** at the bottom of the sidebar (it is hidden while docked). Pick a tab, make your changes, and click **Save**.

Tab	What it holds
Units	Display units: Metric (m, m ² , m ³ , mm, kg) or Imperial (ft, sqft, cuft, in, lb). HERON normally picks this from your PlanSwift pages.
Time log	Share take-off timings with ADLM. Only timings and counts are sent, never drawings, names, quantities or prices. Untick to turn it off.
Material constants	The factors HERON uses to turn quantities into materials: waste, mixes, laps and densities.

Tab	What it holds
Beta	Join the beta programme. Auto take-off is switched off in this release, beta or not.

Material constants

1. Search by name, category or key.
2. Edit the **Value**. **Default** shows what ADLM ships.
3. Click **Save**. **Reset Defaults** puts every constant back to ADLM's figures.

Some defaults in 3.0.1:

Constant	Default
Blockwork waste factor	1.03
Floor and wall tile waste factor	1.10
Rebar unit weight	0.00617 kg/m per mm ² (d ² /162)
Rebar stock length	12 m
Rebar waste factor	1.10 (kept on purpose)
Formwork waste factor	1.10 (kept on purpose)
Paint coverage (all coats)	2.0 m ² per litre
Sharp sand density	1,440 kg/m ³
Hardcore and laterite density	1.6 t/m ³
Roof pitch when the tool has none	15°

AI in HERON

HERON has these AI features. For how ADLM AI works, the monthly allowance and what happens to your data, see [ADLM AI services](#).

Feature	Where	Availability in 3.0
AI Review (AI Bill Review)	Review before saving, at the foot	On for everyone signed in with an active licence
Match with AI	Excel, Fill a client's bill	In the 3.0 release; needs a sign-in and a connection
Auto take-off	Sidebar, under BETA	Switched off for everyone

AI Review

AI Review turns raw take-off names into proper bill descriptions, fixes units, finds duplicates, flags rates out of line with the rest of the job, and points out items a QS would expect (for example blockwork with no rendering).

1. Click **Review & save** to open **Review before saving**.
2. Click **AI Review**.

3. In **AI Bill Review**, tick **Descriptions**, **Rate sanity** and **Missing items** as needed.
4. Click **Run Review**.
5. Accept the findings you agree with and click **Apply Accepted**.
6. Check the sheet and click **Save to ADLM Cloud** as usual.

To ask a question, type in **Ask about this bill** (for example "why is substructure so large a share of this job?") and click **Ask**.

AI Review gives suggestions only. Nothing changes until you accept a finding and apply it, and quantities are never altered. HERON sends the lines' descriptions, units, quantities and rates, the project name, currency and pricing zone, never your drawings. When you accept or reject suggestions, the service learns your house style for your account alone. A HERON clean-up uses 2 units and a bill question 1 unit of your monthly AI allowance.

Match with AI

In **Fill a client's bill**, **Match with AI** proposes which HERON lines make up each of the client's lines, with a confidence and a reason in the cell note. The AI proposes; you tick; only ticked lines are written. It sends the client's descriptions and units and HERON's measured lines, not the drawings.

Auto take-off

Auto take-off and **Auto-takeoff probe** show under **BETA** in the sidebar, but they are greyed out for everyone in HERON 3.0 and 3.0.1: "Auto take-off is in beta and is not available in this release." Joining the beta programme does not turn them on.

NOTE

HERON's bill wording, its checks and its material breakdowns are not AI. They come from the ADLM template and fixed rules.

Troubleshooting

The ADLM template is not in PlanSwift

1. Make sure you are signed in to HERON.
2. Close PlanSwift completely and open it again.
3. In the templates panel, choose **Complete ADLM TakeOff Plugin**.
4. Still missing? Sign out of HERON, sign in again, and restart PlanSwift.
5. Still missing? Reinstall HERON from the Installer Hub with PlanSwift closed.

"PlanSwift has no job open"

Open the job in PlanSwift, then click **Read this job** or **Re-read job**.

"ADLM template not found"

HERON read the items, but trade, element and the template's checks need the ADLM template installed in PlanSwift. See the first item above.

Quantities are far too big or too small

Almost always the scale. Check the page's scale with PlanSwift's Dimension tool, scale again if needed, then **Re-read job**.

HERON shows imperial units on a metric job

Your pages had no usable scale units. Scale them properly, or choose metric in **Settings, Units**.

An item is missing from the take-off

Click **Reload**. Check the **Everything** folder and the **Not in a folder** group, and use the search, which covers the whole job.

Roof timber is missing

Re-read the job with it open in PlanSwift. Check the Roof Covering has a plan area and a pitch.

Review & save says "Nothing to save yet"

Read the job first, so there is a take-off to review.

Load rates is missing or prices stay at 0

Prices need a Rate Gen licence, a connection and a full sign-in (not an offline session). Click **I have RateGen** to check your licence again.

Save to ADLM Cloud refuses to save

- **Offline session:** sign out, then sign in again while connected.
- **Project name already exists:** choose another name.
- **Version conflict:** the project was changed elsewhere. Open the take-off again and save again.

"The pane did not open" (Excel)

Close Excel completely and open the link again from the **Excel** screen. A fresh Excel can take a few seconds.

"That workbook cannot be read" (Fill a client's bill)

Check the file is a bill, not a price list, and that it is not open and locked in Excel. Type the column letters for **Description**, **Unit** and **Quantity** and click **Apply**.

"Monthly AI quota reached"

Your account has used its AI allowance for the month. The rest of HERON keeps working. Ask [/support](#) if you need more.

"This PlanSwift subscription is bound to a different device."

Your licence is tied to another PC. Ask [/support](#) to reset the device lock.

"Internet required for first sign-in (no valid offline license found)."

The first sign-in on a PC must be online. Connect and sign in again.

Frequently asked questions

Does HERON replace PlanSwift?

No. You measure in PlanSwift with the ADLM template, and HERON reads, checks, prices and exports what you measured.

Does HERON change my PlanSwift job?

Reading never changes it. Only **Build this bill in PlanSwift** and **Measure** add items, and they never overwrite a measurement.

Where do I edit rates?

In [ADLM Rate Gen](#). HERON picks rates from your library and lets you type a price on a budget line, but rates are built only in Rate Gen.

Do I need Rate Gen?

Only for prices. Without it you can read, check, review, export quantities and save to ADLM Cloud.

Can I work without the internet?

Yes, once you have signed in online on that PC. Loading rates, AI features and saving to ADLM Cloud need a connection.

Where is my work stored?

Your measurements live in the PlanSwift job file, so back it up. Take-offs saved to ADLM Cloud are kept on your account, with a new version on every save.

Where did the 2.9 screens go?

Dashboard became **Take-offs** and the take-off home. **Quantity Take Off** became **Take-off**. **Save / Export** became **Review & save** for the cloud and the **Excel** screen for workbooks. **Connect Excel** is now **Link Excel to this take-off** on the **Excel** screen.

Does HERON send my drawings to ADLM?

No. AI features send only bill lines, and the take-off time log sends only timings and counts.

How do I get help?

Click **Send feedback** to message ADLM support on WhatsApp, or raise a ticket at [/support](#). Tell us the take-off, the folder and item, whether the page is scaled, the exact message and your PlanSwift version.



ADLM Rate Gen

Build defensible rates from material, labour and plant prices for your location, see the upfront carbon of every rate, and price QUIV, HERON, SERVIQ and ADLM Cloud projects from one library.

ADLM Rate Gen is ADLM's rate build-up tool for quantity surveyors and estimators. It holds a library of material prices, labour day rates and plant hire rates, priced for the part of Nigeria you work in, and builds up a rate for every item of work: ground works, concrete, blockwork, finishes, roofs, painting, steel, windows and doors, and the four building services. Every rate shows exactly what it is made of, so you can check it, change it and defend it. Every priced rate also carries an upfront carbon figure in kgCO₂e. Your library lives on your ADLM account, so QUIV, HERON, SERVIQ and your ADLM Cloud projects all price from the same rates.

This guide covers **Rate Gen 3.0.1**, the new suite design. Rate Gen 3.0.1 is staged for sign-off and reaches you through the Installer Hub. Where a feature arrived in 3.0.0 or 3.0.1, this guide says so.

IMPORTANT

Rates are built only in the Rate Gen desktop app. The RateGen pages on the ADLM website are **read-only**. They show your library and every rate's build-up, but they cannot build a rate, edit a rate, delete a rate or change a material or labour price. To change anything, open Rate Gen on your computer. Your change appears on the website after Rate Gen's next sync.

What's new in 3.0.1

- **Custom rates now download.** Before 3.0.1, Rate Gen never downloaded your custom rates. A rate made on another PC, or on the website before the website became read-only, could be removed from your account at the next sync. Rate Gen now brings every custom rate on your account into **Saved Rates**, at sign-in and at every sync, with its own prices, unit and section. A rate is deleted from your account only when you delete it in Rate Gen. See [Custom rates and sync](#).
- **Carbon for services cables and pipes.** Copper cable and earthing, PP-R pressure pipe and uPVC soil pipe are now weighed from their own names, so services rates that use them get a carbon figure.
- **Build with AI is on by default** for everyone signed in. See [AI in Rate Gen](#).

For everything that changed in 3.0.0, see [What's new in 3.0.0](#).

Before you start

What you need

You need	Notes
A Windows PC	Rate Gen runs on Windows. The window fits any screen size and scaling, down to 860 pixels wide.
An ADLM account with a Rate Gen subscription	The same email and password you use on the ADLM website. See Getting started to buy one.
A pricing location on your profile	Your state decides which regional prices you get. See Your location and price zones .

You need	Notes
An internet connection	For your first sign-in and every sync. After that you can work offline.

Installing or updating Rate Gen

Rate Gen is installed from the ADLM Installer Hub, never from a loose download. See [ADLM Installer Hub](#).

1. Open the Installer Hub and sign in.
2. Open **Installation Center** and find **RateGen**.
3. Click **Install**, or the **Update to** button if you have an older version.
4. Accept the Windows permission prompt.
5. Wait for the Hub to report that the install has finished.

NOTE

Updating keeps your data. Your library, your saved rates and your edits are kept in your own Windows profile and on your account, and an update never touches them.

The order to do things in

You only do steps 1 to 3 once.

1. Set your **Pricing location (State)** on your profile on the ADLM website.
2. Install Rate Gen from the Hub.
3. Open Rate Gen and sign in. Rate Gen loads the prices for your location.
4. Check prices in the **Library**, then check the rates in each trade.
5. Build custom rates for anything the library does not cover.
6. Price your projects in QUIV, HERON, SERVIQ or ADLM Cloud.

Signing in

1. Open **ADLM RateGen** from the desktop or the Start menu. The splash screen shows **Starting up....**
2. Type your email or username in **Email or username**.
3. Type your password in **Password**. The eye button shows or hides it.
4. Click **Log in**, or press . The button reads **Signing in...** while it works.

Rate Gen checks your subscription, then loads the prices for your location. You will see **Sign in successful!** If your profile's location has changed since you last used Rate Gen, it asks whether to update your prices to that zone. Click **Yes**.

Forgot password? and **Create account** open the website.

Signing out

Click **Log out** at the foot of the rail. Rate Gen sends any unsynced edits first. You do not need to sign out each day.

A tour of the Rate Gen window

Rate Gen 3.0 uses the same suite design as every ADLM product: a rail on the left, a top bar, and the screen you are working on.

The rail

Entry	What it opens
Library	Your material and labour library, with plant in the labour list.
ITEM OF WORKS	A heading over the eight trades: Ground , Concrete , Block Works , Finishes , Roofs , Painting , Steel and Window and Door .
SERVICES	Mechanical (air conditioning and ventilation), Electrical (lighting, power, cables, earthing, containment, security), Plumbing (water supply, soil and waste, rainwater, sanitary) and Fire (fire protection and alarm).
MORE	Carbon & Others , the upfront carbon of every priced rate, and Saved Rates , your custom rates, with a count beside it.
Open ADLM Cloud	Opens RateGen on the website, where your rates price your projects.
Export	Saves every rate to Excel.
Help	Opens an email to ADLM support with your account email filled in.
Log out	Signs you out.

Click the button at the top of the rail, or press **Ctrl + B**, to fold it to icons and back. Below 1,100 pixels wide it folds by itself.

The top bar

Control	What it does
Search every rate in the library	Searches every trade and service. Type part of a rate's name and pick a result to open it. Press Ctrl + F to jump here.
Currency	Shows prices in NGN, USD, EUR, QAR, GHS or ZAR. This changes how prices are shown only.
Sync button	Sync from Cloud (F5) . Fetches the latest rates and prices and sends your edits up. Hover over it to see the last sync result.
Banner (eye)	Shows or hides the welcome banner, for more room for rates.
Light or dark	Switches the theme.
Keyboard	Shows the keyboard shortcuts.
Reset all rate edits	Puts every build-up you have edited, in every trade, back to the shipped quantities, and syncs the reset to QUIV and HERON. It asks first.
Undo library changes	Opens Restore an earlier library .
Bell	Notifications : sync results, new published prices and updates from ADLM.

Control	What it does
Profile	Opens your ADLM profile on the website, where you set your pricing location.

Your location and price zones

Materials and labour cost different amounts in different parts of the country, so Rate Gen prices your library for your location.

- **You choose a state.** Your profile on the ADLM website asks for your **Pricing location (State)**: any of the 36 states or the FCT.
- **Prices come from the zone your state is in.** ADLM prices six zones: South West, South East, South South, North Central, North East and North West.
- **There is one place to set it.** Rate Gen has no location picker. You change your state on the website, and Rate Gen picks it up at your next sign-in or sync.

The **Library** shows where its prices came from, for example **Lagos: priced from south west rates**. Set this on your ADLM profile.

The Library: materials, labour and plant

Click **Library** in the rail. It has two tabs, **Material** and **Labour**. Every rate in every trade is priced from these two lists, so a price you change here flows into every rate that uses it.

- **Material** lists each item's **MATERIAL NAME**, **UNIT**, **PRICE** and **CATEGORY**.
- **Labour** lists trades and plant together, with **LABOUR NAME**, **UNIT**, **PRICE** and **CATEGORY**. Labour is a day rate. Plant (excavators, rollers, mixers, generators, cranes and so on) has its own categories, so the category filter narrows the list properly.

Finding an item

- Type in **Search the material library** or **Search the labour library**.
- Pick a category to show one category.
- Use the sort box: **Sort by · library order**, **Sort by · most expensive** or **Sort by · A to Z**.

Changing a price

1. Click the item's row, or select it and press . The **Edit material** or **Edit labour** form opens.
2. Type your price in **Price**.
3. Click **Update the library**.

Every rate using the item is repriced at once, and no sync overwrites your price.

For labour and plant, the form also shows **Specification and expected output**: what the item is, what it typically produces in a day, and what it runs on. The figures are indicative only, a sense check on your rate rather than a guarantee.

Adding an item

1. Click **Add Material +** on the **Material** tab, or **Add Labour +** on the **Labour** tab.

2. Fill in **Name of material** (or **Name of labour**), **Unit**, **Price** and **Category**.
3. For labour and plant you can add a **Note**: what it is and what it produces in a day.
4. Click **Save to the library**.

To remove an item you added, select it and press Delete, or use **Delete** on its row. ADLM's own items cannot be removed, only repriced.

Fetching the latest prices

Click **Update prices** to bring the library's prices up to date from ADLM. Your own prices are offered, not overwritten.

When ADLM publishes a new price for something you changed

Your price stays in use, and a review card appears at the top of the library with the **Item**, **Unit**, **Your price**, the **Published price** and the **Change**.

1. Tick the rows you want to decide on, or tick the header box for all of them.
2. Click **Keep mine** to keep your figures and stop being asked, or **Use published** to take the published price.

Unticked rows stay pending. Reopen a hidden card from the bell with **Review**.

Undoing library changes

Rate Gen copies your material and labour libraries before anything rewrites them: a sign-in, a sync, a change of location, or taking published prices.

1. Click the undo library changes button in the top bar.
2. Under **Restore an earlier library**, pick the point to go back to.
3. Click **Restore** and confirm.

Your current library is copied first, so a restore can itself be undone.

Rates by trade

Every trade and service uses the same screen. At the top is the trade's name and **Add Custom Rate +**. Below is a bar and the table.

Column	Meaning
S/N	The item number.
DESCRIPTION	The item of work, written to the Standard Method of Measurement.
UNIT	The unit the rate is for, such as m ² , m ³ or No.
NET COST	Materials, labour and plant for one unit.
PROFIT	The profit added to the net cost.
OVERHEAD	The overhead added to the net cost.
TOTAL COST	The rate: net cost plus overhead plus profit.

On the bar:

- **Overhead** and **Profit** set the percentages for every rate in the trade. See [Overheads and profit](#).
- **Search this trade** filters the rows.
- The sort box offers **Sort by · order in the bill**, **Sort by · most expensive** and **Sort by · A to Z**.

Click a row, or select it and press , to open its build-up.

NOTE

Services rates say whether a library item is a supply price or an installed price. A supply price is the material only, so allow for fixing. An installed price already includes fixing, so do not add a labour line on top.

Building a rate: reading and changing a build-up

Opening a rate shows its **Rate Composition**. Each line is a component: a material, a labour gang or an item of plant.

Column	Meaning
COMPONENT	What the line is. Click a material or labour name to open it in the library, ready to check or change its price.
QUANTITY	How much of it one unit of work uses.
UNIT	The component's unit.
UNIT PRICE	Its price from your library.
AMOUNT	Quantity times unit price.

Totals, sub-totals and waste allowances are arithmetic, not library items, so they are not links.

How a rate is built

- **Materials:** each material's quantity per unit of work, at your library price, with waste as its own line.
- **Labour and plant:** the gang's or machine's day rate, and any fuel, divided by what it produces.
- **Reused rates:** mortar in a wall is the mortar rate; the mixer in concrete is the mixing rate. Change the reused rate and every rate using it follows.

Changing quantities

When a rate is wrong for how you work, it is usually one quantity: a different mix, a different spacing, a different gang output.

1. Click a **QUANTITY** and type the new figure.
2. Press or click away. The sub-totals refresh.
3. Click **Save**. You will see **Rate saved**: your quantities are kept on this PC, used everywhere the rate appears, and synced to QUIV and HERON.

The other buttons:

- **Cancel** throws away changes since the last save.
- **Reset this rate** puts every quantity back to what ADLM published.
- ◀ goes back to the table, and ✕ closes the build-up.

IMPORTANT

Change prices in the library and quantities in the build-up. A price lives in one place and is shared by every rate that uses it. A quantity belongs to one rate.

If you are offline when you save, you will see **Cloud Sync Pending**. Your edit is saved on the PC and syncs the next time you are connected.

Overheads and profit

A rate is built in two steps:

Net cost = materials + labour + plant

Rate = net cost + overhead + profit

Overhead and profit are each a percentage of the net cost.

- **In a trade**, the **Overhead** and **Profit** boxes set the percentages for every rate in that trade. They start at 10% overhead and 25% profit.
- **In a custom rate**, you set them for that rate alone. They start at 10% and 10%, as a percentage of the material and labour total.

TIP

Set overhead and profit to match how your firm prices before you rely on the totals.

Custom rates

A custom rate is a rate you build yourself, for an item the library does not cover or one you price your own way. Custom rates are saved in **Saved Rates**. They stay on this PC, travel with your account, and are never sent into the ADLM library.

Building a custom rate

1. Open any trade and click **Add Custom Rate +**. The form opens: "Name it, set overhead and profit, then list what goes into it."
2. Type the **Name of rate**.
3. Set **Overhead** and **Profit**.
4. Type the description: the wording that goes on the bill.
5. Under **Materials** (everything that is bought), click **Add material**. Type or pick a **Name of material**. A name from your library fills in its **Rate** and **Unit**. Type the **Quantity** one unit of work uses.
6. Under **Labour** (everything that is worked), click **Add labour** and do the same. Plant is in the labour library, so add plant here too.
7. Check the totals: **Material total**, **Labour total**, **Overall**, the overhead and profit, and the **Grand total**.

8. Click **Save this rate**.

You will see **New Rate Saved**. If you typed a priced line that is not in your library yet, Rate Gen adds it and says how many items it added. It never overwrites a price you already have.

To start from a sentence instead, use **Build with AI** at the top of the same form. See [AI in Rate Gen](#).

Saved Rates

Click **Saved Rates** in the rail to see **Saved Custom Rates**, with **TITLE, DESCRIPTION, OVERHEAD %, PROFIT %, GRAND TOTAL** and **CREATED**.

- Click a rate's wording to open it, change it, then click **Update this rate**.
- Select a rate and click **Delete selected rate**, or use the delete button on its row.
- Use **Search your saved rates, Filter** and **Sort by** to find a rate.

Custom rates are priced from your library, so they follow when you change a library price.

Custom rates and sync

From version 3.0.1, custom rates sync both ways:

- Rates on your account that this PC does not have are **downloaded** into **Saved Rates**, at sign-in and at every sync.
- A rate is deleted from your account **only when you delete it in Rate Gen**.
- Only rates you changed on this PC are uploaded.
- A rate missing from your account but still on this PC is uploaded again, unless you deleted it in Rate Gen on another PC.

So a new PC, or a fresh install, brings back all your custom rates when you sign in.

NOTE

Rate Gen has no plant group on a custom rate yet. If an older rate made on the website has a plant line, the line does not show in Rate Gen, but it is kept on your account and the rate keeps its full value.

Carbon: kgCO₂e on every rate

From version 3.0.0, every priced rate has an upfront carbon figure, worked out from the same materials and quantities as its price. Change a quantity and the price and the carbon move together.

What the figure is

- **Upfront embodied carbon, modules A1-A5** (RICS Whole life carbon assessment, 2nd edition, 2023), in **kgCO₂e per unit** of the rate: making the materials, transport to site, site waste and the fuel plant burns on site.
- **Labour and plant hire carry no material carbon**. The fuel the plant burns does, as site fuel.
- **Cement shows a range**. The low end takes the Nigerian producers' own cement figure (Dangote 570 and Lafarge Africa 537 kg CO₂ per tonne, 2024, kiln only, so a floor). The high end takes the full cradle-to-gate figure, 0.83 kgCO₂e per kg.
- **Reinforcement** uses scrap-based electric-furnace steel (0.821 kgCO₂e per kg), the route Nigeria's own rebar mills use.

- **Nothing is guessed.** A line with no published factor, or a weight that cannot be read, is left out and lowers the rate's coverage instead.

The Carbon & Others screen

1. Click **Carbon & Others** in the rail. The screen is headed **Carbon Computation**.
2. Read the table. Beside each rate's **TRADE**, **UNIT** and **TOTAL COST** are **KGCO2E / UNIT** and **COVERAGE**.
3. Use **Search this trade** to find a rate by name or trade, and **Sort by · most expensive** to put the highest carbon first.
4. Click a rate to open its **Rate Composition**. The **KGCO2E** column gives each line's carbon. Hover over a figure to see its factor and the factor's published source.

COVERAGE is the share of the build-up's cost whose carbon is accounted for. A star (*) marks a rate that uses an assumed weight. The overhead and profit boxes step aside on this screen, because carbon does not use them.

TIP

To change a rate's carbon, change its quantities in its own trade. The carbon follows.

Services carbon factors

From version 3.0.1, services rates that use these materials get a carbon figure:

Material	How it is weighed
Copper cable and earthing	The copper conductor, from the number of cores and the size in mm ² . Insulation, sheath and armour are not counted, so the figure is a floor and marked as an assumed weight.
PP-R pressure pipe	From standard PN10 pipe sizes. A "15mm" pipe is taken as the 20mm (1/2 inch) size.
uPVC soil pipe	110 mm by 3.2 mm.

Rainwater and waste pipe, fittings and manufactured items (air conditioners, pumps, sanitaryware, lights, tanks) have no carbon yet; they need the maker's own figure. Nor do windows and doors, asbestos sheets and ceilings.

Where carbon goes next: ICMS 3 on ADLM Cloud

Rate Gen's carbon travels with your rates to ADLM Cloud. On a project, open the **Export** menu and look in the **ICMS 3** group, labelled "international cost and carbon report":

- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel):** cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, every line's code and carbon source, and the lines not yet placed.
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON):** the same report as data, conforming to the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3.

The carbon on each line comes from your Rate Gen rates. The report total equals the contract total: preliminaries go in Group 08, contingency in 09.020 and VAT in 10.020. Cost and carbon per m² appear when you give an IPMS 1 or 2 floor area. The export works on sample projects too. For SERVIQ projects, ADLM Cloud uses a wider set of building-services carbon factors. See [ADLM Cloud](#).

AI in Rate Gen

ADLM AI suggests; you decide. Nothing it drafts is saved until you save it. For every AI feature across ADLM, see [ADLM AI services](#).

Build with AI

Availability: on for everyone signed in, from version 3.0.1, on by default. It draws on your account's monthly AI allowance (a rate build-up costs 1 unit).

Describe an item of work in one sentence and ADLM AI drafts a full build-up into the custom rate form, for you to check, edit and save.

1. Open a trade (for example **Block Works**) and click **Add Custom Rate +**.
2. In **Build with AI**, type a request with the words "rate" and "build" in it, for example "Build a rate for 225mm blockwork in cement mortar (1:6)".
3. Click **Build with AI**. Rate Gen shows each step: **Reading your sentence**, **Asking ADLM AI for a build-up**, **Filling in materials and labour** and **Checking it against ADLM's rules**.
4. Read the status, for example "AI draft ready (confidence 85%). Review every line before saving."
5. Check and correct every line.
6. Click **Save this rate**.

How it works:

- Rate Gen sends your sentence, your zone and the names of items in your library, your own first.
- Components found in your library are priced from **your** library at your price. Only components your library lacks keep an AI estimate, tagged **[AI]**.
- If the draft fails ADLM's checks, an amber block reads **This build-up did not pass ADLM's checks** and lists what to fix: "Correct the flagged lines before saving: the quantities, not just the prices."
- If every line came back at 0.00, Rate Gen says so. Enter the rates yourself, or pick items from the library so their prices apply.

IMPORTANT

"An AI draft is an advisory estimate from the ADLM library and market data. It is not a professional opinion and not for contract use until you have checked every line."

Carbon is not AI

Carbon & Others works out carbon from each rate's own build-up and published factors, by fixed rules. No AI is involved.

Coming: Price a bill

A **Price a bill** screen, which proposes one of your Rate Gen rates for each item in a client's bill, is built but not yet released. It is not in 3.0.1.

Exporting your rates

1. Click **Export** in the rail, or press **Ctrl + E**.

2. Choose where to save the file. It is named `ADLM_Rates_` followed by the date and time.
3. Click **Save**. You will see **Export completed**.

The workbook has a sheet per trade (**Ground, Concrete, Block Works, Finishes, Roofs, Painting, Steel, Window & Door**), a **Carbon & Others** sheet and a **Saved Rates** sheet.

NOTE

Export is not always in the rail. It appears on the day you first sign in each calendar month, and again 20 days later.

Syncing with the cloud

Your library is kept on your ADLM account as well as on your PC. That is what lets QUIV, HERON, SERVIQ and ADLM Cloud price from the same rates as Rate Gen.

Rate Gen syncs when you sign in. Click the sync button in the top bar, or press `F5`, to sync at any time. A sync:

1. Fetches the rate library ADLM publishes for every trade.
2. Fetches the rates calculated on ADLM Cloud.
3. Fetches the master material and labour prices for your location, keeping every price you set yourself.
4. Syncs your edited build-ups and your custom rates with your account.

When you sync by hand, a **Library checked** box lists each step, for example **Rates: OK, Compute: OK** and **Master prices (south_west): OK**, with the number of materials and labour items. If ADLM cannot be reached, you see **The library could not be checked**, and Rate Gen keeps working with the prices already on the PC.

NOTE

A project you have already priced keeps the rates it was priced with. A change in your library reaches a project only when that line is priced again.

Connection and working offline

Rate Gen 3.0.1 has no signal bars in the top bar. You can tell how your connection is doing in three ways:

- **Hover over the sync button.** It shows the last result, such as **Cloud sync: done** or **Cloud sync: failed**.
- **At start-up**, if ADLM Cloud cannot be reached, a **Working offline** message says that Rate Gen works with the library already on the PC, and that sign-in and sync will work again once the connection allows. It ends with a line for your IT support.

After one successful online sign-in, Rate Gen can sign you in without the internet. You will see **Signed in (offline) via cached license**. Everything on the PC works offline. Syncing, new prices and sending your edits wait until you are back online.

Keyboard shortcuts

Press `F1` or `Ctrl + /` to show the shortcut sheet. The same keys mean the same thing in every ADLM product.

Keys	What they do
F1 or Ctrl + /	Show keyboard shortcuts
Ctrl + 1	Go to Library
Ctrl + 2 to Ctrl + 9	Go to Ground, Concrete, Block Works, Finishes, Roofs, Painting, Steel, Window and Door
Ctrl + F	Search
F5	Sync from Cloud
Ctrl + E	Export all rates (when Export is showing)
Ctrl + B	Fold or unfold the rail
Ctrl + Shift + L	Switch light or dark theme
Enter or Space	In a trade table, open the selected rate
Enter	In a build-up, keep the quantity you typed. In the library, edit the selected item.
Delete	In the library, delete the selected item you added

The RateGen pages on the website (read-only)

The ADLM website shows the same library your Rate Gen app works on. **The website is read-only for rates.** It cannot create, edit or delete a rate, and it cannot change a material or labour price. Every page carries a note headed **Build and edit rates in ADLM Rate Gen:** new rates, changes to a rate and material or labour prices are made in Rate Gen on your computer, and appear on the website after its next sync. Rates already made on the website before this rule stay in your library.

Open the website library with **Open ADLM Cloud** in the Rate Gen rail, or **RateGen** in the website's menu.

The library (/work/library)

The **RateGen** page shows your whole library in one list: published rates, your own corrections and your own rates.

- The tabs are **Item of works, Materials, Labour** and **Plant**.
- Type in the search box to find a rate, material, gang or description, then narrow with **Trade** (or **Category**) and **Sort by**.
- On **Item of works**, each rate shows its **Unit, Net cost, Overhead, Profit** and **Total**.
- On **Materials** and **Labour**, **Used in** tells you how many rates use each item. Prices you set in Rate Gen are marked **your price**.

Click a rate to see its **Rate composition**, then **Open the build-up** for the full page. **Full library** at the top opens the account view (/rategen).

A rate's build-up page

Rate build-up

Search rates, materials and projects

Rate library

Sandcrete blockwork 225mm in cement mortar (1:6)

BESMM4R · F10 · Block Works · measured in m² · last touched 2 August 2026 by Chidi Okafor

Hollow sandcrete blockwork 225mm thick in cement mortar (1:6), in walls, bedded and jointed, measured net over openings.

ZONE: South West CURRENCY: NGN

The build-up			
COMPONENT	QUANTITY	UNIT PRICE	AMOUNT
MATERIALS			
Sandcrete block · 225mm hollow	10 no	N850	N8,500
Cement · 50kg bag	0.55 bag	N1,000	N550
Sharp sand	0.02 m ³	N4,205	N84
Waste & sundries	3 %	on N9,134	N274
LABOUR			
Blocklayer gang 1 mason + 2 labourers	0.06 day	N29,500	N1,770
Net cost			N11,178
Overhead Block Works default	0 %	on N11,178	N0

A rate's build-up on the website, showing the materials, labour and plant behind one rate.

The build-up page lays one rate out in full under **The build-up**: its materials, labour and plant as groups, each line with its **Component**, **Quantity**, **Unit price** and **Amount**, then the **Net cost**, overhead, profit and the **Rate**. A note says where it is priced for, for example **Priced for your zone**. The side panel, **What this rate is**, gives the **Item number**, **Section**, **Unit**, **Priced for**, **Components**, any **Plant** and when it was **Last changed**.

If a rate's stored net cost is more than its lines add up to, the difference is shown as **Not itemised**. It is part of the rate and is never dropped.

Under **Changing it**, the page explains that it reads the rate and does not change it. The **Open in Rate Gen** link there does not open Rate Gen 3.0.1 yet. Open Rate Gen yourself and search for the rate's name.

The account view (/rategen)

This page shows everything your account holds. Cards at the top show your **Pricing Location**, **My Library**, **My Rates** and the **Master Catalog**. Click **Refresh now** to reload.

Tab	What it shows
Master Materials	The published material prices for your location.
Master Labour	The published labour and plant rates for your location.
My Materials	Materials you added in Rate Gen.
My Labour	Labour and plant you added in Rate Gen.
My Rate Overrides	Published rates you changed in Rate Gen.

Tab	What it shows
My Custom Rates	Your custom rates, with their totals.
Effective Rates	The rates your other ADLM products read, with their Source .

Type in **Search this view...** to filter any tab. Your own prices are marked as yours, but they cannot be changed here.

RateGen Updates (/rategen/updates)

Click **Updates** on the account view to see rates ADLM has recently added. Open an update, click **Copy rate name**, then press **F5** in Rate Gen and search for the name. **Mark all as read** clears the count.

How your rates reach QUIV, HERON, SERVIQ and ADLM Cloud

Your Rate Gen library is one library for your account. The other ADLM products read it directly, so there is nothing to export or import. Each product needs your account to hold Rate Gen to price from the library.

Product	How it uses your rates
ADLM Cloud	A project's Rates & budget tab is Rate Gen inside the project. Each unpriced item gets a suggested rate from your own library; click Use this rate to apply it, or Open the line to choose. A rate can only price a line in the same unit. You can still type a price on a project bill line. See ADLM Cloud .
QUIV for Revit	QUIV's bill is quantities only until you price it. With a Rate Gen licence, QUIV prices it from your library and you can map a Rate Gen rate onto a line. See QUIV for Revit .
HERON	Load rates prices the bill and the budget from your library for your zone; it then reads Refresh rates . You can also search Rate Gen for one row. See ADLM HERON .
SERVIQ for Revit MEP	In the Rate Build-Up window, SEARCH RATEGEN LIBRARY finds items in your library. See SERVIQ for Revit MEP .

Edited quantities you save in Rate Gen sync to QUIV and HERON. Your Rate Gen carbon figures feed the ICMS 3 cost and carbon export on ADLM Cloud.

NOTE

These products pick rates from Rate Gen; they never build or edit them.

What's new in 3.0.0

- **The ADLM suite design.** A rail on the left with the Library, every trade, a **SERVICES** group, **Carbon & Others** and **Saved Rates** with a count. The rail folds to icons below 1,100 pixels wide, or with **Ctrl + B**.
- **One layout for every trade.** Find, sort (order in the bill, most expensive, A to Z), and a table you open with a click or **Enter**. Quantities are edited in place.
- **The Library, dialogs, splash and sign-in in the same design**, with loading that names the step it is on, and Rate Gen's own icon.
- **Open ADLM Cloud** replaces "To CM App" and opens RateGen on the website.

- **Services in four disciplines: Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing and Fire.** A 35% uplift was being added twice to some cloud services rates, so they come down.
- **Carbon on every priced rate,** with each line's factor and source.
- **Keyboard shortcuts,** the same in every ADLM product.
- **Mortar fixed.** A 225 mm wall carried 0.054 bags of cement per m², about a quarter of real practice. It now takes 0.195 bags per m², and 12 mm render 0.146, so blockwork and render rates go up.
- **Also fixed:** refreshing one trade no longer wipes the others' cached rates.

Troubleshooting

"Sign in failed. Please verify your credentials."

Check your email or username and password. If you have forgotten your password, click **Forgot password?** and reset it on the website.

"No active subscription for 'rategen'."

The account you used does not hold an active Rate Gen subscription. Check the account, or renew Rate Gen at [/manage](#).

"Internet required for first sign-in (no valid offline license found)."

The first sign-in on a PC must be online. Connect and sign in again.

"Your profile does not have a zone assigned."

Set your **Pricing location (State)** on your profile on the website, then sign out of Rate Gen and sign in again.

"The library could not be checked" or a step shows FAIL

Check your connection and sync again. If a step keeps failing, send support a screenshot of the box.

My rates look wrong for my location

1. Look at the location line at the top of the **Library**.
2. If it names the wrong state or zone, change your **Pricing location (State)** on the website.
3. Press **F5**, or sign out and in again, and click **Yes** when Rate Gen offers to update your prices.

A rate looks far too high or too low

It is nearly always one line. Open the rate, find the line, and click its name to open it in the library. Check the price there, then the quantity in the build-up.

A material or labour line is priced at zero

The name does not match a library item. Pick the name from the list, or add the item to your library.

A rate has no carbon figure, or low coverage

A line has no published factor or no readable weight, so it is left out rather than guessed. Services fittings, manufactured services items, windows and doors and ceilings have no carbon yet.

A price I changed was replaced

Use the undo library changes button in the top bar to restore an earlier copy.

The Export button is missing

That is expected on most days. **Export** appears on the day you first sign in each calendar month, and again 20 days later.

"Cloud Sync Pending" after saving

You were offline, or the server did not answer. Your edit is saved on the PC and will sync when you are connected.

A custom rate is missing on a new PC

Update to Rate Gen 3.0.1 and sign in. From 3.0.1, Rate Gen downloads every custom rate on your account into **Saved Rates**. Older versions did not.

Build with AI turns my request away

The request must contain the words "rate" and "build". Start with "Build a rate for...".

I cannot change a price or build a rate on the website

That is by design. The website is read-only for rates. Make the change in Rate Gen and sync; the website shows it after the sync.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need the desktop app, or is the website enough?

You need the desktop app to build or change anything: prices, quantities, overhead and profit, and custom rates. The website lets you read your library and every rate's build-up, and pick rates onto your project bills.

Where is my data kept?

On your PC and on your ADLM account. Updating Rate Gen does not touch it, and signing in on another PC brings it back.

Does changing a price change my existing projects?

No. A project keeps the rates it was priced with until a line is priced again.

How accurate is the carbon figure?

It is an estimate from published factors and your own quantities, good for comparing options, not a certified assessment. Check its coverage.

Does Rate Gen send my drawings or projects anywhere?

No. Rate Gen sends your library edits, custom rates and prices to your own ADLM account. Build with AI sends only your sentence, your zone and the names of items in your library.

How do I get help?

Click **Help** in the rail to email ADLM support, or raise a ticket at [/support](#). Send the trade, the item number and a screenshot of the build-up.



SERVIQ for Revit MEP

Measure ductwork, pipework, cable, fixtures and equipment straight from your Revit model, price them, and send the take-off to ADLM Cloud.

SERVIQ is ADLM's Revit add-in for measuring the services in a building: ductwork, pipework, cable and containment, and every terminal, fixture and piece of equipment on them. It reads the quantities from the Revit model you have open, so you do not count symbols on a drawing. It is for services quantity surveyors, main-contract QSs pricing an M&E package, and services engineers who want a quick quantity check. You get a measured take-off, a priced bill with overhead and profit, a material schedule, an Excel workbook, and a project on your ADLM Cloud account that you can price, value and report on the web.

This guide covers **SERVIQ 2.0** (ServiQ 2.0.0), the new version built on the same design as QUIV 4.0. In Revit it adds a tab called **SERVIQ** with one **ServiQ** button. In the Installer Hub the product is listed as the **Revit MEP Plugin**. It is the same subscription as the old ADLM Revit MEP Suite.

NOTE

SERVIQ 2.0 is rolling out to every customer at once from 3 October 2026, through the Installer Hub. If your Hub still shows version 1.8.3 and no update, 2.0 has not reached your account yet: click **Refresh** in the Hub later. Version 1.8.3 has the older **ADLM MEP & HVAC** tab with one button per service; see [If you are still on 1.8.3](#) at the end of this guide.

What's new in 2.0

Version 2.0.0 was released on 1 October 2026.

- **A new name and a new panel.** The add-in is now SERVIQ. One **ServiQ** button on the **SERVIQ** tab opens a single panel beside your model. It signs you in, sets up a take-off list, walks you through each service, and saves to ADLM Cloud. The nine per-service ribbon buttons are gone.
- **A take-off list by service.** Start a project, tick **HVAC**, **Plumbing** and **Electrical**, and SERVIQ lists every item to measure, grouped by service, with a progress bar.
- **Auto take-off.** SERVIQ can measure every item on every level for you. Each result gets a confidence, and nothing counts until you accept it.
- **Save to ADLM Cloud the QUIV 4.0 way.** The bill and the budget (each line's material and labour) are saved together and linked, so the web **Budget** tab fills in. Your rates and build-ups travel with the save. The model goes up as a 3D model for the web viewer. Saving again updates the same project, and a project changed on another computer is caught instead of overwritten.
- **Reopening a cloud project** brings back line names, levels, rates and build-ups.
- **Light and dark mode** across the new panel (Revit 2025 and later), and a status bar that shows whether you are online.
- **Keyboard shortcuts** in the full bill window. Press **F1** to see them.
- **Fixed:** the rate build-up window no longer crashes when it opens; adding a take-off no longer puts its last line in twice; clicking a rate cell now lets you type the rate.
- **Fixed:** opening SERVIQ before you sign in no longer pops up a Windows box. SERVIQ shows its own message with a **Sign in** button, and an expired session is renewed quietly where it can be.

Also new on the website (October 2026)

- **Price services from Rate Gen:** price a SERVIQ project on ADLM Cloud in one click from the Rate Gen master library. See [Price the services on ADLM Cloud](#).
- **Services carbon and ICMS 3:** carbon for services rates in Rate Gen, and a cost and carbon report on ADLM Cloud. See [Services carbon and ICMS 3](#).

Before you start

What you need

Item	Requirement
Computer	A Windows PC that runs Autodesk Revit
Revit	Revit 2024, 2025, 2026 or 2027
Model	A Revit model with the services modelled as real elements (ducts, pipes, cable trays, fixtures and so on)
Internet	Needed to sign in, to save to the cloud, and to search the Rate Gen library
Subscription	An active SERVIQ (Revit MEP) subscription on your ADLM account
Optional	An active Rate Gen subscription, if you want to pick items from the Rate Gen library while building a rate

NOTE

SERVIQ is a separate subscription from QUIV for Revit. Having QUIV does not give you SERVIQ, and having SERVIQ does not give you QUIV. See [QUIV for Revit](#) for measuring the building itself.

Get a subscription

1. Go to adlmstudio.net/products and choose the SERVIQ (Revit MEP) plan.
2. Pay, then check that the subscription shows as active on your [dashboard](#).

Install or update SERVIQ

SERVIQ is installed through the ADLM Installer Hub, like every other ADLM product. If you have not used the Hub before, read the [ADLM Installer Hub](#) guide first.

1. Close Revit completely. The Hub cannot replace an add-in that Revit is holding open.
2. Open the **ADLM Installer Hub** and sign in with your ADLM account.
3. Click **Installation Center** in the sidebar.
4. Find the **Revit MEP Plugin** card. It reads **Ready to install** for a first install, or **Update available** when 2.0 is waiting for you.
5. Click **Install**, or the **Update** button on the card.
6. If the **Choose Your Revit Version** window opens, pick your year under **Revit Version** and click **Continue Install**.
7. Click **Yes** if Windows asks for permission to make changes.
8. Wait until the card shows **Installed**.

9. Open Revit. If Revit asks whether to load **ServiQ 2.0**, choose **Always Load**.

TIP

Use more than one Revit year? Click **Repair** on the card after the install and choose the other year. Do it again after every update so each year gets the new version.

NOTE

Updating replaces the program files only. Your projects on ADLM Cloud and the local backup on your computer are kept.

Open SERVIQ and sign in

1. Open the services model in Revit.
2. Click the **SERVIQ** tab.
3. On the **ADLM** panel, click **ServiQ**. The SERVIQ panel opens beside the model.
4. On **Sign in to ServiQ**, type your ADLM **Email** and **Password**.
5. Click **Sign in**, or press in the password box.

The panel opens on its home screen and greets you by name. You sign in once each time you start Revit. To sign out, click **Sign out** in the status bar at the bottom of the panel.

No ADLM account yet? Click **Create an account** under "New to ADLM?". It opens the sign-up page on the website.

IMPORTANT

Your subscription is tied to the computer you first sign in on. To move to a new computer, free the old one first. See [Moving to a new computer](#) in the Installer Hub guide.

Find your way around the panel

The header

Across the top of the panel are the screen's title and a few small buttons:

Button	What it does
Back arrow (Back)	Returns to the previous screen.
Moon or sun (Dark mode / Light mode)	Switches the panel between light and dark. Shown on Revit 2025, 2026 and 2027 only.
Full screen / Dock in Revit	Opens SERVIQ in a large floating window, or puts it back in the Revit side panel. Your work stays as it is.
Minimise	Folds the panel down to its header so you can see more of the model.
Close	Hides SERVIQ. Click ServiQ on the ribbon to bring it back.

You can also drag, float or tab the docked panel the way you do with Revit's own Properties panel. When the panel is wide enough, the take-off list stays on the left and the item you are measuring opens on the right.

The status bar

The bar along the bottom shows your connection:

- **Online** and your name, when SERVIQ can reach ADLM.
- **Offline · take-offs are kept on this computer**, when your PC has no network. You can keep measuring; save to the cloud when you are back online.

The home screen

The home screen shows the model that is **OPEN IN REVIT** and what to do with it.

- **Start a take-off for this model** appears when this model has no take-off yet. It opens **New project**.
- **Continue take-off** appears when a take-off is already in the panel. It shows the project name, the number of lines and how many items are measured.
- **Recent projects** lists your latest saves on ADLM Cloud. Click one to open it in the panel. Click **Refresh** if the list looks out of date, or **New project** to start another.
- **Open ADLM Cloud** opens your SERVIQ projects on the website, where you price, plan and value them.

Start a project and build the take-off list

1. On the home screen, click **Start a take-off for this model** (or **New project**).
2. Under **Project name**, check the name. It starts as the Revit model's name. Change it to something clear, for example the job name and "Services".
3. Under **Services**, tick one or more of **HVAC** (ducts, air), **Plumbing** (pipes, fixtures) and **Electrical** (light, power). The panel shows what "The take-off list will have".
4. Click **Generate take-off list**.

SERVIQ shows "Take-off list ready" and opens the list. If a take-off was already in the panel, it asks before clearing it. Anything you have already saved to ADLM Cloud stays there.

NOTE

"Give the project a name." means the name box is empty or still says "Untitled". "Choose at least one service." means no service is ticked.

The take-off list

The list groups the items by service. Each group shows how many of its items are done, for example "2/4", and you can fold a group away by clicking its heading. A progress bar across the top shows how much of the list is measured.

Service	Item	What SERVIQ measures
HVAC	Ductwork	Duct length by type and size, in metres
HVAC	Duct fittings	Elbows, tees, reducers and transitions, counted

Service	Item	What SERVIQ measures
HVAC	Air terminals	Diffusers, grilles and registers, counted by type and size
HVAC	HVAC equipment	AHUs, FCUs, VAVs and other equipment, counted
Plumbing	Plumbing fixtures	WCs, basins, sinks and showers, counted
Plumbing	Pipework	Pipe length by type and diameter, and pipe fittings counted
Electrical	Lighting	Light fittings and switches, counted
Electrical	Power	Sockets, spurs and distribution boards, counted
Electrical	Cable and containment	Cable, cable tray and conduit length, and conduit fittings counted

Anything that runs is measured in metres. Anything that sits on a run is counted. That is how a services bill is written.

An item you have measured gets a green tick and a note such as "12 lines · 3 levels". An item that already has saved lines stays on the list even if you untick its service later, so nothing measured is ever hidden.

Take off a service

Every item works the same way. Learn one and you know them all.

Step by step: measure the ductwork

1. On the take-off list, click **Ductwork**. The item screen opens.
2. Under step 1, **Choose a level in Revit**, open **Level** and pick a level, or **All Floors** for the whole building.
3. Wait while SERVIQ shows "Reading the model...".
4. Read step 2, **From the model**. It lists each duct by name, type and size with its length. "Read from Revit, no typing."
5. Click a line to show those ducts in the model.
6. Check the **Results** card for the totals.
7. Click **Add to take-off** at the bottom.

SERVIQ confirms, for example "Ductwork added: 14 lines for Level 1", and offers **Next item**. Pick the next level and add it too, or click **Next item** to move down the list. **Previous** goes back one item.

TIP

Adding the same level twice does not double your quantities. SERVIQ says "Already on the take-off" and skips it. The **Add to take-off** button turns green with a tick when that level is already in.

NOTE

"Nothing to measure for ductwork on this level." means that level has no elements of this kind. Try another level, or check the services are in this model and not in a linked one.

Export one item to Excel

On the **Results** card, click **Export to Excel** to save that item and level on its own. For the whole job, use **Export to Excel** on the **Review and save** screen instead (see [Export to Excel](#)).

TIP

Lines are grouped by the names, types and sizes the model uses. A model where half the supply ductwork is called "Duct 1" gives you a bill that says "Duct 1". Fix the names in Revit and measure again, rather than renaming lines every time the design changes.

NOTE

SERVIQ measures what is modelled. A service that exists only as a single-line diagram, a note or a specification clause is not an element in the model, so it cannot be measured.

Auto take-off

Auto take-off measures the items for you, level by level, exactly as you would by hand, and adds them to the take-off. It is not an AI feature: it runs SERVIQ's own measuring on every level.

1. On the take-off list, click **Auto take-off**.
2. The card lists the items not measured yet, all ticked. Untick any you want to measure yourself.
3. Click **Run auto take-off**. Click **Cancel** to close the card without running.

A progress card shows the item and level being measured, how many measurements are done and saved, the time taken and the time left. Click **Stop** to finish after the measurement in progress. What is saved is kept.

Accept the results

When the run ends, SERVIQ tells you how many items it measured, how many "look right" and how many "need a closer look". **Nothing is complete until you accept it.**

- Each result has a confidence: the share of that item's levels that measured and saved without a problem. A result at 85% or more counts as sure.
- At the top of the take-off list, a bar shows how many auto take-off results are waiting. Click **Accept** (for example **Accept 6**) to accept all the sure ones at once.
- For the others, open the item, check its lines and click **Accept and complete**.

IMPORTANT

You cannot save to ADLM Cloud while auto take-off results are waiting. SERVIQ says "Accept the auto take-off results first". Accept them, or open each item and accept it.

TIP

Running auto take-off again does not double count. An item and level already on the take-off is skipped.

Review and save

When the list is measured, click **Review and save**.

The **Review and save** screen shows three counts: items **measured**, items **still to do**, and **bill lines**. If anything is left, it names it, for example "Still to measure: Power, Lighting." Below that, each item's lines are listed with their quantities.

From here you can:

- Click **Save to ADLM Cloud** (or **Save changes to ADLM Cloud** once the project is on the cloud).
- Click **Export to Excel** for the whole job.
- Click **Prices and budget** to open the full bill, where you price it (see below).

Price the bill inside Revit

Prices and budget opens the full bill in its own window, the **ADLM Takeoff Database**. This is where you type rates, build rates up from material and labour, and check the budget. Prices are in naira (₦).

Find your way around the bill window

The left side has three groups:

Group	What is in it
PROJECT	The project name, Save to Cloud and Load Latest Local .
VIEW	Take-Off Data , Take-Off Summary , Budget and Material Schedule .
RECENT CLOUD SAVES	Your projects on ADLM Cloud. Click one to reopen it. The refresh button reloads the list.

Along the top are **Export to Excel**, which exports the whole job, and **Clear All**, which empties the take-off. The header has **Shortcuts** and **Dark / Light**.

Type a rate

1. Click **Take-Off Data**.
2. Click in the **Unit Rate** box on a line and type the rate.
3. Press **Tab** or click elsewhere. The **Amount** (quantity × rate) fills in.

A line with an empty **Unit Rate** is treated as unpriced. The **Bill Total** at the bottom updates as you price.

To remove lines, tick them and click **Delete Selected**. SERVIQ asks you to confirm first.

Add overhead and profit

At the bottom of **Take-Off Data**:

1. Type your **Overhead %**.
2. Type your **Profit %**.
3. Read the **Budget Total**: the **Bill Total** plus overhead and profit.

Build a rate from material and labour

1. On a line in **Take-Off Data**, click the **f** button. The **Rate Build-Up** window opens.
2. Click **+ Material** to add a material row, or **+ Labour** to add a labour row.

3. For each row, fill in the **Description**, **Qty/unit** (how much goes into one unit of the line), **Unit** and **Unit Price**. The **Amount** works itself out.
4. Remove a row you do not want with X.
5. Check the totals at the bottom: **Material**:, **Labour**:, and **Unit cost**:. The unit cost becomes the line's rate.
6. Click **Done**.

TIP

Put waste into **Qty/unit**. For example, 1.05 m of cable per metre run allows 5% waste. That figure carries through to the Material Schedule.

Pick items from the Rate Gen library

If you also have an active Rate Gen subscription, the **Rate Build-Up** window shows a **SEARCH RATEGEN LIBRARY** box.

1. Type a material or labour name in the box.
2. Click a result. It is added to the build-up as a new row with its price.
3. Adjust **Qty/unit** for waste or for the way the item is sold.

Without a Rate Gen subscription the box does not appear, and you type every row yourself. Rates themselves are built and kept in [ADLM Rate Gen](#).

Reuse a build-up on similar lines

Click **Apply to similar lines** in the **Rate Build-Up** window. The same build-up is copied onto every other unpriced line in the same service that has no build-up yet, and SERVIQ tells you how many. Lines that already have a build-up are left alone.

Take-Off Summary, Budget and Material Schedule

- **Take-Off Summary** shows the **Totals** for the job and a **Details** list of every line, grouped by service.
- **Budget** (the **Budget Breakdown**) shows one row per **DISCIPLINE** with its **LINES** and **SUBTOTAL**, the **OVERHEAD %** and **PROFIT %**, and the roll-up from **Bill Subtotal** to **Budget Total**. Once a line has a build-up, **COST COMPOSITION** splits the bill into **Material**, **Labour** and **Unclassified (rate only)**.
- **Material Schedule** is a procurement list. It multiplies each material in each line's build-up by the line's quantity and adds the same material together across the job: **MATERIAL**, **QTY**, **UNIT**, **UNIT PRICE** and **TOTAL**, with the **Total Material Cost**. Only lines with a build-up appear.

Keyboard shortcuts in the bill window

Press **F1** or **Ctrl + /**, or click **Shortcuts**, to see the list.

Keys	What they do
Ctrl + 1 to Ctrl + 4	Go to Take-Off Data, Take-Off Summary, Budget, Material Schedule
Ctrl + S	Save to Cloud
Ctrl + E	Export all to Excel
F5	Refresh cloud projects

Save to ADLM Cloud

1. Click **Review and save** on the take-off list.
2. Click **Save to ADLM Cloud**.
3. If a project with that name is already on your account, SERVIQ says "A project with this name exists". Click **Save anyway** to use that name, or go back and rename the project.
4. Wait while SERVIQ saves the take-off, checks it arrived, saves the budget and uploads the model.
5. Read the message. "Bill and budget saved together and linked." means everything arrived. Click **Open ADLM Cloud** to see it.

What the save sends:

- **The bill:** every line with its name, level, quantity, rate and build-up.
- **The budget:** each line's material and labour, linked to the bill, so the web **Budget** tab fills in.
- **The 3D model,** for the web **3D Model** viewer.

Saving again updates the same project. If someone changed the project on another computer since you opened it, SERVIQ says "This project changed on another device". Open the latest version from your recent cloud saves, then save again.

IMPORTANT

If a save fails, SERVIQ says so and adds "Your take-off is still on this computer." Nothing is lost. Try again when your connection is back.

Reopen a cloud project

On the home screen, click the project under **Recent projects**. Or, in the bill window, click it under **RECENT CLOUD SAVES** and click **Yes** to replace the current take-off. Line names, levels, rates and build-ups come back with it.

The local backup

SERVIQ keeps a backup of your take-off on your computer and updates it every time you add, delete or price a line. Every Revit session starts with an empty take-off. To get your last take-off back:

1. Click **Prices and budget** (or open the bill window from **Review and save**).
2. Click **Load Latest Local**.
3. Check the project name, the save time and the number of rows, then click **Yes**.

TIP

Revit crashed in the middle of a take-off? Open the bill window and click **Load Latest Local**. **Clear All** does not wipe the backup either, so the same button undoes an accidental clear.

NOTE

The backup holds one take-off: the last one you worked on on this computer. To keep several jobs, save each to the cloud with its own name.

Export to Excel

1. Click **Export to Excel** on the **Review and save** screen, or at the top of the bill window (**Ctrl** + **E**).
2. Choose where to save. The file name starts as "Complete MEP BoQ".
3. Click **Save**. SERVIQ confirms the export.

Sheet	What is on it
One sheet per service	Air Terminals, Cable Works, Lighting, Pipe Works, Plumbing Fixtures, Power Fixtures and the rest. Columns: S/N, Description, Quantity, Unit, Rate (₺) and Amount (₺), with a TOTAL row.
Summary	Each service with its number of rows, total quantity and total amount, and a GRAND TOTAL.
Budget Summary	The bill subtotal, overhead %, profit % and the budget total. The total is a live Excel formula, so changing the percentages in Excel updates it.

Only the services you have measured get a sheet. On ADLM Cloud you can export the same project in more formats; see [ADLM Cloud](#).

On ADLM Cloud

Projects you save appear on adlmstudio.net under your SERVIQ (Revit MEP) projects, alongside your other ADLM projects. Click **Open ADLM Cloud** on the home screen, or go to [/projects/mep](#). There you can open the **Bill of Quantity**, **Budget**, **Valuation**, **Work area** and **3D Model** of each project. The [ADLM Cloud](#) guide explains these pages.

TIP

Keep the services and the building as separate projects. They come from different models, change at different times, and are often valued as different packages. A services project can be linked to its building project on ADLM Cloud so its total joins the building's.

Price the services on ADLM Cloud

A SERVIQ project on ADLM Cloud has a **Price services from Rate Gen** panel on its **Dashboard** tab. It builds a material and labour rate for every services line from Rate Gen prices, applies your services constants (standard lengths, connectors and fittings), and updates the bill.

1. Open the project on ADLM Cloud.
2. On the **Dashboard** tab, find **Price services from Rate Gen**.
3. Click **Price services**.
4. Read the result, for example "Priced 20 bill lines from 46 build-up lines. Open the Bill tab to review."
5. Open **Bill of Quantity** and check the rates.

How it finds a price:

- It looks first in the **Rate Gen master library** for your state, the same list of services items that Rate Gen and SERVIQ use. Then it looks in your own Rate Gen library.
- Matching is strict. A name must match exactly, or match word for word with the same size both ways (a 25mm pipe never takes a 32mm price) and the same unit. If no item is clearly the best, the line stays unpriced, so the gap is visible rather than wrong.
- An item marked "(installed)" in the master library is an all-in supply-and-fix price, so no labour is added on top.

NOTE

The button is greyed out on a project shared with you with rates hidden. Rates are built in [ADLM Rate Gen](#): the website picks Rate Gen prices onto your bill, but does not create or edit rates.

Edit services constants under the button opens the services constants: for each type, the standard length (6 m for pipe), the connectors per joint and a fitting uplift. Change them there if your supply lengths differ.

Services carbon and ICMS 3

SERVIQ itself does not show carbon. Carbon for services comes from your Rate Gen rates:

- In Rate Gen 3.0.1, every built-up rate gets an upfront carbon figure in kgCO₂e (stages A1 to A5). Building-services rates are listed under **Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing and Fire**.
- Copper cable and earthing are weighed from their own names (cores × size of conductor). Insulation and sheath are not counted, so a cable's figure is a minimum.
- PP-R pressure pipe and uPVC soil pipe are weighed from their sizes.
- Fittings and manufactured items (AC units, pumps, fans, sanitaryware, light fittings, accessories, fire equipment, tanks) have no carbon figure yet. They need the maker's own figure.

See [ADLM Rate Gen](#) for the **Carbon & Others** screen.

On ADLM Cloud, open the project's **Export** menu and use the **ICMS 3** group ("international cost and carbon report"):

- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**: cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, with every line's code, where its carbon came from, and the lines not yet placed.
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)**: the same report as data. It conforms to the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3.

SERVIQ lines go into Group 05, services and equipment, by type: for example ducts and air conditioners to 05.010 (heating, ventilating and air-conditioning), distribution boards to 05.020 (electrical services), light fittings to 05.030, pipework to 05.050 (water supply and drainage) and WCs and basins to 05.060 (sanitary fittings). External drainage such as inspection chambers goes to Group 06. A line SERVIQ cannot place is listed as not yet placed. The report total equals the contract total: preliminaries go in Group 08, contingency in 09.020 and VAT in 10.020. Carbon per line comes from your Rate Gen rates, so lines priced from an item with no carbon figure show none. Give an IPMS 1 or 2 floor area to see cost and carbon per m².

Learning samples

Your SERVIQ projects page can show a **Learning samples** strip: worked services projects for sample duplex buildings, covering electrical, plumbing and drainage, and air conditioning. Open one to see a fully filled-in project. Samples are read-only. Click **Hide samples** to fold the strip away, and the **Show** button (for example "Show 3 samples") to bring it back.

AI in SERVIQ

ADLM's AI features are described in full in [ADLM AI services](#). For SERVIQ:

Feature	Where	Availability
ADLM AI Review (the AI Review page)	Bill window, under VIEW	Not in standard installs
BUILD WITH ADLM AI	Rate Build-Up window	Not in standard installs
Auto take-off	Take-off list	On for everyone with 2.0. Uses no AI
AI checks in the Work area	ADLM Cloud project	On for everyone (see below)

ADLM AI Review and **BUILD WITH ADLM AI** are built into SERVIQ 2.0 but switched off in a normal install. ADLM switches them on only on machines it sets up for testing. If you do not see an **AI Review** item under **VIEW**, or a **BUILD WITH ADLM AI** box in the **Rate Build-Up** window, that is expected.

Where they are switched on:

- **ADLM AI Review** offers **Market check** (every priced line against the Rate Gen library), **Find errors**, **Clean up bill** (wording, units, duplicates and gaps), **Auto-price unpriced** lines from your rate library, **Import supplier catalogue**, **ASK ABOUT THIS BILL** and **PLAN A TAKE-OFF**. Each finding offers **Apply** or **Dismiss**. "Nothing here changes the bill until you apply it."
- **BUILD WITH ADLM AI** drafts a material and labour build-up from a description of the work. Click **Build rate**, check the rows, and keep or change them.

On ADLM Cloud, for every customer: open a saved SERVIQ project and click **Work area**. Its **Ada** panel can **Check my rates against the market**, **Scan the bill for errors** and **Build up a rate for the selected line**, and you can ask Ada about the project. These work on SERVIQ samples too. Nothing changes your bill unless you apply it. See [ADLM AI services](#) for allowances and how your data is handled.

Troubleshooting

The SERVIQ tab is missing

Cause	Fix
Installed for a different Revit year	Click Repair on the card in the Hub and choose the year you are opening.
Revit was open during the install	Close Revit completely and install again.
Revit's add-in prompt was answered "Do Not Load"	Install again from the Hub, open Revit, and choose Always Load for ServiQ 2.0 .

I still see the ADLM MEP & HVAC tab

You are on version 1.8.3. Update from the Hub when it offers 2.0. See [If you are still on 1.8.3](#).

The docked panel shows only a short hint

Revit restores the panel when it starts, before SERVIQ is opened. Click **ServiQ** on the ribbon to load it.

"Invalid email or password."

Check your email and password by signing in at adlmstudio.net. If you have forgotten the password, reset it on the website, then try again in Revit.

"No active MEP subscription or device mismatch."

Either your SERVIQ subscription is not active, or your licence is in use on another computer. Check your [dashboard](#). If the subscription is active, free the other computer as described in [Moving to a new computer](#), then sign in again. Remember that QUIV and SERVIQ are separate subscriptions.

"Internet is required to sign in" or "Network error"

SERVIQ could not reach the ADLM server. Check your internet connection and sign in again. If you use a VPN or a company proxy, try without it.

An item finds nothing

The elements are probably in a linked model, not the one you have open. Open the linked services file and measure there. Also check you picked a level under **Level**.

Counts are far below the drawings

The service is probably drawn but not modelled, for example as a single-line diagram. There is nothing to measure. Price that part another way and say so in your bill.

"Accept the auto take-off results first"

Auto take-off results are waiting. Click **Accept** at the top of the take-off list for the sure ones, and open each of the others and click **Accept and complete**. Then save.

"Name the project first"

The project has no name. Start a **New project** with a name, or type one under **PROJECT** in the bill window, and save again.

"Sign in to save to ADLM Cloud" or "Your ADLM session has ended"

Click **Sign in** on the message. Your take-off stays on this computer while you sign in.

"You are offline"

Your PC has no network. Your take-off is kept on this computer. Save again when you are back online.

"This project changed on another device"

Someone saved the same project from another computer after you opened it. Open the latest version from **Recent projects**, redo your changes if needed, and save again.

"The 3D model was not uploaded"

The bill and budget saved, but the model did not go up for the web viewer. Make sure the model is open in Revit, open SERVIQ from the ribbon and save again.

My take-off is empty when I open Revit

That is normal. Each Revit session starts empty. Open a project from **Recent projects**, or click **Load Latest Local** in the bill window.

The Rate Gen search box is missing from Rate Build-Up

It only appears with an active Rate Gen subscription. You can still build rates by typing rows with **+ Material** and **+ Labour**.

Price services priced only a few lines

That is by design. A line is priced only when the Rate Gen master library has a clear match with the same size and unit. Price the rest in Revit before you save, or pick a Rate Gen rate onto each line on the web.

Something else went wrong

Contact ADLM through [support](#) with your account email, your Revit year and what you were doing. If asked, SERVIQ keeps a log file at %AppData%\ADLM\RevitMEP\cloud.log that helps support see what happened.

Frequently asked questions

Is SERVIQ the same as the ADLM Revit MEP Suite?

Yes. SERVIQ is the new name, and 2.0 is the new version. Your subscription, your saved projects and your licence carry over.

Do I need QUIV to use SERVIQ?

No. SERVIQ works on its own with its own subscription. On a full bill you will usually want both: QUIV for the building and SERVIQ for the services.

Which Revit versions are supported?

Revit 2024, 2025, 2026 and 2027.

Can I measure one floor at a time?

Yes. Pick a level under **Level**, click **Add to take-off**, then pick the next level. Choose **All Floors** to measure the whole building in one go.

Is auto take-off AI?

No. It runs SERVIQ's own measuring on every level of the model, the same as you would by hand. The confidence is the share of levels that measured without a problem, not a guess.

Do I need a Rate Gen subscription to price?

No. You can type any rate and build rates from material and labour by hand. Rate Gen adds the library search inside **Rate Build-Up**, and gives the prices that **Price services** uses on the web.

Can I import a services bill from Excel?

Not in SERVIQ. It measures from the Revit model.

If you are still on 1.8.3

Until the Hub updates you to 2.0, version 1.8.3 works as before. The Revit tab is **ADLM MEP & HVAC**. Sign in with **Sign In** on the **Tools** panel, then use one button per service (such as **Duct Quantity**): pick a level, check **Result Info** and click **Save to Take-Off**. **Show Takeoff Database** opens the same bill window described in [Price the bill inside Revit](#). Version 1.8.3 has no take-off list, no auto take-off and no linked budget save.



ADLM Time Pro

Record what your gangs really produce on site, then turn a bill quantity into a duration, a crew size and a Microsoft Project programme.

ADLM Time Pro is a Windows app for quantity surveyors, site engineers and project managers who need durations they can defend. You log what each gang actually produced on site, day by day. Time Pro averages those records for every item of work. Then you type in a quantity from your bill, and it tells you how many days the work will take and how many skilled and unskilled hands you need to finish in the time you want. When you are happy, you send the result to Excel or to Microsoft Project.

What's new in 1.1.1

Version 1.1.1, released in August 2026, is the current version. The Installer Hub installs it for every subscriber.

- **Dark mode on every screen.** Follows your Windows setting at first, then remembers your choice. Switch from the bottom of the side menu.
- **Sign out from the side menu.** Sign Out now sits under the theme switch.
- **Choose your currency for Microsoft Project.** Thirteen currencies, starting from your Windows region. Costs show in Project in the same currency you typed.
- **Microsoft Project files now open.** The exported file previously could be rejected by Project. It now opens straight from File, then Open.
- **Tasks chain in Microsoft Project.** Each item is linked finish-to-start to the one before it.
- **Labour and equipment cost correctly.** Labour is now an hourly resource and equipment a per-use resource, so rates land in the right place.
- **Rates accept normal money formats** such as 1,500.00 and #1500.
- **Clearer messages when an item cannot be exported.** Time Pro names the items with no duration and tells you what they need.
- **A readable side menu.** Every button shows its icon and name, with the current screen in ADLM orange.

Version 1.0.1 made Time Pro a paid subscription: you sign in with your ADLM account, Time Pro checks for an active subscription, and your licence is tied to your computer.

NOTE

The keyboard shortcuts and the connection signal indicator added to other ADLM products in September 2026 are not in Time Pro 1.1.1. Nothing newer than 1.1.1 has been released for Time Pro.

Before you start

What you need

Item	Requirement
Computer	A Windows 10 or Windows 11 PC
Other software	None. Time Pro runs on its own and does not need Revit, ArchiCAD or PlanSwift

Item	Requirement
Microsoft Project	Only if you want to open the programme file Time Pro exports. Any recent desktop version that opens Project XML files will do
Internet	Needed for your first sign-in, for fetching weather, and for checking your licence. After that you can record tasks offline
Subscription	An active ADLM Time Pro subscription on your ADLM account

Get a subscription

Time Pro is a paid subscription. An ADLM account on its own is not enough.

1. Go to the Time Pro product page on adlmstudio.net and choose a plan.
2. Pay and wait for the subscription to show as active on your [dashboard](#).

If you do not yet have an ADLM account, create one first with **Sign up** on the website.

Install Time Pro

Time Pro is installed through the ADLM Installer Hub, the same way as the other ADLM products. If you have not used the Hub before, see the [ADLM Installer Hub](#) guide.

1. Open the **ADLM Installer Hub** and sign in with your ADLM account.
2. Click **Installation Center** in the sidebar.
3. Find the **ADLM Time Pro** card. With an active subscription it reads **Ready to install**.
4. Click **Install**.
5. Click **Yes** when Windows asks for permission to make changes.
6. Wait until the card shows **Installed**.
7. Open Time Pro from the **ADLM Time Pro** shortcut on your desktop.

NOTE

Updates come through the Hub too. When a new version is out, the card reads **Update available**: close Time Pro and click the update button on the card. Updating does not delete your Task Log.

Sign in

The first window you see is **Sign in to ADLM Time Management**.

1. Type your ADLM username or email address into **Username or Email**.
2. Type your **Password**.
3. Click **Sign in**.

Time Pro checks your account and your subscription, then opens on the **Task Log**.

- If you do not have an account yet, click **Sign up** under "Don't have an ADLM account?". It opens the sign-up page on the website.
- If your account is fine but has no active Time Pro subscription, you will see a message saying so and a **Subscribe to ADLM Time Pro** button that opens the product page.

One computer per licence

Your Time Pro licence is tied to the computer you sign in on. Once you have signed in online on that PC, Time Pro remembers your licence, so:

- it can reopen without asking you to sign in again for up to about a day and a half (after that you will see **Session expired. Please sign in again.**);
- if the PC has no internet when you sign in, Time Pro can still let you in, as long as you have signed in online on this same PC before and your licence is still valid.

If you move to a new computer, contact [ADLM support](#) so the licence can be released from the old one.

How Time Pro works

Time Pro has one simple idea, and it helps to understand it before you start typing.

1. **Record.** Every day, for every gang, you log the item of work, the crew, the hours and the output. This is the **Task Log**.
2. **Average.** Time Pro groups your records by item of work and works out the average output per day and the average crew that produced it. This is the **Duration Summary**.
3. **Forecast.** You type the quantity from your bill. Time Pro divides it by your average output to give the expected number of days, and tells you the crew needed for the number of days you actually want.
4. **Export.** You send the result to Excel, or to Microsoft Project as a ready-made programme.

IMPORTANT

A brand-new Time Pro has no history, so it cannot forecast anything yet. Every expected duration will show as 0 until you have logged some tasks for that item of work. Start recording on site before you need the forecast. A week of honest records is enough to begin.

What Time Pro does not do

Time Pro builds the durations and crews. It does not draw a Gantt chart, track progress against a baseline, or let you set your own task links. Those jobs happen in Microsoft Project after you export: see "Working with the programme in Microsoft Project" below. Time Pro also does not open or import Microsoft Project files. It only exports to them.

Finding your way around

The side menu

The side menu on the left takes you between the three screens. Use them in this order:

Button	What it is for
Current Weather	Look up a town and fetch today's weather, so it can be stamped on your task records
Task Log	Your daily site records. Everything Time Pro knows comes from here
Duration Summary	One row per item of work, with averages and your forecast. Exports start here

At the bottom of the side menu are two more buttons:

- **Dark Mode** (or **Light Mode** when dark mode is on) switches the colour theme.
- **Sign Out** signs you out of Time Pro on this computer.

The screen you are on is highlighted in ADLM orange.

TIP

If you make the Time Pro window narrow, the side menu shrinks to a strip of icons to give the tables more room. Hover over an icon to see its name. Widen the window again and the labels come back.

The top bar

Across the top of the window you will find:

- **Search here...:** a search box. Start typing an item of work, a trade, a piece of equipment or a weather condition and Time Pro filters the table on the current screen and offers suggestions underneath. Click a suggestion to use it.
- A help button (the question mark). It shows a short note and a link to adlmstudio.net for more ADLM software and training.
- Your name and email. Click them to open a small menu with **Logout**.

Dark mode

Time Pro has a full dark theme that covers every screen, dialog and export window.

- The first time you open Time Pro, it follows your Windows light or dark setting.
- To switch, click **Dark Mode** or **Light Mode** at the bottom of the side menu.
- Time Pro remembers your choice the next time you open it.

Fetching the weather

Weather changes what a gang produces. Time Pro lets you attach real conditions to each record so that later you can tell a wet-season output from a dry-season one. The weather comes from the free Open-Meteo service, so you need an internet connection at the moment you fetch it.

Fetch today's weather

1. Click **Current Weather** in the side menu.
2. Type your town into the box under **SEARCH CITY** and click **Search**.
3. Choose the right place under **SELECT CITY**. Many town names exist in more than one country, so check the result.
4. Click **Fetch Weather**.

Time Pro shows the temperature and condition, with **Wind Speed**, **Humidity**, **Rainfall** and **Cloud Cover**. Your last few readings are listed under **Weather Snapshots**.

Attach weather to your tasks

There are two ways:

- **Automatically.** Once you have fetched the weather, every new task you add picks up the current reading when you save it.
- **By hand.** Select a task in the **Task Log**, then click **Apply Current Weather to Selected Task** on the Task Log, or **Apply to Selected Task** on the **Current Weather** screen.

TIP

Fetch the weather once at the start of the day. The reading stays in place while you move between screens, so every task you add that day gets it.

NOTE

Weather does not change Time Pro's arithmetic. It applies no wet-weather factor. It simply records the conditions so you can judge whether an average fits the job you are planning.

Recording site work in the Task Log

The **Task Log** is where you record daily site work: items of work, labour, hours and outputs. One row is one gang, on one item of work, for one day.

Add a task

1. Click **Task Log** in the side menu.
2. Click **Add Task**. The **Add Task** window opens with today's date already filled in.
3. Type the **Item of Work**, for example "Blockwork 225mm".
4. Pick the **Trade** from the list, for example "Blockwork / Masonry / Bricklaying".
5. Enter the number of **Skilled Labour** and **Unskilled Labour** on this item for the day.
6. Enter the **Hours Worked** and the **Break Hours**. **Net Hours (auto)** fills itself in: hours worked minus breaks.
7. Type the **Equipment Used**, for example "Mixer", if any.
8. Enter the **Output** the gang produced and its **Output Unit**, for example 18 and m2.
9. Check the **Start Date** and **End Date**.
10. Click **Save Task**.

The new row appears in the table straight away and is saved on this computer.

IMPORTANT

The Item of Work must be typed exactly the same way every time. Time Pro groups your records by this text. "Blockwork 225mm" and "225 blockwork" become two separate items, each with half the history. If you work in a team, agree the item names before anyone starts recording.

TIP

Keep the output unit the same as the unit in your bill. If your bill measures blockwork in m2, record the output in m2, or the forecast will be wrong by the conversion.

What each field is for

Field	What to enter
Item of Work	The work being done. This is the field that drives all the averages
Trade	The trade, chosen from the list. It is for your reference and does not change the arithmetic
Skilled Labour / Unskilled Labour	How many of each worked on this item that day. Count the gang, not the whole site
Hours Worked	Hours on the item for the day
Break Hours	Hours not worked out of those. Cannot be more than the hours worked
Net Hours (auto)	Worked out for you. You cannot type into it
Equipment Used	The plant used, such as a mixer, vibrator or hoist
Output / Output Unit	What the gang actually produced, and in what unit
Start Date / End Date	The days this record covers. The end date cannot be before the start date

IMPORTANT

Time Pro treats each row as one day's output when it works out **Avg Output / Day**. Record one row per gang per day. If you put a whole week's output into one row, that item's daily output will look far higher than it really is.

The Task Log table

The table shows your records with these columns: **ID, Item of Work, Trade, Skilled, Unskilled, Hours, Break, Net, Equipment, Output, Unit, Start** and **End**. Time Pro numbers the **ID** for you. The table is for reading only: to change a record, use **Edit Selected**.

Edit a task

1. Click the row you want to change.
2. Click **Edit Selected**. The **Edit Task** window opens with the record filled in.
3. Make your changes.
4. Click **Save Changes**.

The Duration Summary updates on its own. There is nothing to recalculate by hand.

Delete a task

1. Click the row you want to remove.
2. Click **Delete Selected**.

IMPORTANT

Delete Selected removes the row at once. Time Pro does not ask you to confirm and there is no undo. Check you have the right row selected first.

If Save will not work

If the save button stays greyed out, or you see **Please fill Item of Work, check dates, and confirm hours/break values.**, check that:

- the **Item of Work** is not empty;
- the **End Date** is not before the **Start Date**;
- **Break Hours** is not more than **Hours Worked**;
- no number is negative.

Turning records into durations: the Duration Summary

The **Duration Summary** turns your site records into durations from your BOQ quantities. It shows one row per item of work. The averages come from your Task Log. Three columns are yours to type in: **BOQ Qty (Requested)**, **Planned Duration (days)** and **Weather Scenario**. Everything else is worked out for you.

Get a duration from a BOQ quantity

1. Click **Duration Summary** in the side menu.
2. Find the item of work.
3. Click the cell that says **Click to enter BOQ Qty...** in the **BOQ Qty (Requested)** column.
4. Type the quantity from your bill, for example the measured quantity from [QUIV for Revit](#), and press .

Expected Duration (days) fills in at once, and **Planned Duration (days)** starts at the same figure. **Required Skilled / Day** and **Required Unskilled / Day** show the crew needed.

Squeeze or stretch the programme

If the client needs the work finished sooner, or you can only put a small gang on it:

1. Click the **Planned Duration (days)** cell for that item.
2. Type the number of days you want and press .

Required Skilled / Day and **Required Unskilled / Day** change to the crew needed to finish in that time.

Weather Scenario

Weather Scenario starts with the **Predominant Weather** for that item. Overwrite it with a short note of the conditions you are planning for, such as "Rainy season". It is a note only and does not change any figure.

What each column means

Column	How it is worked out
SN	Row number
Item of Work	One row for each distinct item in your Task Log
BOQ Qty (Requested)	You type it: the quantity from your bill
Expected Duration (days)	BOQ Qty divided by Avg Output / Day. How long the work takes at the rate you have really been achieving

Column	How it is worked out
Planned Duration (days)	You can change it. Starts equal to the expected duration
Required Skilled / Day	Skilled workers per day needed to finish in the planned duration, rounded up to whole people
Required Unskilled / Day	The same for unskilled workers
Weather Scenario	You can type here. A note of the conditions you are assuming
Avg Output / Day	The average output across your Task Log rows for this item
Avg Net Hrs / Day	Average hours actually worked, after breaks
Avg Skilled / Day / Avg Unskilled / Day	The average crew that produced that output
Predominant Weather	The weather recorded most often against this item

The arithmetic, with an example

Time Pro keeps the total effort the same and spreads it over the number of days you ask for:

- Expected duration = BOQ quantity ÷ average output per day
- Skilled man-days = average skilled per day × expected duration
- Required skilled per day = skilled man-days ÷ planned duration, rounded up

Say your records for "Blockwork 225mm" average 18 m2 a day from 3 skilled and 2 unskilled workers, and the bill says 540 m2.

- Expected duration: $540 \div 18 = 30$ days.
- Effort: $3 \times 30 = 90$ skilled man-days, and $2 \times 30 = 60$ unskilled man-days.
- Set **Planned Duration (days)** to 20, and the crew becomes 5 skilled ($90 \div 20 = 4.5$, rounded up) and 3 unskilled ($60 \div 20 = 3$).

NOTE

Halving the duration roughly doubles the crew. Time Pro does not know the point where a gang starts getting in its own way on a small workface. That judgement stays with you. A planned duration far below the expected one is a risk worth flagging.

Enter quantities and export in one sitting

IMPORTANT

In version 1.1.1, Time Pro does not keep the figures you type on the Duration Summary. **BOQ Qty (Requested)**, **Planned Duration (days)** and **Weather Scenario** clear when you leave the Duration Summary for another screen, when you add, edit or delete a task, and when you close Time Pro. Enter your quantities, then export to Excel or Microsoft Project before you move away. Keep your bill quantities handy (for example in your BOQ spreadsheet) so you can type them in again.

Exporting your work

Two buttons sit at the top right of the **Duration Summary**: **Excel** and **MS Project**.

Export to Excel

The Excel export is your record and your evidence. Use it when someone asks where a duration came from.

1. Open the **Duration Summary** and enter any BOQ quantities you want included.
2. Click **Excel**.
3. Choose where to save the file. Time Pro suggests a name such as `ADLM_Time_Export_20261001_0930.xlsx`.
4. Click save. You will see **Export complete**.

The workbook has two sheets:

Sheet	What is on it
Summary	One row per item of work: the averages, predominant weather, requested quantity, weather scenario, expected and planned durations and the required crews
DataInput	Every Task Log row exactly as recorded, including equipment, output, unit, dates and the weather attached to it

The sheets are set up to print neatly, with "Generated by ADLM Studios" and the print date in the page footer.

TIP

The Excel export is also the easiest way to keep a backup of your Task Log, or to send your records to a colleague.

Export to Microsoft Project

The **MS Project** button builds a programme file that Microsoft Project opens directly, with tasks, durations, links, resources and costs already in place.

The button only becomes active once at least one item has a BOQ quantity.

1. On the **Duration Summary**, enter a **BOQ Qty (Requested)** for each item you want in the programme.
2. Click **MS Project**. The **Export to MS Project** window opens.
3. Set the **Project Start Date**. It starts on today's date.
4. Choose the **Currency** your rates are in.
5. Under **Resource Rates (enter 0 to fill in MS Project later)**, type:
 - **Skilled Labour – Rate per person/hour**
 - **Unskilled Labour – Rate per person/hour**
 - **Equipment – Rate per use**
6. Click **Export**.
7. Choose where to save the file. Time Pro suggests a name such as `ADLM_Project_20261001_0930.xml`.
8. Click save. Time Pro tells you how many work items it exported.

NOTE

The file is a Microsoft Project XML file (.xml), not an .mpp file. Microsoft Project opens it from **File**, then **Open**. Once it is open, save it as an .mpp from inside Project if you want.

Currencies you can choose

Nigerian Naira, US Dollar, Pound Sterling, Euro, Ghanaian Cedi, Kenyan Shilling, South African Rand, West African CFA Franc, UAE Dirham, Saudi Riyal, Indian Rupee, Canadian Dollar and Australian Dollar. Time Pro starts on the currency of your Windows region and remembers the one you pick. The currency goes into the file, so Microsoft Project shows costs in the same money you typed.

Typing rates

You can type rates the way you normally write money, for example 1,500.00 or ₦1500 . Enter 0 for any rate you would rather fill in later inside Microsoft Project.

Which items are exported

An item goes into the programme only if it has both a BOQ quantity and a planned duration above zero.

- If an item has a quantity but no logged output history, its expected duration is 0. Time Pro names these items and either skips them (telling you how many it skipped) or, if nothing can be exported, shows **Nothing to Export**.
- To include such an item, either type a number of days into its **Planned Duration (days)**, or log some tasks for it in the Task Log first.
- Items with no BOQ quantity are left out.

Working with the programme in Microsoft Project

When you open the exported file in Microsoft Project, you get:

In Project	Where it comes from
A project summary task, "ADLM Project Summary"	Added by Time Pro
One task per exported item of work	The item's Planned Duration (days)
Tasks linked finish-to-start, in the order of the Duration Summary	Added by Time Pro, starting on your Project Start Date
Up to three resources per item, such as "Blockwork 225mm – Skilled Labour", "Blockwork 225mm – Unskilled Labour" and "Blockwork 225mm – Mixer"	Labour as hourly work resources, equipment as a per-use material resource
Resource assignments	The crew from Required Skilled / Day and Required Unskilled / Day
Costs	Your rates, in your chosen currency
Task notes	The BOQ quantity, expected and planned durations, average output, crew, equipment and predominant weather for each item
Calendar	A standard Monday to Friday calendar, 08:00 to 12:00 and 13:00 to 17:00 (8 hours a day)

From here, use Microsoft Project for everything Time Pro does not do:

- **Gantt chart:** the file opens in Project’s Gantt view.
- **Dependencies:** the finish-to-start chain is a starting point. Change or add links in Project where trades can overlap.
- **Rescheduling:** because the tasks are linked, moving the first task moves the whole programme.
- **Baselines and progress:** set a baseline and record progress in Project as usual.

TIP

If your quantities change, export again and rebuild the programme rather than patching the old one by hand. It keeps your Time Pro figures and your programme in step.

Your data

- Your Task Log is saved on this computer as you work, so closing Time Pro never loses a day’s records. It is still there the next time you sign in on this PC.
- Signing out does not delete your Task Log.
- The Duration Summary figures you type (quantities, planned durations, scenarios) are not saved. See “Enter quantities and export in one sitting” above.
- Excel and Microsoft Project files are snapshots. Changing them does not change Time Pro.

AI in Time Pro

Time Pro 1.1.1 has no AI features. Every figure it shows is arithmetic on your own Task Log, and nothing is sent to an AI service. For the AI features in other ADLM products, see [ADLM AI services](#).

How this relates to “Estimate the outputs” on ADLM Cloud

ADLM Cloud is gaining a web **Programme** for cloud projects, built on Time Pro’s idea: it divides each quantity on a project’s bill by a gang output per day and sequences the trades. Under **Where the time comes from**, an **Estimate the outputs** button asks ADLM AI to propose an output per trade from the wording of your bill lines. You then check and edit the **Output** column, or click **Estimate again**. It does not change your bill.

Keep in mind how it differs from Time Pro:

	Time Pro (desktop)	Estimate the outputs (web)
Where outputs come from	Your own site records in the Task Log	An AI estimate from the bill’s wording, which you edit
Uses AI	No	Yes, within your monthly AI allowance
Reads your Task Log	Yes	No. Time Pro’s records stay on your computer
Exports	Excel and Microsoft Project	On the web page

NOTE

At the time of writing, the web Programme with **Estimate the outputs** is part of ADLM Cloud's new workspace, which is still being opened up to customers. If your account opens the older programme page, you will not see the button yet. An estimated output is a starting point; an output measured on your own site, as Time Pro records it, is the stronger evidence.

Troubleshooting

"Your ADLM account does not have an active ADLM Time Pro subscription"

Your username and password are correct, but the account has no active Time Pro subscription. Click **Subscribe to ADLM Time Pro**, complete the purchase, then sign in again. If you have just paid, check your [dashboard](#) shows the subscription as active. If you bought it under a different email address, sign in with that one.

"Sign in failed. Please check your username/email and password."

Check the spelling of your email or username and your password. If you have forgotten your password, reset it on the website, then try again.

"Internet is required for your first sign-in."

Your PC is offline and you have never signed in to Time Pro on it before. Connect to the internet and sign in once. After that, Time Pro can work offline on this PC.

"No valid offline licence was found. Connect to the internet and sign in again."

You are offline and the licence saved on this PC has run out, or it belongs to another computer. Connect to the internet and sign in.

"Session expired. Please sign in again."

Time Pro keeps you signed in for about a day and a half. Sign in again. Your Task Log is still there.

Time Pro is not in my Installer Hub, or reads "Not on your plan"

The card only reads **Ready to install** once your subscription is active. If it reads **Not on your plan**, your account has no active Time Pro subscription: subscribe on the website, then click **Refresh** in the Hub. If you have just paid and it still does not change, sign out of the Hub and back in. If it still does not appear, contact [support](#).

Every Expected Duration shows 0

The item has no output recorded in the Task Log, or its rows have an output of 0. Log some tasks for that exact item of work, spelled exactly the same way. If you need to export it before you have records, type a number of days into **Planned Duration (days)**.

The same item appears twice in the Duration Summary

The item has been typed two different ways in the Task Log, for example with an extra space or different wording. Edit the rows so they all use the same text, and the two lines will merge into one.

My BOQ quantities disappeared

Time Pro clears the Duration Summary entries when you leave that screen, change the Task Log, or close the app. Type them in again and export before moving away.

The MS Project button is greyed out

No item has a BOQ quantity yet. Enter at least one quantity in **BOQ Qty (Requested)** and press .

"Nothing to Export"

Either no item has a BOQ quantity, or the items with a quantity have no duration because there are no logged tasks for them. Follow the message: enter quantities, or type a **Planned Duration (days)** for the items it lists.

Microsoft Project will not open the file

Make sure you are on version 1.1.1 (update through the Installer Hub). Earlier versions produced files that Project could reject. Open the file from **File**, then **Open** in Project, and choose XML files in the file type list if the file does not show.

Costs in Microsoft Project are zero

You left a rate at 0 in the export window. Either export again with your rates, or type the rates for each resource in Project's Resource Sheet.

"Search failed" or "No cities found" on the weather screen

Check your internet connection and the spelling of the town. Try a larger nearby town if a small one is not found.

The side menu only shows icons

The window is narrow, so the menu has shrunk to give the tables more room. Widen or maximise the window to bring the labels back.

I deleted a task by mistake

There is no undo. Add the task again with **Add Task**. If you exported to Excel recently, the **DataInput** sheet has the old values to copy from.

Frequently asked questions

Does Time Pro draw a Gantt chart?

No. Time Pro works out durations and crews from your site records. Export to Microsoft Project to get the Gantt chart, change links, set baselines and track progress.

Can I import a Microsoft Project file into Time Pro?

No. Time Pro exports to Microsoft Project but does not open or import Project files.

Can I export to PDF?

Time Pro does not export PDF directly. Export to Excel and use Excel's print or Save as PDF, or print from Microsoft Project after exporting there. The Excel sheets are already set up to print.

Do I need internet all the time?

No. You need it for your first sign-in and to fetch weather. After that you can record tasks on site without a connection, on the PC where you signed in.

Can I use Time Pro on two computers?

Your licence is tied to one computer. To move it, contact [support](#) to release it from the old PC.

Where does my Task Log live?

On the computer you use Time Pro on, in your Windows user profile. If two people share one Windows login on the same PC, they share one Task Log. Export to Excel regularly to keep a copy.

How many days of records do I need?

There is no minimum, but more is better. A week of daily records on a live site is enough to start forecasting that trade. Records from different weather and different gangs make the average more reliable.

Does the weather change my durations?

No. Time Pro records the weather so you can see it, but applies no adjustment. Use the **Weather Scenario** column to note what conditions your forecast assumes.

Where do my BOQ quantities come from?

From your bill. You can measure them with [QUIV for Revit](#) or another ADLM takeoff tool, or take them from any bill of quantities, and type them into **BOQ Qty (Requested)**. Keep the unit the same as the unit you recorded output in.

Does Time Pro have keyboard shortcuts or a connection indicator?

Not in version 1.1.1. Those arrived in other ADLM products in September 2026 but have not been released for Time Pro.

Does Time Pro use AI?

No. See [AI in Time Pro](#) for how it relates to the AI output estimate on ADLM Cloud.

How much does Time Pro cost?

See the Time Pro page on adlmstudio.net for current monthly and yearly prices.

ADLM Cloud (overview)

Price, value, programme and share the projects you measure in QUIV, HERON, Revit MEP, CIVIQ and ArchiCAD, from any browser.

ADLM Cloud is the web side of your ADLM products. When you save a take-off to the cloud from QUIV, HERON, Revit MEP or CIVIQ, the project appears on adlmstudio.net. There you price the bill with your Rate Gen rates, plan the purchases, value the work done, issue interim certificates, run the programme, export an ICMS 3 cost and carbon report and share progress with your client. You can do all of this from any computer or phone, without Revit or PlanSwift installed.

This guide covers ADLM Cloud as it is on the live site on 4 October 2026, after the new website design went live on 1 October.

What's new in 2026.10

October 2026

- **The new website design is live.** Signing in now takes you to your **Overview** ([/manage](#)), and every signed-in page has the same menu down the left side. The old [/dashboard](#) address opens the Overview too.
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon report.** The project **Export** menu has a new **ICMS 3** group. **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)** gives cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, and **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)** gives the same report as data in the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3 format. It works on learning samples too. See [Exports and reports](#).
- **Price a sample with your own rates.** An open learning sample has **Price with my RateGen rates**, which shows the bill re-priced with your own Rate Gen rates, line by line. Nothing is saved.
- **Carbon on sample cards.** Each learning sample card shows its **Carbon footprint** in tCO2e and how much of the bill's cost that figure covers.
- **Rates are built in ADLM Rate Gen only.** The website shows your rate library and lets you pick a Rate Gen rate onto a bill or budget line, or type a price on a bill line. Building, editing or deleting a rate, and changing library prices, are done in the Rate Gen desktop app. See [ADLM Rate Gen](#).
- **QUIV budgets are priced for you.** When QUIV 4 saves a project, the cloud prices the material and labour schedule from your Rate Gen library and your constants, if your account has Rate Gen. Prices you set on the website are never changed.
- **Constants agree across products.** Pipe stock length 6 m, POP board 1.44 m², emulsion paint 0.026 drum per m², blockwork waste 1.03, tile waste 1.10, and rebar weight d²/162. See [Material and Services Constants](#).
- **Certificates state their period.** **Issue certificate** now asks for **Period from**, **Period to**, **Release retention** and **Notes on this certificate**.
- **Ada can price and report.** Ask Ada to price your unpriced lines and she shows a **Proposed rates** card for you to tick and apply. Ask for a report for a date range and she shows a **Project report** card with **Open the report**.
- **Payment documents agree.** The interim certificate and the printed Interim Payment Application now use the same figure for re-measured lines, and **Less previous payments** shows the net figure everywhere.

September 2026

- Picking a Rate Gen rate on the bill prices the line's material, labour and plant in the Budget at the same time.
- Learning samples for QUIV, HERON, Revit MEP and CIVIQ.
- New project screens: a **Views** list you can hide, and the **Work area**, which joins the model, the bill, the schedule and Ada.
- Projects reopen on the view you were last using.
- **Certificates, Variations and Final account** together under **Contract administration**.
- A redesigned buy schedule, a **Summary** box on the bill with **Mark as tendered**, and re-saving from a plugin no longer wipes your website rates and notes.

The ADLM Cloud guides

The Cloud guide comes in five parts. Read them in order the first time, or jump to the one you need.

Guide	What it covers
Projects and your workspace	The menu, your project lists, samples, the project screen, the 3D model and the Work area.
The bill and the budget	Pricing the bill with Rate Gen rates, the Budget and buy schedule, constants, and every export including ICMS 3.
Valuations and contract administration	Valuing work done, interim certificates, variations, the final account and the contract lock.
Programme and project management	The PM Dashboard, the PM Tracker, the Portfolio dashboard and the programme page.
Sharing, team and Ada	Client dashboard links, collaborators, who sees money, and Ada.

To learn on real data first, open a learning sample: see [Sample projects](#).

Before you start

- **An ADLM account.** The same email and password you use in the desktop products. See [Getting started](#).
- **A licence for the product the project came from.** A QUIV project needs QUIV, a HERON project needs HERON, and so on.
- **A Rate Gen licence (recommended).** Without one you can still open and value a project, but you cannot pick rates from your Rate Gen library, the cloud does not price your QUIV budgets, and on projects shared with you the rates and money stay hidden.
- **A browser.** Any up-to-date browser on a computer, tablet or phone. The 3D model needs WebGL, which every modern desktop browser has.

How ADLM Cloud fits together

1. **Measure** in a desktop product: QUIV or Revit MEP in Revit, HERON in PlanSwift, CIVIQ in Civil 3D.
2. **Save to ADLM Cloud** from the plugin. Each save makes a new version of the project.

3. Open the project on adlmstudio.net from **My tools** or **Projects** in the menu.
4. Price the bill with your Rate Gen rates, check the Budget, and export.
5. Run the job: lock the contract, record progress, issue certificates, decide variations and follow the programme.
6. Share a read-only dashboard with your client, or invite colleagues to work on the project.

Signing in takes you to your **Overview**: your products, anything that needs your attention, the Installer Hub and recent activity.

ADLM Studio Overview

Good evening, Tunde

Adeyemi & Partners — everything the practice is licensed for, and the three things worth your attention this week.

Sunday, 4 October 2026

Products active: 3 (QUIV, RateGen, HERON)

Seats in use: 3 of 5 (Two seats sitting idle)

Next charge: ₦137,600 (Monthly - 7 September 2026)

Courses running: 1 of 2 (One enrolment not started)

Your products

- QUIV** v3.1.7 · installed on 2 machines (CURRENT, 2 of 2 seats, Manage)
- RateGen** v2.5.0 · library synced 2 hours ago (CURRENT, 1 of 2 seats, Manage)
- HERON** v2.9.0 installed · v2.9.1 available (UPDATE, 0 of 1 seat, Update)

Needs your attention (4 items)

- HERON v2.9.1 is waiting to install** (Update): Sharper tracing on photographed sheets. The Hub will apply it to the one machine holding a HERON seat.
- A RateGen seat has been unassigned since 28 July** (Assign)

Installer Hub v1.0

The desktop app that installs and updates everything the practice owns. Sign in once and it keeps all five seats current.

[Download for Windows](#)

Windows 64-bit · 84 MB · released July 2026

Recent activity

- Certificate issued** — BIM for Building Works, Ifeoma Nwachukwu (2d)
- QUIV v3.1.7** installed on TUNDE-WS02 (3d)
- Seat assigned** — RateGen to Chidi Okafor (5d)
- Invoice paid** — ₦137,600 on card ending 4417 (7 Aug)

The account Overview you land on after signing in: your products, what needs your attention, the Installer Hub and recent activity.

AI in ADLM Cloud

ADLM Cloud has these AI features today. Each one proposes; you decide. Nothing writes to your bill without your confirmation. Full details are in [ADLM AI services](#).

Feature	Where	What it does	Availability
Ask Ada	The round button at the bottom corner of every page, and Ask Ada at the top of the menu	Answers about products, and, when you are signed in, about your own projects, bills, budgets, valuations and programme	On for everyone
Ada as estimator	Ask Ada, for example "Price my bill"	Proposes rates for unpriced lines from your own Rate Gen library, on a Proposed rates card; you tick lines and press Apply N rates	On for everyone, on projects you can edit

Feature	Where	What it does	Availability
Ada reports	Ask Ada, for example "a report for September"	A Project report card for a date range, with Open the report for the PDF	On for everyone
Check my rates against the market	A project's Work area	Benchmarks your priced lines against the Rate Gen library for your zone	On for everyone with an active licence
Scan the bill for errors	Work area	Finds duplicates, wrong units, odd quantities and rate outliers	On for everyone with an active licence
Build up a rate for the selected line	Work area	Builds one line's rate from material, labour and plant	On for everyone with an active licence
Estimate the outputs	The programme page (/work/programme)	Proposes a daily gang output per trade so quantities become durations	On for everyone

NOTE

The ICMS 3 report, the carbon figures and **Price with my RateGen rates** are not AI. They work from fixed rules, your Rate Gen rates and published carbon factors.

The AI checks draw on a monthly allowance (200 units at the time of writing): a market check costs 2 units, an error scan or a rate build-up 1, and the same check repeated within a week costs nothing. At the limit you see a plain message, and the rest of ADLM Cloud keeps working.

Troubleshooting

My project is not on the website

Check that the plugin's save finished, then open the product under **My tools** and click **Refresh projects**. Make sure the website and the plugin are signed in with the same account. See [Projects and your workspace](#).

Rates show as dashes

You are a collaborator on someone else's project and your account has no active Rate Gen licence. See [Sharing, team and Ada](#).

A menu item opened a different-looking page

Some menu items still open the older page that does the same job, for example **Projects** opens **All Projects** and **Billing & invoices** opens your **Profile**. The page you land on is the right one for that job.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need Revit or PlanSwift to use ADLM Cloud?

No. You need the plugin to measure and save a project. Once it is on the cloud you can price, value, programme and share it from any browser.

Can I build or edit a rate on the website?

No. Rates are built and edited only in the ADLM Rate Gen desktop app. On the website you can view your library, pick a Rate Gen rate onto a line, or type a price on a bill line.

Is the ICMS 3 report AI?

No. Each line is placed in an ICMS 3 Group by fixed rules, and its carbon comes from your Rate Gen rates and published carbon factors.

Where do I get help?

Ask Ada, chat with us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, or raise a ticket from **Support** in the menu. See [Getting started](#).

ADLM Cloud: projects and your workspace

Find your way around the ADLM Cloud, open your projects, and use the project dashboard, 3D model and work area.

This is one part of the [ADLM Cloud guide](#). It shows you how to find your way around the signed-in website, open a project and use its screens. It covers the live site on 4 October 2026.

What's new in 2026.10

- **One menu on every signed-in page.** Since 1 October the left-hand menu has three groups, **Work**, **Learn** and **Manage**, with **Ask Ada** at the top. Signing in takes you to your **Overview**.
- **Carbon footprint on sample cards.** Each learning sample card shows its upfront carbon (A1-A5) in tCO2e, and how much of the bill's cost that figure covers.
- **Price with my RateGen rates** on an open sample: see the sample's bill priced with your own Rate Gen rates, without saving anything.
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon export** on every project you can export, samples included. See [Exports](#).
- **QUIV budgets priced on save.** For accounts with Rate Gen, a QUIV 4 save arrives with its material and labour schedule already priced.

Before you start

What you need

- **An ADLM account.** Use the same email and password you use in the desktop products.
- **A licence for the product the project came from.** A QUIV project needs an active QUIV licence; a HERON project needs HERON, and so on. A project a colleague shares with you also needs the matching product licence.
- **A Rate Gen licence (optional but recommended).** Without one you can still see and value a project, but you cannot pick rates from your Rate Gen library, and on projects shared with you the rates stay hidden. See [ADLM Rate Gen](#).
- **A browser.** Any up-to-date browser. The 3D model needs WebGL, which every modern desktop browser has.

How a project gets here

You do not create projects on the website. A project starts in a desktop product:

Product	Where you measure	How it reaches the cloud
QUIV	Revit	Measure, then Save to ADLM Cloud
HERON	PlanSwift	Take off with HERON , then Save to ADLM Cloud

Product	Where you measure	How it reaches the cloud
Revit MEP (shown on the website as SERVIQ)	Revit	Extract, then Save to ADLM Cloud
CIVIQ	Civil 3D	Extract, then Save to ADLM Cloud

Every save from the plugin creates a new version of the project. Re-saving does not throw away the rates, purchase marks or supplier notes you added on the website.

NOTE

The steps for each plugin are in its own guide: [QUIV for Revit](#), [HERON](#) and [Revit MEP](#).

Finding your way around

The menu

Every signed-in page has a menu down the left side. On a phone, open it with the menu button at the top left. The search box at the top (**Search projects, rates and programmes**) jumps to a page by its name.

At the top of the menu is **Ask Ada (Your library, answered)**. Click it to open Ada, ADLM's assistant. See [Ada, your assistant](#).

Below it are three groups:

- **Work: Overview, My tools and Projects.**
- **Learn: My learning, Assignments, Certificates, Lessons & events and Guides & docs.**
- **Manage (marked Installer Hub): Overview, Products & seats, Team, Billing & invoices, Downloads and Support.**

Account settings and **Sign out** sit at the bottom. The Learn and Manage groups are covered in [Getting started](#).

What the Work items open

Menu item	Opens	Address
Overview	Your account Overview , the page you land on after signing in	<code>/manage</code>
My tools > QUIV	QUIV projects	<code>/projects/revit</code>
My tools > HERON	HERON projects	<code>/projects/planswift</code>
My tools > RateGen	Your Rate Gen library on the web	<code>/rategen</code>
My tools > Constants	Material Constants	<code>/rategen/material-constants</code>
My tools > SERVIQ	Revit MEP projects	<code>/projects/mep</code>
My tools > CIVIQ	CIVIQ projects	<code>/projects/civil3d</code>

Menu item	Opens	Address
Projects	All Projects , every project on your account	/portfolio

A tool you have no licence for is marked **Add**. Click it to see the product and buy it.

Your projects

All Projects

Click **Projects** in the menu to open **All Projects** ("Projects synced from your ADLM desktop plugins"). Projects are grouped by product. Each card shows the project name, the product, the number of items and when it was last updated. A card marked **Shared** has a public dashboard link turned on.

1. Find the project under its product.
2. Click the card. The project opens in that product's workspace.

If you have QUIV, a note at the top links to the **PM Tracker**. **Back to Dashboard** returns you to your Overview.

A product's project list

Click a tool under **My tools**, for example **QUIV**, to open that product's full project list:

Product	Page title	Address
QUIV	QUIV projects	/projects/revit
HERON	HERON projects	/projects/planswift
Revit MEP	Revit MEP projects	/projects/mep
CIVIQ	CIVIQ projects	/projects/civil3d

At the top are summary tiles: the combined value of the projects shown, **Completed to date** with the share of lines marked, and **Outstanding balance**.

Cloud Storage shows how many project slots you have used, for example "12 of 30 projects". Near the limit you see **Upgrade storage**. At the limit you see **Buy more storage**, and you must delete a project or buy more slots before you can save another. Extra slots are sold in blocks of ten.

The header buttons:

- **Refresh projects** reloads the list, for example straight after a save from the plugin.
- **Portfolio Dashboard** opens the roll-up of all your projects (see [Portfolio dashboard](#)).
- **PM Tracker · QUIV** (QUIV list only) opens the standalone [PM Tracker](#).
- **Add shared project** adds a project a colleague shared with you by code.

Selecting, merging and deleting

1. Click **Select** on each project card you want, or **Select all** for every project shown. **Clear** empties the selection.
2. Click **Delete selected** to delete them. You are asked to confirm, and this cannot be undone.
3. To delete one project, click **Delete** on its card. Only the owner sees this button.

Merge selected combines two or more projects into one, for example the architectural and structural models of one building, or several buildings on one job.

1. Select two or more projects.
2. Click **Merge selected**.
3. Answer the first question: click **OK** if they are separate buildings on one job (each gets its own sheet in the exported bill), or **Cancel** if they are disciplines of one structure.
4. Type a name for the merged project and confirm.

The originals are kept. Inside the merged project you can change the order of the buildings or disciplines with the up and down arrows.

Learning samples

Above your own projects you may see **Learning samples**: worked projects with every view filled in, so you can see a priced, valued and certified job before your own gets there. QUIV and HERON samples are worked duplex jobs, one per foundation type. Revit MEP samples cover the services for those duplexes, and CIVIQ samples are road jobs.

Each sample card shows its value, progress and certificates. New in October, a card can also show:

- **Carbon footprint**: the bill's upfront embodied carbon (A1-A5), in tonnes of CO2e, worked out from your own Rate Gen rates.
- **Covers**: how much of the bill's cost that carbon figure covers, for example "94% of cost". Hover over the figure to see the basis.

The carbon figure appears only when your account has a Rate Gen library to work it out from.

To use a sample:

1. Click a sample card. A banner reads **Sample project** and **Read-only learning material**.
2. Open **What to look at in this sample** for the things worth looking at.
3. Open any view, filter or export. Nothing can be changed.
4. Click **Hide samples** on the list to fold the strip away, or **Show N samples** to bring it back. This only hides them in this browser.

Samples appear for products you have an active licence for. More on samples is in [Sample projects](#).

Price a sample with your own Rate Gen rates

An open sample has a **Price with my RateGen rates** panel: "See this bill priced with your own RateGen rates for" your state. Nothing is saved.

1. Open a sample.
2. Click **Price with my rates**. The button reads **Pricing...** while it works.
3. Read the three tiles:
 - **Bill as priced (lines your rates cover)**: the sample's own total for the lines your library could price.
 - **With your RateGen rates**: the same lines at your rates, with the difference as a percentage.
 - **Lines priced**: how many lines your rates priced, for example "212 of 240", and the share of the bill's cost they make up.

4. Read the table: **Item**, **Qty**, **Unit**, **Bill rate**, **Your rate** and **From**. **From** says how each line was priced: **Same item**, **By the work** (matched by the work the line measures, marked **assumed** where it assumed something), **Services pricing** (SERVIQ lines) or **Not priced**.
5. Click **Show all N lines** to see every line. Click **Price again** after changing your rates in Rate Gen.

Lines no rate fits are listed as not priced rather than guessed. A CIVIQ sample tells you Rate Gen has no civil rates instead of pricing a road from building rates. The panel needs a Rate Gen licence.

Inside a project

The project screen

When you open a project, the bar at the top holds:

- **Projects**: back to the list.
- The contract status: **Draft (editable)** or **Contract locked**.
- **Copy project ID**: copies the ID used by **Open from Cloud** in the Windows plugins.
- **Collaborators**: invite colleagues (owner only).
- **Delete**: delete the project (owner only).
- **Project report**: preview and download a PDF progress report. On the PM Dashboard this button reads **PM report**.
- **Export (Workbooks)**: the Excel and ICMS 3 exports.
- **Save changes**: saves your rates, progress and settings. It reads **Saved** when there is nothing new to save.

IMPORTANT

Changes to rates, progress and valuation settings are not kept until you click **Save changes**. Save before you leave the page.

Down the side is **Views**, the project's screens in three groups. Click **Hide** to give the bill the full width, and **Views** to bring the list back. The project reopens on the view you last used.

Group	View	What it is for
Overview	Dashboard	Overview and progress
Commercial	Bill of Quantity	Rates and line items
Commercial	Budget	Cost plan & procurement
Commercial	Valuation	Certificates and settings
Delivery	Work area	Model, bill, schedule and Ada together
Delivery	3D Model	View & verify the BIM model
Delivery	PM Dashboard	Schedule, EVM, risks, issues

3D Model does not appear for HERON projects or for projects imported from an Excel bill, because they are measured from drawings rather than a model.

The Bill of Quantity and Budget are covered in [The bill and the budget](#). Valuation is in [Valuations and contract administration](#), and the PM Dashboard in [Programme and project management](#).

Dashboard

The Dashboard answers three questions: what is the job worth, how much is done, and what is left.

- **Estimated total:** measured work, sums, preliminaries, contingency, VAT and approved variations.
- **Completed to date:** completed items plus executed PC sums, preliminaries and variations.
- **Outstanding balance:** the estimated total less what has been earned.
- **Progress:** the share of the work done.

Progress overview counts completed, remaining and total work items. If you record actual quantities or rates, **Actual vs planned performance** compares them with the plan. Switch the chart between **Donut**, **Bars** and **Trend**.

On QUIV and HERON projects, **Linked Services & Works** lets you link another project, such as the Revit MEP services for the same building, so the **Linked total** shows the whole job.

1. Click + **Link a project**.
2. Choose it from **Select a project...**
3. Click **Link**. **Unlink** removes it later.

On Revit MEP projects, **Price services from RateGen** prices the services bill from your Rate Gen library. Click **Price services**. The lengths, joints and fittings it allows for come from your Services Constants (see [Material and Services Constants](#)).

The **Share dashboard** button on this view creates a public link for your client. See [Sharing a dashboard with your client](#).

3D Model

The 3D Model view opens the attached model in your browser.

1. Pick the discipline (**Architectural** or **Structural**).
2. Click a line in the **Bill of Quantity** panel to light up its elements in the model, or click an element to find the lines it was measured for.
3. **Material breakdown** shows the material lines behind the selection.
4. Click **Clear highlight** to start again.

The model is attached automatically when you save from QUIV. See **BIM models** in [Valuations and contract administration](#).

Work area

The Work area puts the model, the priced bill (**Bill of Quantities**) and the **Construction schedule** on one screen, with Ada beside them.

1. Click **Work area** in **Views**.
2. Pick a bill line: its elements light up and the tasks that build it are marked.
3. Pick a task: the lines it builds light up.
4. Click an element: the lines and tasks behind it are found.

Use **Filter bill lines** and **Filter tasks** to narrow the lists. With nothing picked, the screen says "Pick a bill line, a task or an element to see how they join up."

The **Ada** panel reads **Answering from your project**. It has an **Ask about this project** box and these buttons:

Button	What it does	AI?
Check duration, time, cost & material	A health check worked out on the page: schedule against the project finish, actual cost, material	No
Check my rates against the market (or Check N selected line(s))	Compares your priced lines with the Rate Gen library for your zone	Yes
Scan the bill for errors	Duplicates, wrong units, implausible quantities, rate outliers	Yes
Build up a rate for the selected line	One line's rate from material, labour and plant	Yes
What is this project worth?	Asks Ada for the value and work done	Yes

After the health check, **Ask Ada to explain** asks her to talk you through it. The panel reminds you: "Ada only uses items that exist in this account. She proposes; you decide."

To run a market check:

1. Tick lines in **Bill of Quantities** to check only those, or tick nothing to check them all.
2. Click **Check my rates against the market**.
3. Read the answer in the Ada panel. Each line gets a chip in the **Check** column: above market, below market, in range or unit mismatch.

No rate is ever changed by a check. To use a better rate, pick it from your Rate Gen library on the bill.

Exports from the project screen

Click **Export** in the top bar. The groups are **Bill & Budget**, **Generic BoQ**, **Elemental BoQ**, **Trade BoQ**, **Milestone BoQ** and **ICMS 3** ("international cost and carbon report"). Each is described in [Exports and reports](#).

The ICMS 3 group has two exports:

- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**: cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, with every line's code, where its carbon came from, and the lines not yet placed.
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)**: the same report as data, with full ICMS 3 codes, in the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3 format.

The export menu is on every project you can export, including learning samples. Collaborators with **View only** access, and collaborators without Rate Gen on priced exports, cannot download.

AI in this part of ADLM Cloud

- **Work area checks**: market check, error scan and rate build-up, as above. On for everyone with an active licence. Each draws on your monthly AI allowance.
- **Ada**: ask about any of your projects from **Ask Ada**. Signed in, she reads only your own account. On a sample, **Ask about this project** in the Work area can comment on the lines you selected, but cannot read the rest of the sample.

See [ADLM AI services](#) for how each feature works and what it costs.

Troubleshooting

My project is not on the website

Check that the plugin's save finished; the plugin confirms when a project is saved to the cloud. Then click **Refresh projects** on the product's list. Make sure you are signed in to the website with the same account as the plugin. If the plugin started offline, sign out and back in with a connection, then save again.

I cannot save another project: storage is full

The **Cloud Storage** bar shows you are at your limit. Delete projects you no longer need, or click **Buy more storage** to add slots in blocks of ten.

My changes disappeared

Rates, progress and settings are only kept when you click **Save changes**. Make your edits again and save before leaving the project.

The sample card shows no carbon footprint

The figure is worked out from your own Rate Gen rates. Without a Rate Gen library on your account, the card leaves it out.

Price with my rates says nothing could be priced

Your library has no rate for that kind of work in your state, or the sample is a CIVIQ road job, which Rate Gen does not price. Check your state under **Pricing location (State)** on your Profile.

Frequently asked questions

Do I need Revit or PlanSwift to use ADLM Cloud?

No. You need the plugin to measure and save a project, but once it is on the cloud you can price, value, programme and share it from any browser.

Can I delete a sample project?

No. Samples are read-only and cannot be deleted. Click **Hide samples** to fold them away.

Does Price with my rates change the sample?

No. Nothing is saved. It only shows what your rates would make of that bill.

Why is the 3D Model view missing?

HERON projects and Excel imports are measured from 2D drawings or a spreadsheet, so they have no model to show.

Where do I get help?

Ask Ada, chat with us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, or raise a ticket from **Support** in the menu.

ADLM Cloud: the bill and the budget

Price the Bill of Quantity, pick Rate Gen rates, plan materials and labour in the Budget, and export reports.

This is one part of the [ADLM Cloud guide](#). It covers pricing a project's Bill of Quantity, the Budget (material and labour), your constants, and every export, including the new ICMS 3 cost and carbon report. It describes the live site on 4 October 2026.

What's new in 2026.10

- **Rates are built in ADLM Rate Gen only.** On the website you pick a Rate Gen rate onto a bill line or a Budget row, or type a price on a bill line. You cannot build, edit or delete a rate on the website, or change library prices. Do that in the Rate Gen desktop app; see [ADLM Rate Gen](#).
- **ICMS 3 cost and carbon export**, in Excel and as JSON data, on the **Export** menu. See [The ICMS 3 cost and carbon report](#).
- **QUIV budgets are priced on save.** QUIV 4 sends its material and labour schedule as quantities. If your account has Rate Gen, the cloud adds the prices when the project is saved.
- **Constants agree across products.** Pipe stock length 6 m, POP board 1.44 m², emulsion paint 0.026 drum per m², blockwork waste 1.03, tile waste 1.10 and rebar weight d²/162.

Before you start

- Open the project: see [Projects and your workspace](#).
- To pick rates you need an active **Rate Gen** licence and a Rate Gen library. Your library uses the zone of the state you chose under **Pricing location (State)** on your Profile.
- To change anything you must own the project or have **Full access**, and the contract must not be locked for the change you want to make.

The Bill of Quantity

The bill lists every measured line with its quantity, unit and rate. Above it are the totals (**Measured, PC, Variations, Project total**) and a ribbon of bill tools. Click **Hide tools** or **Show tools** to fold the ribbon.

The ribbon has six tabs:

Tab	What is on it
Home	Only fill empty rates, Show actual qty / rate, and grouping By element or By trade
Rates	Rate Gen tools: Auto-sync rates , Sync rates , Follow RateGen changes and Load RateGen rates
Navigate	Jump to a category or trade, and Top / Bottom of the bill
Contract	Lock contract or Unlock , Preliminaries % and the contract sum
Variations	Add variation , Go to list and Approve / reject
Provisional	Add PC sum , Add provisional sum and Go to Summary

To find a line, type in **Search items (description / group / S/N)...**

Grouping. Group the bill by building element (Substructure, Superstructure and so on) or by trade (Concrete Works, Formwork, Masonry and so on). To move a line to another group, drag it onto that category, or change its **Category:** or **Trade:**. ADLM remembers the change for next time. Use **+ New category** to add your own.

Rows. You can move a row up or down, or drag it into a new place. **Delete row (you'll be able to undo)** removes a line; the undo bar lets you bring it back.

Summary. The **Summary** box at the foot of the bill adds up measured work, **Preliminaries**, **PC sums**, **Provisional sums**, **Contingency**, **Approved variations** and **VAT** to an **Estimated total**. Contingency and VAT are percentages you can change there. When the priced bill goes out, click **Mark as tendered** so the project shows at the Tendered stage. **Not tendered after all** reverses it.

Preliminaries. **Preliminaries %** on the **Contract** tab sets the preliminaries as a percentage of measured work plus the sums (typically 5 to 10%). Under the bill, the preliminary items checklist shares that pool between items: set each **Alloc %**, record **Actual N** and tick **Done** as each item is executed. **Even split** shares the pool equally.

PC and provisional sums. On the **Provisional** tab, **Add PC sum** adds a prime-cost sum for a nominated supplier or subcontractor, and **Add provisional sum** adds an allowance for work not yet defined. Tick each one once it has been executed, so it counts towards earned value.

Pricing the bill with Rate Gen rates

Rates come from your Rate Gen library: the ADLM master rates for your zone, plus the prices and custom rates you set in the Rate Gen desktop app. On the website you choose which rate goes on a line. You do not build rates here.

Pick a rate for one line

1. Click the line's **Rate** cell.
2. Type part of the rate's name, for example "blockwork 225". Your Rate Gen library is searched (this needs a Rate Gen licence).
3. Pick a rate from the list.

When you pick a Rate Gen rate on the bill, ADLM prices that line's material, labour and plant in the Budget at the same time. The budget build-up reproduces the rate you picked, so the bill and the budget agree. If the rate has no build-up, the rate still goes on the line and a message tells you why the budget could not be priced.

Type a price instead

You can also put your own figure on a bill line:

- **Type a number** for the rate.
- **Type a formula** starting with **=**, for example **=1.2*1.5*95000**. Only numbers and **+ - * / () %** are allowed. Press **Enter** or click away to apply it.

A price you type stays on this project's line only. It does not change your Rate Gen library.

Rates you type or pick stay fixed on the line. To let the budget set the rate again, clear the cell. The line then says the rate has been released and will be priced from the budget build-up when you save.

Fill many lines at once

On the **Rates** tab:

1. Click **Load RateGen rates** so searches are fast.
2. Tick **Only fill empty rates** on the **Home** tab if you want lines you have already priced left alone.
3. Click **Sync rates** to fill rates from your library.

Follow RateGen changes: while this is on, a rate you change in your Rate Gen library (in the desktop app) is applied to this bill too. Turn it off before the bill goes out, so the prices stay as issued.

TIP

To price many similar lines at once, link them. A line marked "Linked: rate changes propagate to similar items" passes its rate on to the others.

TIP

Ada can propose rates for every unpriced line from your own library. See [AI in the bill and budget](#).

Your rate library on the web

Click **RateGen** under **My tools** to see your Rate Gen library on the web ([/rategen](#)). Its tabs are **Master Materials**, **Master Labour**, **My Materials**, **My Labour**, **My Custom Rates** and **Effective Rates**. Use it to look up a price or a rate before you pick it on a bill.

IMPORTANT

The library on the website is for viewing. To build a new rate, change a build-up, change a material or labour price, or delete a rate, open the ADLM Rate Gen desktop app. Your changes reach the website when Rate Gen syncs.

The Budget

The Budget is the **Material & Labour breakdown** of every bill item, laid out in the same order and sections as the bill. For each bill item:

Bill Rate = Material + Labour + O&P

Each row is a resource: **Material**, **Labour**, **Plant**, **Equipment** or **Consumable**.

1. Price a row by typing a rate, entering a **=** formula, or searching your Rate Gen library in the rate cell.
2. Set Overhead and Profit for the item, or use **Global Overhead & Profit** and click **Apply to all** to write the same figures onto every item.
3. Click **Save changes**. The new bill rate flows up to the Bill of Quantity.

QUIV budgets priced for you

QUIV 4 measures the material and labour schedule from your Revit model and sends it as quantities, with no prices. When the project is saved and your account has Rate Gen, the cloud prices it:

- A material row with no price gets one from your Rate Gen library, or the ADLM master list where your library has none.

- A labour row with no price gets one from your **Labour Rates** constants, on its bill line's own quantity and unit.
- A bill line priced this way with no overhead or profit gets your **Markup** constants (10% overhead and 25% profit unless you change them), so its bill rate is a selling rate.

A row that already has a price, typed on the website or kept from an earlier save, is never changed. Without Rate Gen, the budget stays as quantities only. This applies to QUIV projects; HERON budgets are unchanged.

Marking purchases

A bill item only counts as complete when every line under it is marked procured or done. Buying the materials is not enough until the labour is done too.

- Tick a line to mark it procured.
- Use **Mark all** for a whole bill item, or **Unmark all** to undo.

Buy schedule

Switch from **Breakdown** to **Buy schedule** to see what to buy and when:

- **Should already be bought:** late purchases.
- **Buy this week:** what is due now.
- **Not yet scheduled:** materials for work with no dates yet.
- **Lead time:** how many days before work starts each material should be bought (14 days unless you change it).

The buy schedule takes its dates from the tasks on the PM Dashboard, so plan the programme first.

NOTE

Once the contract is locked, procurement marking on the Budget is frozen. Bill items you mark complete on the Bill of Quantity still show as done here.

Material and Services Constants

Material Constants

Material Constants are the factors behind every material and labour schedule, such as how many bags of cement go into a cubic metre of concrete or how many blocks into a square metre. They are the same constants QUIV and HERON use on the desktop. Open them from **Constants** under **My tools** (</rategen/material-constants>).

1. Find a constant with **Search constants...**, or open a group: **Waste Factors, Concrete, Blinding, Blockwork, Formwork, Reinforcement, Structural Steel, Coverage, Finishes, Ceiling & Roof, Filling, Measurement, Labour Rates, Lumpsum Items, MEP – Cost Split, Plant and Markup.**
2. Change its **Value**. The **ADLM default** column shows the starting figure.
3. Click **Save changes**. **Reset** on a row, or **Reset all to defaults**, puts the ADLM figures back.

New schedules use your constants straight away. An existing project keeps its figures until its schedule is rebuilt.

Constants that now agree across ADLM products (October 2026):

Constant	ADLM default	Which means
Pipe stock length	6 m/length	One pipe length is 6 m
POP ceiling board coverage	1.44 m ² /board	One POP board covers 1.44 m ²
Emulsion paint (20L drum)	0.026 drums/m ²	0.52 litres per m ²
Blockwork waste factor	1.03	3% waste on blocks
Tiles per area	1.1 m ² /m ²	10% waste on tiles
Rebar unit weight coefficient	0.00617 kg/m/mm ²	Rebar weight per metre is d ² /162

NOTE

HERON keeps a 1.10 waste factor on rebar and formwork on purpose, so a HERON budget can show slightly more of both than a QUIV one for the same work.

Services Constants

Services Constants (/rategen/services-constants) are your house standards for pricing MEP services: the standard length (**Std length**), how connectors are counted (**Per stick** or **Per joint (sticks – 1)**) and the **Fitting uplift %**. They feed **Price services** on Revit MEP projects.

1. Choose **Metric** or **Imperial**.
2. Edit the rows.
3. Click **Save constants**.

Exports and reports

Excel workbooks

Click **Export** in a project's top bar and choose:

Group	Options
Bill & Budget	Export bill & budget workbook: your bill with its own sections and totals, plus separate Material, Labour and Plant schedules, a Schedule of Current Prices and a Material Summary. Export bill & budget (by trade): the same, sectioned by trade.
Generic BoQ	Export generic BoQ (by category) and Export generic BoQ (by trade)
Elemental BoQ	Bungalow or Multi-storey , grouped by building element
Trade BoQ	Bungalow (Trade format) or Multi-storey (Trade format) , one bill per work section
Milestone BoQ	Bungalow (Milestone format) or Multi-storey (Milestone format) , one priceable bill per construction stage, as the basis for a payment schedule
ICMS 3	ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel) and ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)

The ICMS 3 cost and carbon report

ICMS 3 is the International Cost Management Standard. It lets a client compare your project's cost and carbon with other projects anywhere, because every line sits in the same standard Groups. ADLM builds the report from your bill.

1. Open the project and click **Export**.
2. Under **ICMS 3** ("international cost and carbon report"), click **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**.
3. Open the downloaded file, named after the project with "ICMS 3" on the end.

The workbook has five sheets:

Sheet	What it shows
ICMS 3 report	The project details, each marked Stated or Assumed , the carbon method, how much of the cost has a carbon figure behind it, and how much is placed in an ICMS Group
Cost by Group (G-2)	Cost by ICMS 3 Group with the share of the total, and cost per m ² when a floor area is known
Carbon by Group (H-1, H-2)	Upfront carbon (A1-A5) by Group in tCO ₂ e, with a low-end figure, and kgCO ₂ e per m ² when a floor area is known
Lines	Every bill line with its ICMS code, Sub-Group, quantity, rate, cost, kgCO ₂ e, where its carbon came from, anything assumed, and why it was placed where it is
Not placed	Lines not yet placed in an ICMS Group, largest first, with the reason

How the figures are worked out:

- **The report total equals your contract total.** Preliminaries go in Group 08, contingency in 09.020 and VAT in 10.020, so nothing in the bill is left out.
- **Carbon per line comes from your Rate Gen rates.** Every built-up rate in Rate Gen carries a carbon figure (kgCO₂e). Where a line has no matching rate, its carbon is worked out from the work it measures, and the **Lines** sheet says what was assumed.
- **Cost and carbon per m²** appear when the project has an IPMS 1 (gross external) or IPMS 2 (gross internal) floor area recorded. Without one, those columns stay empty.
- Details the bill does not carry, such as the country (Nigeria), currency (NGN) and base date (the day you export), are filled in and marked **Assumed** on the first sheet.

ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON) gives the same report as data, with full ICMS 3 codes. It conforms to the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3, so a client's cost database can read it directly.

TIP

The ICMS 3 export works on learning samples too. Export one from a sample to see a finished report before you send your own.

NOTE

The ICMS 3 report is not AI. Lines are placed by fixed rules, and carbon comes from your Rate Gen rates and published carbon factors.

PDF reports

- **Project report:** the Project Progress Report for the open project.
- **PM report:** the Project Management Report (schedule and earned value), from the PM Dashboard.
- **Management report:** across all your projects, from the Portfolio Dashboard.

Each opens a preview first. Click **Download PDF** to save it. A report Ada opens for a date range adds a **This Period** page: work valued, certified, procured, actual against planned, and what happened on the programme in that window.

Valuations and certificates

Print valuation and **Export Excel** in the daily valuation log, the certificate downloads in **Certificates**, and the final account **Download** are described in [Valuations and contract administration](#).

AI in the bill and the budget

Feature	Where	What it does	Availability
Ada prices your bill	Ask Ada: "Price my bill"	Proposes a rate for every unpriced line from your own Rate Gen library, unit as a hard rule, rates you chose before first. You tick lines on the Proposed rates card and press Apply N rates	On for everyone, on projects you can edit and whose rates you can see
Check my rates against the market	Work area	Benchmarks priced lines against the Rate Gen library for your zone: above market, below market, in range or unit mismatch	On for everyone with an active licence
Scan the bill for errors	Work area	Duplicates, wrong units, odd quantities, rate outliers	On for everyone with an active licence
Build up a rate for the selected line	Work area	One line's rate from material, labour and plant, each part marked as looked up or estimated	On for everyone with an active licence

None of these changes a rate by itself, and none of them builds a rate in your library. See [ADLM AI services](#).

Troubleshooting

I cannot change rates or delete lines

The contract is probably locked: the top bar says **Contract locked**. Raise a variation instead, or unlock the contract from the **Contract** tab on the bill ribbon. If the project is shared with you at **View only**, you cannot edit it at all; ask the owner for **Full access**.

I cannot find a button to build or edit a rate

There is none on the website. Rates are built and edited only in the ADLM Rate Gen desktop app. On the website, pick a Rate Gen rate onto the line, or type a price on the bill line.

The budget says "Re-save this project from the plugin"

The project was saved before the material and labour breakdown was sent. Open it in the plugin and save it to the cloud again.

Picking a rate did not price the Budget

The rate has no build-up in Rate Gen, it is no longer in your library, the line has no quantity, or you only have view access. The message under the line says which. The rate still goes on the line; price the Budget rows yourself, or choose a rate that has a build-up.

My QUIV budget has quantities but no prices

Your account has no active Rate Gen licence, or the project was saved before your library had prices for those materials. Price the rows yourself, or get Rate Gen and save from QUIV again.

The ICMS 3 report has no cost per m²

The project has no IPMS 1 or IPMS 2 floor area recorded, so per-m² figures are left out.

Most of my bill is on the Not placed sheet

The descriptions did not match an ICMS 3 Group. Each line on that sheet says why. Clearer descriptions in the plugin give better placement on the next save.

Frequently asked questions

Does re-saving from the plugin overwrite my prices?

No. Each save is a new version. Rates, purchase marks, supplier details and notes you added on the website are kept, and prices already on budget rows are never replaced.

Does a price I type on the bill change my Rate Gen library?

No. It stays on that project's line. Your library only changes in the Rate Gen desktop app.

Where does the carbon in the ICMS 3 report come from?

From the carbon figure on each of your Rate Gen rates, which Rate Gen works out from published factors (ICE, CIBSE TM65, IStructE, manufacturer EPDs and others). The **Carbon from** column on the **Lines** sheet shows the source line by line.

Where do I get help?

Ask Ada, chat with us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, or raise a ticket from **Support** in the menu.

ADLM Cloud: valuations and contract administration

Value the work done, issue interim payment certificates, and run variations and the contract lock.

This is one part of the [ADLM Cloud guide](#). It covers valuing work done, the contract lock, interim payment certificates, variations, the final account and the BIM models attached to a project. It describes the live site on 4 October 2026.

What's new in 2026.10

- **Certificates say what period they cover.** **Issue certificate** now opens a short form with **Period from**, **Period to**, **Release retention** and **Notes on this certificate**. Before, every certificate showed only its issue date.
- **Release retention.** At practical completion you can release retention on a certificate. The form shows how much is held and refuses to release more.
- **One figure for re-measured work.** The interim certificate and the printed Interim Payment Application now value a re-measured line the same way, from its actual quantity.
- **Net figures under Less previous payments.** The rows under **Less previous payments** now show the net amount (after retention) on screen and in Excel, the same as the PDF.
- **Ada reports for a period.** Ask Ada for "a report for September" and she shows what was valued and certified in that window, with the PDF one click away.

Before you start

- Open the project: see [Projects and your workspace](#).
- Price the bill first: see [The bill and the budget](#).
- Only the owner and collaborators with **Full access** can record progress, lock the contract, issue certificates or decide variations.

Recording progress

Progress is recorded on the **Bill of Quantity**:

1. Tick a line's box to mark it fully done (**Mark as completed**), or type a percentage in its **Done** box. Partial values are paid pro rata.
2. Click **Save changes**. Each save is logged against that day in the daily valuation log.

If a line is re-measured on site, tick **Show actual qty / rate** on the bill's **Home** tab and enter the actual quantity. Certificates and valuations use the actual quantity once it is recorded. An actual quantity of 0 means the work was omitted.

The Valuation view

Click **Valuation** in **Views**. At the top:

- **Valuation basis:** choose **By Bill of Quantity** (each line valued by its own % complete) or **By Budget (Material & Labour)** (each line valued from its material and labour lines marked on the Budget).
- **Show daily valuation log** and **Show valuation settings** turn those sections on and off.

Valuation settings

These are saved per project:

Setting	Default	What it does
Client / Employer	blank	The client's name on the valuation and exported bill
Retention %	5	Held back from the gross value
VAT %	7.5	Added to the subtotal
Withholding tax %	2.5	Deducted from the subtotal

Set these once, when the contract is agreed, so every later valuation is worked out the same way.

The daily valuation log

1. Choose a day in **Valuation date**.
2. Read down the figures: **Gross value of works to date**, **Net valuation to date** (after retention), **Less previous payments** ("Not applicable for first valuation" on the first one), **Subtotal before taxes**, and **Total amount due for payment**.
3. Click **Print valuation** for the formal Interim Payment Application, or **Export Excel** for an editable workbook.

Contract administration

Below the valuation is **Contract administration**, with four views: **Certificates**, **Variations**, **Final account** and **BIM models**.

Locking the contract

Locking freezes the priced bill as the contract sum. After that, new items become variations and re-measured quantities are recorded as actuals, so the contract figure never moves.

1. Open the **Bill of Quantity** and click the **Contract** tab on the ribbon.
2. Click **Lock contract**.
3. Choose a 4-digit PIN and type it twice. If your account uses email codes for sensitive actions, you enter the code sent to your email instead.

IMPORTANT

Keep the PIN safe. You need the same 4 digits to unlock the contract, and a lost PIN cannot be recovered without asking ADLM support.

To unlock, click **Unlock** on the same tab and enter the PIN (or the emailed code).

Interim payment certificates

Each certificate is numbered and carries its own cumulative, less-previous, retention, VAT and withholding tax values, ready for Architect, QS and client sign-off.

1. Open **Certificates** under **Contract administration**.
2. Click **Issue certificate**. A short form opens.
3. Set **Period from** and **Period to**: the period this certificate covers. Leave them blank and the certificate can only show its issue date.
4. Leave **Release retention** at 0 on an ordinary interim. At practical completion, type the amount of retention to release. The label shows how much is held, for example "Release retention (N2,000,000 held)".
5. Optionally type **Notes on this certificate**. They are printed on it.
6. Click **Issue it**. **Cancel** closes the form without issuing.

The certificate certifies the current value to date as the next IPC. Retention you release is added back on this certificate and taxed with the rest. If you type more than is held, the form says "Only N... is held" and will not issue.

Then:

1. Set each certificate's status as it moves along: **Draft**, **Approved**, **Paid**.
2. Download any certificate as an Excel workbook.

Each certificate row shows **Cumulative**, **Less prev.**, **This cert**, **Retention**, VAT, withholding tax and **Net payable**. Only the latest certificate can be deleted, which keeps the sequence honest.

TIP

Lock the contract before the first certificate, so every certificate is measured against the same baseline.

Variations

1. Open **Variations** and click **Add variation**.
2. Fill in **What changed**, the **Instruction reference**, the **Type** (**Addition** or **Omission**) and the **Value (N)**.
3. A new variation waits for approval and is not counted yet. Open it and click **Approve** or **Reject**.

Only approved variations move the project total. The tiles show **Approved**, **net**, **Additions**, **Omissions** and **Waiting for approval**. Lines added to a locked contract from the plugin are raised as variations for you.

Final account

This shows the closing settlement: **Measured work**, **Preliminaries**, **Provisional and PC sums**, contingency and **Approved variations**, set against the **Contract sum**, with **Certified so far**. The movement reads as an over-run, **Under-run (savings)** or **On budget**.

1. When the job is finished, click **Close the final account**. The contract must be locked first.
2. Confirm. Items, variations and certificates are frozen.
3. Click **Download** for the final account workbook.

To make an adjustment later, click **Reopen**. No new certificate can be issued while the final account is closed.

BIM models

On QUIV, Revit MEP and CIVIQ projects, the model is exported to IFC and attached to the project automatically when you save from the plugin, one slot each for **Architectural**, **Structural** and **MEP**. Each slot shows whether it is **Attached** and whether its element IDs match the bill. If the model does not cover the bill, the missing element IDs are listed.

If the plugin was not used, click **Advanced: manual upload** and then **Upload manually** (or **Replace manually**) to attach an IFC file yourself. Files can be up to 100 MB.

AI in valuations

The valuation figures themselves are plain arithmetic, not AI. Ada can read them for you:

Ask Ada	What you get
"When was the last certificate, and what has been paid?"	Certificates in the range you give, their status, and amounts certified and paid
"How many variations were raised and decided in September?"	Variations raised, approved and rejected in that range
"Give me a September report I can send the client."	A Project report card showing Work valued , Certified , Bought and Activity entries . Open the report opens the PDF with a This Period page

Ada reads only; she cannot issue a certificate, decide a variation or lock a contract. She never sends anything to your client: you check the PDF and send it yourself. Ada is on for everyone who is signed in. See [ADLM AI services](#).

Troubleshooting

I forgot the contract PIN

The PIN cannot be recovered on the website. Contact ADLM support from **Support** in the menu to have it reset.

Issue it is greyed out

The **Release retention** amount is more than the retention held. Lower it, or leave it at 0. If the final account is closed, click **Reopen** first.

My old certificates say "Period – to" a date

Certificates issued before October were saved without a period. New certificates carry the period you enter.

The certificate and the valuation printout show different figures

From October both use the actual quantity of a re-measured line. Check that the actual quantity is entered on the bill and click **Save changes**, then print again.

Frequently asked questions

What happens when I lock the contract?

The priced bill becomes the contract sum and stops moving. New items become variations, re-measured quantities are recorded as actuals, and certificates are measured against the locked figure. HERON shows the lock too and saves your edits as actuals.

When should I release retention?

Typically half at practical completion and the rest at the end of the defects period, as your contract says. Release each part on the certificate for that stage.

Where do I get help?

Ask Ada, chat with us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, or raise a ticket from **Support** in the menu.

ADLM Cloud: programme and project management

Track progress with the PM Dashboard and PM Tracker, and see every project at once on the Portfolio dashboard.

This is one part of the [ADLM Cloud guide](#). It covers the PM Dashboard inside each project, the standalone PM Tracker, the Portfolio dashboard across all your projects, and the programme page that works out durations from your bill. It describes the live site on 4 October 2026.

What's new in 2026.10

- **Ada as your project manager.** Ask Ada "What should I do next on this job?" or "Is it behind programme?" and she answers from the PM Dashboard's own figures: tasks done and overdue, CPI, SPI and the planned finish.
- **Reports for a date range.** Ask Ada for a report on any period. The PDF adds a **This Period** page with tasks finished, tasks due but not finished, risks raised and issues opened or resolved in that window.
- **The programme page.** `/work/programme` turns each project's bill into a programme from gang outputs, and **Estimate the outputs** proposes those outputs with AI.

Before you start

- Open the project: see [Projects and your workspace](#).
- The PM Dashboard works best on a priced bill, because earned value is measured in money.
- The buy schedule on the Budget takes its dates from the PM Dashboard's tasks, so build the programme early. See [The bill and the budget](#).

The PM Dashboard

The PM Dashboard is the programme for one project, tied to its bill. Click **PM Dashboard** in the project's **Views**.

Build the task list

Use one of these buttons:

- **Generate from BoQ** creates one task per bill item.
- **Import MS Project** brings in a programme from a Microsoft Project file (.xml or .mpp). Once tasks exist, the button reads **Update MS Project**, which refreshes the schedule and keeps your progress and links. **Delete imported tasks** removes the imported tasks again.
- **Add Task**, **Add Risk** and **Add Issue** add items by hand.

Read the dashboard

The dashboard shows tiles for **Progress**, **Budget Used**, **Overdue**, **CPI**, **SPI** and **Tasks Done**. Below them are charts for **Tasks**, **Budget**, **Tasks by priority** and **Burndown**, and an **Earned Value Summary**.

Earned value in plain terms:

Figure	Meaning
BAC	Budget at completion: what the job is meant to cost in total.
PV	Planned value: what should have been done by now.
EV	Earned value: the budget value of the work actually done.
AC	Actual cost of that work.
EAC	Estimate at completion: what the whole job now looks likely to cost.
VAC	Variance at completion: EAC against BAC.
CPI / SPI	Cost and schedule performance. Below 1 means over budget or behind.

Update tasks, risks and issues

1. Click **View Details** for **WBS / Tasks, Risk Register** and **Issue Log**.
2. In the task table, set each task's %, its status (**Not started**, **In progress**, **Completed** or **Blocked**) and its actual days. Setting 100% marks the task Completed.
3. Click **Save changes** when you are done.

Export calendar downloads the tasks as a calendar file. **Reschedule** moves the tasks after a date changes.

The top bar's report button reads **PM report** on this view. It opens the Project Management Report (schedule and earned value) as a PDF preview; click **Download PDF** to save it.

The PM Tracker

The PM Tracker (/pm-tracker) is for jobs you want to programme without a bill: tasks, risks and issues only. It is a QUIV feature, so you need an active QUIV licence.

1. Open your **QUIV projects** list (**My tools > QUIV**) and click **PM Tracker · QUIV**. You can also click the PM Tracker note on **All Projects**.
2. Click **New Project**, type a **Project name** and click **Create project**.
3. Open the project. Use **Dashboard** for the PM dashboard described above and **Details** for the task, risk and issue tables.

You can keep up to 10 PM Tracker projects. Delete one to add another.

Sharing a PM Tracker project. Click **Share**.

- **View Only:** tick **Enable public link** and copy the link. Your client sees a read-only dashboard without signing in. Untick it to switch the link off.
- **Invite Editor:** type a colleague's email and click **Send Invite Email**. They receive a single-use join link, tied to that email address, that lets them edit tasks, risks and issues.

The Portfolio dashboard

Portfolio Dashboard (</portfolio-dashboard>) rolls up every project you can see, across all products. Open it with the **Portfolio Dashboard** button on any product's project list.

- **Overview** shows the overall progress ring and tiles for **Total projects**, **Completed items**, **Remaining items**, **Total work items**, **Planned total**, **Completed to date**, **Outstanding balance** and **Overall progress**. The **Project breakdown** table lists each project with its product, status, items, BoQ total, completed value and progress.
- **Charts** compares products: **BoQ Total vs Completed**, **by Product**, **Projects by Product**, **Overall Delivery** and **Progress by Product**.
- **Report** gives an executive summary and a breakdown by product.

Buttons in the header:

- **Refresh** reloads the figures.
- **Export Excel** downloads the portfolio as a workbook.
- **Management report** opens a PDF report across your whole organisation, which you can preview and download.

The programme page

The programme page (</work/programme>) works out how long a job will take from its bill: the quantity of each item of work, divided by what a gang produces in a day. Type the address into your browser while signed in. It is not on the menu yet.

1. Open </work/programme> . Your projects are listed with their bill value.
2. Click **Open** on a project, or choose it under **Project**.
3. Read the headline: **Duration** in weeks, **Start on site**, **Practical completion** and **Peak gangs on site**.

Adeyemi & Partners
 Quantity Surveyors - Lagos

Ask Ada
 Your library, answered

WORK

Overview

My tools

QUIV

HERON

RateGen

Revit MEP

CIVIQ

Revit MEP
 Measure the services in Revit and they join the building project's total.
[See what it adds](#)

Projects

LEARN

My learning

Assignments

Certificates

Programme

Search rates, materials and projects

4

Tunde

Programme

Moremi Estate Block A — 6 trades, sequenced from the quantities already measured. Nothing here was estimated by hand.

PROJECT Moremi Estate Block A

ZONE South West

CURRENCY NGN

Duration
12 weeks
 71 working days, six-day week

Start on site
1 Sep
 2026

Practical completion
23 Nov
 2026

Peak gangs on site
9
 across every trade running at once

The programme

Add or remove a gang and the whole chain moves

TRADE	W1	W3	W5	W7	W9	W11	GANGS	DATES	VALUE
Ground	16d						- 2 +	1 Sep - 19 Sep	N2,699,368
Steel	37d						- 2 +	14 Sep - 27 Oct	N16,200,871
Concrete	7d						- 3 +	6 Oct - 14 Oct	N4,537,712
Block Works	37d						- 3 +	10 Oct - 23 Nov	N20,590,103
Window and Door	47d						- 1 +	1 Sep - 26 Oct	N16,977,240
Finishes	1d						- 3 +	1 Sep - 2 Sep	N1,837,440

Every duration is the gang output already held against the rate, multiplied by the quantity measured off the model, divided by the gangs you put on it. Trades start at their normal overlap rather than waiting for the one before to finish — blockwork begins when the frame is 60% through, not after the last beam.

Under **The programme**, each trade is listed with its **Gangs**, **Dates** and **Value**. "Add or remove a gang and the whole chain moves": change the number of gangs on a trade and every later date follows.

ADLM Studio

Adeyemi & Partners

Quantity Surveyors - Lagos

Ask Ada

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WORK

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SOON

Revit MEP

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LEARN

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1

Tunde

Where the time comes from

ITEM OF WORK	TRADE	QUANTITY	OUTPUT	GANG-DAYS
Hardcore filling 150mm, compacted Floor - Ground slab build-up	Ground	1,120 m³	0.02 d/m²	22
Damp-proof membrane, 1000 gauge under slab Floor - Ground slab build-up	Ground	1,120 m²	0.01 d/m²	9
High-yield reinforcement, 12mm bars Rebar - 12mm	Steel	9,840 kg	0.01 d/kg	74
Mass concrete (1:3:6) in foundations Structural Foundation - Pad	Concrete	214 m³	0.06 d/m³	13
Reinforced concrete (1:2:4) in ground beams Structural Framing - Ground beam	Concrete	96 m³	0.08 d/m³	7
Sandcrete blockwork 225mm in cement mortar (1:6) Basic Wall - 225 Blockwork	Block Works	1,842 m²	0.06 d/m²	111
Flush door 900×2100, hung on frame Door - M_Single-Flush	Window and Door	48 no	0.35 d/no	17
Aluminium sliding window, glazed Window - Sliding_2 pane	Window and Door	186 m²	0.16 d/m²	30
Porcelain floor tiling 600×600 on screed bed Floor - Porcelain tile 600×600	Finishes	96 m²	0 d/m²	0
Total gang-days				282

Where the time comes from: each item of work with its output and gang-days.

1. Click **Estimate the outputs** to have AI propose an output for each trade. It also runs once by itself the first time you open a project here.
2. Check the **Output** column and change any figure that does not match your site.
3. Click **Estimate again** to rerun it after the bill changes.

If a bill has no priced quantities, the page says "Nothing on this bill can be sequenced".

AI in programme and project management

Feature	Where	What it does	Availability
Estimate the outputs	Programme page, under Where the time comes from	Groups your bill lines by trade and unit and proposes a daily gang output per trade. The outputs are stored for the project; your bill is not changed	On for everyone
Ada as project manager	Ask Ada	Reads tasks finished, due and overdue, risks and issues, CPI, SPI and the planned finish, and suggests what to do next, most urgent first	On for everyone, signed in
Ada reports	Ask Ada: "a report for last month"	A Project report card, and a PDF with a This Period page for that window	On for everyone, signed in

Ada has no forecasting tool: she explains the planned finish, CPI and SPI but does not produce a final-cost forecast. At the monthly AI limit, **Estimate the outputs** says the allowance is spent, and the outputs stay editable by hand. See [ADLM AI services](#).

Troubleshooting

My model was refused, or a slot says the model does not cover the bill

The model is missing element IDs that priced lines were measured from. It is usually an older revision or the wrong file. Re-export the IFC from the same Revit model the take-off came from, then save again from QUIV or use **Upload manually**.

The buy schedule says everything is Not yet scheduled

The PM Dashboard has no tasks with dates. Click **Generate from BoQ** or **Import MS Project**, set the dates, and save.

I cannot create another PM Tracker project

You have 10 already. Delete one you no longer need.

Estimate the outputs gives figures that are too high for my site

They are a starting point. Type your own figures into the **Output** column; the programme follows them.

Frequently asked questions

What is the difference between the PM Dashboard and the PM Tracker?

The PM Dashboard sits inside a project and is tied to its bill, so earned value is in money. The PM Tracker is a separate list of up to 10 programmes with no bill behind them.

Can my client see the programme?

Share the PM Tracker project with **View Only**, or share the project dashboard. See [Sharing, team and Ada](#).

Where do I get help?

Ask Ada, chat with us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, or raise a ticket from **Support** in the menu.

ADLM Cloud: sharing, team and Ada

Share a dashboard with your client, invite collaborators, control what they see, and get answers from Ada.

This is one part of the [ADLM Cloud guide](#). It covers sharing a project with your client or colleagues, who sees the money on a shared project, your team and seats, and Ada, ADLM's assistant. It describes the live site on 4 October 2026.

What's new in 2026.10

- **Ada proposes rates you confirm.** Ask Ada "Price my bill" on a project you own and she shows a **Proposed rates** card. Nothing is priced until you press **Apply N rates**.
- **Ada reports for a period.** Ask for "a report for September" and a **Project report** card opens the PDF for that window. You check it and send it yourself.
- **Ada knows the project you are looking at.** Signed in, "this project" means the one open on your screen.
- **Ask Ada from the menu.** Ask Ada (**Your library, answered**) sits at the top of the left-hand menu, as well as the round button at the bottom corner of every page.

Before you start

- Only the project **owner** can turn on a public link, invite collaborators or delete the project.
- A collaborator needs their own ADLM account and an active licence for the product the project came from.
- To see rates and money on someone else's project, a collaborator needs an active Rate Gen licence.

Two ways to share

There are two ways to let someone else see a project. They are not the same.

	Public dashboard link	Collaborator
Who it is for	A client with no ADLM account	A colleague or consultant who will work on the project
Sign-in needed	No	Yes, with their own account and the matching product licence
What they see	A summary dashboard only	The whole project, at View only or Full access
Can edit	No	Only with Full access

Sharing a dashboard with your client

1. Open the project's **Dashboard**.
2. Click **Share dashboard**.
3. Tick **Enable public link**.
4. Click **Copy link** and send it to your client.

The button then reads **Shared · link on**, and the project's card on **All Projects** is marked **Shared**. Your client sees a read-only Project Dashboard: overall status, progress, the contract sum and its make-up, cost to date

and forecast, interim certificate totals, and the planned and actual spend. They cannot edit anything.

IMPORTANT

Anyone who has the link can open the dashboard, and it shows money. When you no longer want it shared, untick **Enable public link**. Ticking it again brings back the same link.

Inviting collaborators

1. Open the project and click **Collaborators**.
2. Under **Access level**, choose **View only** or **Full access**.
3. Optionally fill in **Label (optional)** (for example the firm's name), **Restrict to emails (optional)** and **Max uses (0 = unlimited)**.
4. Click **Generate code**.
5. Under **Active codes**, click **Copy** to copy the code, or **Link & QR** for a join link and QR code. **Copy link** copies the link and **Download QR** saves the QR image.

Send the code or link to your colleague. **People with access** lists everyone who has joined. You can change each person between **View only** and **Full access**, or click **Remove**. **Revoke** stops a code being used again.

TIP

Use **Restrict to emails (optional)** and a **Max uses** of 1 when you send a code by WhatsApp, so a forwarded code cannot be used by someone else.

Joining a project someone shared with you

You can use either a link or a code.

- **With a link or QR code:** open it. Sign in if asked. The page shows **Joining project...** and then opens the project.
- **With a code:** open the product under **My tools** (for example **HERON**), click **Add shared project**, type the **Share code** and click **Add project**.

If you do not have the matching product, you see **Subscription required** and a button to get it. A code that has been revoked, has reached its use limit or is restricted to other emails is refused.

A shared project opens with a note: **Shared project · Full access** or **Shared project · View only**. At View only it adds "You can view this project but can't edit or download it."

Who sees the money

Money on a shared project follows two rules: the access level the owner chose, and whether the person has Rate Gen.

	Owner	Full access	View only
Edit rates and progress	Yes	Yes	No
Download exports and reports	Yes	Yes	No
Invite people, delete, public link	Yes	No	No

	Owner	Full access	View only
See rates and money	Yes	Only with a Rate Gen licence	Only with a Rate Gen licence

A collaborator without an active Rate Gen licence sees **Rates hidden**. A **RateGen subscription is required to view rates**. For them:

- rates and money totals show as a dash, on the project list and inside the project;
- bill and budget exports are refused;
- they cannot raise variations, rebuild the schedule or price services;
- Ada will not propose rates for that project, and money in her reports and in report PDFs shows as a dash.

The owner always sees everything. A public dashboard link shows the summary money to anyone with the link, so turn it off when the job is closed.

Team and seats

Team (</manage/team>) shows your account's seats and the machines they are activated on. Open it from **Seats** on the **Products** page, or by typing the address.

- **Members** lists the account holder. Adding colleagues to one account is not available yet, so each person signs in with their own ADLM account. To work together on a project, use [collaborators](#).
- **Machines** lists the computers holding a seat. To move a seat to a new computer, click **Free the seat** on the old one and then sign in on the new one. Nothing is deleted.
- **Seats per product** and **Free activations** show how many seats you own and how many are free right now. **Buy more seats** opens the purchase page.
- **Talk to us about a practice account** asks ADLM to set up several people under one bill.

More on seats and devices is in [Getting started](#).

Ada, your assistant

Ada is ADLM's assistant on adlmstudio.net. She answers from ADLM's own information and, when you are signed in, from your own account and projects. She is on for everyone.

Open Ada

1. Click the round **Ask Ada** button at the bottom corner of any page, or **Ask Ada** at the top of the left-hand menu. The panel opens with **Ada** and **Answers from ADLM, not the internet**.
2. Type in **Ask about a product, a price, training...** and press , or tap a suggestion: **Products**, **Trainings**, **Software downloads** or **Material quantities**.

What she can do

- **For anyone:** what a product does, what it costs, which one your drawings need, trainings and downloads.
- **Signed in, about your account:** your subscriptions, expiry dates and project slots.
- **Signed in, about your projects:** a project's value, work done, progress, whether the contract is locked, CPI and SPI, the biggest bill lines, the budget split between material, labour and plant, and what is still to buy and when.

- **Price your bill:** "Price my bill" gives a **Proposed rates** card. Untick any line you disagree with, check **Adds to the bill**, and press **Apply N rates**. Nothing is priced until you press it.
- **Report on a period:** "What happened between 1 and 30 September?" gives a **Project report** card with **Work valued, Certified, Bought and Activity entries**. **Open the report** opens the PDF.
- **Hand you to a person:** choose **Chat on WhatsApp** in one of her answers.

She reads only your own account: naming someone else's project finds nothing. She keeps each quantity in its own unit, never invents a figure, and never asks for a password or card details.

What she cannot do

Ada cannot change a quantity, rate, budget row, valuation, certificate, variation or task, lock a contract or issue a certificate. Apart from **Apply N rates**, which you press, nothing she does writes to a project. She is not a quotation: use `/quote` for prices you can rely on.

Limits

- Up to 1,000 characters per message, and about 40 messages every 10 minutes.
- A monthly allowance per signed-in account. At the limit she says so and offers WhatsApp until it resets at the start of next month.
- If Ada is offline, she says so and offers **Browse products** and **Chat on WhatsApp**.

AI in sharing and Ada

Feature	Availability	Needs
Ada, product questions	On for everyone	Nothing; visitors share a monthly limit
Ada on your account and projects	On for everyone	Signed in
Ada as estimator (Proposed rates)	On for everyone	Signed in, a project you can edit, rates visible to you
Ada reports for a period	On for everyone	Signed in, access to the project

Ada runs on Claude models through Amazon Bedrock in ADLM's own AWS account. See [ADLM AI services](#) for how she works, what she sends and the allowances.

Troubleshooting

Rates show as dashes on a shared project

You are a collaborator without an active Rate Gen licence. Rates and money stay hidden until you have one. The project owner always sees them.

"Subscription required" when I open a share link

You need an active licence for the product the project was made in (for example HERON for a HERON project). Click the button on the page to get it, then open the link again.

The share code does not work

The code may have been revoked, reached its use limit, or been limited to other email addresses. Ask the owner for a new code.

Ada asks which project I mean

She reads only your own projects. Learning samples belong to no account, so she cannot find them by name. Name one of your own projects, or use the **Work area** buttons on the sample.

Ada says she cannot propose rates

You can only view that project, or you cannot see its rates. Ask the owner for **Full access**, or get Rate Gen.

Frequently asked questions

Can my client see the project without an ADLM account?

Yes. Turn on **Share dashboard** and send the link. Your client sees a summary dashboard and cannot change anything.

What is the difference between View only and Full access?

View only collaborators can look but cannot edit or download. **Full access** collaborators can edit rates and progress and download exports. Neither can invite others, delete the project or share it publicly; only the owner can.

Can I add colleagues to my account?

Not yet. Each person uses their own ADLM account. Share individual projects with them as collaborators.

Does Ada send reports to my client?

No. She drafts and opens the report. You check it and send it yourself.

Where do I get help?

Ask Ada, chat with us on WhatsApp on +234 810 650 3524, or raise a ticket from **Support** in the menu.

Sample projects

Twenty finished, read-only jobs you can open on ADLM Cloud to see a bill, a budget, valuations and a programme filled in from start to finish.

Sample projects are complete, worked jobs that ADLM Studio has put on ADLM Cloud for you to learn from. Each one is a real-looking Nigerian job: a priced bill of quantities, a budget with suppliers, a locked contract, interim certificates, variations, a programme with risks and issues, and, for the model-based products, a 3D model. When your own first project has only a bill in it, a sample shows you what every other tab will look like once the job is running.

There are four samples for each product that has a cloud project screen: QUIV for Revit, HERON for PlanSwift, SERVIQ for Revit MEP, CIVIQ for Civil 3D and QUIV for ArchiCAD. Every sample is read-only. You can open it, read it, filter it and export it, but nobody can change it, save over it or delete it.

This guide lists every sample, says what is in it and what it teaches, shows how to price a sample with your own Rate Gen rates and export it as an ICMS 3 cost and carbon report, and ends with six short exercises.

Before you start

What you need

- **An ADLM account.** Sign in at adlmstudio.net.
- **An active licence for the product.** Samples appear only for products you hold an active licence for. A QUIV licence shows you the QUIV samples, a HERON licence the HERON samples, and so on. If your licence has expired, the samples for that product disappear with your own projects until you renew. See [Getting started](#) and **Products** at [/manage](#).
- **Nothing else.** You do not need Revit, PlanSwift, Civil 3D or ArchiCAD installed to open a sample. A Rate Gen licence is not needed either: samples show every rate to everyone.

What a sample is, and what it is not

- A sample is **learning material**. The figures are worked properly (rates come from a material and labour build-up, the contract sum is calculated the same way as on your own jobs, and the certificates add up), but the clients, sites and suppliers are made up.
- A sample is **not a template**. You cannot copy it into your account or start your own project from it. Your own projects still start in the desktop plugin.
- A sample is **not yours**. It does not appear in your project list or gallery, it does not use any of your cloud storage slots, and it is not counted in your totals on the Overview page.

Finding the samples

On a product's project list

1. Sign in at adlmstudio.net.
2. Open the product's project list, for example **QUIV projects** ([/projects/revit](#)), **HERON projects** ([/projects/planswift](#)), **Revit MEP projects** ([/projects/mep](#)) or **CIVIQ projects** ([/projects/civil3d](#)).

3. Above your own project cards, look for the **Learning samples** strip. It reads, for example, "Worked duplex projects, one per foundation type, each measured from its own 3D model. Open one to see every tab filled in. Samples are read-only."
4. Click a sample card to open it.

On a tool's page

1. Under **My tools**, click the tool, for example **QUIV** (</work/tool/quiv>).
2. Scroll past **How a project starts**. The **Learning samples** strip sits there too.
3. Click a sample card to open it.

For QUIV for ArchiCAD

ArchiCAD samples are on the **QUIV for ArchiCAD** page (</archicad>), above **Your ArchiCAD projects**. See [Early-access products](#).

Reading a sample card

Each card shows:

On the card	What it means
The flag at the top left	The foundation type, pavement type or building the sample is about, for example Raft foundation or Interlocking paving
Read-only (with an eye)	You can look but not change
The name	The job, for example "5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation"
The two short lines under the name	The site, then the stage the job has reached
Contract	The locked contract sum, in millions of naira
Lines	How many priced lines are in the bill
Certificates	How many interim certificates have been issued
3D model	Shown when the sample has a model you can open
Carbon footprint	The upfront carbon (A1-A5) of the sample's bill in tCO2e, worked out from your own Rate Gen rates
Covers	The share of the bill's cost that the carbon footprint is worked out on

Hiding and showing the strip

- Click **Hide samples** to fold the strip away once you no longer need it.
- Click **Show 4 samples** to bring it back. The number is how many samples that product has.

NOTE

Hiding the strip only hides it in the browser you are using. On another computer or phone it starts open again.

Read-only: what you can and cannot do

When a sample opens, an orange banner across the top reads **Sample project · Read-only learning material**, followed by the foundation or job type and the stage. Under it is a one-line summary of the job and the ground conditions, and a fold-out list called **What to look at in this sample**. The banner ends: "You can open every tab, filter, and export, but nothing can be changed. Sync your own model from the plugin to start a project of your own."

You can	You cannot
Open every view: Dashboard , Bill of Quantity , Budget , Valuation , Work area , 3D Model (where there is one) and PM Dashboard	Change a rate, a quantity, a percentage done or a setting
Search and filter the bill and the budget	Save changes. The server refuses with "Sample projects are read-only learning material."
See every rate and every money total, with or without Rate Gen	Delete the sample, merge it with another project or select it for bulk actions
Price the bill with your own Rate Gen rates, without saving anything	Save the new prices to the sample
Download the Excel workbooks and reports, including the ICMS 3 cost and carbon report	Add certificates, variations, tasks, risks or issues
Open the 3D model and pick elements	Invite collaborators or share it with a code

A few more points:

- **Nobody can edit a sample.** It is the same for every customer, and ADLM Studio does not edit it by hand either. If one is ever updated, it is replaced as a whole.
- **Samples never reach the desktop plugins.** The project list the plugins read never includes samples, so you cannot open a sample in Revit or PlanSwift and save your work over it.

TIP

Because you cannot break a sample, it is the safest place to try things. Click every tab, open every certificate, and download every export. Then do the same on your own project.

Pricing and carbon on a sample

From October 2026, a sample can show you what your own Rate Gen rates make of its bill, and its carbon footprint. None of this changes the sample.

Price with my RateGen rates

Under the orange banner of an open sample is a panel called **Price with my RateGen rates**. It re-prices the sample's bill with the Rate Gen rates your account prices with, for the state on your profile: ADLM's rates for that state, with your own changes and custom rates on top. Nothing is saved.

1. Open a sample.
2. In the **Price with my RateGen rates** panel, click **Price with my rates**.

3. Read the three tiles: **Bill as priced (lines your rates cover)**, **With your RateGen rates** with the percentage difference, and **Lines priced**, which shows how many lines your rates covered and what share of the bill's cost that is.
4. Read the table under them. Each line shows the **Bill rate** beside **Your rate**, and **From** says how your rate was found (see the table below).
5. The table shows 25 lines. Click **Show all** and the number of lines to see the rest.
6. After changing your rates, click **Price again**.

From	Meaning
Same item	Your rate with the line's own description and unit
By the work	Your rate for the work the line measures, such as concrete of that mix or blockwork of that thickness, with the unit converted. "assumed" after it means the bill did not say something and it was assumed: hover over it to see what
Services pricing	A SERVIQ line priced from the services rates
Not priced	No rate of yours fits. The line is left out rather than guessed

On the building samples, your rates usually cover most of a bill's cost (87 to 98% on the live samples). The CIVIQ road samples cannot be priced this way: the panel says "RateGen has no civil works rates yet", because pricing roads from building rates would give a confident wrong answer.

TIP

A large difference on one trade is worth a look in [ADLM Rate Gen](#). Rates are built and edited there, not on the website.

The carbon footprint on a sample card

Sample cards show a **Carbon footprint** in tCO2e and how much of the cost it **Covers**. It is the upfront embodied carbon (A1-A5) of the bill: the materials, their transport to site and site waste. It is worked out from your own Rate Gen rates, the same way as the ICMS 3 export, so two accounts can see slightly different figures. If you have no Rate Gen library of your own, ADLM's rates for your state are used.

On the duplex samples the footprint usually covers 90 to 98% of the cost. The PC and provisional sums, and services items with no carbon factor, make up most of the rest. See Carbon in cost planning in the [QS handbook](#) for what the figure means.

Export a sample as an ICMS 3 report

Every sample can be exported as an ICMS 3 cost and carbon report:

1. Open the sample and click **Export**.
2. Under **ICMS 3**, click **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)** or **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)**.

The report sorts the bill's cost and upfront carbon into the 13 ICMS 3 Groups and adds up to the contract sum. A sample states no floor area, base date or location, so those details show as **Assumed** and the per-m² columns are blank. The [QS handbook](#) explains ICMS 3 and works through the raft duplex.

How samples relate to your own projects

A sample is laid out exactly like one of your own projects. The same views, the same columns, the same tiles. The difference is that a sample has already been through the whole job.

Stage of a job	Your new project	A sample
Takeoff	Lines arrive from the plugin	Done
Priced	You price the bill, or let the budget build the rates	Done: every line priced from a material and labour build-up
Contract locked	You lock the contract sum	Done: locked at the agreed sum
Valuations	You record progress and issue certificates	One to four certificates already issued
Final account	You agree the final account	Done on the pile duplex, its MEP services and the laterite road

To start a project of your own:

1. Open your model or drawings in the desktop product.
2. Measure with the plugin.
3. Save to ADLM Cloud. The project appears on the same page as the samples, below the **Learning samples** strip.

The product guides explain each step: [QUIV](#), [HERON](#), [SERVIQ for Revit MEP](#), and the cloud workspace in [ADLM Cloud](#).

The four duplexes

QUIV, HERON and QUIV for ArchiCAD all use the same four duplex designs, one for each common foundation type. SERVIQ uses the services for the same four buildings. Learning one duplex once helps you read it in every product.

Duplex	Client	Site	Ground	Stage reached
4-Bedroom Duplex - Strip Foundation	Mr & Mrs Adebayo Ogunleye	Oluyole Estate, Ibadan	Firm lateritic clay, 150 kN/m2	Interim Certificate 1 issued: substructure complete, ground floor frame under way
4-Bedroom Duplex with Family Lounge - Pad & Strip Foundation	Engr. Chidi Nwosu	Lokogoma District, Abuja	Stiff sandy clay over weathered rock, 200 kN/m2	Interim Certificate 2 issued: first floor slab cast, first floor walls rising
5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation	Mrs Funmilayo Bakare	Lekki Phase 1, Lagos	Soft silty clay, 60 kN/m2, water table 1.8 m	Interim Certificate 3 issued: roofed, doors and windows going in, finishes started
4-Bedroom Terrace Duplex - Bored Pile Foundation	Harbourview Homes Ltd	Ikate, Lekki, Lagos	Loose reclaimed sand over peat to 9 m	Practical completion reached and final account agreed

Every duplex job is priced the same way: bill rates come from a material and labour build-up with 10% overhead and 15% profit. The contract adds 7.5% preliminaries, 5% contingency and 7.5% VAT. Valuations hold 5% retention, add 7.5% VAT and deduct 2.5% withholding tax. Each duplex also carries the same three PC and provisional sums: electrical installation (N4.5m), plumbing and water supply (N3.8m), and external works, soakaway and septic tank (N2.6m).

The programme on the **PM Dashboard** follows seven phases: Substructure; Ground floor frame and blockwork; First floor slab, beams and staircase; First floor frame, blockwork and roof beam; Roof carpentry and covering; Doors and windows; and Finishes. Each phase is broken down into the trades a planner would draw, such as formwork, reinforcement and the concrete pour, rather than one long bar.

QUIV samples (Revit)

QUIV samples are measured from their own 3D Revit models. Each has an **Architectural** and a **Structural** model attached, and every bill line remembers the elements it was measured from. The strip reads "Worked duplex projects, one per foundation type, each measured from its own 3D model."

The bill uses QUIV's own descriptions, for example "Foundations – Excavation (trench)", grouped into the work sections Earthworks, Concrete Works, Formwork, Reinforcement, Masonry, Damp-proofing, Carpentry & Roofing, Joinery, the three finishes sections (wall, floor and ceiling) and Decoration.

Strip foundation

- **Name on the card:** 4-Bedroom Duplex - Strip Foundation. Flag: **Strip foundation**.
- **The job:** a two-storey, four-bedroom duplex in Ibadan on firm clay.
- **What is in it:** 65 bill lines (12 concrete, 11 reinforcement, 9 formwork, 7 earthworks and the rest across masonry, roofing, joinery and finishes), 222 budget lines, a contract sum of about N127.6m, one approved certificate (about 19% of the contract valued), and two variations: AI-01 deepens the strip footing at the rear wall after a soft spot was found, and AI-02 adds a concrete apron round the building.
- **What it teaches:** the start of a job. Substructure is complete, the ground floor frame is under way, and only one certificate has been issued, so you can see what a first valuation looks like and how a variation found during excavation is priced at the bill rate.

Pad and strip foundation

- **Name on the card:** 4-Bedroom Duplex with Family Lounge - Pad & Strip Foundation. Flag: **Pad and strip foundation**.
- **The job:** a larger four-bedroom duplex with a family lounge in Abuja, with pad bases under the columns and strips under the walls.
- **What is in it:** 67 bill lines (including separate excavation to trenches and to pits), 228 budget lines, a contract sum of about N157.4m, two certificates (the first paid, the second approved, about 42% valued), and two variations: a cantilever balcony to the master bedroom, and burglary-proof laminated glass to the ground floor windows.
- **What it teaches:** how one certificate follows another. Look at **Less previous payments** on certificate 2. The risk register also shows a risk that has been closed (weathered rock met at 1.2 m).

Raft foundation

- **Name on the card:** 5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation. Flag: **Raft foundation**.
- **The job:** a five-bedroom duplex in Lekki Phase 1 on soft clay with a high water table, so it sits on a raft.

- **What is in it:** 64 bill lines (including excavation to reduce levels for the raft and disposal of surplus material), 221 budget lines, a contract sum of about ₦209.0m, three certificates (two paid, one approved, about 68% valued), and three variations: dewatering during the raft excavation, porcelain floor tiles to the living room, and extra rainwater goods to the rear. The electrical PC sum has been executed.
- **What it teaches:** a job well into finishes. The budget shows materials for later phases being bought ahead of time, and the issue log has three issues at different stages (resolved, in progress and open).

Bored pile foundation

- **Name on the card:** 4-Bedroom Terrace Duplex - Bored Pile Foundation. Flag: **Pile foundation**.
- **The job:** a terrace duplex in Ikate, Lekki, on reclaimed sand over peat, carried on bored piles.
- **What is in it:** 72 bill lines (the most of the four, because piling adds concrete, reinforcement and formwork lines), 246 budget lines, a contract sum of about ₦146.6m, four certificates (all paid, about 90% valued), and three variations: pile integrity testing, extending the piles on grid A by 2 m after deeper peat was found, and a granite kitchen worktop. All three PC and provisional sums are executed.
- **What it teaches:** the end of a job. The last certificate releases half the retention at practical completion, and the **Final account** is agreed, with a final contract value of about ₦132.4m, roughly ₦14.2m under the contract sum.

HERON samples (PlanSwift)

HERON samples are the same four duplexes, measured from PDF drawings in PlanSwift instead of from a model. The strip reads "Worked duplex projects, one per foundation type, measured from PDF drawings."

Name on the card	Flag	Bill lines	Budget lines	Contract	Certificates	Final account
4-Bedroom Duplex - Strip Foundation	Strip foundation	65	222	about ₦127.6m	1	No
4-Bedroom Duplex with Family Lounge - Pad & Strip Foundation	Pad and strip foundation	67	228	about ₦157.4m	2	No
5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation	Raft foundation	64	221	about ₦209.0m	3	No
4-Bedroom Terrace Duplex - Bored Pile Foundation	Pile foundation	72	246	about ₦146.6m	4	Yes

The quantities, rates, certificates, variations, risks and issues match the QUIV sample of the same duplex. What differs is how the bill reads:

- **Descriptions are written out in full**, the way a QS writes them from drawings. "Foundations - Excavation (trench)" in QUIV becomes "Excavate trenches for foundations, not exceeding 2.00m deep" in HERON.
- **Lines are grouped by takeoff folder:** Substructure, Frame, Blockwork, Roofing, Doors & Windows and Finishes.
- **There is no 3D model**, so the **3D Model** view does not appear.

What they teach: that a drawing-based takeoff ends up in exactly the same commercial workflow as a model-based one. Open the HERON and QUIV samples of the same duplex side by side and compare the bill descriptions against the identical totals.

SERVIQ samples (Revit MEP)

SERVIQ samples are the building services for the same four duplexes: electrical, plumbing and drainage, and air conditioning. Each has an MEP model attached, so you can pick a bill line and see the fittings and pipe runs it was measured from. On the website the product appears as **Revit MEP**. The strip reads "Services for the worked duplexes: electrical, plumbing and drainage, and air conditioning."

Every MEP sample has 45 bill lines in three sections (17 Electrical Installations, 24 Plumbing & Drainage and 4 HVAC) and 110 budget lines. The PC and provisional sums are a utility meter and service connection (₦0.85m), a borehole and submersible pump (₦2.4m) and a solar inverter with battery backup (₦4.2m). The programme has six phases: electrical first fix, plumbing and drainage rough-in, electrical second fix, sanitary fittings and pumping, air conditioning and ventilation, and testing and commissioning.

Strip duplex services

- **Name on the card:** 4-Bedroom Duplex - Strip Foundation - MEP Services. Flag: **Strip duplex**.
- **What is in it:** 36 light points, 36 sockets, 7 split units and 16 sanitary fittings. Contract about ₦29.7m, one approved certificate (about 6% valued), one variation (an outdoor socket and garden light circuit).
- **What it teaches:** services at their earliest stage, with conduits cast into the first floor slab and plumbing sleeves in. A first certificate on a services contract is small; this one shows why.

Pad and strip duplex services

- **Name on the card:** 4-Bedroom Duplex with Family Lounge - Pad & Strip Foundation - MEP Services. Flag: **Pad and strip duplex**.
- **What is in it:** 40 light points, 42 sockets, 9 split units and 22 sanitary fittings. Contract about ₦34.9m, two certificates (about 21% valued), two variations (a rain shower upgrade and CCTV conduit for six cameras).
- **What it teaches:** first fix complete and pipework pressure-tested. The issue log records a leak found during the pressure test and resolved.

Raft duplex services

- **Name on the card:** 5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation - MEP Services. Flag: **Raft duplex**.
- **What is in it:** 48 light points, 52 sockets, 9 split units and 22 sanitary fittings. Contract about ₦35.9m, three certificates (about 55% valued), two variations (lifting the pump chamber above flood level and an extra split unit). The utility connection sum is executed.
- **What it teaches:** second fix and sanitary fittings going in, and how site conditions (a high water table) turn into a services variation.

Pile duplex services

- **Name on the card:** 4-Bedroom Terrace Duplex - Bored Pile Foundation - MEP Services. Flag: **Pile duplex**.
- **What is in it:** 28 light points, 32 sockets, 7 split units and 10 sanitary fittings. Contract about ₦26.5m, four paid certificates (about 90% valued), two variations (relocated inspection chambers and surge protection). All three sums are executed.
- **What it teaches:** services complete, commissioned and the final account agreed, at about ₦23.8m, roughly ₦2.7m under the contract sum.

Early-access products: CIVIQ and QUIV for ArchiCAD

CIVIQ and QUIV for ArchiCAD are not on general sale yet. Their samples appear only for accounts that have early access to those products. If you do not have early access, you will not see these samples, and nothing is wrong with your account.

CIVIQ samples (Civil 3D)

CIVIQ samples are four road jobs, one for each common pavement type. Each carries a corridor model: pavement layers, kerbs, drains and culverts between 20 m stations, which you can open in **3D Model**. Lines are measured per chainage band, the way CIVIQ extracts them. They appear on **CIVIQ projects** (</projects/civil3d>). The strip reads "Worked road and drainage jobs, measured chainage by chainage from the corridor."

The bill has two sections, Earthworks and External Works. The PC and provisional sums are relocation of existing services (₦3.5m), street lighting (₦6.0m) and materials testing for CBR, compaction and cores (₦1.2m). The programme has six phases: site clearance and topsoil strip; earthworks; drainage and culverts; sub-base and base course; surfacing; and kerbs, markings and road furniture. Variations on road jobs are site instructions (SI-01, SI-02).

Name on the card	Flag	Site and client	Road	Bill lines	Budget lines	Contract	Certificates	Stage
Estate Access Road - Asphalt Pavement	Flexible pavement (asphalt)	Akobo, Ibadan, for Greenfield Court Residents Association	480 m long, 7.3 m carriageway, 322 m ³ cut, 317 m ³ fill	39	116	about ₦352.2m	2 (about 45% valued)	Drains and culvert in, sub-base being laid
Industrial Estate Road - Rigid Concrete Pavement	Rigid pavement (concrete)	Agbara Industrial Estate, Ogun, for Agbara Logistics Park Ltd	360 m long, 7.3 m carriageway, 218 m ³ cut, 327 m ³ fill	49	168	about ₦315.2m	1 (about 10% valued)	Earthworks and drainage under way
Housing Estate Street - Interlocking Paving Stones	Interlocking paving	Gwarinpa, Abuja, for Cedar Grove Homes Ltd	300 m long, 6 m carriageway, 178 m ³ cut, 464 m ³ fill	30	100	about ₦130.9m	3 (about 78% valued)	Paving laid, kerbs and markings going in
Rural Feeder Road - Laterite with Culverts	Laterite feeder road	Ikire-Apomu, Osun, for Osun State Rural Access Agency	1,200 m long, 6 m carriageway, 90 m ³ cut, 1,927 m ³ fill, two stream crossings	20	48	about ₦170.8m	4 (all paid, about 90% valued)	Road handed over and final account agreed

What each one teaches:

- **Asphalt road:** a big jump between certificates once drainage goes in. The variation SI-01 replaces soft material at Ch 0+300 with laterite, priced at the bill rate for filling.
- **Concrete road:** the most detailed bill of the four (49 lines), and an early job with one certificate. SI-01 thickens the slab at the loading bay, not yet executed.
- **Interlocking street:** a nearly finished job with both site instructions executed and the services relocation sum spent.
- **Laterite feeder road:** a long, mostly fill road with culverts. An extra culvert barrel was added after a flood survey, half the retention is released on the last certificate, and the final account closes at about ₦154.4m, roughly ₦16.4m under the contract sum.

QUIV for ArchiCAD samples

ArchiCAD samples are the same four duplexes, measured from the ArchiCAD model and costed as an ArchiCAD bill. They appear on the **QUIV for ArchiCAD** page (</archicad>). The strip reads "Worked duplex projects, one per foundation type, measured from the ArchiCAD model."

Clicking a card opens the sample's ArchiCAD bill page, with the same orange **Sample project · Read-only learning material** banner. The bill is grouped into the ArchiCAD work sections: Substructure, Frame, Upper Floors, External Walls, Internal Walls, Roof, Windows & External Doors and Internal Doors. Each line keeps the elements it came from, and the costed bill is saved as a BoQ version. **Dashboard** opens the cost breakdown with **Cost by category** and the **Budget tracker**.

Name on the card	Flag	Bill lines	Bill total	Contract	Certificates
4-Bedroom Duplex - Strip Foundation	Strip foundation	55	about ₦70.3m	about ₦98.5m	1
4-Bedroom Duplex with Family Lounge - Pad & Strip Foundation	Pad and strip foundation	57	about ₦88.4m	about ₦120.5m	2
5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation	Raft foundation	54	about ₦126.9m	about ₦167.2m	3
4-Bedroom Terrace Duplex - Bored Pile Foundation	Pile foundation	62	about ₦90.3m	about ₦122.8m	4

ArchiCAD bills have fewer lines than QUIV for the same building, because they cover the model's structure, walls, roof and openings rather than every finish. The clients, sites, variations, risks and issues match the duplex of the same name.

What they teach: how an ArchiCAD model becomes a costed, sectioned bill, and how the cost of each work section compares. Substructure is the biggest section on the raft and pile duplexes, which is exactly what you would expect on poor ground.

Exercises

These six exercises take ten to fifteen minutes each. Any product's samples work, but the steps below use the QUIV samples. On HERON the steps are the same without the 3D model.

Exercise 1: Open a sample

1. Go to **QUIV projects** (</projects/revit>).

2. In the **Learning samples** strip, click **5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation**.
3. Read the orange banner. Note the stage: "Interim Certificate 3 issued".
4. Click **What to look at in this sample** and read the list.
5. Under **Views**, click each view in turn, from **Dashboard** to **PM Dashboard**.
6. Click **Projects** to go back to the list.

Exercise 2: Read the bill

1. Open **4-Bedroom Duplex - Strip Foundation**.
2. Click **Bill of Quantity**.
3. Find the first lines under Earthworks, for example "Foundations - Excavation (trench)". Note the quantity in m³ and the rate.
4. Scroll through the work sections and note which section carries the most money.
5. Click **3D Model**, then pick a bill line to see the elements it was measured from.
6. Now open the HERON sample of the same duplex and find the same excavation line. It reads "Excavate trenches for foundations, not exceeding 2.00m deep", with the same quantity and rate.

TIP

This is the best way to see that QUIV and HERON produce the same bill. Only the descriptions and grouping differ.

Exercise 3: Compare the budget

1. Open **4-Bedroom Duplex with Family Lounge - Pad & Strip Foundation**.
2. Click **Budget**.
3. Pick one bill item and read the rows under it: the **Material**, **Labour** and **Plant** lines that make up its rate. Check that **Bill Rate = Material + Labour + O&P** (10% overhead and 15% profit).
4. Look at which rows are ticked as procured and which are only part bought. Materials for phases already started are bought; later phases are not.
5. Switch to **Buy schedule** and read **Should already be bought** and **Buy this week**.

Exercise 4: Follow the valuation

1. Open **4-Bedroom Terrace Duplex - Bored Pile Foundation**.
2. Click **Valuation**.
3. Under **Contract administration**, open **Certificates**. There are four, all paid.
4. For each certificate, read the value this period, the retention held, VAT added and withholding tax deducted.
5. On certificate 4, find the retention released: half the retention comes back at practical completion.
6. Open **Variations** and read AI-01 to AI-03. Note that AI-02 (extending the piles) is priced at the bill rate for piling.
7. Open **Final account** and compare the final contract value with the contract sum.

Exercise 5: See the PM dashboard

1. Open **5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation**.
2. Click **PM Dashboard**.

3. Read the files: **Progress**, **Budget Used**, **Overdue**, **CPI**, **SPI** and **Tasks Done**.
4. Read the **Earned Value Summary**. A CPI or SPI below 1 means over budget or behind programme.
5. Click **View Details** and open **WBS / Tasks**. See how the Substructure phase is split into trades.
6. Open **Risk Register** and **Issue Log**. Find the risk about the high water table (closed) and the issue about window frames out of square (in progress).

Exercise 6: Export a sample as an ICMS 3 cost and carbon report

1. Open **5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation**.
2. Click **Export**, and under **ICMS 3** click **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**.
3. Open the workbook. On **ICMS 3 report**, see which details are **Stated** and which are **Assumed**, and read the carbon coverage.
4. Open **Cost by Group (G-2)**. Check that the total is the contract sum, about N209.0m. Substructure (2.02) is about a quarter of it, because the raft sits on soft clay.
5. Find preliminaries in 2.08, contingency in 2.09 and VAT in 2.10.
6. Open **Carbon by Group (H-1, H-2)**. Note which Group carries the most carbon, and that 2.10 reads **Not used**.
7. Open **Lines** and find the roof beam lines. Read **Placed by** and **Why**, and decide whether you agree with the Group they were given.

What's new in 2026.10

- **September 2026:** sample projects arrived for QUIV and HERON, four duplexes each.
- **Late September 2026:** samples added for Revit MEP, CIVIQ and QUIV for ArchiCAD, and the **Learning samples** strip added to each tool's page under **My tools**.
- **End of September 2026:** the sample programmes now show each phase broken into trades (formwork, reinforcement, pours and so on), the way a real programme of works is drawn, instead of one bar per phase.
- **October 2026:** Price with my RateGen rates on an open sample, a **Carbon footprint** on each sample card, and the **ICMS 3** cost and carbon export on every sample. Exports from samples now open reliably.

Troubleshooting

I cannot see the Learning samples strip

- **Check your licence.** Samples only appear for a product you hold an active licence for. Open **Products** at [/manage](#) and check the product is active and not expired.
- **Check you are on the right page.** The strip is on a product's project list (for example [/projects/revit](#)), on the tool's page under **My tools**, and on [/archicad](#) for ArchiCAD. It is not on the **Projects** gallery ([/work/projects](#)) or the **Overview**.
- **Check whether you hid it.** If you see a button reading **Show 4 samples**, click it.
- **CIVIQ and ArchiCAD:** these samples appear only with early access to those products.
- If none of these apply, click **Refresh projects** or reload the page.

I changed a rate in a sample and it will not save

That is expected. Samples are read-only. The message "Sample projects are read-only learning material." means the server refused the change. Try the same thing on one of your own projects.

I want to use a sample as a starting point for my job

You cannot copy a sample. Download its workbooks from **Export** if you want a reference, then measure your own job in the plugin and save it to ADLM Cloud.

The sample has no 3D Model view

HERON samples are measured from PDF drawings and have no model. QUIV, Revit MEP and CIVIQ samples do. ArchiCAD samples open on the ArchiCAD bill page instead of the project screen.

There is no carbon footprint on a sample card

The card shows a footprint only when your Rate Gen rates give the bill a carbon figure. Check the state on your profile, then reload the page. The figure is refreshed every few minutes, so a change to your rates can take a short while to show.

I cannot find a sample from inside the plugin

Samples are kept out of the desktop plugins on purpose, so nobody can save over them. Open them on the website.

Frequently asked questions

Do samples count towards my cloud storage? No. Your project slots count only the projects you own.

Do samples show up in my totals on the Overview page? No. The **Overview** and the **Projects** gallery count only your own projects and projects shared with you.

Can my colleagues see the same samples? Yes. Every customer with the product sees the same samples. Because nobody can change them, what you see is what they see.

Can I see the rates without Rate Gen? Yes. Samples show every rate and money total to everyone. On your own projects and shared projects, the normal Rate Gen rules apply. See [ADLM Rate Gen](#).

Can I download a sample? Yes. The Excel workbooks and reports work on samples just as they do on your projects, including the ICMS 3 cost and carbon report.

Does Price with my RateGen rates change the sample? No. It shows your prices beside the bill's own and saves nothing. The sample is the same for everyone afterwards.

Are the clients and sites real? No. The names, sites and suppliers are made up. The quantities are measured from real models of the four duplexes and four roads, and the money is worked out the same way the website works out your own jobs.

Why are the QUIV and HERON figures identical? They are the same buildings measured two ways. That is the point: a drawing takeoff in HERON and a model takeoff in QUIV lead to the same bill, budget and valuations.

Why do the ArchiCAD figures differ from QUIV? The ArchiCAD bill covers what the ArchiCAD model holds (structure, walls, roof and openings) and is grouped into ArchiCAD's work sections, so it has fewer lines and a

lower total.

Will the samples change? ADLM Studio may refresh a sample to show a new feature. It is replaced as a whole and keeps the same name and link.

I need help. Contact us through [/support](#).

ADLM AI services

Every AI feature across ADLM's software, what it does for you, how it works, and what it will never do on its own.

ADLM's software has a family of AI helpers: **Ada** on the website, who answers product questions and works beside you as an estimator and project manager; AI checks on your bill in ADLM Cloud; and AI reviews, rate matching and take-off help in the desktop products. This guide lists each one, where to find it, how it works and who can use it today.

One rule runs through all of them: **the AI suggests, you decide**. Quantities come from your model or drawings, rates from a rate library. Where an AI feature can change your bill, it shows a proposal first and waits. Every answer is advisory, and the quantity surveyor checks it before it goes into a contract.

Before you start

What you need

- **To be signed in** for anything beyond product questions to Ada.
- **An active ADLM licence**. At the time of writing, any active ADLM product licence opens the AI tools; there is no separate AI add-on. See **Products** at [/manage](#).
- **An internet connection**. The AI runs on ADLM's servers. Offline, the rest of each product keeps working.

Availability labels

Label	Meaning
On for everyone	In the current release for any signed-in user with an active licence.
Beta	Only in a beta build or on the beta channel.
Not in standard installs	In the product but switched off in a normal install; ADLM switches it on only on machines it sets up for testing.
Switched off	Shown but disabled for everyone in this release.
Coming	Built, not yet in any release.

Every AI feature at a glance

Feature	Product	Availability	Needs
Ada, the website chat (product questions)	Website	On for everyone	Nothing; guests share a monthly limit
Ada on your account and projects	Website	On for everyone	Signed in
Ada as your estimator and project manager	Website	On for everyone	Signed in, a project you own

Feature	Product	Availability	Needs
Ada in the Work area of a project	ADLM Cloud	On for everyone	Signed in, access to the project
Check my rates against the market	ADLM Cloud	On for everyone	Signed in, active licence, priced lines
Scan the bill for errors	ADLM Cloud	On for everyone	Signed in, active licence
Build up a rate for the selected line	ADLM Cloud	On for everyone	Signed in, active licence
Estimate the outputs (programme gang outputs)	ADLM Cloud	Being opened up to customers (the /work/programme page)	Signed in, a project with a bill
AI Rate Check	QUIV 3 (classic workspace)	Not in the QUIV 4.0 panel	Signed in, priced bill lines
✦ Run the whole takeoff / Auto take-off	QUIV 3.1.9 and later; Auto take-off in QUIV 4.0	On for everyone	Signed in, a take-off list. Uses no AI model
QUIV AI Assistant , the AI prompt bar and AI Assist	QUIV	Not in standard installs	Set up by ADLM
AI Match Labour and AI Match Materials	QUIV	Not in standard installs	Set up by ADLM
AI Review (AI Bill Review)	HERON 2.9 and 3.0	On for everyone	Signed in, active licence
Auto take-off	HERON	Beta in 2.9; switched off in 3.0	Beta channel (2.9 only)
Build with AI	Rate Gen 3.0.1	On for everyone	Signed in, active licence
Price a bill (price a client's bill with ADLM AI)	Rate Gen	Coming	Not released
ADLM AI Review and BUILD WITH ADLM AI	SERVIQ (Revit MEP)	Not in standard installs	Set up by ADLM
WhatsApp sales assistant	WhatsApp	Rolling out	A WhatsApp number

NOTE

Rate Gen's **Carbon & Others** screen, HERON's description library and Specifications, and the ICMS 3 cost and carbon export are not AI features. They work from fixed rules, factors and your own data. They are mentioned here only because people ask.

How ADLM AI works, in plain words

1. **Your product gathers the facts:** bill lines, rates, your model's level names. The AI never measures anything.
2. **The facts go to ADLM's AI service, on Amazon Bedrock in ADLM's own AWS account,** using Anthropic's Claude models: a fast model for most jobs, a stronger one when it is unsure.
3. **Answers are grounded in the Rate Gen library** for your region of Nigeria. Library figures are marked as such; estimates are marked too ([AI] in Rate Gen).
4. **You get a proposal, not a change,** with a reason and often a confidence figure.

No feature invents a quantity, uses another firm's data, or gives a professional opinion. Answers from the AI cost tools carry the same note: an advisory estimate from the Rate Gen library and market data, to be checked before contractual use. Nothing writes to your bill, budget or library without your confirmation, except QUIV's **AI Match** (not in standard installs), which fills confident matches with real library prices and marks each for review.

Ada, the ADLM assistant on the website

What Ada does for you

Ada is the chat on adlmstudio.net. For anyone, she answers what a product does, what it costs and which one your drawings need, and can add a product to your cart or point you to a training. Signed in, she also answers questions about your own account and projects.

Where to find her

1. Click the round **Ask Ada** button at the bottom corner of any page. The panel opens with **Ada and Answers from ADLM, not the internet**.
2. Type in **Ask about a product, a price, training...** and press , or tap a suggestion: **Products, Trainings, Software downloads** or **Material quantities**. The last one starts "How many bags of cement do I need for " for you to finish.

NOTE

Ada's page at </ada> describes her in places she is not yet, such as inside the desktop products and the mobile app. This guide lists only where she is today.

How she works

- **What she sends:** your message, the recent conversation and, if you are signed in, the page you are on, so "this project" means the one you have open.
- **What she reads:** ADLM's live catalogue and, when you are signed in, only your own account and projects. Naming someone else's project finds nothing.
- **Which model:** Claude, on Amazon Bedrock in ADLM's AWS account.
- **What she never does:** invent a price, product, date or project figure, or ask for a password or card details. If a tool finds nothing, she says what she searched.
- **Confirmation:** she only reads. Rate proposals go through a card you confirm (see the next section).

What she can tell you about your account

Ask about	What she reads
Your projects	Count, combined value, work done, outstanding, progress, which have a 3D model
One project	Value, work done, actual cost, progress, contract locked or not, CPI and SPI, tasks done and overdue, planned finish
Your subscriptions	What you own, active or expired, expiry, project slots used
A material or trade	Total quantity and cost of, say, cement, 12mm rebar or masons, in one project or all
The bill	Each line's quantity, unit, rate, amount and % complete, optionally filtered
The budget	Material vs Labour vs Plant, procured vs still to buy, the biggest resources
What to buy next	Materials still to order, soonest first, with order dates from the programme (14 days' lead time unless you say otherwise)

She keeps each quantity in its own unit and never converts units unless you give her the factor.

Limits

- Up to 1,000 characters per message, and about 40 messages every 10 minutes.
- A monthly allowance per signed-in account; guests share one monthly limit (see "AI allowances" below).
- If Ada is offline, she says so and offers **Browse products** and **Chat on WhatsApp**.

Ada as your project manager and cost manager

Signed in and chatting from the **Ask Ada** button, Ada works like a senior QS and site PM beside you. She reads the project; she does not run it.

What she can read on a project

- **The bill:** every line's quantity, unit, rate, amount and progress.
- **The budget:** the Material & Labour breakdown, procured and still to buy.
- **Valuations:** certificates issued in a date range, what was certified (approved or paid) and what was paid.
- **The programme:** tasks finished, due but not finished, overdue, risks and issues, and the planned finish.
- **Earned value:** CPI (cost) and SPI (schedule), as the PM dashboard works them out.
- **Variations:** raised and decided in a period.

Cost questions and variances

Ask the value of a project, what is done, what a line costs, the biggest items, the material and labour split, or what you have budgeted for a material. She quotes the stored figures exactly; if a bill has no rates, she says so. She points out variances the data shows: lines over budget, actual cost against planned, CPI or SPI below 1, and tasks past their dates. She does not invent one the data does not show.

What needs attention

Ask "What should I do next on this job?" She runs the same checks as the tip strip on your project's tabs, most urgent first: unpriced lines, contract not locked, no recent progress, overdue tasks, lines over budget, budget rows with no price, no programme. Each tip names its tab: **PM dashboard**, **Rates & budget**, **Valuations** or **Bill**.

Forecasting

Ada has no forecasting tool. She gives the planned finish, CPI, SPI and what is still to buy, and explains what they suggest, but she does not produce a final-cost forecast. Open the project's **PM Dashboard** for the full earned-value picture.

Reports and notes

Ask for "a report for last month" or "what happened between 1 and 30 September". She works out the dates in Lagos time and reads what moved: work valued, lines completed, actual against planned, certificates, variations, purchases, late tasks, risks, issues and the activity log. A **Project report** card shows **Work valued**, **Certified**, **Bought** and **Activity entries**; **Open the report** opens the PDF. She can draft a short note from those figures for you to copy and edit. She never sends anything.

Pricing unpriced lines, with your confirmation

Ask "Price my bill". Ada proposes a rate for every unpriced line from **your own** Rate Gen library (master rates plus your overrides and custom rates), matched by description, with the unit as a hard rule and rates you chose before ranked first.

1. Read the **Proposed rates** card: one line per proposal with a tick box, quantity, rate and amount.
2. Untick any line you disagree with, and check **Adds to the bill**.
3. Press **Apply N rates** (it reads **Tick a line to apply** when nothing is ticked).

Nothing is priced until you press the button. If you can only view a project, or cannot see its rates, she says she cannot propose rates for it.

What she cannot change

Ada cannot change a quantity, rate, budget row, valuation, certificate, variation or programme task, lock a contract or issue a certificate. Apart from **Apply N rates**, which you press, nothing she does writes to a project.

The AI cost checks Ada can run

Ada can also run three AI cost tools on your project's real bill lines: **check my rates** against the market, **find errors**, and **suggest a rate** for any described item of work (no project needed). They work as described under "AI checks in ADLM Cloud". She uses a region only when you name one.

Prompts to try with Ada

These prompts use ADLM's learning sample projects, so you can see what to ask and what a good answer looks like.

IMPORTANT

Ada reads **your own** projects only. Samples belong to no account, so if you name "5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation" in the chat she will ask which of your projects you mean. On a sample, use the AI buttons in its **Work area**, or ask questions that need no project, such as rate build-ups. Ask whole-project questions about your own project.

To open a sample, find the **Learning samples** strip on a product's project list (the Sample projects guide explains it), open one, then click the **Work area** tab.

Cost manager

Ask these about your own project, for example your own raft or strip duplex.

Ask	What Ada should answer
"What is my raft duplex worth, and how much work is done?"	Total value, work done, actual cost recorded and progress %
"Is the contract locked, and what is the contract sum?"	Locked or not, and the sum if locked
"What are the ten biggest items in my strip duplex bill?"	The largest lines by amount, with quantity, unit and rate
"Split my budget into material, labour and plant."	The split, and what is procured versus still to buy
"What changed on my pad and strip duplex between 1 and 30 September?"	Work valued, certificates and amounts certified and paid, variations, purchases and late tasks, with a report card
"What do I still need to buy, and when must I order it?"	Materials still to order, soonest first, anything overdue
"The gross floor area is 420 m ² . What is the cost per m ² ?"	The project value divided by the area you gave. Ada does not store floor areas, so give her one
"What will this job cost at the end?"	CPI, SPI and what remains to buy, explained. She has no final-cost forecast and should say so

Project manager

Ask	What Ada should answer
"What should I do next on my strip duplex?"	The most urgent tips first, each with the tab to open
"Is my pad and strip duplex behind programme?"	SPI, tasks done out of total, overdue tasks and the planned finish
"Which tasks are late this month?"	Tasks due in the month and not finished, by name
"When was the last certificate, and what has been paid?"	Certificates in the range you give, their status, amounts certified and paid
"How many variations were raised and decided in September?"	Variations raised and decided in that range

Ask	What Ada should answer
"Give me a September report I can send the client."	A summary with a Project report card. Open the report gives you the PDF to check and send yourself

Estimator

Ask	Where	What you should get
Check my rates against the market	Work area of any QUIV, HERON or SERVIQ sample	A verdict per line, with deviation, benchmark and reason
Scan the bill for errors	Work area of any sample	Duplicates, wrong units, odd quantities and rate outliers, each with a reason
Select a concrete line, then Build up a rate for the selected line	Work area of the 5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation sample	The rate built up from material, labour and plant, each part marked as looked up or estimated
"Build me a rate for 225mm hollow sandcrete blockwork in cement-sand mortar 1:6, South West."	Ada chat, anywhere	A build-up from the Rate Gen library for that zone
"Build a rate for a 600mm bored pile, per metre, in Lagos."	Ada chat, anywhere	A build-up with more estimated lines, as piling is thinner in the library. Check them
"Compare the concrete in my strip duplex and my raft duplex."	Ada chat, two of your projects	Concrete lines and totals from each bill, side by side
"How much rebar and how much concrete is in my raft duplex?"	Ada chat, your project	Rebar in kg and concrete in m ³ , each in its own unit. Divide for kg per m ³ and check it against your norm
"Which lines in my pile duplex have no rate?" then "Price them."	Ada chat, your project	The unpriced lines, then a Proposed rates card to tick and apply

TIP

The HERON samples have the same bills as the QUIV ones with descriptions written out in full. Run a market check on the HERON and QUIV versions of the same duplex to see how wording affects matching.

AI checks in ADLM Cloud (the Work area)

Every cloud project has a **Work area** tab ("Model, bill, schedule and Ada together"). Its **Ada** panel, headed **Answering from** your project, has five buttons and an **Ask about this project** box:

Button	What it does	AI?
Check duration, time, cost & material	A health check worked out on the page	No
Check my rates against the market (or Check N selected line(s))	Benchmarks priced lines against the Rate Gen library	Yes

Button	What it does	AI?
Scan the bill for errors	Duplicates, wrong units, implausible quantities, rate outliers	Yes
Build up a rate for the selected line	One line's rate from material, labour and plant	Yes
What is this project worth?	Asks Ada	Yes

1. Open a project and click **Work area**.
2. Tick lines in **Bill of Quantities** to check only those, or tick nothing to check all.
3. Click **Check my rates against the market**.
4. Read the result in the Ada panel; each line gets a chip in the **Check** column.

How it works: each priced line's description, unit, quantity and rate (up to 250 lines) is compared with the Rate Gen library for your zone. Verdicts are **above market**, **below market**, **in range** or **unit mismatch** (the unit disagrees with the benchmark, nothing more). No rate is ever changed. A market check costs 2 units; an error scan or build-up 1. Repeating the same check within a week costs nothing.

NOTE

On a sample, **Ask about this project** can comment on the lines you have selected, which travel with your question, but cannot read the rest of the sample.

Programme gang outputs in ADLM Cloud

A programme needs a daily output per trade (m² of blockwork a gang lays in a day, for example) to turn quantities into durations.

NOTE

The programme page (</work/programme>) is still being opened up to customers. If it does not open for you, it is not on your account yet.

1. Open a project's programme (</work/programme>).
2. Under **Where the time comes from**, click **Estimate the outputs**. It also runs once by itself the first time.
3. Check and edit the **Output** column. **Estimate again** reruns it.

Your bill lines are grouped by trade and unit, and a few descriptions from each group go to the AI, which proposes an output per trade. The outputs are stored for the project, and your bill is not changed. At the limit, the screen says this month's allowance is spent and ordinary building figures stay editable.

QUIV for Revit

QUIV 4.0 is the current release, and its new panel is what QUIV opens. The QUIV 3 **classic workspace** only returns on machines ADLM has set up for it. Where a feature lives depends on the workspace.

AI Rate Check

Availability: The QUIV 3 classic workspace only. It is not in the QUIV 4.0 panel; in 4.0, use **Check my rates against the market** in the ADLM Cloud Work area instead.

1. Open **BoQ** in the QUIV sidebar.
2. Click **AI Rate Check**. It reads **Checking...** while it runs.
3. Read the **AI Rate Check** report: lines needing attention, worst first, or "Every checked rate sits within market range of its RateGen benchmark."

How it works: QUIV sends the priced lines (up to 250) through ADLM Cloud to the AI service, which benchmarks them against the Rate Gen library. No rate is changed; the report says so. At the limit you see "This account has used its AI allowance for the month. Contact ADLM support if you need it raised."

Full handover and Auto take-off

Availability: On for everyone signed in. ♦ **Run the whole takeoff** (Full Handover) arrived in QUIV 3.1.9; in QUIV 4.0 it is **Auto take-off**.

It measures every item on your take-off list, level by level and type by type, with QUIV's own measuring engines. Despite the "AI" wording on screen, a run **uses no AI model**. It is rationed because it walks every module over every level.

In QUIV 4.0:

1. Under **How to start**, choose **Auto take-off** ("AI measures, you review"), or click **Auto take-off with AI** on the take-off list.
2. Tick the items in the picker. Items QUIV cannot reach say "You pick this in Revit".
3. Click **Run auto take-off**. Revit stays usable. **Stop** ends the run.
4. Review the results. A result is "sure" when at least 85% of its planned measurements saved without failing; it is not a model's guess.
5. Click **Accept N** for the sure results, or open each item, check it and accept.

Nothing a run measured counts until you accept it. In the classic workspace, ♦ **Run the whole takeoff** sits under the take-off list; QUIV asks permission once and lets you stop or undo the run.

At the limit: runs are counted per day. QUIV warns when two or fewer remain ("2 full handover runs left today") and shows the server's reason at the limit. If the server cannot be reached to count, the run goes ahead rather than block your work.

QUIV AI Assistant, the AI prompt bar and AI Assist

Availability: Not in standard installs. The QUIV 3.1.6 notes announced the AI Assistant, but a normal install does not show it.

You type what you want measured, for example "beam and slab quantities for first floor". The AI picks the QUIV module and the real Revit level name from the lists QUIV sends (nothing else from the model leaves your computer), and QUIV measures it with its normal engines. The AI only routes the request; it never produces a quantity. It appears as **AI Assistant** in the sidebar (**QUIV AI Assistant**, with ♦ **Run**), a prompt bar on module pages and an **AI Assist** pill. Prompts are counted per day.

AI Match Labour and AI Match Materials

Availability: Not in standard installs.

On the budget page, these match rows still priced at zero to real rates: labour against your labour library and the labour part of your build-ups, materials against the Rate Gen materials library. The AI only picks from candidates QUIV sends, and units must agree. Matches at 75% confidence or more are filled in and marked **AI: ...** in the status column for review. Check every one before you save.

HERON for PlanSwift

AI Review (AI Bill Review)

Availability: On for everyone signed in, in HERON 2.9 and HERON 3.0.

AI Review turns raw take-off names into proper bill descriptions, fixes units, finds duplicates, flags rates out of line with the job, and points out items a QS would expect (for example blockwork with no rendering). You can also ask questions about the bill.

1. Open the review sheet: **Review before saving** in HERON 3.0 (in HERON 2.9, click **Save to Cloud** to open the review table).
2. At its foot, click **AI Review**.
3. In **AI Bill Review**, tick **Descriptions**, **Rate sanity** and **Missing items** as needed.
4. Click **Run Review**.
5. Accept the findings you agree with and click **Apply Accepted**.
6. Check the review table and save as usual.

To ask a question, type in **Ask about this bill** (for example "why is substructure so large a share of this job?") and click **Ask**.

How it works:

- HERON sends the table's descriptions, units, quantities and rates, the project name, currency and pricing zone to ADLM's AI service on Amazon Bedrock.
- When you accept or reject suggestions, the service learns your house style (wording, units, section order, rejected phrases). That profile is kept for your account alone.
- Rate checks are benchmarks against the Rate Gen library.
- **Quantities are never altered.** "Suggestions only. Nothing changes in your bill until you accept a finding and press Apply." Saving to the cloud still needs your confirmation.

Auto take-off in HERON

Availability: Beta channel only in HERON 2.9 (open **Settings**, choose **Beta**, tick **Join the beta programme**, then restart HERON). In HERON 3.0, **Auto take-off** sits under **BETA** in the sidebar but is switched off for everyone: "Auto take-off is in beta and is not available in this release."

Match with AI (Fill a client's bill)

Availability: On for everyone signed in, in HERON 3.0.

On HERON's **Excel** screen, **Fill a client's bill** fills a client's own Excel bill with your HERON quantities. **Match with AI** proposes which HERON lines make up each of the client's lines, with a confidence and a reason in the cell note. The AI proposes; you tick; only ticked lines are written, to a copy of their file. It sends the client's descriptions and units and HERON's measured lines, never your drawings. It needs a sign-in and a connection.

HERON's description library and **Specifications** are not AI, though your specifications help AI Review write in your style.

Rate Gen

Build with AI

Availability: On for everyone signed in, in Rate Gen 3.0.1, on by default.

Describe an item of work in one sentence and ADLM AI drafts a full build-up into the custom rate form, for you to check, edit and save.

1. Open a trade screen (for example **Block Works**) and click + **Add Custom Rate**.
2. In **Build with AI**, type a request containing the words "rate" and "build", for example "Build a rate for 225mm blockwork in cement mortar (1:6)".
3. Click **Build with AI**.
4. Read the status, for example "AI draft ready (confidence 85%). Review every line before saving."
5. Check and edit every line, then save the rate yourself.

How it works: Rate Gen sends your sentence, your zone and the names of items in your library (your own first). Components found in your library are priced from **your** library at your rate; the AI's figure is discarded. Only components your library lacks keep an AI estimate, tagged **[AI]**. If the draft fails ADLM's checks, an amber block reads "This build-up did not pass ADLM's checks" and lists what to fix. Nothing saves itself: "An AI draft is an advisory estimate from the ADLM library and market data. It is not a professional opinion and not for contract use until you have checked every line."

Carbon is not AI. **Carbon & Others** works out upfront carbon (RICS A1-A5) from each rate's own build-up and published factors.

Coming: Price a bill

Availability: Coming; built, not yet approved for release.

A **Price a bill** screen will open any client's bill (.xlsx or .xls) in its own layout. ADLM AI proposes one of your Rate Gen rates per item, with the unit as a hard rule, and nothing is priced until you **Accept** a line or **Accept the sure matches**. The client's file is never changed; the priced bill is saved as a copy. A QUIV tool that fills a client's own bill with QUIV quantities is also in development.

SERVIQ for Revit MEP

Availability: Not in standard installs. A normal SERVIQ 2.0 install does not show the **AI Review** page or **BUILD WITH ADLM AI**.

On machines ADLM has set up, **ADLM AI Review** offers **Market check**, **Find errors**, **Clean up bill**, **Auto-price unpriced**, **Import supplier catalogue**, **ASK ABOUT THIS BILL** and **PLAN A TAKE-OFF**, with each finding offering **Apply** or **Dismiss**. "Nothing here changes the bill until you apply it." **BUILD WITH ADLM AI** in the rate composition window drafts a build-up with **Build rate**.

The WhatsApp sales assistant

Availability: Rolling out on ADLM's WhatsApp line, +234 810 650 3524.

It answers questions about ADLM products, prices, trainings and the website, and sends the right page or video. It cannot see your account, licences or projects. It runs on Claude models and answers from a knowledge pack ADLM keeps; it never invents prices, features, dates or links, and will not offer a free trial (there is none). Ask for a person and it tells you how to reach the team. Conversations are kept so the team can follow up: the transcript for 90 days, its tags longer. Never send a password or card number on WhatsApp.

AI allowances and what happens at the limit

There are two counters. Both reset on their own.

The AI service allowance (cost tools)

Market checks, error scans, build-ups, bill reviews and Build with AI draw on a monthly allowance per account, in units: a rate build-up 1, a market check 2, an error scan 1, a HERON clean-up 2, a bill question 1, a QUIV take-off request 1, an AI Match batch 1, a supplier catalogue import 5. Telling the service what you accepted or rejected costs nothing, and so does the same request again within 7 days.

At the time of writing the standard allowance is 200 units a month, resetting at 01:00 WAT on the 1st. At the limit you see a plain message such as "Monthly AI quota reached", and the rest of the product keeps working. Ask [support](#) if you need more.

When ADLM's own AI budget is tight, the error scan, supplier catalogue import and **Ask about this bill** pause first, with a message saying so. Market checks and build-ups stay up longest.

The website allowance (Ada and QUIV actions)

- **Ada:** a monthly allowance per signed-in account ("This account has used its monthly AI allowance ... It resets at the start of next month."). Guests share one monthly limit: "Our AI assistant has reached its limit for visitors this month. Sign in to keep using it, or reach us on WhatsApp."
- **QUIV prompts and handover runs:** counted per day (10 of each at the time of writing), resetting at 01:00 WAT.

AI and your data

What leaves your computer: only what the feature needs: bill lines, a typed request, module and level names, or a sentence describing a rate. The Revit or PlanSwift model itself is never sent to the AI.

Where it goes: ADLM's servers and Amazon Bedrock in ADLM's own AWS account, running Anthropic's Claude models. Ada runs in AWS's Ireland (EU) region; the AI cost tools in AWS's US East region. Under AWS's terms your prompts are not used to train the models, and ADLM does not train anything on your rates or bills.

What ADLM stores	Why	How long
A usage record per AI call (account, feature, product, tokens, estimated cost)	Allowances and spend	Kept

What ADLM stores	Why	How long
A short summary of each AI verdict, with the model and prompt version	So a verdict can be explained later	Kept, never edited
Cached results for the exact request	The same question costs nothing twice	7 days
Your HERON house style	Descriptions in your wording	Kept, your account only
Ada conversations, with your account if signed in and your connection address	Improving Ada and following up enquiries	Kept
WhatsApp conversations	Following up enquiries	Transcript 90 days; tags kept

ADLM never shows one firm's bills, rates or wording to another, never lets Ada read anyone's projects but yours, and never changes your bill, budget or library without your confirmation (QUIV AI Match, not in standard installs, marks every match for review). Every result is advisory: the QS reviews it, and the figures in a contract are the ones you accept.

What's new in 2026.10

- **Ada as estimator and project manager:** project tips, period reports with a PDF card, and rate proposals you confirm with **Apply N rates**. She also knows which project page you are on.
- **Work area** on every cloud project, with Ada and the AI cost checks.
- **Programme gang outputs** estimated from the bill.
- **QUIV 4.0: Auto take-off** with confidence and **Accept N**.
- **HERON 3.0: AI Review** carried over; **Auto take-off** switched off.
- **Rate Gen 3.0.1: Build with AI** on by default, prices from your library first and flags drafts that fail ADLM's checks.
- **All AI runs on Amazon Bedrock** in ADLM's AWS account.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
"AI is not switched on for this account yet", with a note that model access is pending	A temporary server problem. The rest of the product works. Try later or contact support .
"The AI rate check needs an active ADLM subscription..."	Renew your licence at /manage .
"Sign in to ADLM to use AI review." (HERON)	Sign in, then open AI Review again.
"Your session could not be verified..." (QUIV)	Sign out, sign in again and retry.
"Monthly AI quota reached"	Wait for the reset on the 1st, or ask support .
Ada asks "which project" on a sample	Use the Work area buttons, or ask about your own project.

What you see	What to do
Rate Gen asks for the words "rate" and "build"	Start with "Build a rate for..."
No QUIV AI Assistant, AI Match or SERVIQ AI Review	They are not in standard installs.

Frequently asked questions

Is the AI always right? No. It can misread a description, pick the wrong benchmark or miss a local price. That is why every result shows its reason and source, and why you, the QS, check it.

Does ADLM AI make up rates? Rate checks benchmark against the Rate Gen library, and build-ups price from your library first. Where the library has nothing, the AI estimates and marks the line ([AI] in Rate Gen). Check every marked line.

Does AI cost extra? At the time of writing, any active ADLM licence includes the features marked on for everyone, within the allowances above.

Which region are the benchmarks for? One of the Rate Gen library's six Nigerian zones. Tell Ada your region; the desktop products use your profile's zone.

Is my data used to train AI? No. ADLM does not train on your data, and Amazon Bedrock does not use prompts to train the models.

Where do I get help? Visit [support](#), or see the [QUIV](#), [HERON](#), [Rate Gen](#), [SERVIQ for Revit MEP](#) and [ADLM Cloud](#) guides.

The ADLM QS handbook

Key QS formulas, a formula library, constants, grade and unit conversions, ICMS 3 and carbon in cost planning, and real use cases for every ADLM product.

About this handbook

This is a working reference for quantity surveyors and estimators in Nigeria. It sets out the formulas you use every day, the conversion factors behind a material schedule, and the conversions you need when a drawing, a supplier or a client speaks a different unit.

Two kinds of figure appear in it, and each one is labelled:

- **ADLM value.** A default held in ADLM software. The handbook names the product: Rate Gen **Material Constants** on the website, QUIV (the Revit plugin), or HERON. These are the figures your ADLM software will use unless you change them.
- **Typical.** A widely used industry figure, with its assumption stated. Use it as a starting point and check it against your specification, your supplier and your site.
- **Worked from ADLM values.** A figure this handbook calculates from ADLM's own constants and carbon factors, such as the carbon in a cubic metre of 1:2:4 concrete. Your software works it out from your own build-up, so its figure can differ a little.

IMPORTANT

Nothing here replaces the contract documents. A specification, a structural engineer's bar schedule or a design mix always overrides a rule of thumb. Where a figure in this handbook and your drawings disagree, the drawings win.

NOTE

ADLM's material defaults were recalibrated in September 2026 against the build-up formulas in several hundred real Nigerian bills. If your copy of QUIV, HERON or Rate Gen shows a different figure, you may be on an earlier version, or someone on your account may have changed it. You can see and edit every value in **Material Constants**.

Prices in the worked examples are illustrative only. Use current prices from your own Rate Gen library or your suppliers.

Key QS formulas

Each formula below gives the units, a worked example and the mistake that most often goes with it.

Areas and volumes of common shapes

Shape	Area or volume	Units
Rectangle	$A = L \times B$	m ²
Triangle	$A = \frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height}$	m ²

Shape	Area or volume	Units
Trapezium	$A = \frac{1}{2} \times (a + b) \times h$	m^2
Circle	$A = \pi \times d^2 \div 4$	m^2
Annulus (ring)	$A = \pi \times (D^2 - d^2) \div 4$	m^2
Sector	$A = (\theta \div 360) \times \pi \times r^2$	m^2
Prism or slab	$V = \text{cross-section area} \times \text{length}$	m^3
Cylinder (pile, column)	$V = \pi \times d^2 \div 4 \times h$	m^3
Cone or pyramid	$V = \frac{1}{3} \times \text{base area} \times h$	m^3
Frustum (tapered pad, cone)	$V = h \div 3 \times (A1 + A2 + \sqrt{(A1 \times A2)})$	m^3
Sphere	$V = \pi \times d^3 \div 6$	m^3

Worked example. A bored pile 600 mm in diameter and 10 m deep:

$$V = \pi \times 0.6^2 \div 4 \times 10 = 0.2827 \times 10 = \mathbf{2.83 \text{ m}^3} \text{ of concrete per pile.}$$

HERON's piling template uses the same formula: concrete = number of piles $\times$ depth $\times \pi \times (D \div 2)^2$.

TIP

Convert every dimension to metres before you multiply. A 600 mm diameter entered as 600 turns 2.83 m^3 into $2,827,433 \text{ m}^3$.

Common mistake: using the radius where the formula wants the diameter (or the reverse). $\pi \times d^2 \div 4$ and $\pi \times r^2$ give the same answer only if you use the right one.

Girth and centre-line method for trenches and walls

For a wall or a trench that runs all round a building, measure along the centre line. The centre line is shorter than the outside perimeter and longer than the inside perimeter.

You know	Centre-line girth of a rectangular building
External dimensions $L \times B$	$2 \times (L + B) - 4t$
Internal dimensions $L \times B$	$2 \times (L + B) + 4t$

Here t is the wall thickness (or the trench width, for a trench measured from its own edges). Each external corner takes $2 \times \frac{1}{2}t$ off the outside girth, and a rectangle has four corners, so $4t$ comes off in total. A building with set-backs still loses $4t$ overall, because every extra outside corner is balanced by an inside corner.

Worked example. A bungalow measures $12.00 \times 8.00 \text{ m}$ over 225 mm external walls. The strip footing trench is 675 mm wide and 900 mm deep, centred on the wall.

1. External perimeter = $2 \times (12.00 + 8.00) = 40.00 \text{ m}$.
2. Centre-line girth = $40.00 - 4 \times 0.225 = \mathbf{39.10 \text{ m}}$.
3. Excavation = $39.10 \times 0.675 \times 0.90 = \mathbf{23.75 \text{ m}^3}$.
4. Blockwork in foundation, 900 mm high = $39.10 \times 0.90 = \mathbf{35.19 \text{ m}^2}$.

Internal walls. An internal wall runs between the inner faces of the external walls. Its trench runs only between the inner edges of the external trenches, which are further apart.

For one internal wall across the 8.00 m width of the example:

- Wall length = $8.00 - 2 \times 0.225 = 7.55 \text{ m}$.
- The external trench's inner edge sits $0.1125 + 0.3375 = 0.45 \text{ m}$ in from the outside face, so the trench length = $8.00 - 2 \times 0.45 = 7.10 \text{ m}$.

Common mistake: measuring the internal trench at the wall length (7.55 m). The 0.45 m at each end has already been dug as part of the external trench, so it would be measured twice.

Excavation, bulking and compaction

Quantity	Formula	Units
Trench excavation	$(w + 2 \times \text{working space}) \times \text{depth} \times \text{length}$	m^3
Pad excavation	$(L + 2ws) \times (B + 2ws) \times \text{depth}$	m^3
Earthwork support (trench)	$2 \times \text{depth} \times \text{length}$	m^2
Loose volume to cart away	$\text{in-situ volume} \times (1 + \text{bulking \%})$	m^3
Loose fill to order	$\text{compacted volume} \times \text{compaction factor}$	m^3
Disposal	$\text{excavated volume} - \text{volume backfilled}$	m^3

A working space of **0.30 m** each side of strip and pad excavation is a typical allowance, and earthwork support is measured as $2 \times \text{depth} \times \text{length}$.

NOTE

Methods of measurement treat working space differently. Some measure the net size of the foundation and leave working space in the rate; others allow it as a separate item. Follow the method named in your contract (BESMM4, NRM2 or SMM7) and say which one you used in your preambles.

Typical bulking (in-situ to loose, after digging):

Material	Typical bulking
Sand and gravel	10 to 15%
Ordinary soil, loam, laterite	20 to 30%
Clay	30 to 40%
Broken rock	50 to 70%

Typical compaction. Laterite and sand fill lose roughly 15 to 30% of their loose volume when compacted in layers, so a compaction factor of about **1.2 to 1.3** loose m^3 per compacted m^3 is common. Hardcore varies with its grading.

Worked example. From the trench above (23.75 m^3 in-situ, ordinary soil):

1. Loose volume = $23.75 \times 1.25 = 29.69 \text{ m}^3$.

2. With a tipper carrying about 6 m³ loose (ask your haulier for the real figure), that is $29.69 \div 6 = 4.9$, so **5 trips**.

Filling in tonnes. QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen **Material Constants** all convert measured fill to tonnes at **1.6 t/m³** (hardcore, laterite and general fill).

Hardcore 150 mm thick inside the example building (7.55 × 11.55 m):

- Area = $7.55 \times 11.55 = 87.20 \text{ m}^2$.
- Volume = $87.20 \times 0.15 = 13.08 \text{ m}^3$.
- Weight = $13.08 \times 1.6 = \mathbf{20.93 \text{ t}}$.

IMPORTANT

Never treat trips per m³ as tonnes per m³. A common bill template converts fill with "m³ ÷ 3.51", which gives tipper TRIPS. Reading that 0.285 as tonnes per m³ makes the filling about six times too light. ADLM's software had this error and it was corrected in September 2026; check any spreadsheet you inherit for the same thing.

Concrete volume, dry volume and mix materials

Volume is length × width × depth, in m³. Measure net. Do not deduct the space taken by reinforcement. SMM7 and NRM2 do not deduct voids of 0.05 m³ or less; check the rule in your contract's method.

Dry volume. Cement, sand and granite shrink when they are mixed with water, because the fine material fills the voids between the coarse. One cubic metre of placed concrete needs about **1.54 m³** of dry materials. QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen **Material Constants** all use 1.54. That factor already carries the normal allowance for waste, so ADLM's concrete waste factor is **1.00**.

ADLM's formula (QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen **Material Constants**), for a mix c : s : g and V m³ of concrete:

- Cement (bags) = $V \times (c \div (c + s + g)) \times 1.54 \times 1,440 \div 50$
- Sharp sand (t) = $V \times (s \div (c + s + g)) \times 1.54 \times 1,440 \div 1,000$
- Granite (t) = sharp sand tonnes × 2

The constants are: cement 1,440 kg/m³, sharp sand 1,440 kg/m³, a 50 kg bag, and a granite-to-sand multiplier of 2.

Materials per m³ of concrete (ADLM values):

Mix	Cement (bags)	Sharp sand (t)	Sharp sand (m ³ loose)	Granite (t)
1:1:2	11.09	0.55	0.39	1.11
1:1.5:3	8.06	0.60	0.42	1.21
1:2:4	6.34	0.63	0.44	1.27
1:3:6	4.44	0.67	0.46	1.33
1:4:8	3.41	0.68	0.47	1.37

Worked example. The strip footing from the girth example is 675 mm wide and 225 mm thick, in 1:2:4.

1. Volume = $39.10 \times 0.675 \times 0.225 = \mathbf{5.94 \text{ m}^3}$.
2. Cement = $5.94 \times 6.34 = 37.6$, so order **38 bags**.

3. Sharp sand = $5.94 \times 0.63 = 3.76 \text{ t}$.

4. Granite = $5.94 \times 1.27 = 7.53 \text{ t}$.

5. At an illustrative ₦11,500 a bag, the cement costs $38 \times 11,500 = \text{₦}437,000$.

NOTE

The granite rule "sand $\times 2$ " is right for every mix in the table, because each has twice as much stone as sand. For a mix such as 1:2:3, work the granite out from its own share: $V \times (3 \div 6) \times 1.54 \times \text{density}$.

Common mistakes:

- **Leaving out the dry-volume factor.** Applying 1:2:4 to the wet volume gives 4.3 bags/m³ instead of about 6.3, which under-orders cement by a third.
- **Confusing cement density with bags per m³ of concrete.** 1 m³ of cement weighs 1,440 kg, which is 28.8 bags. That is the bulk density of the cement itself, not the cement in a cubic metre of concrete. A bill that prints 28.8 bags/m³ for 1:2:4 has made exactly this mistake.

Blinding

Blinding is a thin, lean concrete layer, usually 50 to 75 mm, under footings and slabs. Its volume is area $\times$ thickness, in m³.

QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen **Material Constants** treat blinding as a lean **1:4:8** mix:

Per m ³ of blinding (ADLM value)	Before waste	With 5% waste
Cement	3.25 bags	3.41 bags
Sharp sand	0.65 t	0.68 t
Granite	1.30 t	1.37 t

Worked example. Blinding 50 mm thick under the strip footing:

1. Volume = $39.10 \times 0.675 \times 0.05 = 1.32 \text{ m}^3$.
2. Cement = $1.32 \times 3.41 = 4.5$, so **5 bags**.
3. Sharp sand = $1.32 \times 0.68 = 0.90 \text{ t}$.
4. Granite = $1.32 \times 1.37 = 1.80 \text{ t}$.

Common mistakes:

- **Costing blinding as 1:2:4.** That gives 6.3 bags/m³ for a layer that needs about 3.4.
- **Leaving out the granite.** Blinding at 1:4:8 or 1:10 still contains stone. QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen once carried about 0.9 bag/m³ and no granite; this was corrected in September 2026.

Blockwork

Nigerian sandcrete blocks have a face of 450 $\times$ 225 mm. With 10 to 15 mm joints, a square metre of wall takes about 9.3 blocks, and practice orders **10 per m²** to cover breakage on delivery. The count is the same for 225 mm and 150 mm blocks, because the face size is the same.

ADLM values (QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen Material Constants):

Per m ² of wall	Value
Blocks	10 nr
Blockwork waste factor	1.03 (QUIV, Rate Gen); 1.05 (HERON)
Mortar cement	0.20 bag
Mortar sharp sand	0.055 t

ADLM applies the mortar figure to every block thickness. A 150 mm wall uses less mortar than a 225 mm wall. A typical allowance is about **two-thirds** of the 225 mm figure, roughly 0.13 bag of cement and 0.036 t of sand per m², assuming the same 1:6 mortar and the same joint thickness. If you price a lot of 150 mm walling, set your own figure in **Material Constants**.

Area to measure. Measure the net face area of the wall, on its centre line, and deduct openings. SMM7 and NRM2 do not deduct voids of 0.5 m² or less. Check the rule in the method named in your contract, including BESMM4.

Worked example. Ground-floor 225 mm walls 3.00 m high on the 39.10 m centre line, with four 1.20 × 1.20 m windows and two 0.90 × 2.10 m doors.

1. Gross area = 39.10 × 3.00 = 117.30 m².
2. Openings = 4 × 1.44 + 2 × 1.89 = 5.76 + 3.78 = 9.54 m².
3. Net area = 117.30 – 9.54 = **107.76 m²**.
4. Blocks = 107.76 × 10 × 1.03 = **1,110 blocks**.
5. Cement = 107.76 × 0.20 = 21.6, so **22 bags**.
6. Sharp sand = 107.76 × 0.055 = **5.93 t**.
7. At an illustrative ₦1,300 a block, the blocks cost 1,110 × 1,300 = **₦1,443,000**.

Common mistake: using the outside perimeter instead of the centre line. On this building that adds 0.90 × 3.00 = 2.7 m² of walling that does not exist, and on a large building the error grows with every corner.

Plaster, render and screed

ADLM per m² values (QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen Material Constants):

Work	Cement per m ²	Sand per m ²
Render or plaster, one face	0.13 bag	0.05 t plaster sand
Floor screed (40 mm, 1:3)	0.40 bag	0.057 t sharp sand
Tile bed (floor)	0.40 bag	0.057 t sharp sand
POP wall screeding	0.04 bag	none

These are per m² of the face measured, the way Nigerian bills state them. The render figure includes the usual allowance for dubbing out uneven blockwork.

From first principles, using HERON's method:

Cement (bags) = area × thickness × dry factor × waste × (c ÷ (c + s)) × 28.8

The 28.8 is the number of 50 kg bags in a cubic metre of cement (1,440 ÷ 50). HERON's defaults are:

- **Screed:** 40 mm, 1:3, dry factor 1.30, waste 1.05.
- **Render:** 12 mm, 1:6, dry factor 1.30, waste 1.05.

For screed: $1 \times 0.040 \times 1.30 \times 1.05 \times 0.25 \times 28.8 = 0.39 \text{ bag/m}^2$, which agrees with the 0.40 in the table.

For a 12 mm 1:6 render, the same sum gives about 0.07 bag/m² before any dubbing out. That is why the bill figure of 0.13 is higher.

Worked example. Screed 40 mm thick to the 87.20 m² floor:

1. Cement = $87.20 \times 0.40 = 34.9$, so **35 bags**.
2. Sharp sand = $87.20 \times 0.057 = 4.97 \text{ t}$.

For a different screed thickness, scale it: about **0.01 bag of cement per mm per m²** at 1:3.

Common mistake: pricing render on both faces of a wall from one face area, or the reverse. Measure each face you will plaster.

Reinforcement weight, laps, cutting lengths and bends

Unit weight. Steel weighs 7,850 kg/m³, so a bar of diameter d mm weighs:

$$\text{kg/m} = d^2 \div 162 \text{ (exactly } 0.006165 \times d^2\text{)}$$

QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen **Material Constants** all use a coefficient of **0.00617 kg/m per mm²**, which is the same rule. Many ADLM templates write it as $(d^2 \div 36) \times 0.2222$, which is $d^2 \div 162$ in another form.

Bar schedule table (12 m bars):

Bar	kg/m ($d^2 \div 162$)	kg/m (BS exact)	kg per 12 m bar	Bars per tonne
6 mm	0.222	0.222	2.67	375
8 mm	0.395	0.395	4.74	211
10 mm	0.617	0.617	7.41	135
12 mm	0.889	0.888	10.67	94
16 mm	1.580	1.578	18.96	53
20 mm	2.469	2.466	29.63	34
25 mm	3.858	3.853	46.30	22
32 mm	6.321	6.313	75.85	13

Bars per tonne are rounded. When you order, round up to whole bars for each diameter.

Stock length. ADLM's standard stock length is **12 m** (QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen **Material Constants**). Some mills deliver bars a little short of 12 m. That is why some ADLM bar counts use a usable length of 11 to 11.7 m.

Laps. Where a run is longer than a stock bar, bars are lapped. A typical tension lap is **40 to 50 bar diameters** (40d for a Y16 is 640 mm). The real figure depends on concrete grade, bar type and position, and the structural drawings state it.

Waste and lap allowances held by ADLM:

Allowance	Value	Product
General reinforcement waste	1.05	QUIV, Rate Gen Material Constants
General reinforcement waste	1.10	HERON
Beam main bars, laps and waste	1.15	QUIV
Staircase bars, laps and waste	1.10	QUIV
Lap/bend extra on column and pile bars	0.30 m per bar	HERON templates
Lap/bend extra on beam bars	1.20 m per bar	HERON templates
Binding wire	0.01 kg per kg of steel (10 kg/t)	QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants

Rates per m³ of concrete. When there is no bar schedule yet, an estimate can price steel as kilograms per m³ of concrete. Typical starting rates, used by ADLM as defaults, are:

Element	Typical starting rate
Strip footing	40 kg/m ³
Slab	80 kg/m ³
Beam	160 kg/m ³
Column	180 kg/m ³

Replace them with the engineer's bar schedule as soon as you have it. Real rates vary widely with spans, loads and the designer's detailing.

Link cutting length. HERON's beam and column link templates use:

$$\text{link length} = 2 \times ((b - 2c) + (h - 2c)) + 0.15 \text{ m}$$

where b and h are the member's width and depth and c is the cover. The 0.15 m allows for the two hooks. The number of links is (length ÷ spacing) + 1.

Bends. Under BS 8666 (shape code 11, an L-bar), total length = A + B – 0.5r – d, where r is the bending radius. With the standard radius of 2d for bars up to 16 mm, this works out as a deduction of **2d for each 90° bend**. Larger bars use a larger radius, so take the length from the bar schedule.

Worked example. A beam 225 × 450 mm, 6.00 m long. It has 3 Y16 bottom bars and 2 Y16 top bars, with R10 links at 200 mm centres and 50 mm cover (HERON's default).

1. Main bars = 5 × 6.00 × 1.580 × 1.15 (QUIV's beam laps and waste) = **54.5 kg**.
2. Link length = 2 × ((0.225 – 0.10) + (0.45 – 0.10)) + 0.15 = 2 × 0.475 + 0.15 = **1.10 m**.
3. Number of links = 6.00 ÷ 0.20 + 1 = **31**.
4. Links = 31 × 1.10 × 0.617 = **21.0 kg**.
5. Total = 54.5 + 21.0 = **75.5 kg**, plus 0.76 kg of binding wire.

An L-bar Y12 with legs of 2.00 m and 0.30 m has a cutting length of 2.30 – 2 × 0.012 = **2.276 m**.

Common mistakes:

- **Mixing kilograms and tonnes.** 75.5 kg is 0.0755 t. A rate per tonne applied to a quantity in kg is a thousand times too high, and a tonne quantity read as kg is a thousand times too low. An older HERON build made this error when an item was measured in tonnes; it was corrected in September 2026.
- **Applying a lap allowance twice.** That happens when you add laps bar by bar and then also apply a percentage on top.

Formwork areas

Formwork is measured as the area of concrete face in contact with it, in m².

Member	Formwork area
Beam (soffit and two sides)	$(2h + w) \times L$
Column	$2 \times (a + b) \times h$
Pad footing sides	$2 \times (L + B) \times h$
Suspended slab soffit	net soffit area
Slab edges	perimeter $\times$ slab thickness
Pile casing (if used)	$\pi \times d \times \text{depth}$

QUIV uses $(2h + w) \times L$ for beams and $2 \times (w + d) \times h$ for columns.

Board and sundries (ADLM values, QUIV, HERON and Rate Gen Material Constants):

Item	Value
Board coverage	2.88 m ² per sheet (2.4 $\times$ 1.2 m)
Nails	0.0576 bag per sheet, about 0.02 bag per m ² (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen). HERON stores 0.0524 per sheet because it already adds 10% board waste, which comes to the same 0.02 bag per m ² .
Bracing timber	6.3 m per sheet (QUIV, Rate Gen); 0.60 piece per m ² (HERON)
Formwork waste	1.10 (HERON)

Worked example. Formwork to the 225 $\times$ 450 mm beam, 6.00 m long:

1. Area = $(2 \times 0.45 + 0.225) \times 6.00 = 1.125 \times 6.00 = \mathbf{6.75 \text{ m}^2}$.
2. Sheets = $6.75 \div 2.88 = \mathbf{2.34 \text{ sheets}}$.
3. Nails = $2.34 \times 0.0576 = \mathbf{0.13 \text{ bag}}$.
4. Bracing = $2.34 \times 6.3 = \mathbf{14.8 \text{ m}}$.

TIP

If your beam depth is the overall depth including a slab cast with it, deduct the slab thickness from h for the sides. The slab soffit formwork already covers that strip.

Common mistake: measuring formwork to the top face of a slab or footing. Only the faces the concrete is cast against are measured.

Roofing: pitch factor, rafter length and sheets

Pitch factor. The area on the slope = plan area × pitch factor, where pitch factor = $1 \div \cos(\text{pitch})$. This works for gable and hipped roofs, as long as every slope has the same pitch. Use the plan area measured over the eaves.

Pitch	Pitch factor	Slope (%)
10°	1.015	17.6
15°	1.035	26.8
20°	1.064	36.4
22.5°	1.082	41.4
25°	1.103	46.6
30°	1.155	57.7
35°	1.221	70.0
40°	1.305	83.9
45°	1.414	100.0

Rafter length. QUIV's roof module uses:

- rafter length = (half span + overhang) ÷ cos(pitch)
- rise = half span × tan(pitch)

The span is measured between wall plates.

ADLM roof defaults:

Item	Value	Product
Rafter spacing	1.2 m	HERON
Purlin spacing	0.9 m	HERON
Eaves overhang	0.6 m	HERON
Timber stock length	3.6 m	QUIV, HERON
Covering per sheet	2.0 m ²	QUIV, HERON
Nails per sheet or bundle	30	QUIV, HERON
Ridge cap cover per piece	0.8 m	HERON
Roof sheet per m ² of covered area	1.0 m ² /m ²	Rate Gen Material Constants

Worked example. The 12.00 × 8.00 m bungalow (wall plates 8.00 m apart), a 0.60 m overhang all round, and a 30° pitch.

1. Plan over eaves = $13.20 \times 9.20 = 121.44 \text{ m}^2$.
2. Area on slope = $121.44 \times 1.155 = 140.2 \text{ m}^2$.
3. Rafter length = $(4.00 + 0.60) \div \cos 30^\circ = 4.60 \div 0.866 = 5.31 \text{ m}$.

4. Rise = $4.00 \times \tan 30^\circ = 2.31$ m.

5. At 2.0 m^2 of cover per sheet, $140.2 \div 2.0 = 70.1$, so **71 sheets**.

Laps on long-span sheets. Rate Gen's 1.0 m^2 per m^2 assumes your measured area already covers the laps, or that the sheet is priced per m^2 of cover. If you buy by sheet width, allow for the side lap: a sheet about 1.0 m wide typically covers 0.85 to 0.9 m. Allow an end lap of about 150 to 200 mm where sheets join along the slope. Together these usually add **10 to 15%** to the net area on the slope. Check the manufacturer's effective cover width.

Common mistake: pricing roof covering on the plan area. At 30° , that leaves out 15.5% of the roof.

Painting coverage

ADLM values:

Product	Value
QUIV, Rate Gen Material Constants	0.026 drum (20 L) per m^2 , all coats, which is 0.52 L/m^2
HERON	2.0 m^2 per litre, all coats (0.5 L/m^2), plus 5% waste
HERON primer	3.57 m^2 per litre, plus 5% waste

Typical. A good emulsion covers about 10 to 12 m^2 per litre per coat on smooth, sealed plaster. Expect less on rough render. A mist coat plus two full coats on new render comes close to ADLM's 0.5 L per m^2 .

Worked example. 250 m^2 of emulsion:

- QUIV and Rate Gen: $250 \times 0.026 = 6.5$ drums (130 L).
- HERON: $250 \times 1.05 \div 2.0 = 131.25$, so **132 L**.

Common mistake: applying a per-coat coverage figure ($10 \text{ m}^2/\text{L}$) to a total that needs three coats. That under-orders paint by about two-thirds.

Tiling with wastage

ADLM values:

Item	Value	Product
Tiles per m^2 of floor or wall	1.10 m^2 (10% cutting waste)	QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants
Tile pack coverage	1.44 m^2 per pack	QUIV, HERON
Bed (cement)	0.40 bag per m^2	QUIV, Rate Gen Material Constants
Bed (sharp sand)	0.057 t per m^2	QUIV, Rate Gen Material Constants
White cement grout	0.02 bag per m^2 (about 1 kg)	QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants
Floor tile bed	40 mm, 1:3	HERON
Wall tile bed	25 mm, 1:3	HERON

A pack of 1.44 m^2 is four $600 \times 600 \text{ mm}$ tiles. To count individual tiles: number = area $\times$ waste factor $\div$ area of one tile.

Worked example. 600 × 600 mm floor tiles to 87.20 m²:

1. Tiles = 87.20 × 1.10 = **95.92 m²**.
2. Packs = 95.92 ÷ 1.44 = 66.6, so **67 packs**.
3. Bed = 87.20 × 0.40 = **35 bags** of cement and 87.20 × 0.057 = **4.97 t** of sand.
4. Grout = 87.20 × 0.02 = **1.74 bags** of white cement.

Allow more waste (12 to 15%) for small rooms, diagonal laying or large-format tiles.

Common mistake: ordering exactly the net area. Cuts at walls and around fittings always produce offcuts you cannot use.

Earthworks volumes: average end area and prismoidal

For cuttings, embankments and road works, take cross-sections at regular intervals and calculate the volume between them.

Method	Formula
Average end area (two sections)	$V = L \times (A1 + A2) \div 2$
Average end area (series, spacing d)	$V = d \times (A1 \div 2 + A2 + A3 + \dots + An \div 2)$
Prismoidal (end areas A1, A2, true mid-section Am)	$V = L \div 6 \times (A1 + 4Am + A2)$
Simpson's rule (odd number of sections, spacing d)	$V = d \div 3 \times (A1 + 4(A2 + A4 + \dots) + 2(A3 + A5 + \dots) + An)$
Spot levels on a grid (cell area a)	$V = a \div 4 \times (\Sigma h1 + 2\Sigma h2 + 3\Sigma h3 + 4\Sigma h4)$

In the grid formula, h1 to h4 are depths at points shared by 1, 2, 3 and 4 grid cells.

Worked example. Three cross-sections 20 m apart: 12.5 m², 15.0 m² and 18.2 m².

1. Average end area: $20 \times (12.5 \div 2 + 15.0 + 18.2 \div 2) = 20 \times 30.35 = \mathbf{607 \text{ m}^3}$.
2. Prismoidal over 40 m, with 15.0 m² as the mid-section: $40 \div 6 \times (12.5 + 4 \times 15.0 + 18.2) = 6.667 \times 90.7 = \mathbf{605 \text{ m}^3}$.

Average end area usually gives slightly more than prismoidal. The difference grows where the sections change shape sharply.

Common mistake: using a mid-section in the prismoidal formula that was averaged from the two end sections. It must be a surveyed section at the true midpoint, or the formula gives the same answer as average end area.

Pipework and cable lengths with fittings allowances

Lengths. Measure along the run, including the vertical drops to each outlet, switch or fitting. BESMM and SMM measure pipework and cable in metres, with fittings counted as extra over the pipe.

Stock lengths and connectors. These are ADLM values from the Rate Gen **Service Constants** on the website:

Service	Standard length	Connectors
Pipe	6 m	one per joint (lengths – 1)
Conduit	3 m	one per joint

Service	Standard length	Connectors
Cable tray or trunking	3 m	one per joint
Duct	1.2 m	one per joint
Cable	100 m drum	none

The fittings allowance in **Service Constants** is **0%** by default. Rate Gen adds nothing for fittings unless you set a percentage. ADLM's MEP plugin takes lengths from the Revit model and adds no fittings allowance of its own.

Typical allowances where fittings are not measured separately:

- Pipework fittings: 10 to 15% of the pipe cost.
- Cable: 5 to 10% on length, for terminations, loops and snaking.
- Conduit: about 10% for bends and boxes.

These are rules of thumb for early estimates. A priced bill should measure fittings.

Worked example.

1. 47 m of 20 mm conduit: $47 \div 3 = 15.7$, so **16 lengths** and **15 couplers**.
2. 64 m of pipe: $64 \div 6 = 10.7$, so **11 lengths** and **10 couplings**.
3. 230 m of 2.5 mm² cable with a 10% allowance: $230 \times 1.10 = 253$ m, which is 3 drums of 100 m.

Common mistake: counting one coupler per length. A straight run of n lengths has n – 1 joints.

Formula library

One row for each formula in this handbook.

Item	Formula	Units	Notes
Rectangle	$L \times B$	m ²	
Triangle	$\frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height}$	m ²	
Trapezium	$\frac{1}{2} \times (a + b) \times h$	m ²	
Circle	$\pi \times d^2 \div 4$	m ²	d is the diameter
Cylinder	$\pi \times d^2 \div 4 \times h$	m ³	Piles, round columns
Cone or pyramid	$\frac{1}{3} \times \text{base area} \times h$	m ³	
Frustum	$h \div 3 \times (A1 + A2 + \sqrt{(A1 \times A2)})$	m ³	Tapered pads
Centre-line girth (external dims)	$2(L + B) - 4t$	m	Rectangle; any plan loses 4t net
Centre-line girth (internal dims)	$2(L + B) + 4t$	m	
Trench excavation	$(w + 2ws) \times d \times L$	m ³	ws = working space, typically 0.30 m

Item	Formula	Units	Notes
Earthwork support	$2 \times d \times L$	m ²	Both sides of a trench
Loose volume	in-situ $\times (1 + \text{bulking})$	m ³	Bulking 10 to 70% by soil type
Fill to order	compacted $\times 1.2$ to 1.3	m ³	Typical compaction factor
Fill weight	m ³ $\times 1.6$	t	ADLM value
Concrete cement	$V \times c \div \Sigma \times 1.54 \times 1,440 \div 50$	bags	ADLM; 6.34 bags/m ³ for 1:2:4
Concrete sand	$V \times s \div \Sigma \times 1.54 \times 1.44$	t	ADLM
Concrete granite	sand t $\times 2$	t	ADLM; valid when g = 2s
Blinding (1:4:8)	$V \times 1.05 \times (3.25 \text{ bags}, 0.65 \text{ t}, 1.30 \text{ t})$	bags, t	ADLM
Blocks	area $\times 10 \times 1.03$	nr	ADLM; same for 225 and 150
Blockwork mortar	area $\times 0.20 \text{ bag} + \text{area} \times 0.055 \text{ t}$	bags, t	ADLM, 225 mm
Render	area $\times 0.13 \text{ bag} + \text{area} \times 0.05 \text{ t}$	bags, t	ADLM, per face
Screed (40 mm 1:3)	area $\times 0.40 \text{ bag} + \text{area} \times 0.057 \text{ t}$	bags, t	ADLM
Mortar (first principles)	$A \times t \times \text{dry} \times \text{waste} \times c \div (c + s) \times 28.8$	bags	HERON method
Rebar weight	$d^2 \div 162 \times \text{length}$	kg	d in mm
Bars per tonne	$1,000 \div (d^2 \div 162 \times 12)$	nr	12 m bars
Lap length	40d to 50d	mm	Typical; drawings govern
Link length	$2((b - 2c) + (h - 2c)) + 0.15$	m	HERON template
Number of links	$L \div \text{spacing} + 1$	nr	
L-bar cutting length	$A + B - 0.5r - d$	m	BS 8666 shape 11; 2d per 90° bend for d ≤ 16 mm
Binding wire	steel kg $\times 0.01$	kg	ADLM
Beam formwork	$(2h + w) \times L$	m ²	QUIV
Column formwork	$2(a + b) \times h$	m ²	QUIV
Formwork sheets	area $\div 2.88$	sheets	ADLM
Pitch factor	$1 \div \cos(\text{pitch})$	factor	
Roof slope area	plan area over eaves $\times \text{pitch factor}$	m ²	Uniform pitch
Rafter length	$(\frac{1}{2} \text{ span} + \text{overhang}) \div \cos(\text{pitch})$	m	QUIV
Roof rise	$\frac{1}{2} \text{ span} \times \tan(\text{pitch})$	m	QUIV
Roof sheets	slope area $\div 2.0$	sheets	QUIV, HERON
Paint	area $\times 0.026$	20 L drums	QUIV, Rate Gen; 0.52 L/m ² all coats

Item	Formula	Units	Notes
Tiles	$\text{area} \times 1.10$	m ²	QUIV, Rate Gen
Tile packs	$\text{area} \times 1.10 \div 1.44$	packs	QUIV, HERON
Average end area	$L \times (A1 + A2) \div 2$	m ³	
Prismoidal	$L \div 6 \times (A1 + 4A_m + A2)$	m ³	A _m measured, not averaged
Pipe lengths	$\text{run} \div \text{stock length, rounded up}$	nr	6 m pipe, 3 m conduit
Couplers	$\text{lengths} - 1$	nr	Per straight run
Material carbon, A1-A5	$\text{kg} \times (\text{factor} + A4 + \text{wf} \times (\text{factor} + A4 + 0.005 + 0.013))$	kgCO ₂ e	Rate Gen method (IStructE 2020)
Carbon waste factor	$w \div (1 - w)$	factor	5% waste gives 0.053
Site fuel carbon (A5a)	$\text{litres} \times 2.66$	kgCO ₂ e	Diesel; ADLM value
Tonnes of carbon	$\text{kgCO}_2\text{e} \div 1,000$	tCO ₂ e	
Cement carbon	$\text{bags} \times 45.4$ (low end 31.7)	kgCO ₂ e	Worked from ADLM values, A1-A5
Rebar carbon	$\text{tonnes} \times 899$	kgCO ₂ e	Worked from ADLM values, A1-A5
225 mm block carbon	$\text{blocks} \times 2.31$	kgCO ₂ e	Worked from ADLM values; assumed mass
1:2:4 concrete carbon	$\text{m}^3 \times 317$ (low end 230)	kgCO ₂ e	Worked from ADLM values
Carbon coverage	$\text{cost with a carbon figure} \div \text{total cost}$	%	ICMS export
Cost per m ² (ICMS 3)	$\text{total construction cost} \div \text{IPMS 2 (or IPMS 1) area}$	₦/m ²	State which area
Carbon per m ² (ICMS 3)	$\text{total kgCO}_2\text{e} \div \text{IPMS 2 (or IPMS 1) area}$	kgCO ₂ e/m ²	State which area
ICMS Group 08	$(\text{measured} + \text{PC and provisional sums}) \times \text{preliminaries \%}$	₦	ADLM Cloud
ICMS 09.020	$(\text{measured} + \text{sums} + \text{preliminaries}) \times \text{contingency \%}$	₦	ADLM Cloud
ICMS 10.020	$(\text{subtotal} + \text{contingency}) \times \text{VAT \%}$	₦	ADLM Cloud

Constants

Material densities and conversions

Material	Value	Source
Cement, bulk	1,440 kg/m ³	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)

Material	Value	Source
Sharp sand, for concrete conversion	1,440 kg/m ³	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Hardcore, laterite, general fill	1.6 t/m ³	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Sharp sand and granite, for rate conversion	1.6 t/m ³	ADLM (QUIV rate conversion)
Dry volume factor, concrete	1.54	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Dry volume factor, mortar, screed, render	1.30	ADLM (HERON)
Dry volume factor, tile beds	1.20	ADLM (HERON)
Plain concrete	2,400 kg/m ³	Typical
Reinforced concrete	2,500 kg/m ³	Typical (about 2% steel)
Steel	7,850 kg/m ³	Typical
Water	1,000 kg/m ³	Typical
Loose sand, dry	1,450 to 1,600 kg/m ³	Typical; varies with moisture
Granite chippings, loose	1,450 to 1,600 kg/m ³	Typical
Compacted laterite	1,800 to 2,000 kg/m ³	Typical

NOTE

ADLM uses 1,440 kg/m³ for sharp sand because that is the median of the trip-to-tonne conversions Nigerian firms use in their own bills (they range from 1.36 to 1.67 t/m³). Damp sand bulks and weighs differently, so check what your supplier means by a tonne.

Bag, roll and pack sizes

Item	Size	Source
Cement bag	50 kg	ADLM
Emulsion paint drum	20 L	ADLM
POP glue (Top Bond)	10 kg	ADLM
Formwork board	2.4 × 1.2 m (2.88 m ²)	ADLM
BRC mesh roll	48 m ² gross, 45.7 m ² net of 5% laps	ADLM
DPM roll	50 m ² gross, 45.5 m ² net of 10% laps	ADLM
DPC roll	50 m	ADLM (HERON)

Item	Size	Source
Waterproofing felt roll	40 m ²	ADLM (Rate Gen Material Constants)
Tile pack	1.44 m ²	ADLM (QUIV, HERON)
Reinforcement bar	12 m	ADLM
Roof timber	3.6 m	ADLM
Conduit, trunking	3 m	ADLM (Rate Gen)
Pipe	6 m	ADLM (Rate Gen)
Cable drum	100 m	ADLM (Rate Gen)

Wastage allowances

Work	Factor	Source
Concrete (on top of 1.54)	1.00	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Blinding	1.05	ADLM
Blockwork	1.03	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Reinforcement	1.05	ADLM (QUIV, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Reinforcement (on the number of 12 m bars, covering laps and offcuts)	1.10	ADLM (HERON)
Beam main bars, laps and waste	1.15	ADLM (QUIV)
Staircase bars, laps and waste	1.10	ADLM (QUIV)
Finishes (render, screed)	1.05	ADLM
Formwork (whole plywood sheets, cutting and striking loss)	1.10	ADLM (HERON)
Tiles	1.10	ADLM (QUIV, HERON, Rate Gen Material Constants)
Paint and primer	1.05	ADLM (HERON)
Roofing sheets, laps	1.10 to 1.15	Typical
Timber	1.10	Typical

TIP

Never stack waste factors. If a factor already carries waste (like the 1.54 dry-volume factor for concrete), adding 5% on top counts it twice. That is exactly why ADLM moved its concrete waste factor from 1.05 to 1.00.

Labour outputs per day

HERON holds these outputs per gang for an 8-hour working day. It works out the labour rate per unit as the gang's cost per day divided by its output per day.

Work	Output per day
Concrete	10 m ³
Filling	15 m ³
Blockwork	12 m ²
Reinforcement	250 kg
Formwork	12 m ²
Rendering	20 m ²
Plastering	20 m ²
Screeding	25 m ²
Painting	40 m ²
Floor tiling	8 m ²
Wall tiling	7 m ²
Skirting	30 m
Wall plate	30 m
Roof	15 m ²
Surface treatment	50 m ²
DPC	30 m
DPM	50 m ²
Wire mesh	50 m ²

Worked example. A blockwork gang of one mason and two labourers costs, say, ₦45,000 a day (an illustrative figure). At 12 m² a day, the labour rate is $45,000 \div 12 = \text{₦}3,750$ per m².

Rate Gen **Material Constants** and QUIV also hold labour rates per unit as defaults: for example ₦5,500 per m³ of concrete, ₦600 per m² of blockwork, ₦1,300 per m² of rendering and ₦50,000 per tonne of reinforcement. Treat these as placeholders and set your own in **Material Constants**; labour rates vary widely between states and between labour-only and gang rates.

Plant outputs

ADLM's plant allowances are **zero by default** in Rate Gen **Material Constants**. Nobody can defend a plant figure that nobody set, so plant is costed only when you enter your own.

Typical outputs for planning:

Plant	Typical output	Assumption
Small drum mixer (one-bag)	10 to 15 m ³ per day	Hand-fed, with a full gang
Backhoe loader, trench digging	15 to 25 m ³ per hour	Ordinary soil, good access
Plate compactor	100 to 200 m ² per hour per layer	150 mm layers of laterite
Tipper, local haul	6 to 10 trips per day	Under 10 km, no queues

Plant outputs depend heavily on site conditions. Check them against your own records before you price.

Grade and unit conversion

Concrete grades and nominal mixes

Grade	Characteristic strength at 28 days	Nominal mix commonly equated	Typical use
C7.5 to C10	7.5 to 10 N/mm ²	1:4:8	Blinding, mass fill
C15	15 N/mm ²	1:3:6	Oversite, plain strip footings
C20	20 N/mm ²	1:2:4	General reinforced work in houses
C25	25 N/mm ²	1:1.5:3	Suspended slabs, beams, columns
C30	30 N/mm ²	1:1:2	Heavier structural work, water-retaining

IMPORTANT

These pairings are a rough guide only. A nominal mix batched by volume on site often falls short of the grade it is equated with, especially when sand is damp or the water is not controlled. Where the specification calls for a grade (C25, for example), a design mix tested by cube results governs, and its cement content comes from the mix design, not from this table.

Reinforcement grades and notation

Notation	Meaning	Typical yield strength
R	Plain round mild steel	250 N/mm ²
Y or T	High yield deformed bar (ribbed)	410 to 460 N/mm ² under BS 8110; 500 N/mm ² under BS 4449:2005
H	High yield bar in BS 8666 schedules	500 N/mm ²

How to read the notation:

- **4Y16** means four high yield bars, 16 mm in diameter.
- **R10-200** means plain 10 mm bars (usually links) at 200 mm centres.

High yield bars carry more load per kilogram than mild steel, so never substitute mild steel without the engineer's approval.

Block sizes

Common name	Size (L × H × W)	Typical use
9 inch block	450 × 225 × 225 mm	External and load-bearing walls
6 inch block	450 × 225 × 150 mm	Internal partitions
5 inch block	450 × 225 × 125 mm	Light partitions, where available
4 inch block	450 × 225 × 100 mm	Infill, fences, where available

Each block has a 450 × 225 mm face, so the count per m² is the same for every thickness: about 9.3 laid, 10 ordered.

Imperial to metric

Imperial	Metric
1 inch	25.4 mm
1 foot	0.3048 m
1 yard	0.9144 m
1 ft ²	0.0929 m ²
1 yd ²	0.8361 m ²
1 ft ³	0.0283 m ³
1 yd ³	0.7646 m ³
1 acre	4,046.9 m ²
1 lb	0.4536 kg
1 long ton (UK)	1,016 kg
1 imperial gallon	4.546 L
1 US gallon	3.785 L

A standard Nigerian plot of 60 × 120 ft is 7,200 ft², which is **668.9 m²** (about 18.29 × 36.58 m).

To go back from metric: 1 m = 3.281 ft, 1 m² = 10.764 ft², 1 m³ = 35.315 ft³, 1 kg = 2.205 lb.

Tonnes and trips of sand, laterite and granite

Suppliers sell sand, laterite and granite by the trip, named after the truck's nominal capacity. The volume in a trip depends on the truck and on how full it is loaded.

Typical truck	Typical load
5-tonne tipper	about 3.5 m ³

Typical truck	Typical load
10-tonne tipper (6-wheeler)	about 6 to 7 m ³
20-tonne tipper (10-wheeler)	about 12 to 14 m ³
30-tonne trailer	about 18 to 20 m ³

These volumes are typical, not fixed. Confirm what a trip means with your supplier before you price.

Conversions:

- Tonnes = m³ × density (1.6 t/m³ for fill, 1.44 t/m³ for sharp sand, as ADLM uses).
- m³ = tonnes ÷ density.
- Trips = loose m³ ÷ m³ per trip.

QUIV's **Material Constants** count hardcore and laterite at **5 m³ per truckload trip** by default.

Worked example. You need 20.93 t of hardcore and the quarry sends 10-tonne trucks:

1. Volume = 20.93 ÷ 1.6 = 13.1 m³.
2. At about 6.5 m³ a trip, 13.1 ÷ 6.5 = 2.0, so **2 trips**.

IMPORTANT

Keep the three units apart: tonnes, cubic metres and trips. Most expensive filling errors come from a factor in one unit being read as another.

Cement bag conversions

From	To
1 bag	50 kg
1 tonne	20 bags
1 m ³ of cement (1,440 kg)	28.8 bags
1 bag	0.0347 m ³ (34.7 L)
1 head pan of cement	about 0.6 bag (typical 20 L pan, level)

A level head pan holds about 20 L, so 20 ÷ 34.7 = 0.58 bag. Head pans vary, so measure the one on your site before you rely on it.

Percentages and slopes

Percentages:

- Waste factor = 1 + waste % ÷ 100. For example, 5% gives 1.05.
- Markup and margin are different. A 25% markup on cost is a 20% margin on price: margin = markup ÷ (1 + markup).
- Percentage change = (new – old) ÷ old × 100.

Slopes. Slope % = rise ÷ run × 100 = tan(angle) × 100. A gradient of 1 in n is 100 ÷ n percent.

Gradient	Percent	Degrees	Typical use
1 in 100	1.0%	0.57°	Drain fall, minimum
1 in 80	1.25%	0.72°	Floor and drain falls
1 in 60	1.67%	0.95°	Flat roof falls
1 in 40	2.5%	1.43°	Paving falls, foul drains
1 in 20	5.0%	2.86°	Gentle ramps
1 in 12	8.33%	4.76°	Accessible ramp, maximum
1 in 10	10.0%	5.71°	Driveways
1 in 4	25.0%	14.04°	Steep drive
1 in 2	50.0%	26.57°	Roof pitch
1 in 1	100%	45.0°	Steep roof

Common mistake: reading a 100% slope as vertical. A 100% slope is 45°: one metre up for every metre across.

ICMS 3: International Cost Management Standard

ICMS is a standard way of grouping and reporting construction costs so that projects can be compared, wherever they were built and however their bills were laid out. The third edition, ICMS 3, came out in November 2021 and added carbon: the same codes now report a project's carbon emissions beside its cost.

ICMS is published by the ICMS Coalition, a group of professional bodies from around the world that includes RICS. It does not replace your method of measurement. You still measure and bill to BESMM4 or NRM2. ICMS is a layer on top: a fixed set of headings that every bill can be sorted into for reporting.

Why it matters

- **Comparing like with like.** Two Nigerian bills for similar duplexes can be laid out quite differently, and a bill from Accra or London differently again. Sorted into ICMS Groups, they line up heading by heading, so you can compare substructure with substructure and services with services.
- **Clients and funders ask for it.** International clients, development banks and cost consultants increasingly want cost reports in ICMS form, and carbon beside the cost.
- **Benchmarking.** A firm that reports every job in ICMS builds up its own cost and carbon per m² by building type, which is the start of a cost database.

How ICMS 3 is built

ICMS 3 codes a cost by levels, joined with full points. **01.2.03.030** reads Buildings : Construction : Structure : Frames and slabs.

Level	What it is	Examples
1	Project type	01 Buildings, 02 Roads and runways, 04 Bridges, 08 Pipelines (19 types in all)
2	Cost category (life cycle stage)	1 Acquisition, 2 Construction, 3 Renewal, 4 Operation, 5 Maintenance, 6 End of life

Level	What it is	Examples
3	Group	01 to 13 (below)
4	Sub-Group	03.030 Frames and slabs, 05.020 Electrical services

Levels 1 to 3 are required. Level 4 is optional, and is where the detail of a bill goes.

Project and sub-project. ICMS lets you report a project as a whole, or split it into sub-projects, each with its own project type. An estate could be reported as one project, or as each house type plus the estate road. ADLM's export reports each ADLM Cloud project as one project.

The 13 Groups of Construction (Level 2, category 2):

Group	Title	Carbon reported?
01	Demolition, site preparation and formation	Yes
02	Substructure	Yes
03	Structure	Yes
04	Architectural works, non-structural works	Yes
05	Services and equipment	Yes
06	Surface and underground drainage	Yes
07	External and ancillary works	Yes
08	Preliminaries, constructors' site overheads, general requirements	Yes
09	Risk allowances	Yes
10	Taxes and levies	Not used
11	Work and utilities off-site	Not used
12	Production and loose furniture, fittings and equipment	Yes
13	Construction-related consultants and supervision	Not used

Cost and carbon share the codes. Construction Costs and Construction Carbon Emissions use the same Groups and Sub-Groups, so one table can carry both. Groups 10, 11 and 13 are not used for carbon: a tax or a consultant's fee has a cost but no material carbon in this sense.

Floor areas come from IPMS. ICMS 3 pairs with the International Property Measurement Standards for the floor area that cost and carbon per m² are divided by:

- **IPMS 1** is the external floor area, measured to the outer face of the external walls. It is close to a gross external area.
- **IPMS 2** is the internal floor area, measured to the inside of the external walls (the "internal dominant face"). It is close to a gross internal area.

Cost per m² = total construction cost ÷ floor area. Carbon per m² = total kgCO₂e ÷ floor area. Always say which area you divided by, because the two give different answers for the same building.

NOTE

This section covers the parts of ICMS 3 that a cost report for a building uses. The standard itself has much more: other project types, life cycle costs, and detailed rules on what each Group includes. Read the standard before you issue an ICMS report you will be held to, and check with your client which edition and which level of detail they want.

Mapping a Nigerian bill into ICMS 3 Groups

A BESMM4 or NRM2 bill is arranged by work section (excavation, concrete, blockwork, finishes). ICMS is arranged by part of the building (substructure, structure, architectural works). So mapping means reading each line and asking which part of the building it builds.

Two rules settle most lines:

- **Keep the parts of an item together.** The concrete, reinforcement and formwork of a column all go where the column goes, in 03.030. They are not split into a "concrete" heading and a "formwork" heading as a work-section bill does.
- **The lowest floor slab is substructure.** ICMS 02.020 runs up to the top of the lowest floor slab. The ground floor slab, its hardcore, DPM and mesh are all Group 02, not Group 03.

Common bill sections against ICMS 3 Groups (typical; check every line):

Bill section or item	ICMS 3 Group and Sub-Group
Preliminaries and general items	08. Staff and supervision 08.010, hoarding and security 08.030, plant 08.040, scaffolding 08.050, temporary water, power and accommodation 08.060, insurances 08.110, testing 08.130
Site clearance, topsoil strip	01.060
Demolition	01.050
Soil investigation	01.010
Dewatering	01.090
Piling	02.010
Excavation, disposal, anti-termite, blinding, foundation concrete, blockwork below DPC, hardcore, DPM, ground floor slab	02.020
Basement walls and floor	02.030
Columns, beams, suspended slabs, roof beams, staircases (concrete, reinforcement and formwork)	03.030
Roof timbers: trusses, rafters, purlins, wall plates	03.030
Roof covering, ridge, fascia, gutters, rainwater goods	04.030
External blockwork walls	04.020
Internal blockwork walls and partitions	04.040

Bill section or item	ICMS 3 Group and Sub-Group
Windows and external doors	04.020
Internal doors	04.040
Ironmongery, burglar bars, balustrades, fitted cupboards	04.050
Plaster, screed, tiling, ceilings, painting (inside)	04.060
External render and external wall finishes	04.020
Air conditioning and ventilation	05.010
Electrical installation	05.020
Light fittings	05.030
CCTV, intercom, data	05.040
Plumbing and water supply	05.050
Sanitary fittings	05.060
Fire services	05.080
Lifts	05.100
Generators	05.130
Solar and inverters	05.140
Septic tank, soakaway, manholes, foul drains	06.030
Storm water drains and culverts	06.020
Fencing, gates, boundary wall	07.020
Paving, kerbs, driveways	07.040
Landscaping	07.050
External lighting, borehole, external services	07.070
PC and provisional sums	The Group of the work the sum covers
Contingency	09.020 Construction contingencies
VAT paid by the client on the contract	10.020
Loose furniture	12.010
Public utility connections beyond the site	11.010
Consultants' fees	13.010 (not usually in a contractor's bill)

IMPORTANT

ICMS says mapping needs a cost professional's judgement. A lintel, a parapet or a boundary wall can sit in different Groups depending on what it does. When a line is genuinely unclear, decide it yourself and note why, rather than forcing it into the nearest heading.

How ADLM does it: the ICMS 3 export on ADLM Cloud

ADLM Cloud turns any priced QUIV, HERON or SERVIQ project into an ICMS 3 cost and carbon report. Open the project, click **Export**, and look for the **ICMS 3** group, described as "international cost and carbon report". It has two entries:

Entry	What you get
ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)	Cost and upfront carbon (A1-A5) by ICMS 3 Group, with every line's code, where its carbon came from, and the lines not yet placed
ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)	The same report as data, for software that reads the RICS Data Standard 3.3.3

It works on any project you can export, including the [sample projects](#).

How each line is placed. The export reads every bill line in this order and stops at the first thing that settles it:

1. **Words that win anywhere.** Railings, balustrades, burglar bars and ironmongery go to 04.050, preliminaries to 08, contingency to 09.020 and VAT to 10.020, wherever they appear.
2. **The QUIV element.** "Columns – Reinforcement" was measured on the Columns element, so it goes to 03.030 with the column's concrete and formwork.
3. **The line's own words.** "WC", "septic tank", "interlocking paving", "clear site" and many more.
4. **The HERON section heading** the line sits under, such as "--- Sub ---".
5. **The bill category** the plugin gave the line, such as Substructure or Frames.

A SERVIQ line is always a building service, so it goes to Group 05 unless its words say drainage or external works. A "Ditto" line follows the line above. A line that none of these settles is **left unplaced**. The export never guesses a Group, because the standard says that call belongs to a cost professional.

How the money is placed. The report total is the contract sum, worked out the same way as the bill's own **Summary**:

Part of the contract sum	Where it goes
Measured lines	Their Group, as above
PC and provisional sums	Their Group, read from their description like a bill line
Preliminaries (Preliminaries % of measured work and the sums)	Group 08, shared between your preliminary items by their Alloc % . Each item's name picks its Sub-Group where it can, for example "Insurances" goes to 08.110. With no items, one line in 08.
Contingency (on measured work, sums and preliminaries)	09.020 Construction contingencies
VAT (on the subtotal plus contingency)	10.020

Approved variations are not in the report. It follows the contract sum, not the estimated final cost.

Where the carbon comes from. Each line's carbon comes from your own Rate Gen rates, firmest match first. The **Carbon from** column on the **Lines** sheet says which:

Carbon from	Meaning
applied	The Rate Gen rate the plugin priced the line with
same	A rate with the line's own description and unit
work	A rate for the work the line measures (concrete by mix, rebar by size, blockwork by thickness), with any unit converted and anything the bill does not say listed under Assumed
direct	A SERVIQ line that names its own size, such as a cable "4×95 mm ² ", weighed from the line itself
matched	Your closest rate for the wording, offered for you to check
none	No rate fits. The line has no carbon figure and lowers the coverage

Preliminaries, contingency and VAT carry no carbon in the report.

The Excel workbook has five sheets:

Sheet	What is on it
ICMS 3 report	The project details ICMS asks for (project type, country, currency, base date, price basis, status, floor areas, carbon boundary, factor sources), each marked Stated or Assumed , plus the carbon method, the carbon coverage and how much of the cost is placed
Cost by Group (G-2)	Construction Costs by Group, % of total and cost per m ² when a floor area is given, with any unplaced cost shown in red
Carbon by Group (H-1, H-2)	Upfront carbon by Group in tCO ₂ e, with the low end and kgCO ₂ e per m ² . Groups 10, 11 and 13 read Not used
Lines	Every line with its ICMS code, Sub-Group, quantity, rate, cost, kgCO ₂ e, Carbon from , the Rate Gen rate used, Assumed , Placed by and Why
Not placed	The lines you still need to place in a Group, largest first

"Assumed" details. Where a project does not state a detail, the report fills in a default and marks it **Assumed**: project type 01 Buildings, country NG, currency NGN, base date the day you export, carbon boundary A1-A5 and quantity source "Bills of quantities". Project status is taken from the project: Estimate, Tender, Contract awarded or Final account.

NOTE

The screen where you enter a project's ICMS details (floor areas, base date, location) and move a line to another Group is not on ADLM Cloud yet. Until it arrives, those details show as **Assumed**, the per-m² columns are blank, and you divide by the floor area yourself.

The JSON file is the same report in the layout of the RICS Data Standard (RDS) 3.3.3, the data format RICS publishes for ICMS 3 cost and carbon. Cost and carbon go in one entry per Group and Sub-Group, carbon in kgCO₂e with the low end beside it. The line detail, cost per m², the assumed details and the unplaced cost are

kept in an extra ADLM section of the file. Send the JSON when a client or cost consultant has software that reads RDS. Send the Excel workbook to people.

Worked example: the raft duplex

The **5-Bedroom Duplex - Raft Foundation** sample has a contract sum of about ₦209.0m: ₦161.4m of measured work, ₦10.9m of PC and provisional sums, 7.5% preliminaries, 5% contingency and 7.5% VAT. Exported from the QUIV sample, **Cost by Group (G-2)** reads:

Code	Group	Cost	%
2.01	Demolition, site preparation and formation	₦0.24m	0.1%
2.02	Substructure	₦52.98m	25.3%
2.03	Structure	₦30.92m	14.8%
2.04	Architectural works	₦77.22m	36.9%
2.05	Services and equipment	₦8.30m	4.0%
2.06	Surface and underground drainage	₦2.60m	1.2%
2.08	Preliminaries	₦12.92m	6.2%
2.09	Risk allowances	₦9.26m	4.4%
2.10	Taxes and levies	₦14.58m	7.0%
2	Total Construction Costs	₦209.03m	100%

What to read from it:

- 1. The total equals the contract sum.** Nothing is lost or double counted.
- 2. Substructure is a quarter of the cost,** as you would expect for a raft on soft clay. On the strip foundation duplex it is about 12%.
- 3. Group 05 is the two PC sums,** electrical (₦4.5m) and plumbing (₦3.8m). The services are not measured in this bill. The SERVIQ sample of the same building carries them.
- 4. Group 06 is the soakaway and septic tank sum.**
- 5. Group 08 is shared between the 22 preliminary items,** so **Lines** shows 08.010 for supervision, 08.110 for insurances, 08.060 for site accommodation, and so on.
- 6. Check the Lines sheet before you issue it.** In this sample the export puts the roof beam lines (about ₦9.9m) and the roof carpentry (about ₦2.8m) under 04.030 Roof finishes, because their QUIV element is named "Roof Beams" and "Roofs". ICMS 3 puts roof beams and roof timbers in 03.030 Frames and slabs. Moved there, Structure becomes about ₦43.7m (20.9%), the same as the HERON sample of this duplex. This is exactly the judgement the standard leaves to you.

Per m². The sample does not state a floor area. Suppose the gross internal area (IPMS 2) is 420 m², an assumed figure for this example only. Cost per m² = 209,030,000 ÷ 420 = **₦497,700 per m²** (IPMS 2). Do the same with the total tCO2e from **Carbon by Group** for carbon per m².

The carbon figures depend on your own Rate Gen library, so they differ from one account to another. On the duplex samples, a subscriber with a Rate Gen library gets a carbon figure on about 90 to 98% of the cost.

Carbon in cost planning

A cost plan says what a building will cost. A carbon figure beside it says how much greenhouse gas its materials and construction will release. Clients, banks and planners now ask for both, and the best time to cut carbon is the same as the best time to cut cost: at the design stage, while the specification can still change.

Upfront embodied carbon

Embodied carbon is the carbon released in making, moving, building, maintaining and finally removing a building's materials, as opposed to the energy used to run it. Whole-life carbon assessments split it into stages, following EN 15978 and the RICS professional standard *Whole life carbon assessment for the built environment* (2nd edition, 2023):

Stage	What it covers
A1-A3	Product: raw materials, transport to the factory and manufacture ("cradle to gate")
A4	Transport of the product to site
A5	Construction: site waste and fuel and energy used on site
B1-B7	Use: maintenance, repair, replacement and operational energy and water
C1-C4	End of life: demolition, transport, waste processing and disposal

Upfront carbon is A1 to A5: everything up to practical completion. It is what a bill of quantities can measure, because the bill already lists the materials. ADLM reports upfront carbon only.

Units. Carbon is reported as carbon dioxide equivalent: other greenhouse gases are converted to the amount of CO₂ that would warm the planet as much. **kgCO₂e** is kilograms. **tCO₂e** is tonnes: 1 tCO₂e = 1,000 kgCO₂e.

Carbon factors. A factor is the carbon per kg of a material, cradle to gate (A1-A3). Multiply the mass of material by the factor, then add transport and site waste:

$$\text{carbon (kgCO}_2\text{e)} = \text{mass (kg)} \times (\text{factor} + \text{A4} + \text{wf} \times (\text{factor} + \text{A4} + \text{C2} + \text{C3-C4}))$$

- **A4** is transport per kg: 0.005 kgCO₂e/kg for local materials (about 50 km by road) and 0.032 for national ones (about 300 km).
- **wf** is the waste factor: the extra material bought to cover what is wasted. For a waste rate *w*, $\text{wf} = w \div (1 - w)$, so 5% waste gives 0.053.
- **C2** and **C3-C4** are the transport and disposal of that waste: 0.005 and 0.013 kgCO₂e/kg (1.77 for timber).
- Fuel burnt on site (A5a) is litres × the fuel's factor, for example 2.66 kgCO₂e per litre of diesel.

This is the calculation in the Institution of Structural Engineers' *How to calculate embodied carbon* (2020), and it is the one Rate Gen uses.

How Rate Gen 3.0.x gives every rate a carbon figure

From Rate Gen 3.0.0, every built-up rate has a carbon figure, worked out from the same materials and quantities as its price. Open **Carbon & Others** in Rate Gen. The screen is titled **Carbon Computation**, and its table shows each rate's **TRADE**, **TOTAL COST**, **KGCO₂E / UNIT** and **COVERAGE**.

- **It follows the build-up.** Change a quantity in a rate's trade and its carbon changes with it. Open a rate to see each material's kgCO₂e, and hover over a figure for its factor and source.
- **Labour and plant hire carry no material carbon.** Site fuel in a build-up is counted as A5a.

- **Cement gives a range.** A rate with cement shows a low end and a high end. The high end takes the full cradle-to-gate cement factor. The low end takes the Nigerian producers' own reported figure, which covers only the kiln and its fuel, so it is a floor.
- ****An asterisk (*) marks an assumed mass*,** for example a sandcrete block weighed from its standard size rather than from a stated weight.
- **Services cables and pipes, from Rate Gen 3.0.1.** Copper cable and earth conductor are weighed from the cores and size in their own names, counting the copper only. PP-R pressure pipe and 110 mm uPVC soil pipe are weighed from their standard sizes. Manufactured items such as air conditioners, pumps, sanitaryware and light fittings are left without carbon in Rate Gen, on purpose, because they need the maker's own figure.

The factor sources Rate Gen names are: CIDB Malaysia (2021) *Embodied Carbon Inventory Data for Construction Materials*; IStructE (2020) Table 2.3 (from ICE v3.0 and product EPDs); the UK Government GHG Conversion Factors 2024 for fuels; CARES EPD 0060 (2026) for rebar; and the Dangote Cement and Lafarge Africa 2024 annual reports for the cement low end.

On ADLM Cloud, the same calculation runs on every rate in your library, for the state you price in. ADLM Cloud also holds factors for building services that SERVIQ measures: air conditioners, pumps, distribution boards and similar products at the CIBSE TM65 (2021) figure of 9 kgCO₂e per kg of product where the item has no EPD, LED light fittings at 43.1 kgCO₂e each (the median of six panel EPDs), sanitaryware, ductwork, cable tray and more. These feed the ICMS export and the sample cards.

How the carbon flows into the ICMS export

1. Rate Gen works out kgCO₂e per unit for each rate in your library.
2. The ICMS export finds the rate behind each bill line (see **Carbon from** above) and multiplies its kgCO₂e per unit by the line's quantity, converting units where needed (rebar in kg against a rate in tonnes, for example).
3. The lines add up to a carbon total for each Group, in tCO₂e, with a low end from the cement range.
4. The cover sheet states the **carbon coverage**: the share of the cost that has a carbon figure behind it.
5. With a floor area, carbon per m² = total kgCO₂e ÷ IPMS 2 (or IPMS 1) area.

Read the coverage first. A report that covers 60% of the cost understates the building's carbon by roughly the carbon of the other 40%. Look at the lines with **Carbon from** "none" on the **Lines** sheet. They are usually PC sums, manufactured services items or lines with no matching rate.

Typical carbon factors

Factors per kg (ADLM values, from Rate Gen):

Material	Factor, A1-A3 (kgCO ₂ e/kg)	Source named in Rate Gen
Cement	0.83 (low end 0.57)	CIDB 2021; low end from Dangote and Lafarge 2024 reports
Reinforcement bar	0.821	CARES EPD 0060, scrap-based electric arc furnace steel
Structural steel sections	1.55	IStructE 2020
Steel fabric mesh	0.77	CIDB 2021
Binding wire, nails	2.27	CIDB 2021

Material	Factor, A1-A3 (kgCO ₂ e/kg)	Source named in Rate Gen
Sandcrete hollow blocks	0.0781 (low end 0.0545)	CIDB 2021, concrete block 10 MPa
Sand, hardcore, laterite	0.0049	CIDB 2021
Granite, crushed rock	0.010	CIDB 2021
Sawn softwood	0.263	IStructE 2020
Sawn hardwood	0.31	CIDB 2021
Plywood	0.681	IStructE 2020
Aluminium roofing sheet	13.0	IStructE 2020
Sheet glass	1.44	IStructE 2020
Ceramic and vitrified tiles	0.78	CIDB 2021
Emulsion paint	2.54	CIDB 2021
Diesel burnt on site	2.66 per litre	UK GHG Conversion Factors 2024

Per unit you buy (worked from the ADLM values, A1-A5, including transport and site waste):

Item	kgCO ₂ e	Low end	Mass used
Cement, 50 kg bag	45.4	31.7	50 kg
Reinforcement, per tonne	899		1,000 kg
Structural steel, per tonne	1,598		1,000 kg
225 mm sandcrete block	2.31	1.66	27.5 kg (assumed)
150 mm sandcrete block	1.53	1.10	18.2 kg (assumed)
Sharp sand, per tonne	11.4		1,000 kg
Granite, per tonne	16.7		1,000 kg
A142 mesh, per m ²	1.88		2.22 kg/m ²

Concrete has no single factor in Rate Gen. Its carbon comes from the cement, sand and granite in its build-up. Using the mix quantities from the concrete section of this handbook:

Mix	kgCO ₂ e per m ³	Low end
1:1.5:3	393	283
1:2:4	317	230
1:3:6	232	171

These are worked from ADLM values, not read from Rate Gen. Your own Rate Gen concrete rate can differ a little, because its build-up may include other items, such as fuel for plant.

A few points about these figures:

- **Cement does most of the work.** In 1:2:4 concrete, the cement is about 90% of the carbon. Cutting cement content, or using a lower grade where the design allows, is the biggest single lever on a Nigerian building's upfront carbon.
- **The rebar factor is chosen for Nigeria.** Nigerian rebar mills melt scrap in electric furnaces, and much imported rebar comes from Turkish scrap-based mills, so Rate Gen uses a scrap-based EPD (0.821). The world-average figure in IStructE 2020, mostly from blast furnace steel, is 1.99. Using it would more than double the rebar carbon.
- **Block masses are assumed.** They come from the NIS 87:2007 block sizes at 1,920 kg/m³. A block from your supplier may weigh more or less.

Worked example. 100 m² of 225 mm sandcrete blockwork, using the ADLM block and mortar constants from this handbook:

1. Blocks = $100 \times 10 \times 1.03 = 1,030$ blocks $\times 2.31 = 2,383$ kgCO₂e.
2. Mortar cement = $100 \times 0.20 = 20$ bags $\times 45.4 = 909$ kgCO₂e.
3. Mortar sand = $100 \times 0.055 = 5.5$ t $\times 11.4 = 63$ kgCO₂e.
4. Total = 3,355 kgCO₂e = **3.36 tCO₂e**, or about **33.5 kgCO₂e per m²** of wall. At the low end it is about 2.40 tCO₂e.

IMPORTANT

Upfront carbon is not whole-life carbon. It leaves out maintenance, replacement, the energy used to run the building and end of life. Say "upfront carbon (A1-A5)" on every report, and state the coverage and the factor sources, so nobody reads it as more than it is.

This part of the handbook follows real jobs from start to finish. Each use case shows which ADLM products to use, in what order, and where one product hands over to the next. The button names are the ones you see on screen. For the full detail on any product, follow the link to its own guide.

Which ADLM tool for which job

Start here when you are not sure which product to open. Most jobs use two or three products together, with ADLM Cloud as the place the project ends up.

The job	Use this	Where it ends up
Check whether a Revit model is ready to measure	QUIV for Revit: Model Checker	A readiness score, an issues list and a QS Query Report
Measure the building from a Revit model	QUIV for Revit	A bill and a budget in Revit, saved to ADLM Cloud
Measure from PDF drawings	ADLM HERON with PlanSwift 10 or 11 and the ADLM templates	A priced bill, a budget and an Excel bill, saved to ADLM Cloud
Measure MEP services from a Revit model	SERVIQ for Revit MEP	A priced services bill and material schedule, saved to ADLM Cloud
Price a bill someone sent you in Excel	ADLM Cloud: Import Excel BoQ · HERON , then HERON to measure it	A HERON project with your measurements behind the client's lines

The job	Use this	Where it ends up
Build and keep your own rates	ADLM Rate Gen	One rate library on your account, read by QUIV, HERON, SERVIQ and ADLM Cloud
Plan durations and crew sizes	ADLM Time Pro	An Excel record and a Microsoft Project programme
Plan the budget and purchases	ADLM Cloud: Budget	A material, labour and plant breakdown, and a buy schedule
Value work and issue payment certificates	ADLM Cloud: Valuation	Interim payment applications, certificates, variations and a final account
Report to a client	ADLM Cloud: Share dashboard, Project report, Export	A public read-only dashboard, PDF reports and Excel workbooks
Work with a colleague on one project	ADLM Cloud: Collaborators	Shared access at View only or Full access
Report cost and carbon to ICMS 3	ADLM Cloud: Export , then ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)	Cost and upfront carbon by ICMS 3 Group, adding up to the contract sum

NOTE

Each product is a separate subscription. QUIV does not include SERVIQ, and HERON does not include Rate Gen. Pricing from the rate library in any product needs a Rate Gen subscription on the same account.

Use case 1: A bungalow BoQ from a Revit model

Scenario

An architect sends you the Revit model of a three-bedroom bungalow on strip foundations. The client wants a priced bill of quantities by the end of the week.

Who it is for	Tools used
Quantity surveyors and estimators who receive Revit models	QUIV for Revit, ADLM Rate Gen, ADLM Cloud

Steps

In Revit, check the model first:

1. Open the model in Revit.
2. On the **ADLM Calculator** tab, click **Model Checker**.
3. Under **Select Model Type**, choose **Architectural Model**.
4. Tick **Check for Overlapping Elements**, then click **Run Model Check**.
5. Read the **Readiness Score** and the **Element Categories**. Click each row under **Issues** to find the element in Revit, and fix duplicates before you measure.
6. If parts of the model are missing or unclear, click **View QS Query** and send the **QS Query Report** to the architect with **Export PDF**.

Measure with QUIV:

1. On the **ADLM Calculator** tab, click **ADLM Calculator** and sign in if asked.
2. On the dashboard, under **Ready for a new project?**, click **Bungalow**.
3. On the **Take off List**, tick the items this job needs and click **Continue**.
4. Work down the sidebar from **Oversite Qty** and **Strip Qty** to **Finishes Qty**. In each module, choose the level and type, check the **Model Quantities**, enter your own inputs (bar sizes, spacing, thicknesses), then click **Save**.
5. The first time you save, type the **Project name** in the **Save Takeoff** window. Use a clear name, for example the client and the building.

TIP

To measure everything in one go, click ♦ **Run the whole takeoff** under the take-off list, then **Let QUIV run the whole takeoff**. Items that start with a pick in Revit are listed under **Still needs you**, and you measure those yourself.

Check the bill and save it to the cloud:

1. Click **BoQ** under **Database** in the sidebar.
2. Read down the **Bill of Quantities**. Use the **Done** tick for each line you have checked.
3. Click **Save To Cloud** and confirm the **Project name**.

Price the bill on ADLM Cloud:

1. Sign in at adlmstudio.net and open your QUIV projects (</projects/revit>). Click **Refresh projects** if the job is not there yet.
2. Open the project and click **Bill of Quantity** under **Views**.
3. On the ribbon, open the **Rates** tab and click **Load RateGen rates**.
4. On the **Home** tab, tick **Only fill empty rates**, then on the **Rates** tab click **Sync rates**. Rate Gen fills every line it can match.
5. For each line still without a rate, click its **Rate** cell and type part of a rate's name. Pick a rate from your library, or type a figure.
6. In the **Summary** box at the foot of the bill, set **Contingency** and **VAT**. On the **Contract** tab, set **Preliminaries %**.
7. Click **Save changes**.

Send the bill out:

1. Click **Export** in the top bar.
2. Choose **Bungalow** under **Elemental BoQ** for a bill by building element, or **Bungalow (Trade format)** for a bill by work section.
3. When the bill goes to the client, click **Mark as tendered** in the **Summary** box, and turn **Follow RateGen changes** off on the **Rates** tab.

What you get at the end

A measured and priced bill on ADLM Cloud, an elemental or trade bill in Excel, and a budget behind every line that you can use later for purchasing and valuations.

Tips

- You can also price inside Revit: on the QUIV Bill, click **Load RateGen Prices**, or **View Rates and Map** for one line. Pricing on the cloud is easier to share and to change later.
- Rates you type or pick on the cloud are kept when you re-save the project from QUIV.
- If a quantity looks double, run the **Model Checker** again with **Check for Overlapping Elements** ticked, and check that no linked model is placed twice.

Use case 2: Pricing a tender from PDF drawings

Scenario

A contractor sends you a tender set of PDF drawings for a two-storey office block. There is no model. You need a priced bill in Excel by the tender date.

Who it is for	Tools used
Estimators and quantity surveyors working from 2D drawings	ADLM HERON with PlanSwift, the ADLM templates, ADLM Rate Gen, Microsoft Excel, ADLM Cloud

Steps

Set up the job in PlanSwift:

1. Open **ADLM HERON** and sign in, so the ADLM templates are switched on. If this is the first sign-in on the PC, restart PlanSwift.
2. In PlanSwift, create a new job and set it to metric.
3. Import the PDF drawings, rename each page (for example "Ground Floor Plan") and group the pages into folders by drawing set.
4. Scale every page you will measure on, using a long grid dimension. Check the scale on a dimension running the other way with PlanSwift's Dimension tool.

IMPORTANT

The scale is set for each page, not the whole job. An unscaled page gives wrong quantities on every line measured on it.

Measure with the ADLM templates:

1. In PlanSwift's templates panel, choose **Complete ADLM TakeOff Plugin**.
2. Work trade by trade: SUBSTRUCTURE, FRAME, BLOCKWORK AND OPENINGS, FINISHES, ROOFING, then the services if they are in your scope.
3. Name each item after the room or element, for example "Offices" or "225 Wall Area". The names become the descriptions on your bill.
4. Organise the folders the way you want the bill to read, for example by storey: "Office Sub", "Office GF", "Office FF".

Read and price the takeoff in HERON:

1. In HERON, on the **Dashboard**, click **Start New**.
2. Click **Quantity Take Off**. Check the **Take Off Items** and the **Take Off Breakdown** for each folder.

3. Double-click concrete items to add reinforcement with **+ Bars** and **+ Links**, then click **Apply Reinforcement**.
4. Click **Save / Export**. The **Review Takeoff Before Saving** screen opens.
5. Type the job name in **Project Name**.
6. Click **Load rates**. HERON prices the bill from your Rate Gen library and shows how many items matched.
7. For lines with no rate, select the row, type in **Search Rate**: and double-click a result, or type a rate in the **Rate** cell.
8. Check any row shaded amber. Its rate is below the material and labour cost HERON worked out.
9. Use **Up** and **Down** to put the bill in the order you want it printed.

Export and save:

1. Click **Export All** for one workbook with every folder, or **Export Folder(s)** to choose.
2. Click **Save to Cloud** so the job is kept on your account and can be opened on the website.
3. On the **Budget** page in HERON, pick a folder, click **Load rates**, then **Export** for the linked budget workbook.

What you get at the end

An Excel bill of quantities with one sheet per folder, QS item lettering and a **GEN SUMMARY** sheet, a linked budget workbook with a **Basic Prices** sheet, and the same job on ADLM Cloud.

Tips

- If you rescale a page after measuring, click **Reload** in **Quantity Take Off** before you save.
- Avoid two items with the same name in one folder. HERON merges them.
- For steelwork, name items with the full designation (for example UKB 305x165x40) and run **Steel Tonnage** to get the tonnage.
- If your firm has its own tender template in Excel, use **Connect Excel** and the **Takeoff Link** pane to link HERON's figures into your own cells instead of exporting.

Use case 3: Your firm's own rate library

Scenario

Your firm prices excavation, concrete and blockwork its own way, with its own gang sizes, and hires an excavator for bulk digging. You want every estimator to price QUIV and HERON jobs from the same rates.

Who it is for	Tools used
Senior quantity surveyors and practice leads who set the firm's rates	ADLM Rate Gen (desktop and the RateGen pages on the website), QUIV for Revit, ADLM HERON, ADLM Cloud

Steps

Set up the library once:

1. On the ADLM website, open **Profile** and set your **Pricing location (State)**. Rate Gen prices from the zone your state belongs to.
2. Open **ADLM RateGen** and sign in. Click **Yes** if it asks to update your prices to your zone.

3. Click **Library** in the sidebar. Check the location line at the top.
4. On the **Material** tab, click **Edit** on each material you buy at a different price, type your price and click **Update Library**. Do the same on the **Labour** tab for day rates and plant hire.
5. Add anything missing with **Add Material +** or **Add Labour +**, then **Save to Database**. Plant goes in the **Labour** list.

Adjust the shipped rates:

1. Open a work section, for example **Concrete**.
2. Set the **Overhead** and **Profit** boxes to your firm's percentages.
3. Click a rate's **Description** to open its **Rate Composition**.
4. Double-click a **Quantity** cell and type your figure, for example your own mix or gang output.
5. Click **Save**. You will see **Rate saved successfully. Your edits will sync to QUIV and HERON**.

Build custom rates, with plant:

1. Click **Add Custom Rate +** in any section.
2. Type the **Name of Rate** and the **Description**, and set **Overhead** and **Profit**.
3. Under **Materials**, click **Add Material** and pick each material by name, with its **Quantity** per unit.
4. Under **Labour**, click **Add Labour** for the gang. Add the plant here too, for example the excavator, because plant is in the labour library.
5. Check the **Grand Total** and click **Save**.
6. Click **Sync from Cloud** in the header to send the rate to your account.

Check the rate reached your account:

1. On the website, open **RateGen** in the left-hand menu (`/rategen`).
2. Open **My Custom Rates**, then **Effective Rates**. Your rate shows with a **Source** of `user-custom`.

Use the rates on jobs:

1. **HERON**: on the review screen, click **Load rates**, or use **Search Rate**: to apply one rate to a row. In the **Budget**, type a name in a **Price** cell to search your library.
2. **QUIV**: save the job to the cloud, open it on ADLM Cloud, and pick your rates in the **Bill of Quantity** by typing part of the name in the **Rate** cell. Picking a rate also writes its materials, labour and plant into the **Budget**.
3. **Any ADLM Cloud bill**: use **Sync rates** on the **Rates** tab to fill empty lines from your library.

What you get at the end

One library on your account, priced for your location, with your own build-ups and custom rates. QUIV, HERON and ADLM Cloud all price from it, so two estimators pricing the same item get the same rate.

Tips

IMPORTANT

Rates are built only in the ADLM Rate Gen desktop app. The website shows your library and every rate's build-up, but it cannot build, edit or delete a rate or change a price. From Rate Gen 3.0.1 your custom rates download to every PC you sign in on, so a rate built on one PC appears on the others.

- Change prices in the library, and quantities in the build-up. A price is shared by every rate that uses it. A quantity belongs to one rate.
- A project you have already priced keeps its rates. A library change reaches it only when the line is priced again, or when **Follow RateGen changes** is on.

Use case 4: A budget for a client

Scenario

A private client is building a duplex and wants to know what it will cost before committing, split into what goes on materials and what goes on labour. You have measured the building in QUIV or HERON and saved it to the cloud.

Who it is for	Tools used
Quantity surveyors advising a client or a developer; contractors planning their own costs	QUIV for Revit or ADLM HERON, ADLM Rate Gen, ADLM Cloud

Steps

Price the bill so the budget fills itself:

1. On ADLM Cloud, open the project and click **Bill of Quantity** under **Views**.
2. Click a line's **Rate** cell, type part of a rate's name and pick a Rate Gen rate. ADLM writes that line's materials, labour and plant into the **Budget** at the same time, so the bill and the budget agree.
3. Repeat for each line, or use **Sync rates** on the **Rates** tab with **Only fill empty rates** ticked.
4. Click **Save changes**.

Check the budget:

1. Click **Budget** under **Views**. Each bill item is broken down into rows of **Material**, **Labour**, **Plant**, **Equipment** or **Consumable**.
2. Price any row still at zero by typing a rate, a **=** formula, or a Rate Gen name in its rate cell.
3. Under **Global Overhead & Profit**, type your percentages and click **Apply to all**.
4. Click **Save changes**. The new bill rates flow up to the **Bill of Quantity**.

Plan the purchases:

1. Build the programme first on the **PM Dashboard** (click **Generate from BoQ**, or import one as in Use case 6).
2. In the **Budget**, switch from **Breakdown** to **Buy schedule**. Read **Should already be bought**, **Buy this week** and **Not yet scheduled**, and set the **Lead time** for each material.

Give the client the figures:

1. Click **Export** in the top bar and choose **Export bill & budget workbook**. The workbook has your bill plus separate Material, Labour and Plant schedules, a Schedule of Current Prices and a Material Summary.
2. Click **Project report** for a PDF progress report, then **Download PDF**.
3. To let the client follow the job without an account, open **Dashboard**, click **Share dashboard**, tick **Enable public link** and click **Copy link**.

What you get at the end

A budget for every bill item, a workbook that shows materials, labour and plant on separate schedules, and a buy schedule tied to the programme.

Tips

- In QUIV you can see the same split inside Revit: open **Budget** under **Database** and use the **All**, **Material** and **Labour** filters. Tick **Bought** as items are bought.
- In HERON, the **Budget** page shows **Project cost (material + labour)** against the **Take-off value (BoQ)**, with the **Margin. Over budget** marks an item whose cost is higher than its rate.
- A bill item counts as complete only when every line under it is marked. Buying the materials is not enough until the labour is done too.
- If a picked rate did not price the Budget, the rate has no build-up in Rate Gen. Price the budget rows yourself, or pick a rate that has one.

Use case 5: Monthly interim valuations and payment certificates

Scenario

The contract is signed on a priced bill. You are the QS on site and must value the work every month, issue an interim certificate, and handle variations as the client changes things.

Who it is for	Tools used
Consultant and contractor quantity surveyors running a live contract	ADLM Cloud (any QUIV or HERON project)

Steps

Before the first valuation, set the contract up once:

1. Open the project and click **Valuation** under **Views**. Click **Show valuation settings**.
2. Fill in **Client / Employer**, **Retention %**, **VAT %** and **Withholding tax %**. The defaults are 5, 7.5 and 2.5.
3. Choose the **Valuation basis: By Bill of Quantity** (each line valued by its own % complete) or **By Budget (Material & Labour)**.
4. Open the **Bill of Quantity**, click the **Contract** tab on the ribbon, then **Lock contract**. Choose a 4-digit PIN and type it twice.
5. Click **Save changes**.

IMPORTANT

Keep the PIN safe. You need the same 4 digits to unlock the contract, and a lost PIN can only be reset by ADLM support.

Each month, record progress:

1. Walk the site with the bill.
2. On the **Bill of Quantity**, tick a line's box for work fully done (**Mark as completed**), or type a percentage in its **Done** box for part-done work.

3. Tick executed PC and provisional sums on the **Provisional** tab, and tick **Done** against preliminary items as they are executed.
4. Click **Save changes**. The save is logged against that day.

Prepare the valuation:

1. Open **Valuation** and click **Show daily valuation log**.
2. Choose the day in **Valuation date**.
3. Read down **Gross value of works to date**, **Net valuation to date**, **Less previous payments**, **Subtotal before taxes** and **Total amount due for payment**.
4. Click **Print valuation** for the formal Interim Payment Application, or **Export Excel** for an editable workbook.

Issue the certificate:

1. Under **Contract administration**, open **Certificates**.
2. Click **Issue certificate**. It certifies the current value to date as the next IPC.
3. Set its status as it moves along: **Draft**, then **Approved**, then **Paid**.
4. Download the certificate as an Excel workbook for the client.

Handle variations:

1. Open **Variations** and click **Add variation**.
2. Fill in **What changed**, the **Instruction reference**, the **Type** (**Addition** or **Omission**) and the **Value (N)**.
3. When the instruction is agreed, open the variation and click **Approve**. Only approved variations change the project total.

At the end of the job:

1. Open **Final account** and check the movement against the **Contract sum**.
2. Click **Close the final account** and confirm. Then click **Download** for the final account workbook.

What you get at the end

A dated valuation for every month, a numbered run of interim certificates with retention, VAT and withholding tax worked out the same way each time, a variations register, and a final account.

Tips

- Lock the contract before the first certificate, so every certificate is measured against the same baseline.
- Only the latest certificate can be deleted, which keeps the sequence honest.
- If the model or drawings are re-measured after the lock, re-save from QUIV or HERON. Re-measured quantities are recorded as actuals and new lines are raised as variations, so the contract sum does not move. HERON shows a red **CONTRACT LOCKED** chip when this applies.
- Changes are kept only when you click **Save changes**. Save before you leave the page.

Use case 6: A programme from the bill

Scenario

The client asks how long the bungalow from Use case 1 will take, and how many workers you need to finish in 20 weeks. Your site team has been logging gang outputs on another job for a month.

Who it is for	Tools used
Site quantity surveyors, site engineers and project managers	ADLM Time Pro, Microsoft Project, ADLM Cloud

Steps

Build up output history in Time Pro (before you need it):

1. Open **ADLM Time Pro** and sign in.
2. Each morning, click **Current Weather**, search your town, choose it under **SELECT CITY** and click **Fetch Weather**.
3. Click **Task Log**, then **Add Task** for each gang: the **Item of Work**, the **Trade**, **Skilled Labour** and **Unskilled Labour**, **Hours Worked** and **Break Hours**, the **Output** and **Output Unit**. Click **Save Task**.
4. Record one row per gang per day, and type the item names exactly the same way every time.

IMPORTANT

A new Time Pro has no history, so every expected duration shows 0. Start recording on site before you need the forecast. A week of honest records is enough to begin.

Turn bill quantities into durations:

1. Keep the bill open beside you, for example the Excel export from ADLM Cloud.
2. In Time Pro, click **Duration Summary**.
3. For each item, click **Click to enter BOQ Qty...** and type the quantity from the bill, in the same unit you recorded output in. Press .
4. Read **Expected Duration (days)** and the crew under **Required Skilled / Day** and **Required Unskilled / Day**.
5. Where the programme must be shorter, type the days you want in **Planned Duration (days)**. The crew changes to match.

Export the programme:

1. Click **Excel** to keep a record of where every duration came from.
2. Click **MS Project**. Set the **Project Start Date**, choose the **Currency** and type the resource rates (or 0 to fill them in later).
3. Click **Export** and save the `.xml` file.
4. Open the file in Microsoft Project from **File**, then **Open**. Adjust the links where trades can overlap, and set a baseline.

Bring the programme into the project on ADLM Cloud (optional):

1. Save the programme from Microsoft Project.

2. On ADLM Cloud, open the project's **PM Dashboard** and click **Import MS Project**. Choose the `.xml` or `.mpp` file.
3. Track progress with each task's % and status, and read **CPI** and **SPI** on the dashboard.

What you get at the end

Durations and crew sizes based on what your own gangs produce, a Microsoft Project programme with tasks, links, resources and costs, and (if you import it) a programme on ADLM Cloud tied to the bill and the buy schedule.

Tips

IMPORTANT

In Time Pro 1.1.1 the figures you type on the **Duration Summary** clear when you leave that screen, change the Task Log or close the app. Enter your quantities and export in one sitting.

- Keep the output unit the same as the bill unit. Blockwork recorded in m2 must be forecast against a quantity in m2.
- If you only need a quick programme without site records, use **Generate from BoQ** on the **PM Dashboard**, which creates one task per bill item, and set the dates yourself.
- When quantities change, export from Time Pro again and use **Update MS Project** on the **PM Dashboard**. It refreshes the schedule and keeps your progress and links.

Use case 7: MEP services for a commercial building

Scenario

You are pricing the mechanical and electrical package on a four-storey office building. The services engineer has a Revit MEP model. The building itself was measured separately in QUIV.

Who it is for	Tools used
Services quantity surveyors and main-contract Qs pricing an M&E package	SERVIQ for Revit MEP (the ADLM Revit MEP Plugin in the Installer Hub, the ADLM MEP & HVAC tab in Revit), ADLM Rate Gen, ADLM Cloud

Steps

Measure the services:

1. Open the services model in Revit. If the services sit in a linked file, open that file directly.
2. On the **ADLM MEP & HVAC** tab, click **Sign In** on the **Tools** panel.
3. Start with HVAC. Click **Duct Quantity**, choose a level under **Select Level**, then a type under **Select Duct Type**.
4. Check the schedule, click **Result Info**, then **Save to Take-Off**.
5. Repeat for each level, then for **Duct Fitting Quantity**, **Air Terminal Quantity** and **HVAC Equipment Quantity**.
6. Move on to **Pipe Works Quantity** and **Plumbing Fixture Quantity**, then **Lighting Quantity**, **Power Quantity** and **Cable Quantity**.

Price inside Revit:

1. Click **Show Takeoff Database** on the **Tools** panel and open **Take-Off Data**.
2. Type a **Unit Rate** on lines you price as a single figure.
3. For lines you want built up, click the **f** button. In the **Rate Build-Up** window, use **SEARCH RATEGEN LIBRARY** to add materials and labour, adjust **Qty/unit** for waste, and click **Done**.
4. Click **Apply to similar lines** to copy a build-up to other lines in the same service.
5. Type your **Overhead %** and **Profit %** at the bottom of **Take-Off Data**.
6. Open **Budget** to see the **COST COMPOSITION** (material, labour and rate-only lines), and **Material Schedule** for the procurement list.

Save and combine on ADLM Cloud:

1. Under **PROJECT**, replace "Untitled" with the job name and "Services", then click **Save to Cloud**.
2. On the website, open your Revit MEP projects (</projects/mep>), or click **View Projects** on the **ADLM** panel).
3. Open the project. On its **Dashboard**, click **Price services** under **Price services from RateGen** to price the services bill from your library. The lengths, joints and fittings it allows for come from your Services Constants.
4. Open the building project (the QUIV job). On its **Dashboard**, under **Linked Services & Works**, click **+ Link a project**, choose the services project from **Select a project...** and click **Link**. The **Linked total** now shows the whole job.

What you get at the end

A services bill measured from the model, a material schedule for procurement, a "Complete MEP BoQ" Excel workbook from **Export to Excel**, and one figure for building and services together on ADLM Cloud.

Tips

- Set your house standards for services once at </rategen/services-constants> : standard lengths, how joints are counted and the fitting uplift. Click **Save constants**.
- Keep the services and the building as separate projects. They come from different models and are often valued as different packages.
- A service drawn as a single-line diagram or a note is not modelled, so it cannot be measured. Price it another way and say so in the bill.
- Every Revit session starts with an empty Take-Off Database. Click **Load Latest Local** to bring back your last take-off.

Use case 8: Importing a client's Excel bill into HERON

Scenario

A client sends you a bill of quantities in Excel, prepared by another firm. They want it checked and priced, and they want real measurements behind the main lines.

Who it is for	Tools used
Quantity surveyors re-measuring or pricing someone else's bill	ADLM Cloud (Import Excel BoQ · HERON), ADLM HERON with PlanSwift, ADLM Rate Gen

NOTE

Excel bill import is switched on for your account by ADLM and needs a live HERON subscription. If you do not see **Import Excel BoQ · HERON** on your HERON projects page, contact ADLM support through [/support](#). There is no import button inside HERON itself.

Steps

Import the bill on the website:

1. Sign in at adlmstudio.net and open your HERON projects ([/projects/planswift](#)).
2. Click **Import Excel BoQ · HERON**.
3. Type a name in **Project name (optional)**, or leave it blank to use the file name.
4. Under **Excel workbook (.xlsx)**, choose the client's file, then click **Import project**.
5. Open the new project and read the bill. Where the workbook had no material and labour schedule, one has been built for you and priced from your material constants and Rate Gen.

Build the bill in PlanSwift:

1. In PlanSwift, create a job for the drawings and import and scale them.
2. In HERON, on the **Dashboard**, find the imported project under **Recent Projects** and click **Build in PlanSwift**.
3. In the **Build Bill in PlanSwift** window, check the **Template** chosen for each line and change any wrong match. Check **Measured as**, **Depth/Height**, **Width** and **Thickness** where the template needs them.
4. Click **Build in PlanSwift**. Each section becomes a take-off folder and each line a measurable item.

Measure, price and save:

1. Click **Measure** on a line in the **Build Bill in PlanSwift** window to send it to PlanSwift, then trace it on the drawing.
2. In HERON, go to **Quantity Take Off** and click **Reload**.
3. Click **Save / Export**, then **Load rates** to price from your library.
4. Click **Save to Cloud**. Your measurements land on the same lines that came from the client's file.

What you get at the end

The client's bill, in their order and wording, with your measured quantities behind it, priced from your library and saved as a HERON project you can value and share like any other.

Tips

- Click **Download the import template** if you want a workbook laid out the way the importer reads best.
- Upload the client's own bill, not one exported from the ADLM website. An ADLM export is refused.
- Building again is safe: lines already in the job are updated, never duplicated, and a line that already has a measurement keeps it. Use **Only lines not in the job** on a second run.
- If you only need to price the bill, not re-measure it, you can price it straight on ADLM Cloud after the import, as in Use case 4.

Use case 9: Sharing a project with a client or collaborator

Scenario

Your client wants to follow progress without learning the software. A structural engineer and a junior QS in another office need to work on the same project.

Who it is for	Tools used
Project leads and consultants who report to clients or work with other firms	ADLM Cloud

There are two ways to share, and they are not the same. A public dashboard link is for a client with no ADLM account: they open a summary dashboard without signing in, and cannot edit anything. A collaborator signs in with their own account and the matching product licence, and sees the whole project at **View only** or **Full access**.

Steps

Share a dashboard with your client:

1. Open the project and click **Dashboard** under **Views**.
2. Click **Share dashboard**.
3. Tick **Enable public link**, then click **Copy link** and send it to the client.

The client sees a read-only Project Dashboard: overall status, progress, the contract sum and its make-up, cost to date and forecast, interim certificate totals, and planned and actual spend. The button now reads **Shared · link on**.

Invite a collaborator:

1. Open the project and click **Collaborators**.
2. Under **Access level**, choose **View only** or **Full access**.
3. Fill in **Label (optional)**, **Restrict to emails (optional)** and **Max uses (0 = unlimited)** if you want to limit who can join.
4. Click **Generate code**.
5. Under **Active codes**, click **Copy**, or **Link & QR** for a join link and a QR code.

Join as a collaborator:

1. Open the link and sign in, or open the project list for that product, click **Add shared project**, type the **Share code** and click **Add project**.
2. The project appears marked **Shared with you**.

What each person can see and do

	Owner	Full access	View only
Edit rates and progress	Yes	Yes	No
Download exports and reports	Yes	Yes	No
Invite people, delete, public link	Yes	No	No

	Owner	Full access	View only
See rates and money	Yes	Only with a Rate Gen licence	Only with a Rate Gen licence

A collaborator without Rate Gen sees **Rates hidden**. A **RateGen subscription is required to view rates**. Rates and money totals show as a dash, bill and budget exports are refused, and they cannot raise variations, rebuild the schedule or price services.

What you get at the end

A client who can check progress from a phone at any time, and colleagues who can work on the same project at the level of access you chose.

Tips

IMPORTANT

Anyone who has the public link can open the dashboard. When you no longer want it shared, untick **Enable public link**. Ticking it again brings back the same link.

- A collaborator also needs a licence for the product the project came from, for example HERON for a HERON project. Without it they see **Subscription required**.
- Under **People with access**, change a person between **View only** and **Full access**, or click **Remove**. **Revoke** stops a code being used again.
- Give the client a **Project report** PDF each month alongside the link, so they have a dated record.

Use case 10: Training a new estimator with the sample projects

Scenario

A graduate joins your firm. You want them to understand what a finished, priced and valued ADLM project looks like before they touch a live job.

Who it is for	Tools used
Practice leads, training managers and new users teaching themselves	ADLM Cloud learning samples, QUIV for Revit, ADLM HERON, SERVIQ for Revit MEP, ADLM Rate Gen

Steps

Week 1: read finished jobs:

1. Sign in at adlmstudio.net and open a product's project list, for example your QUIV projects (</projects/revit>) or HERON projects (</projects/planswift>).
2. Above your own projects, find **Learning samples**. If the strip is folded away, click the button that reads **Show** and the number of samples.
3. Open a sample. The banner reads **Sample project · Read-only learning material**. Read **What to look at in this sample** first.
4. Go through every view in order: **Dashboard**, **Bill of Quantity**, **Budget**, **Valuation**, then **PM Dashboard**. On QUIV samples, open **3D Model** and click bill lines to see the elements they were measured from.

5. Try every **Export** to see what each workbook looks like.

Week 2: compare foundations and methods:

1. Open the QUIV and HERON samples for the same foundation type. One was measured from a model, the other from PDF drawings.
2. Compare their bills line by line. Note where a model gives a quantity directly and where a drawing needs a measurement.
3. Open the SERVIQ samples to see how a services bill is laid out.

Week 3: measure a small job:

1. Give the trainee a small, finished job your firm has already measured by hand.
2. Have them run the **Model Checker** (QUIV) or scale the pages (HERON), measure, and save to the cloud under a clearly marked training name.
3. Compare their bill with the sample and with your own figures. Discuss every line more than a few per cent out.

Week 4: price and value:

1. Have the trainee price their bill on ADLM Cloud from Rate Gen, check the **Budget**, and export a bill.
2. Have them record some progress, prepare a valuation in the daily valuation log, and print it with **Print valuation**.
3. Delete the training project when you are done, so it does not use a storage slot.

What you get at the end

A new estimator who has seen every stage of an ADLM job on a realistic project, measured and priced one of their own, and can tell a good bill from a doubtful one.

Tips

- Samples are read-only. A trainee can open every tab, filter and export, and nothing can be broken.
- Samples appear for the products your account holds an active licence for.
- **Hide samples** only hides them in that browser. Click **Show N samples** to bring them back.
- Go through the [Rate Gen guide](#) section on reading a build-up together. An estimator who can read a rate's **Rate Composition** can defend every price on a bill.

Use case 11: An ICMS 3 cost and carbon report for a client

Scenario

A client's development bank wants the cost plan for a four-bedroom duplex in ICMS 3 form, with its upfront carbon, so it can compare the project with others in its portfolio.

Who it is for	Tools used
Quantity surveyors reporting to international clients, funders and cost consultants	QUIV for Revit or ADLM HERON, ADLM Rate Gen, ADLM Cloud

Steps

Price the bill:

1. Measure the building in QUIV or HERON and save it to ADLM Cloud.
2. Price every line from your Rate Gen rates. The carbon comes from the same rates, so a line priced from a Rate Gen rate gets a firm carbon figure.
3. In Rate Gen, open **Carbon & Others** and check that your main rates (concrete, reinforcement, blockwork, roofing, finishes) show a figure under **KGCO2E / UNIT**.

Set the contract figures on ADLM Cloud:

1. Open the project.
2. On the **Contract** tab, set **Preliminaries %**.
3. Under the bill, set each preliminary item's **Alloc %**, or click **Even split**. Each item becomes its own line in Group 08.
4. In the **Summary** box at the foot of the bill, set the contingency and VAT percentages.
5. Click **Save changes**.

Export and check:

1. Click **Export**. Under **ICMS 3**, click **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (Excel)**.
2. On the **ICMS 3 report** sheet, read every detail marked **Assumed** and correct it in your covering letter, especially the base date and the floor area.
3. Check the carbon coverage on the same sheet. If it is well below 90%, look at the lines with **Carbon from "none"** on the **Lines** sheet and price them from Rate Gen rates where you can.
4. Open **Not placed** and decide a Group for each line it lists.
5. Sort **Lines** by **ICMS code** and read down the **Why** column. Note any line you would place differently, such as roof beams placed under roof finishes, and adjust the Group totals in your report.
6. Divide the totals by the floor area for cost and carbon per m², and say which IPMS area you used.
7. If the bank's cost team uses software that reads the RICS Data Standard, export **ICMS 3 cost and carbon (JSON)** as well.

What you get at the end

A cost report in the 13 ICMS 3 Groups that adds up to the contract sum, an upfront carbon figure (A1-A5) for each Group in tCO₂e with its low end, cost and carbon per m², and a line-by-line record of where every figure came from.

Tips

- The report follows the contract sum. Approved variations are not in it, so issue a fresh report when the final account is agreed.
- Always quote carbon as "upfront carbon (A1-A5)" with the coverage and the factor sources from the cover sheet.
- Quote the low end too where cement dominates. It shows how much depends on the cement figure.
- Try it on a sample first. The [sample projects](#) export to ICMS 3 just like your own.

Good habits

These habits save the most time across all the ADLM products.

Name projects clearly

- Use the same pattern everywhere, for example client, building and stage: "Adeyemi Duplex, Lekki, Tender". The name you type in QUIV, HERON or SERVIQ is the name on the website and on every export.
- Add the discipline to the name when one job has several projects, for example "Services" for the SERVIQ project, so you can find and link them.
- Mark training and trial projects clearly, and delete them when you finish. Each project uses a storage slot.

Check the model or the drawings first

- Run the **QUIV Model Checker** before you measure a Revit model. Duplicated elements and links placed twice are the usual reason a quantity comes out double.
- In HERON, scale every page and check the scale on a second dimension before you measure anything.
- In SERVIQ, look at the counts on the model page first. A model with far fewer fittings than the drawings show is telling you something before you measure.

Save to the cloud often

- Save to the cloud at the end of each working session, not only at the end of the job. Each save from QUIV and HERON updates the project or adds a new version, and does not wipe the rates or purchase marks you added on the website.
- QUIV's ♦ **Run the whole takeoff** does not save to the cloud. Check the bill, then click **Save To Cloud** yourself.
- On ADLM Cloud, click **Save changes** before you leave a project. Rates, progress and settings are not kept until you do.

Keep your rates in one place

- Keep one rate library for your firm, in Rate Gen, and price every job from it. Do not keep a second set of rates in a spreadsheet.
- Set your **Pricing location (State)** on your profile, so every product prices for the right zone.
- Build and edit every rate in the Rate Gen desktop app. The website is read-only for rates; use it to read build-ups and to pick rates onto your projects.
- Turn **Follow RateGen changes** off on a bill before it goes out, so the prices you issued do not move.



Read the latest version of this guide at adlmstudio.net/guides.
Need help? adlmstudio.net/support

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